



BUGS FIXED.

PLAYABILITY IMPROVED.

MARRIAGE 2.0

SEASON TWO

WRITTEN BY

MAX SEBASTIAN

MARRIAGE 2.0: SEASON TWO

Bugs fixed. Playability improved.

Marriage — it's so last century, right?

Think again.

This is **Marriage 2.0**

The modern relationship, **upgraded**.

In modern America, **nearly half of all married couples** end up calling in the divorce lawyers. The average marriage lasts only 8 years. And as for second marriages, around 80% end up in divorce. But there is an alternative to the Great Break-Up.

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Marriage 2.0 has developed a proprietary technology based on **exhaustive experience** and **expensive research**, that can discover your inner desires, and those of your partner—even desires that are so secret, you might not have known you had them yourself.

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MARRIAGE 2.0

SEASON TWO

MAX SEBASTIAN

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MIA AND CHRISTIAN

EPISODE 1

They watched rom-coms all the time — it was the big thing they did together, almost the very heart of their relationship — and so it seemed natural that one day, it would be a rom-com that made them look at their own relationship differently.

This one was called “Permission,” and, as usual, it had been recommended by the streaming service algorithm based on other movies they’d watched.

Snuggled up on their sofa in their little house in the suburbs of Boston, Mia’s leg slung affectionately over Christian’s.

She said, ‘That’s like us.’

‘Huh?’

‘Those guys are just like us.’

The movie was about a couple heading toward a seemingly inevitable marriage proposal whose friends gave them the idea that they might want to experience a little more of what life had to offer before taking that final step toward lifelong commitment.

‘But we’re already married,’ Christian pointed out.

Mia smiled. ‘But I was your first, right? And you were mine.’

‘Sure.’

‘So we’re just like them.’

Christian just shrugged and went back to watching the movie, which so far was turning out to be not as much of a comedy as he had been expecting. Something in the premise seemed interesting to him, though. It wasn’t the usual rom-com kind of thing.

He said, ‘You’re saying you wish you’d dated other people?’

‘No,’ Mia shook her head. ‘I’m just saying... they remind me of us, that’s all.’

A little further into the movie, what interested Christian was that the female protagonist — played by the actress from that British movie Mia liked, “Starter for 10” — was wondering how it might be to try dating other men. She didn’t want to end things with her fiancé; she was just curious about what sex would be like with other men. Her fiancé — played by one of the guys from that hilarious Eurovision movie — didn’t seem so interested but clearly wanted to make her happy.

It wasn’t the usual rom-com kind of thing at all.

‘They really remind you of us?’

‘A little.’

‘Maybe us before we got married?’

‘Maybe.’

Christian saw a strange little glint in Mia’s eye. She never normally acted this way around a movie they were watching. They would laugh at movies and sometimes cry. Still, they didn’t usually attempt to draw any parallels between a rom-com and their actual lives.

He said, ‘Do you wish we’d been with other people?’

And she replied, ‘No... not really.’

But there was something in her voice that sounded disingenuous.

It shook him up a little, actually.

Was Mia suddenly having buyer’s remorse? They’d been together for seven years now. True, they’d only gotten married six months ago, but surely she’d had plenty of time to think about this.

Was she suddenly curious about other men?

On-screen, the movie was becoming more of a drama than the usual kind of rom-com they liked to watch together.

‘I don’t need anyone else.’

‘No, me neither.’

There was a note in Mia’s voice that almost sounded like regret.

But it was a little late now to start getting curious about other people, wasn’t it? They were married — and happily married.

And yet, as the movie continued, it was clear that the protagonists had also been happy in their relationship; it was just that their curiosity had been stirred by their friends. Her curiosity especially.

Christian had never had second thoughts about being with Mia. She was gorgeous. And every minute he spent with her was like pure comfort food.

He knew he’d hit the jackpot when they started dating back in college. Oh, sure, he fantasized about the occasional celebrity here and

there — didn't everybody? But he'd known what he had with Mia was not to be taken lightly. He'd put a ring on it after two years together.

It had taken nearly five more years to pin down the wedding because they'd had to save up so much damn money for it.

'You're sure?'

'Why would I need anyone but you?'

This damn movie, though.

It made it seem like a thrill for the couple to entertain the idea of pursuing a harmless, no-strings fling just before settling down with each other for the long run.

Christian looked at Mia, and she gave him a reassuring smile back. Maybe she was simply testing him. She liked to throw him the occasional test. 'Do you like this rug, or that one?' or 'would you mind if we go to Shelley's party instead of Mike's dinner thing?' or even 'do you want to drive?' There was always a right answer, and she'd be disappointed if he got it wrong.

Right now, she probably just had concerns that someday he might wonder how it would be with another woman. The main thing was to reassure her that he wanted only her, and would only ever want her.

'It's not a very realistic movie, is it?'

'Not really.'

But there was that hint of sadness in her voice again.

God.

Was she curious about other men?

Christian looked at her and felt a strange flicker of fear. What if, someday, she had her eyes turned by some charming guy, and she came to regret that she'd never had the chance to date various men before settling down?

Their friends had all dated plenty of people before settling down, even the ones already married.

What if Mia came to resent him because she'd never had the opportunity to explore?

This damn movie. Clearly, the male protagonist wasn't really in this to explore other women. He only wanted his fiancée. This really wasn't much of a rom-com. Definitely wasn't comedy. Was it even, technically, romantic? The main couple seemed to be in severe danger of breaking up.

And then, there it was.

God. Damn.

Twist ending.

‘I thought this was supposed to be a romantic comedy!’ Christian complained.

Mia was oddly quiet for a moment.

What was she thinking?

Then she grabbed the remote and smiled, saying, ‘So we’ll give it a thumbs down, right?’

Hmm. Perhaps Amazon Prime’s algorithm wasn’t quite as good as Netflix’s for recommending movies for them to watch.

After that, they went to bed and cuddled up, nuzzling each other in the time-honored fashion that would inevitably lead to making love. There was nothing wrong with their relationship, was there? They had sex often enough.

But now... Christian found his mind wandering.

It was that damn movie’s fault.

There was a moment while he made love to Mia that it did, if he was honest, seem a little too comfortably familiar. Was that a problem?

Of course sex didn’t seem quite as explosively incredible as it had been when they first met — they knew each other so well now. Everything they did, they’d done before countless times. There wasn’t that newness that made things impossibly exciting all the time.

But things were still wonderful. Mia was gorgeous. And it wasn’t like he’d have it better if he was with anyone else for as long as this and longer. It was just the inevitability of a genuinely long-term relationship, right?

Yet that damn movie did make Christian think.

He didn’t like thinking about wanting another woman.

Instead, he thought about how it would be to have Mia go out with someone else just to assuage her curiosity.

How would Christian have acted if he’d been in that movie? The guy had been sad but trying to act supportive and unaffected by her consensual adultery.

Suddenly, Christian was thinking about how it would be if Mia returned from someone else’s bed.

Freshly sexed.

God.

The glow of postcoital excitement still in her cheeks...

Would Christian be sad, trying to act supportive and unaffected? Trying to make like it wasn’t a big deal.

In the movie, the couple kissed briefly when they were reunited, and then that was that. Letting it lie. Why hadn’t the guy made love to her?

Wouldn't he want to show her she was still his?

Christian would have fucked her. He would have fucked Mia if she had returned from a date with someone else. Over and over. Don't let the passion between them die. Strike while the iron was hot and all that. Give her something else to glow about.

'What is this?'

'What is what?'

His mind came crashing back to earth. Mia was on top of him, straddling him, holding his head with both hands as she kissed him, rubbing herself up against his hardness. God, it felt good.

'*This*,' she said, sitting up, offering him a superb view as she shifted back. Her hands moved to his cock.

'You need me to explain?' he said dryly. 'I thought we'd done it enough that you'd know by now.'

'No,' she smirked. 'You don't need to explain.'

But she was looking at it as though she'd never seen one before. Holding it with both hands, slowly stroking it like a new toy.

'You're so *hard*,' she said in a kind of awe-struck whisper.

Gazing at his erection like it was made of 24-carat gold or something.

'Well, duh. You're naked, and you're on top of me, and we're about to — '

'But you're not usually *this* hard. I mean... Wowzers.'

True enough, he was rock-hard. It wasn't that he had ever had any problems getting hard, but when you had sex all the time with the same woman, day in, day out, it happened at maybe 80–90% proof. Maybe 70% if you'd been drinking.

'*Sometimes* I am,' he protested.

He remembered the summer they'd vacationed at that resort in Boca Raton. Mia had worn a bikini for the first time — previously, it had always been one-piece swimsuits — because her friends had bought her one for her birthday. God, he'd been hard for that whole trip.

'On special occasions, sure,' Mia nodded, smiled. 'Like when I put on that bikini, right?'

They laughed. He felt vindicated that she remembered how it had been.

'Right,' he said.

But then she said, 'So why is it a special occasion now?'

She ducked down, gently blew on the end of his cock as she held it aloft, admiring its shape. The airflow from her mouth felt curiously good.

He said, 'You're complaining?'

She shook her head. 'I'm just curious.'

There was something oddly hot about how she was looking at his cock. The way she was exploring it. She was genuinely excited by it, by how hard he was.

There was even a little flush in her cheeks.

She said, 'Is it the movie? The actress in the movie?'

He said, 'What?' Worried he was about to be in trouble for lusting after some other woman — even though he hadn't been. Honest to God, he hadn't been thinking about the woman in the movie. He had genuinely been thinking about Mia.

'What's her name... Rebecca Hall.'

Christian looked down at her, but she didn't seem to be trying to trip him up. She was amused that he might be this hard because he'd been fantasizing about a Hollywood actress, she wasn't offended.

'I wasn't thinking about her,' he insisted.

She grinned. 'I'm not jealous,' she insisted and slipped the tip of his cock into her mouth.

God, that felt good.

She was so beautiful. Those big, brown eyes of hers. Her high cheekbones. She didn't often go down on him like this. It had never bothered him that much that she didn't — but this was hot.

She sank down on him, and as she did so, she closed her eyes and quietly moaned with pleasure.

Christian couldn't get the movie out of his head. It wasn't the actress, it was the movie. He was picturing the movie as if Mia was starring in it. As if he and Mia were in that bar, the piano guy flirting with Mia. Mia going home with the piano guy instead of him.

And now Christian was imagining Mia sucking that piano guy's cock instead of his. Cupping his balls as she took him in her mouth.

'Oh — *God...*'

He came. He really wasn't expecting it. It just happened. His cock pulsed and jerked, and then he was shooting it out into her mouth.

He expected her to cry out, perhaps jump away from him in disgust. But she didn't — she swallowed. She swallowed and moaned even louder — contented, delighted, thrilled. And she swirled her tongue around him, lapping up the last remaining drops.

'I'm...I mean... I didn't...' he said, breathless, not finding the right words to apologize.

She smiled broadly, as though he'd been the one to make her come.

She giggled and said, 'Maybe we should have given that movie a thumbs-up instead, huh?'

Then, a few days later, they finished dinner and got all cozy together on the couch, and Mia put on a movie from Amazon Prime, and it also had Rebecca Hall starring in it.

The female lead was a sad, sad woman whose singer-songwriter husband had died. And then Ted Lasso came along on a motorcycle to fall in love with her.

'What is this?' Christian said as they watched this woman visiting her husband's damn grave.

Mia grinned and snuggled in close to him. 'It's her,' she said, flicking her eyes to the screen. 'It's the one. You know, Rebecca Hall. You like her.'

Christian was a little stunned.

Why would Mia want to encourage him to have a crush on some Hollywood actress?

'Her?' he said.

Mia giggled. 'It's okay. I don't mind.'

'I don't... I mean... I...'

'I'm not jealous.'

She'd said that before. And now Rebecca Hall was banging some local guy in her log cabin, and Mia's hand was moving down to Christian's lap, seeking something out that just wasn't there.

'Oh,' she said, finding his manhood somewhat softer than she'd expected.

Then she was trying to stroke him through his pants while Rebecca Hall sparred onscreen with Ted Lasso, conflict turning into inevitable attraction, according to the rom-com rules. But Christian wasn't reacting the way she'd hoped.

'It's not as sexy, this movie,' she said, as Ted Lasso charmed Rebecca Hall's family and friends halfway through the movie. And Christian wondered if he should try faking a crush on Rebecca Hall just to make his wife happy.

When she had his pants open and his cock in her hand, he had to start really making an effort to get hard so as not to leave her offended.

But the movie wasn't getting him going. Rebecca Hall, bless her, wasn't exactly putting the lead in his pencil. She was okay, sure — but she wasn't Mia. And perhaps because this movie wasn't as erotic, it didn't help either. Even when the two leads onscreen finally slept together, it wasn't much to write home about.

Christian found himself thinking of the previous movie. The scene in which the couple went to a bar to find her another man.

'*There!*' Mia said as he was finally hard, and then she slipped onto her knees on the floor in front to start sucking his cock.

He didn't come in her mouth this time; they had time to move to the bedroom. It wasn't quite as explosive as it had been after they'd watched "Permission," but it was good.

Only, Christian couldn't stop thinking about how it would be to take Mia to a bar and then let her find another man to take home.

The next evening, they watched "The Awakening" together, and it wasn't even a romantic movie — it was a ghost story. A good one, but not romantic. Christian wasn't even a little bit hard.

'What's going on with you?' he asked Mia when she seemed disappointed.

'I thought you liked her,' she protested.

'No... I mean... she's a fine actress. Why are you trying to get me to have a crush on Rebeca Hall?'

Crestfallen, Mia pulled herself up from the floor in front of him. 'You were so *hard*...' she said quietly.

'That wasn't because of her.'

Mia walked away, leaving Christian scratching his head. He didn't understand her. Now she was upset because he didn't get hard watching a particular Hollywood actress. Why was he in trouble for that?

Then she came back out of the kitchen, and she was crying.

'I don't want us to become... you know...'

'What?'

'The kind of married couple that doesn't have sex.'

Christian frowned. 'We're not. We still have sex. All the time.'

'It's not how it used to be.'

He felt he had no satisfactory answer to that. He could hardly deny it. He said, 'It's still good. It's still *great*.'

‘If it were great, you would always be hard like you were when we watched that movie.’

That movie. That damn movie.

Romcoms weren’t supposed to make couples argue. Okay, so that one had been more of a romantic drama. But still, it had been recommended to them — and recommendations were based on what they’d watched before, right? They were supposed to be movies that you would want to watch.

‘We just need to get in the right mood,’ Christian said, sighing, wishing there was a more straightforward answer. ‘Sometimes I’m in a better frame of mind... when I’m not tired from work...’

‘It’s not just when you’re tired,’ she said.

There was a long pause. She sat down on the armchair. Suddenly the air felt frosty between them. It had never been like this before, not since the day they’d met.

Was this what marital problems felt like?

She said, ‘Are we “17 Again”? Is that who we are?’

Christian sighed again. Why did she have to try to frame their lives as a rom-com movie? Now she was suggesting they were becoming a Zac Efron movie, for God’s sake.

‘No, we’re “The Notebook,”’ he insisted, adding under his breath, ‘*Without* the dementia.’

‘You’re going to buy a necklace for your secretary...’ Mia wailed, and Christian couldn’t fail to get the “Love, Actually” reference.

‘You can’t just let movies run your life,’ he said.

She looked up from her hands, and he thought she would be angry with him. But then she suddenly started properly crying.

He moved to her, kneeling at her feet. ‘What is it?’

‘I did something,’ she said between sobs.

Christian felt his whole body turn to ice. And now he was having rom-com visions. In this case, “Crazy, Stupid Love.”

Had Mia had an affair?

Was she going to suddenly announce she wanted a divorce?

How could a perfectly happy marriage come to this so suddenly?

‘What did you do?’

It took her a few moments to reply.

‘I signed up for a program,’ she said at last.

‘A *program*?’

‘It’s called Marriage 2.0.’

Christian felt his jaw drop. ‘You signed up for marriage counseling?’

She looked down at him, wide-eyed, wiping the tears from her cheeks. 'It's not marriage counseling,' she said, sounding a little panicked, worried he would suddenly leave her because of this. 'It's like... a program to make marriage fun again.'

'Sounds like marriage counseling.'

'No, it's not. It's more like... a vacation. Or a visit to a theme park. They arrange adventures for couples, that's all.'

'And you didn't think to tell me you signed us up?'

She looked frightened. He felt crushed. Why would she ever be frightened of him?

'I thought it would be a nice surprise,' she said. 'I thought we would have fun... and then I'd explain, and you'd understand...'

He smiled, trying to reassure her. 'I do understand,' he insisted.

Then he asked her, 'So what happened when you signed up for the program?'

She said, sounding disappointed, 'Nothing much. They told me I should watch a movie with you.'

He laughed, 'We do that all the time. Did you pay them for this advice?'

She laughed and shrugged.

He said, 'Which movie did they want you to watch with me?'

'I was just supposed to put on Amazon Prime. And when I did, that movie came up, the one with *her* in it. Rebecca Hall.'

There was a moment when things started to make a little more sense. It hadn't exactly been the usual kind of movie they watched together. That was why, when it had started out, they had both assumed it would turn out to be just another cute rom-com.

'Why would they want us to watch that movie?' Christian asked, but his brain was already coming up with theories.

Mia grinned, 'Well, I thought it might be because she was in it... But apparently she wasn't what got you so... *hard*...'

Christian gave a little nod. Thinking that it didn't make any sense for a marriage counseling program to suggest watching a movie to get the husband interested in the starring actress. But to introduce the idea that a man might be interested in letting his partner date other guys...

That was what had excited Christian about that movie, wasn't it?

That was what the point of that movie had been: that the woman involved needed to see other men to provide her what was lacking in her life.

‘Maybe we should watch it again,’ he said, ‘And maybe we can both figure out why they would want us to watch it.’

Mia giggled. ‘I’ll bet it’s because you *do* like her...’

They snuggled up on the couch, and Mia showed him the Marriage 2.0 website on her iPad — and she played him the introductory video. It sounded intriguing.

Not exactly marriage counseling. Kind of an adventure.

‘So what have they told you to do?’ he asked her once he generally understood what it was all about.

‘Watch Amazon Prime,’ she said. ‘*They* selected that movie.’

So they put it on the TV again.

Christian thought it would be boring, watching it a second time — it wasn’t exactly “The Godfather.” But, somehow, it was different watching it this time. They’d been told to watch this movie to kick-start their adventure. This was going to lead to an improvement in their relationship. A rekindling of their marriage.

They cuddled together, and this time watching the movie seemed to take on a different meaning.

‘You think that’s what we’re like?’ he asked her as they watched the awkward opening sex scene, in which long-term lovers clearly no longer have the spark they once had.

‘Not yet,’ she said, her hand wandering to his lap as though to test his ongoing response to what they were watching. ‘But I don’t want to ever be like that.’

God. It did start like a rom-com. It had that whole cutesy feel going on. The gay friends helping to propel the heterosexual plot along.

Then came the inciting incident — the dinner in which the friends suggested the couple would somehow miss out if they never had sex with anyone else again.

‘You’re sure you don’t like her?’ Mia was saying as they watched the lead couple talking about whether they regretted not having experience with others.

Christian was getting a little hard. He knew what was coming.

‘No more than other Hollywood actresses,’ he said. ‘What about you? Maybe they think you have a crush on that guy. What’s his name?’

‘Dan Stevens. No, I don’t think I like him that much.’

They watched another dissatisfying sex scene, and Mia was now stroking her husband's cock through his pants.

Then, on screen, Rebecca Hall's character said to her fiancé, 'I think you should sleep with other women.'

Off-screen, Christian was aware that his wife's hand had stopped still. Was she worried he wanted to sleep with other women? He really didn't. If the marriage program was hinting at that, it was wrong.

'It's a shame this movie doesn't end happily,' he said, subconsciously trying to distract her from the idea that he would want other women.

'It kind of ends happily,' Mia said.

'No, it doesn't.'

'They aren't meant to be together. She finds that out. She's happier for it.'

'But she leaves him. He's not happy at the end.'

On-screen, the Dan Stevens character flirted with the older brunette from that "Bound" movie.

Mia said, 'So if you were writing this movie, how would you make it end happily?'

Christian had to think. It wasn't made easier by the fact that the movie had arrived at the scene that had been playing in Christian's mind ever since they'd first watched it: the bar scene.

Christian said, 'I don't know... I guess... if I wrote it... they would have slept with a few people... and then realized they still wanted each other.'

Mia nodded.

On-screen, Rebecca Hall was telling Dan Stevens to explore the bar and see if there was anyone he liked the look of — and while he was exploring, she was approached by a strange guy. And then the piano player approached her and attempted to rescue her from the strange guy by claiming to be her fiancé. And then she was flirting with the piano player.

And the Dan Stevens character spotted her flirting with the guy.

And he came to introduce himself as her 'friend.'

By the time the characters left the club, and she was headed home with the guy who was not her boyfriend, Christian was rock hard in Mia's hands.

'*This* part?' Mia said, unzipping him, pulling out his towering inferno of an erection. 'This is the part that gets you so hard?'

He just breathed and focused on not coming into her hand.

Not coming in her mouth when she suddenly engulfed his tip with her eager lips.

At the piano player's apartment, Rebecca Hall slipped away to the bathroom to text her husband and double-check he was okay with her sleeping with somebody else. Why was that so hot?

Then they were watching her have sex with a man who was not her fiancé.

God.

Christian couldn't stop imagining Mia doing this with some other guy.

Mia walking home after an adventure like that.

The couple reunited, quietly telling each other everything was okay. The conversation getting a little awkward. A kiss between them — again, awkward.

Christian said, 'He's stupid, just letting her go like that.'

'Huh?' Mia asked, her mouth full of his cock.

'He should take her back — properly. Have her himself,' he said. Talking without really thinking about it in order to distract himself, to hold off the pending orgasm.

'Hmm?'

'The relationship's basically over because he never takes her back after she's been with the other guy.' Then he said, 'If it was me...'

Mia came up for air suddenly. 'If it was you and Rebecca Hall?'

'No — if it was *you* and me...'

'You and *me*?'

'Yeah — when you came back to me, I'd take you like never before.'

Needing clarity, she said slowly, 'If we went to a bar... and I went home and slept with another guy... you'd want to sleep with me straight after?'

And when she said that, there was no way he could hold back. He came right in her face.

EPIISODE 2

Another night they were watching Netflix, but when Mia selected the next episode of “The Good Place,” the streaming app started playing a movie called “Newness” instead.

Christian was about to turn it off and on again, but Mia stopped him.

‘It’s them,’ she said, showing them a text message she’d received on her phone, which read simply: Watch the movie together.

Christian was impressed. ‘They hacked our Netflix account?’

Mia shrugged. ‘I had to give them the account details. All our account details.’

He raised his eyebrows at that.

She smirked. ‘That’s how this works. They get access to all our personal info — like those credit check guys.’

‘Oh.’

‘And they sent me a special headset I had to wear, which measured my responses to certain things they showed me.’

‘A headset?’

She smiled. ‘You should do it too — then they’ll know you even better.’

Christian frowned. ‘Sounds too much like “A Clockwork Orange” to me.’

Mia looked at him blankly — and he knew she hadn’t seen that particular movie. Not exactly her type.

He said, ‘So based on your brain scan and all our personal information, they’re telling us to watch this movie?’

‘Apparently,’ she grinned.

But it wasn’t as though they had much choice — the movie was already playing on their TV. They couldn’t even read the description for the thing — it just played, and they had to watch.

‘Who’s even in it?’

‘Nicholas Hoult. He was in the X-Men movies, remember?’

‘I don’t think I recognize him. Google says... oh, apparently he was in that Hugh Grant movie, “About a Boy”. I liked that one. He was the kid!’

‘He’s not a kid *now*...’

This particular movie they were watching was definitely not a romantic comedy. It was more of an erotic romance, and a moody one at that. It was a thrill, though, knowing they were being told to watch this as part of their Marriage 2.0 program. It was supposed to help improve their relationship — so they felt they could enjoy how erotic the movie was.

Snuggling up on the couch together, Christian soon found Mia’s hand in his lap, seeking out his bulge as they watched the opening scenes.

And not long after that, Christian managed to slip his hand into his wife’s panties, as they watched the movie’s romantic leads meet after a night of disappointing dates with other people. Christian enjoyed how wet Mia was already as they watched the movie introduce the two lead characters — Martin and Gabi. She was drenched in anticipation.

‘Do you like her?’

‘Sure. She looks a little like you.’

‘You think so?’

‘Her accent is different. You think he’s hot?’

‘Maybe.’

The movie was good — interesting, arty rather than explicit, but nevertheless stylish and sexy. They watched Martin and Gabi hook up with people through online dating apps, and then go through disappointing sex with other people before hooking up with each other.

Was there a message here, about the ease of modern dating?

Or the fact that easy hookups didn’t necessarily lead to good sex?

The key for Martin and Gabi seemed to be that they connected intellectually, even though they had agreed early after meeting that they intended to have sex. And then the fact that they intended, from the get-go, to sleep with each other added a certain frisson to their date.

Mia said, ‘What are we supposed to learn from this one?’

‘I don’t know.’

‘Maybe that we’re lucky, we found each other already?’

‘Maybe.’

‘We didn’t have to go through crappy dates before we found each other.’

‘Maybe it’s telling us that whatever might have happened, we would have ended up meeting each other anyway,’ Christian said and slipped his fingers in his mouth, tasting her. Enjoying her flavor.

‘That must be it.’

‘What’re they going to do for the rest of the movie? There’s, like, 90 minutes left.’

‘I don’t know.’

Christian slid down onto the floor in front of her, dragging down her jeans, her sodden panties. Seeking more of her flavor.

Mia smiled down at him, but then her eyes closed, and she lay back as he found his way through the soaking little patch of dark fur to the glistening pink folds of her pussy.

And soon, her hands moved to his head as he pressed his hot mouth to her, kissing her there, sucking on her there, lapping at her juices.

For a little while, neither of them was really watching the movie.

Martin and Gabi becoming an established couple.

Martin introducing Gabi to his parents.

The excitement of a new relationship beginning to wear off.

Martin deciding to go for a night out with his friends — without Gabi. Gabi feeling left out, engineering a night out for herself with someone else.

By the time Christian finally came up for air, his entire face wet with Mia’s excitement, on-screen, Martin was cheating on Gabi, and Gabi was cheating on Martin.

Christian and Mia were not really thinking so much about the movie, however, as Christian buried his face between his wife’s shapely thighs, and Mia’s breathing became panting, and her sighs became plaintive cries, and her hips started bucking, her hands clamping her husband’s head to her body as she hit her orgasm hard.

When Christian finally pulled himself up from the floor, and Mia opened her eyes again, they were watching a romantic movie in which the romantic leads were bored of each other.

‘*God...*’ Mia said, her thighs remaining open as though she needed her intimate parts to quickly cool down.

‘Is the movie nearly over?’

Mia reached for the remote to check on the movie run-time. ‘No, there’s still an hour left.’

‘A whole hour?’

The movie was confusing because they were used to more standard rom-coms, which were more about a couple meeting, falling for one

another, experiencing some kind of complication before resolving it for their happy ever after. Right now, they were expecting Martin and Gabi to resolve their relationship hiccup and then ride off into the sunset together. That shouldn't take a whole hour in rom-com land.

Christian sat beside Mia, and her hand again sought out his bulge. But this was not a sexy part of the movie. Christian wasn't even nearly fully hard.

Christian sat enjoying the flavor of his wife lingering on his lips, but the movie was not helping their mood — Martin and Gabi were arguing.

Now they were seeing a couples therapist.

What was this movie supposed to be teaching them?

But then Martin and Gabi were told to be honest with each other, and the two of them took that requirement in an interesting new way — telling each other secrets from their sexual pasts.

Suddenly, the two of them were getting hot for each other again.

But Mia protested, 'How are we supposed to do that?'

'How d'you mean?'

'I mean. I don't have any naughty secrets.'

'No.'

'We know everything about each other already.'

Christian smiled. 'I had a crush on my roommate's girlfriend once... does that count? But then you came along, and I forgot all about her.'

Then the movie started getting hot again, and a new message became clear.

Martin and Gabi were talking about flirting with other people.

The tension between them suddenly ratcheted up a few notches. It wasn't a bad kind of tension — it was anticipation, mild shock, and burgeoning excitement all rolled into one as they noticed the sudden change in direction the movie was taking.

Gabi was dancing with a guy while Martin watched her from afar.

Then Martin was chatting with another woman while Gabi kept tabs on him.

And afterward, they were telling each other how they enjoyed watching each other.

Christian felt his wife's hand tighten on his bulge, and he turned to see that she was watching the movie as though it was laying out the true

meaning of life. Her eyes connected with his, and there was an energy in that connection that could not be denied.

Was this the message Marriage 2.0 was trying to get across to them?

There were such clear parallels between this and the first movie they'd been shown — "Permission".

And Mia could tell her husband was reacting to what he saw on-screen.

Gabi urging Martin to get a lap dance at a strip club so she could watch.

Martin telling Gabi he wanted to watch her date another guy.

Mia breathing, 'You're so hard, my love.'

Christian moaning as she released his hardness from captivity and began to stroke it.

She said, 'You do like her?'

And he replied, 'Not her... the movie...'

Mia looked at him, wide-eyed, and then at the movie. She could see the connection to what had happened in the Rebecca Hall movie they'd watched. The common element in both movies

Gabi picking out another guy on a dating app, going out to meet him at a bar.

Martin lurking in the background at the bar, watching her meet her date.

Gabi asking Martin at the end of the date what he wanted her to do. Martin telling her to take her date back to their place.

Gabi reporting back afterward about how the guy had fucked her in their kitchen, much to Martin's enjoyment.

Mia was astonished at how her husband responded to what he saw — his sensationally hard cock telling her there really was something in this.

And then, eventually, Christian turned to his wife and said to her in no uncertain terms: 'I want to watch you go on a date.'

They weren't concentrating so much in the second half of the movie.

Gabi and Martin were arranging a threesome — picking out a girl on the dating app for them both to share.

Mia and Christian focused on what Christian had declared more than the movie playing on their TV. Mia was straddling her husband's thighs,

his rock-hard cock sunk deep inside her. She rocked back and forth on his shaft as she asked him for more detail.

‘How would you want to do it?’

‘We could try one of those dating apps, maybe?’

‘I guess we could.’

‘Or we could just find you someone at the bar.’

The way she looked at him as she fucked him was so hot — she was surprised at him, impressed at him, thrilled at the idea he had put forward, and keen to make sure he was really serious about this.

She took off the rest of her clothes, and her nipples were so stiff.

‘You really want to see me flirting with another guy?’

‘Sure. And then I want to see you take him home.’

‘*Seriously?*’

Even just talking about it had them both horny as rabbits in spring. The fact that Christian seemed serious about this made it that much hotter. And Christian felt bold enough to speak openly about how he felt because they were doing this Marriage 2.0 program. They were supposed to be examining their feelings like this.

But the fact that they were so into each other meant they missed part of the movie. They skipped over the section where the Hollywood morality machine kicked in, and decided that Martin and Gabi’s unconventional approach to a relationship just could not stand.

Christian and Mia were rolling about on the floor, mashing their private parts together while Martin and Gabi got hooked on other people, then got bored with those other people, then returned to each other determined to pursue a more ‘serious’ relationship.

While Gabi and Martin agreed to take things more steadily, Christian had Mia bent over the kitchen counter, fucking her hard while she told him she hoped he wouldn’t get jealous if the guy she met had a huge cock.

When the credits started to roll up their TV screen, Christian was too busy pounding his beautiful wife’s pert behind, pumping her full of his hot cream as she told him she was going to fuck someone else, maybe right here where her husband was doing her now.

And since they were doing the Marriage 2.0 program, neither of them doubted that it would happen.

They were being directed to do this.

Mia was going to date another man.

Friday night.

Christian returned home at the usual time from work, only to find Mia upstairs in their bedroom — trying on dresses in front of their full-length mirror.

‘Look!’ she laughed. ‘They sent me some brand new clothes!’

Her dress was fairly casual — yet molded to her curves, with a plunging neckline that showed a heart-skipping amount of cleavage. It certainly made Christian stop in his tracks to run his eyes all over his wife’s delectable form.

‘They sent you some new clothes?’ he said, seeking clarification.

‘Uh-huh,’ she said, all smiles, enjoying that he was just standing there gawping at her. ‘We’re going out tonight.’

‘We are?’ Christian felt his heart rate suddenly pick up.

‘They sent me a message telling me to pick out an outfit for our night out at the bar.’

‘The bar?’

‘Uh-huh,’ she said with a smirk, her eyes connecting with his to silently acknowledge their shared belief that this could only mean they were supposed to try out the whole Mia dating somebody else thing.

Needing more of a verbal confirmation, Christian said, ‘We’re really doing this?’

‘Uh-huh.’

God.

It felt like they were stepping into their very own movie. And not exactly a romantic comedy. Christian couldn’t remember feeling this kind of anticipation, this kind of tension, for a long time. Probably ever since he asked Mia out back in college, and she gave him a sweet little kiss and told him to call her.

And who knew it would be so exciting watching Mia trying on dresses? Not to mention underwear. It seemed that Marriage 2.0 had used the services of a company called Stitch Fix, which a quick Google on his phone told Christian was a company that used ‘recommendation algorithms and data science to personalize clothing items based on size, budget, and style’. Mia had been sent boxes containing dresses and tops and lingerie to try on. Whatever she liked, she could keep; the rest could be shipped back.

Marriage 2.0 had apparently told Stitch Fix that Mia needed elegant but casual dresses that would impress a potential date — and some seriously sexy lingerie in case her date was a success.

Christian couldn't believe how exciting it was to watch Mia trying on clothes — underwear, for God's sake — that were intended to seduce another man.

It was confirmation that she actually intended to do this.

She wanted another man to enjoy the sight of her in a sexy dress, and then peel it off her at the end of the evening to reveal a set of seriously scandalous lingerie.

It was proof that Mia was hoping to sleep with another man.

He was hard as he sat on the edge of the bed and watched her trying on lacy bras, thong panties, and — get this — thigh-high stockings.

She'd never worn anything like this for Christian. In fact, it wasn't the kind of clothing she'd probably buy for herself, even if they had all the money in the world. Perhaps it took an outside agency — a specialized organization — to show her that she could wear this kind of outfit and look simply stunning.

'Can you help me with my zip?'

'Of course.'

And why was it so sexy that she would ask his opinion on which items to wear for her date? There was something twisted about him deciding on something for her to seduce someone else.

'You look nice.'

'You're sure? You think this is the one?'

'Oh yes. Every guy in the place will want you, looking like that.'

She smiled. 'I don't need every guy in the place. Just one.'

He loved how often she smiled since they'd started doing this program. Part of his enjoyment was how obviously excited she was, and how happy she seemed to be to try something new.

'Are you going to wear something nice?'

'Well, I only have to stand back and keep myself hidden away.'

'Maybe you'll meet someone, too.'

'If I met someone, too, I wouldn't get to watch you meeting somebody.'

She kissed him after he said that, and he could see a glimmer of something in her eyes that seemed like relief. They hadn't really discussed the idea of opening their relationship up fully. He got the feeling she wasn't particularly interested in him hitting on other women — let alone dating someone else. But, strangely, he wasn't particularly interested in seeing other women. The buzz was in having Mia stray.

'Maybe there'll be no one there,' she said as she spritzed herself with perfume.

‘Then we’ll go to a different bar.’

‘Maybe no one will want to flirt with me.’

‘Are you kidding? You look incredible.’

She kissed him again, and he felt her tremble. They were both nervous. But she was nervous about whether anyone would want her when they arrived at the bar, while he was nervous that when it came down to it, she might get scared and decide not to do it.

He fully trusted that plenty of guys would want to go home with her.

She had complete trust that she was supposed to do as Marriage 2.0 advised — which in this case, was going out to a bar to look for a hot guy who was not her husband.

It was terrifying, and yet the most exciting thing to happen to them in years.

There was an Uber car waiting outside, which took them to a bar across town. All of it was arranged by Marriage 2.0, which directed Mia and Christian what to do through text messages.

‘I guess there’s no doubt we’re supposed to do this,’ Christian pointed out.

Mia said, ‘You should still do the assessment yourself. Otherwise, maybe this will be more my kind of thing than yours.’

He smiled. ‘I don’t know. So far, it definitely feels like my kind of thing.’

The bar was busy, lively, which only seemed to feed the adrenaline buzz coursing through their veins. Their lack of familiarity with the place gave them a sense of apprehension, but also a curious sense of freedom.

‘At least nobody we know will be here,’ Mia pointed out.

‘Chances are they won’t be,’ Christian agreed.

They wandered up to the bar to order drinks. Mia was glancing around nervously, and it took Christian a few moments to realize she might, actually, be checking out what the guys were like around here. He felt a little tremor of sexual arousal and anxiety sweep through his system on realizing it.

My wife is looking to get laid, he thought.

They ordered drinks — a Bud for Christian and a chilled Chardonnay for Mia.

They chatted about Mia's wine for a few moments, trying not to let the nerves get the better of them. Trying not to feel they were entirely out of their depth.

Christian glanced around the place himself. Scouting the local talent. Was there anyone here who looked like Mia's type? What was Mia's type? There seemed to be a lot of guys in suits. The after-work crowd? It reminded Christian that he hadn't been for a night out with the guys in his office for a long while.

Then he started noticing guys looking their way. Subtly, at first, but then there was no doubt people were noticing Mia.

It was surprisingly exciting.

But when they noticed Christian standing there with her, it was clear their interest cooled.

Christian suddenly said under his breath, 'I shouldn't be here.'

'What?'

'They think we're together.'

'We are together.'

'But we're trying to pretend we're not. That you're available.'

Mia smiled nervously, acknowledging that she should have known that, but that this was all a little overwhelming for her to focus properly. It was such a strange experience. They were both conditioned by marriage to believe their dating days were over. To think that Mia was now suddenly available if any confident guys happened along — it went against their entire beings, it seemed.

Christian said, 'In that first movie, Rebecca Hall sent her fiancé off to see if there was anyone around who interested him, right? And that left her alone at the bar...'

Mia nodded. 'So then the guys started approaching her,' she said.

'And then in that "Newness" movie, Nicholas Hoult purposefully kept away from her when he was watching her flirt with guys at the bar.'

'Right.'

'So maybe I should hang back... leave you to it...'

Christian stepped away. He circled the establishment like a commercial airliner waiting to land at a busy airport. Would people know he'd come in with Mia? Would they figure out what he was up to? Would people notice that he was subtly keeping watch on the attractive brunette at the bar?

Mia hardly had time for two sips of her wine before the first man approached her.

Christian held his breath, his heart skipping a beat.

He saw her smile at the guy. He saw the guy's half-concealed look of surprise that she hadn't immediately batted him away. There was no piano man to swoop in and rescue her from an under-par first suitor — this wasn't a movie, though it felt like they were in the middle of one.

Christian watched her talking with the guy, laughing at what he said. Toying with her hair as she listened to him. He was impressed at how effortless she made it seem.

Flirting.

Particularly considering that she was out of practice.

She was enjoying the attention — Christian could tell. She'd been such a loyal girlfriend, fiancée, and wife since they'd first met, she'd missed out on all this. But she took to it like a duck to water — and she loved every minute.

The guy asked her something, and she shook her head, pointing at her wrist as though she was wearing a watch. The guy then nodded and drifted away. It took a moment or two for Christian to realize Mia had turned the guy down.

He texted her.

Christian: Not interested?

He watched her pull her phone out of her clutch, place it on the bar in front of her, then tap out a message back to him.

Mia: I didn't like his smile.

He chuckled at that.

Christian: Never mind, it's still early :-)

And early it was. It wasn't another minute before two guys drifted up to her, as though they'd been egging each other on to go hit on her. She didn't seem to mind that there were two of them. Christian could see her checking both of them out, assessing them, deciding on which she liked better.

'Hey, buddy!'

'Oh — God, sorry.'

Christian accidentally bumped into somebody — he hadn't been watching where he'd been going. He'd been too focused on Mia.

'Watch it next time.'

'Sorry, sorry.'

When he finally glanced back at his wife at the bar, the two guys she'd been with had gone, and she was deep in conversation with a very smartly dressed man. A man who seemed a little older, perhaps — and very charming.

'Oh my God...' Christian said under his breath, suddenly finding it hard to breathe.

The guy looked like he could be a candidate to play James Bond, now that Daniel Craig had ended his term. He seemed entirely confident and self-assured — and Mia looked utterly taken by him.

Was this the man who was going to sleep with his wife?

EPISODE 3

Christian stood at one end of the bar, watching as his wife and another man sat together at a table.

He could hardly believe how hot this was. Even just watching Mia flirting with another guy — flashing those sweet smiles, gazing into his eyes, nodding gently at whatever he said as though she was really into him.

Gently toying with the ends of her shoulder-length brown hair.

She was happy, she was having fun, she was enjoying the attention of a guy who was clearly interested in sleeping with her. And at the back of her mind, she knew that if she really wanted to, she *could* go home with this guy and sleep with him.

That was the thing about Marriage 2.0. They devised these adventures for couples based on what they really wanted, deep down. They had pushed Mia and Christian to watch certain movies as part of their evening routine, raising the prospect of Mia seeing other men.

Then, they had gently nudged Mia and Christian to this bar, where Mia could meet guys she might like to sleep with.

They were supposed to be doing this. It was good for their marriage. That gave Christian a certain level of confidence and trust in all this, a generally good feeling of safety.

And yet there was one little kink in his armor: Mia had signed up for Marriage 2.0 on her own, in secret, hoping to prevent their marriage from stagnating into a sexless friend zone. Although the Marriage 2.0 AI technology had examined every detail of Christian's records online, and had reviewed Mia's own perspective of her husband, they hadn't assessed him personally.

It gave him a slight nagging doubt as he watched Mia chat with her suitor over a glass of wine.

God, she looked sensational in that dress. And she appeared to be arching her back, to push out her chest and draw his eye to her cleavage.

The guy was a little older than them, Christian suspected. He had that kind of effortless charm and good looks that intimidated Christian a little, making him think of jocks in college, or perhaps even a movie star. But Mia seemed delighted that he was taking an interest in her. And Christian desperately wanted her to have the best kind of adventure possible.

She'd still come back to her husband, wouldn't she? It wouldn't be like in that Rebecca Hall movie. Mia and Christian were already married; they'd already committed their lives to each other.

And besides, there was no way this Marriage 2.0 program could damage their marriage, was there?

The two of them talked for a while. It was intense.

Watching them, Christian was struck by how differently she acted with this other guy than she did with him. It was bizarre because he had seen her act this way before — back when he and Mia had started dating.

This was the Mia he'd met in college, back before his eyes as though she'd time-traveled.

It wasn't that she'd become a completely different person in the years they'd been together. Yet Mia had certainly evolved since. Christian realized quickly that it was simply because she didn't need to flirt with her husband anymore. He was already hooked.

It was a shame, though. Because she was so sexy when she was like this — and as her husband, ordinarily, he wouldn't get to see it.

He watched as Mia and her suitor exited the table to freshen up their drinks. It seemed that the guy offered to get another order, but Mia then decided to go with him, so they could continue chatting.

There was an obvious opening at the bar beside Christian. He caught his breath as Mia led her date over there to order drinks.

As she approached the bar, she showed no hint of knowing Christian. He was impressed at her performance. But she stood close enough to him, while her date ordered a couple of cocktails, so that he could breathe in her perfume.

It made him feel a little giddy.

She said, 'You know, I don't normally let strange men buy me cocktails.'

He smiled, 'I'm not so strange. And these cocktails are worth it. Let me choose something for you.'

'Okay, sure.'

He was impressed at how the guy held himself, his confidence, his evident charm. Had he really just walked up to Mia and talked her into joining him for the evening? That was never something Christian had been able to do. In college, he'd generally dated women he knew from class before he met Mia, and every time it had taken time to get to know them first.

Mia was acting as though he was the most impressive man she'd ever met. The guy just took it in, remained calm, and casually dropped various compliments that seemed to ignite a fire within Mia.

'Oh, this is seriously good. How did you know I love rum?'

'It's sweet, like you. Maybe a little exotic. And it's very good going down.'

'Like me?' Mia giggled at the double entendre. Christian raised his eyebrows at how forward she was being — she'd definitely been loosened up by alcohol.

Her date replied, 'Maybe we'll find out later.'

And she said, 'I hope so.'

Christian's manhood was thickening up, listening to them together. Mia was being so bold. It was incredible. Christian shivered at the way his wife was talking to this tall, dark stranger. And she was just standing there — close enough to touch.

Mia put her hand on the counter, and Christian had to stifle a gasp. She'd removed her wedding ring.

Christian forced himself to keep calm. Breathe.

'Look at yours — my *God*...'

'You want a taste? It's good.'

'Sure, I'll try... Oh wow...'

'Strong, huh?'

'And so big... I don't think I could handle all that...'

'I bet you could if you tried... and you'd feel so satisfied...'

Were they even talking about cocktails anymore? Christian was mildly disturbed by how quickly this guy had gotten into such an overt sexual conversation with Mia. It had probably taken Christian a few weeks to make this kind of progress with her. Maybe months.

For a moment, Mia's date was talking to the bartender again — discussing cocktails and the intricacies of making them. It allowed Mia to turn her head and offer her husband a mischievous little smile.

It was a huge thrill for him.

It was only brief, and then she turned back to her date, once again acting as though there was a wall between her and Christian. But it was exhilarating for him — acknowledging that he was there, that she was doing this as part of their adventure. That she was enjoying herself and enjoying having her husband there to see.

That she was thankful to have a husband like him, who would want to support an experience like this.

‘Christian!’

‘Huh?’

The voice suddenly snapping him out of his daze did not come from Mia — it came from behind him. Christian turned around on his barstool to find an attractive blonde he vaguely recognized.

‘It *is* you!’

Oh, Jesus. Christian’s stomach lurched. She was someone he’d dated for a few weeks at college, way before Mia had come along. But had she lost weight? She hadn’t looked quite this skinny, he was sure. Not a patch on Mia, even in a dress that left little to the imagination.

‘Uh... hi,’ he said, trying to remember her name. Chrissie? Missy?

She stepped forward and did the whole air kiss beside both cheeks. He could smell her strong, floral perfume.

‘Did you look this good when we were dating?’ she said, running her eyes all over him like he was a piece of meat.

Christian offered a bemused smile, saying, ‘I don’t think I’ve changed all *that* much...’

But his focus wasn’t on this blonde woman, whom he suspected may have dumped or ghosted him when they were dating in college. It was suddenly apparent to Christian that there was a solid silence coming from Mia and her date.

There was no doubt Mia could hear everything being said. Christian knew enough from the sheer quality of the silence coming from her direction to know that he was in trouble. And he suspected he already knew why.

‘So weird running into you like this — and here of all places...’

The blonde was just talking at this point, apparently oblivious to the fact that Christian wasn’t even trying to look interested in her beyond a customary courtesy. But she was sufficiently self-focused that she didn’t appear to notice that he was looking at his phone, checking for an expected message from his wife...

Mia: Why is it that she's under the impression that you guys dated back in college?

Christian flashed a polite smile at the blonde, and then started tapping out a reply to Mia. The blonde didn't object to — didn't really notice — him suddenly lowering his gaze to his phone.

Christian: I don't know... I guess we may have dated a little before you came along?

There was a pause where he knew Mia was positively seething.

Mia: I thought you didn't date anyone before me?

Christian sighed.

Christian: I never said that. I think that's always been something you assumed.

Mia: You always said there was nobody before me.

Christian: I meant I was never in love with anyone before you.

Mia: That's not what you implied.

Christian: I never lied to you. Clearly, you didn't want to know about anyone I dated before you, so I never spoke about them.

Mia: So, how many people did you sleep with before me?

Christian: I don't know.

Mia: Jesus, that many?

Oh, dear. Christian's heart sank. He was in big trouble. This would ruin the entire evening.

And now he heard Mia say to her date: 'Hey, you want to get out of here? I am suddenly feeling like dancing. You want to take me dancing?'

Her date seemed to take it in his stride, replying, 'I know the perfect place...'

Then Mia and her date swooshed out of there as though she was excited to go dancing with him — but really, she was storming out on her husband.

Oh, God.

'...and then they said I could actually have the apartment after all, and you have no idea how much that just saved my life...'

The blonde — Lucy? — was still talking at him as though he'd been paying rapt attention to her the whole time. It was awful, but he didn't care much about her.

He held up his phone as he got to his feet, said, 'I'm so sorry... Chrissie, was it? My date — the guy I was supposed to meet this evening — has been arrested. He needs me to go bail him out.'

The blonde's face fell. 'Oh.'

‘Nice to see you again, though. And I’m so glad you got that apartment.’

The mention of her new apartment suddenly made her smile, and she said, ‘Right?’ She seemed confident he’d been fully engaged in her monologue the whole time.

Then, as he was already two steps toward the door, she called out after him, ‘It was nice to see you again too! I hope your... date is okay!’

Then, a few paces further on, he heard her call out, ‘And it’s Missy, by the way!’

But by the time he was out on the street, there was no sign of Mia or her date. They must have taken a taxi or an Uber to wherever they were going dancing.

Christian waited a moment or two by the curb, but there wasn’t even a text message from Mia letting him know where they were going.

Christian waited twenty minutes. And then he went home alone.

He felt a touch of nausea. At the same time, a weird buzz within him almost counterbalanced that queasy sensation in his stomach.

In the Uber home, he suffered the usual emotional fallout from an argument with Mia — the guilt, the remorse, the fear, the sorrow. And yet, at the same time, he thought about her being out on a night out with that charming older guy, and it genuinely turned him on.

She would go dancing with the guy if that was what she’d told him.

But would she actually sleep with the guy?

Ordinarily, Christian would have doubted that Mia had the temerity to take that final step with her date, particularly since she’d only just met him.

But Mia was feeling hurt by Christian; she was angry at him. Perhaps she would go all the way with her date — out of some attempt to shock her husband and pay him back for the apparent deception he’d carried out when they’d first met. Perhaps she’d even feel justified to ‘cheat’ on her husband because he’d experienced sex with other people before they’d met, and she hadn’t, and that was unfair, wasn’t it?

So there was at least a chance that she would agree to go back to the guy’s place and sleep with him at the end of the night.

Christian didn’t believe Mia would stay angry at him forever. They’d get over this bump in the road — hell, he had effectively told her he was

open to her sleeping with other guys, and he wasn't asking to sleep with anybody else himself. Maybe she'd see that as rebalancing the books.

Arriving home, letting himself in through the front door, taking off his jacket and hanging it up, he tried to look on the bright side.

Perhaps Mia would have such a good time with her date, it would soften her anger against her husband.

Perhaps she'd even drop her grievances altogether.

He pulled a beer out of the fridge in their little kitchen and then collapsed on the sofa in the living room to watch TV.

He didn't have to spend ages choosing something to watch — as soon as he switched on the TV, there was a movie for him. Chosen by Marriage 2.0.

“Eyes Wide Shut.”

He'd never seen it before. It was a very stylish and sexy — and somewhat crazy — story about a husband deeply troubled by the possibility of his wife being unfaithful.

The movie was a little hinged on coincidences, but it certainly caught Christian's mood — keeping him aroused and a little nervous while never letting him forget that Mia was out there somewhere, potentially seeking infidelity herself.

Sure, there were moments where he wondered whether Marriage 2.0 was attempting to persuade him to consider a little extramarital adventure himself. But he soon recognized that looking at his life through the “Eyes Wide Shut” lens, it was clear that he was like the Nicole Kidman character, and Mia was in the Tom Cruise role. He was at home acting the innocent, while Mia was out flirting with the possibility of being unfaithful, troubled by something in her husband's past.

Ultimately, there was a happy ending of sorts. Tom Cruise and Nicole Kidman's characters were reconciled, and all was forgiven. Christian liked to think that it was intended to comfort him — Marriage 2.0 was telling him, albeit in a roundabout way — that everything would turn out okay.

But when those credits rolled, he realized how long it had been since Mia had gone off with that guy.

The movie's running time was two hours and 40 minutes.

Surely Mia wouldn't still be dancing with her date at a club. Had she gone home with him?

Had she already been unfaithful? That thought made his heart race and his manhood thicken up considerably. Wow. Had Mia actually done it? Had she finally slept with someone who wasn't Christian?

But these questions led to an uncomfortable possibility: what if Mia did something with the guy and refused to tell Christian anything about what had happened?

What if she was unfaithful and then denied that it had actually happened?

What if she cheated on him behind his back, and Christian was excluded from this whole adventure? He did not like the thought of that.

What if she slept with the other guy, and suddenly decided Christian was not good enough to bother saving their marriage?

He woke up to the sound of the front door closing. He felt woozy, confused. He didn't remember falling asleep. For a few moments, he wasn't even sure where he was. Then it came to him. Home. Bedroom. Waiting for Mia.

The sound of her climbing the creaky stairs shook him out of his zombie-like stupor.

Was it really her? Had she really done it?

It took a moment before the memory of their argument returned, and along with it, a heart-sinking portion of fear. It was morning. Daylight flooded in through the faded curtains. Had she come home to tell him their marriage was over?

The bedroom door opened, and there she was.

Christian caught his breath.

EPISODE 4

‘Hey.’
‘Hey.’

She looked so good — so hot. Cute in that dress. Sexy with those stockings covering her shapely legs. Hair a little messed up, makeup a little smeared.

‘How was it?’

‘Wonderful.’

He braced himself for her anger, for her spite, for her announcement that it was all over, she was grabbing her stuff and heading out of there. But there was none of that.

She looked afraid, not angry. Wary, her eyes seeking him out, trying to read him from across the room, perhaps even hoping for his forgiveness.

Trying to figure out whether he might have changed his mind about allowing her to go home with another man.

‘You had fun?’

‘Uh-huh.’

God, had she ever looked *this* sexy? Why did it take sex with another man to make him want her this much?

‘Do you still love me?’ she asked him.

‘Of course. More than ever.’

He attempted a calm smile, and thankfully it seemed to reassure her a lot. She visibly relaxed and even tried a smile of her own.

‘You went back to his place?’

She nodded her head. He pulled himself out of bed. Stepped over to her. She looked as though she wasn’t sure whether he was about to shout at her or kiss her.

‘And did you...?’

Mia stepped toward him, placed one hand on his shoulder, and with her other hand, touched her forefinger to his lips, bidding him stop talking.

She pulled him to her, pressed her mouth up against his. He breathed, inhaling her unfamiliar scent. It made his entire body shiver, tingle. He could smell the night out on her — a hint of the dance club, he thought. Or was that sweat from having sex?

He could smell a man's cologne on her — subtle, but there.

She'd done it. She'd really done it.

Well, she was supposed to, wasn't she? That had been the whole point. They'd decided to imitate that Rebecca Hall movie — and in that movie, Rebecca Hall had left that bar with the piano player and then fucked him, before returning to her husband at home.

This was what Marriage 2.0 had meant for them, too.

Mia had gone with that guy. She'd slept with him.

Christian grabbed her and kissed her hard, feeling a yearning for her he hadn't felt in a while. She was incredible. She'd really done it. She was beauty personified, sex in the flesh. She was a goddess.

Panting, he sucked on her lips and pawed at her breasts.

Gasping for air, she exclaimed, 'Oh, honey!'

Apparently, she was surprised and delighted that he wanted her this much — that her adventure in another man's bed really had made her husband desire her that much more.

He took hold of her, moved her back, pressed her up against the wall, and she let out a little squeal in surprise and delight. His hands moved down her body, sweeping over her curves, taking in the shape of her hips, the heat of her thighs. Pulling up her dress to check out her gorgeous rear.

Yanking down her panties.

He could smell her arousal in the air — or was it the smell of sex? It made him tremble and fizz as adrenaline flooded his system.

This was the biggest turn-on ever.

Imagine — Mia, his sweet, beautiful, loyal wife, experiencing another man for the first time in her life. She must have been excited. She must have been so wet for him. And the buzz, the glow of sex with somebody new, was carried over into her interaction with her besotted husband.

She turned him so that he was against the wall, and as they continued exploring each other's mouths, she pressed herself against him — feeling the distinct form of his sensationally hard cock.

‘I can’t believe you did it,’ he murmured, so bewitched by her.

Feeling how hard he was seemed to lend Mia confidence, reassuring her as to the true feelings of her husband. And her reassurance that he was into this seemed to excite her.

She kissed him harder, wanting him like never before.

He slipped the straps of her dress off her shoulders, revealing her bare breasts. Where was her bra? Somehow, it only turned him on more — she must have left it at his place.

He coaxed and squeezed her breasts, wondering if the other man had done this, too. He must have. Had he enjoyed touching her tits? Grazing his hands against those stiff nipples of hers?

Mia moaned as he touched her, then louder as he dropped down to suck her breasts. He could smell that cologne on her again, stronger on her chest. She hadn’t showered after being with him. He loved that she’d come straight home, back to her husband, after her adventure in another man’s arms.

The dress fell to the floor, and now he tugged on her panties to remove them, too — leaving her in only those sexy black stockings.

‘You’re so beautiful,’ he said as he gazed up at her from a crouching position.

He guided her over to an armchair. He didn’t even want to wait to get her into the bedroom.

‘Did you like being with another man?’ he asked her.

‘Yes,’ she said, barely able to get more than a whisper out between sighs.

He removed her shoes, parted her legs, and for a moment just stared at her exposed pussy, amazed by it, enthralled, enchanted.

This pussy, which had only ever been touched by Christian, had now been sullied by a man she’d picked up in a bar.

Mia sat there, gazing down at him, clearly ecstatic at his rekindled passion for her, but also curious as to what he was doing, how he was taking the thought that she’d been unfaithful, that she’d gone to another man’s bed.

He inhaled that thick, spicy aroma of her glistening sex. There was no man smell here, though he wasn’t sure what he’d been expecting. The guy had most likely used condoms, right? And the delicious scent of Mia’s arousal would probably overwhelm the guy’s own odor, anyway.

‘It felt good being with him?’ Christian asked her.

She caught her breath, surprised he would ask her such a thing.

He kissed her juicy cunt.

‘Was he big?’ he asked her. ‘Did he feel good inside you?’

She whimpered, a sound he’d never heard from her before. She was crazily turned on. Two guys in one night. A complete stranger. The first cock that didn’t belong to her husband — ever. It must have been a little overwhelming for her.

Christian was feeling a little overwhelmed himself. But he had urges to address.

He crushed his mouth against her soaking wet pussy, and then without even really thinking about it, engorged himself on her wicked flavor. Mia gasped, then cried out, startled yet elated at how he made her feel with his eager mouth.

He slipped his tongue inside her, fucking her with it, as her other lover must have done with his cock.

He loved how she responded to him, the way she couldn’t sit still, constantly moving her body to some unheard music, swaying her head this way and that as she moaned plaintively.

He must have warmed her up. Primed her for her husband’s touch.

Christian slid two fingers inside her as his lips engulfed her clit, and she seemed almost to explode.

After that, they did relocate to the bedroom.

Mia undressed him, revealing his stiff cock as though unwrapping the most wonderful Christmas present. The brightness on her face as she beheld the towering presence of his erection was a joy to see in itself.

‘You like that I went with him,’ she said, crouching to remove his jeans and his underwear, her face moving close to his stiff pole.

‘Uh-huh.’

‘It turns you on, thinking of me fucking him?’

‘Oh, yes.’

She knelt and held his cock to her mouth. Gazing up at him as she stretched her lips around his tip. He let her toy with it, stroke it, squeeze it, suck on it for as long as he could manage.

Then he urged her up from the floor.

She squealed as he maneuvered her down onto the bed so she was lying on her front, her knees drawn in to lift her butt into the air, where he could stand on the floor and just slide inside her.

She was so wet when he was inside her. She’d never been that wet that he could remember. Thrusting into her, it was like fucking a ripe, juicy peach.

The sensation of fucking an adulteress.

‘Oh God...’ she moaned as he thrust into her. ‘You’re so hard, honey...’

‘You fucked him...’

He turned her over, so he could slide inside her missionary style. The scent of her first sexual encounter that night was so strong on her, it was almost overwhelming. Such a turn-on, Christian had to fight not to come straight away.

‘You’re so wet...’ he said, stroking her pussy with the tip of his cock as a way of pacing himself.

‘I have a husband who gets turned on if I sleep with other guys.’

And that made him come, explosively, filling her trembling pussy with his cream, making her feel so satisfied, and so desired, and so alive that she hit another orgasm when she felt him pump his hot seed inside her.

They were lying there beside each other, exhausted, sweaty, immensely satisfied, when he said, ‘I’m sorry I gave you the impression you were the only person I ever dated.’

She sighed. ‘It’s okay. I think I understand why you did.’

‘I never cheated on you, you know that, don’t you?’

‘I know.’

‘After we first met, that was it for me.’

‘I guess it was partly my fault — I was so in love with you, and it was all so new to me, and I wanted it to all be new for you, too. So we could explore it all together... I didn’t let you tell me the truth, didn’t give you a chance.’

‘I didn’t lie to you. I just meant it, like... I’d never felt that way about anyone else before. I’d never been in love before.’

‘You wanted to make me happy. I get it now. You just let me form my own impression about you.’

‘If you’d have asked me straight up if I’d dated anyone before you, I would have told you the truth.’

Mia nodded. He could tell she didn’t like the thought that he’d dated women before her — that he’d slept with women before her — but she was also trying to move on from it.

She said, ‘It’s not like I would have broken up with you if I knew you’d been with other people. But I guess I had a firm idea about what I

wanted in you when we met...'

'Uh-huh.'

'Like you, tonight...'

'Tonight?'

She looked at him, gave him a regretful smile. 'I came home... you wanted me to come home after sleeping with that guy. I never really told you what happened...'

'What did happen?'

Christian was confused.

She locked eyes with his. 'I haven't told you any lies. I did go back to his place with him after we went dancing.'

'But you didn't... sleep with him.'

She shook her head. 'You seemed so excited about the possibility... so I let you think it happened... and you were so turned on...'

'Why didn't you?'

'I just... I wasn't certain how you'd react. If I came home, and I'd slept with him, and it turned out you were jealous, and you hated the idea of me being with someone else after all...'

He nodded. Disappointed, but understanding where she was coming from. Happy that she'd decided to forgive him for his little college deception.

He said, 'Well, now you know how I'd react.'

She smiled. 'I guess I do.'

'So what happened when you went back to his place?'

'We just talked. And drank coffee. And... I guess we did make out a little just before I left.'

'You made out with him?' Christian grinned, feeling a little tickle of arousal between his thighs.

She smiled again and blushed. 'It was nice...'

But then her expression turned serious. 'What were you thinking while I was out there with him? You came home?'

'I came home. I waited...'

'Were you upset with me? Angry?'

He shook his head. 'I was a little nervous... that you were mad at me, that you might not forgive me for giving you the impression... you know... that I was a virgin when we met.'

She smiled. 'I forgive you. I was mad at you... I guess it just... it made me question the way I see you, the way I know you.'

'I'm sorry.'

'It was just a surprise, that's all. I thought I knew you.'

‘I thought I knew you,’ Christian grinned. ‘And then you signed up for this program...’

‘It is pretty wild, isn’t it? But you need to do the assessment, too. Or else maybe it keeps sending me out to meet other guys, and you’re left miserable at home, waiting.’

‘It wasn’t entirely miserable,’ he grinned. ‘You know, I was hoping something would happen between you two.’

Mia gave him a thrilled little smirk and leaned in to offer him a kiss. He enjoyed how excited she was about this strange new adventure: her husband wanted her to sleep with other guys.

What if he did the assessment, and the program decided they should be doing something completely different?

Saturday afternoon. After a long lie-in to recover from a highly active night, they went downstairs to get Christian fully assessed for Marriage 2.0.

Mia had the headset in its original box, in the coat closet by the front door.

It was pretty simple to set the system up — Christian could sit comfortably on the living room couch, and Mia helped him line up the headset properly and attach the extra sensors to the right places on his chest.

‘We’re not supposed to attach something to my...’ Christian joked, glancing down at the semi producing a bulge in his pajama pants.

Mia giggled. ‘I think they can tell how you’re feeling from your brain activity and heart rate.’

She handed him a pair of glasses and some earbuds, which he dutifully put on. Then they had to log in to the client section of the Marriage 2.0 website and click on the button to add a spouse to an existing adventure.

‘Okay, you’re all set,’ she said. ‘Now you just have to watch whatever they show you — and respond honestly.’

‘Respond honestly?’

‘Yeah, you know. Don’t try to hide your feelings about whatever you’re seeing. It’s better for both of us if you just respond naturally.’

‘Okay. How long’s it going to take?’

‘I don’t know. It took me a few hours.’

‘Right...’

He wasn’t sure what he was expecting. A parade of different romantic comedy movies, perhaps. If the assessment was going to take a few hours, there was probably time to get through a few 90s Hugh Grant movies, or some 2000s Jennifer Lopez classics, or perhaps some pre-Marvel Mark Ruffalo.

But he wasn’t shown movies — or at least, certainly not whole movies.

What came to him via the glasses and the earbuds were a series of images and scenes that started relatively calm and slowly, but then gradually progressed to more dramatic and explicit material. It didn’t take a genius to understand what they were getting at — trying to figure out what turned him on, what caught his interest, what kind of thing he was into.

There were recognizable glimpses of movies like *Dirty Dancing*, *Forgetting Sarah Marshall*, and *Wild Things*; and, after a while, consciously more dramatic or erotic movies like *Secretary*, *Black Swan*, and *The Voyeurs*.

But most of the images and scenes were from things Christian hadn’t seen before. It took him a while to notice they were testing out little scenarios on him.

A young woman stripping off for her professor. A delivery driver being invited into a home to have some fun with a housewife. A couple inviting a friend to join them in bed.

As the assessment continued, the material Christian was shown became more intense and pornographic.

Women toying with a stripper at a bachelorette party. A blonde out for a run inviting another runner to take her into the woods for some sudden sex. Two men taking a redhead into a hotel room to share.

Some situations weren’t of interest to him. Some were genuine turn-offs — kinky slave stuff, humiliation, people peeing on each other, and what appeared to be a skinny guy forcing a very large woman to eat lots of cake.

And yet, as afternoon became evening, it seemed to Christian that more and more of the scenes shown to him were making him feel aroused, and there were fewer and fewer duds in between.

The assessment was homing in on the kinds of things that really turned him on.

The woman who loses a bet and has to suck the cock of one of her husband’s friends. A woman fucking a guy with a big dick while her

husband sits in the corner watching. A married couple making out while another man fucked the wife from behind. A whole room full of guys watching a single woman being fucked.

It confirmed, and even justified the feelings Christian had been having when it came to the idea of Mia dating another man.

At the end of the assessment, Christian took off the glasses and earbuds, only to find Mia sitting beside him, looking highly amused.

‘What is it?’

‘You’ll be wanting a shower then?’ she said, stifling a giggle.

He looked himself over — he did look like a complete mess. It wasn’t the fact that he was dripping with sweat, or that his hair looked so greasy it might have been a fire hazard. It was the fact that his pajama bottoms showed quite clearly that he’d come over and over again while he’d had his assessment.

‘God, it’s like going through puberty again,’ he laughed.

‘It was kind of like that for me, too,’ Mia said reassuringly.

‘You want to join me in the shower?’ he suggested.

‘Only if you tell me what they showed you. And what got you the most... excited.’

‘I guess I can remember a few things. Then what?’

She shrugged. ‘We could chill in front of the TV. See what’s on Netflix?’

‘Or what they want us to watch on Netflix?’

EPISODE 5

They were wandering around a farmer's market at the weekend when they ran into one of their former neighbors. Miriam Bywater had lived opposite them for the first few years they'd been there, but after having twins, she and her husband Darren had needed a bigger place.

'You are looking *so* good,' she said to them. 'Both of you. And I'm not just saying that.'

'Thank you,' they mumbled demurely.

Christian could see cogs and gears going around in Miriam's eyes as she tried to work them out. There was a brief flash of an idea, and then she said to Mia under her breath: '*Are you pregnant?*'

Then, as she realized the sensitivity of such a suggestion, she said, 'Oh my God, I mean, it's just you have this *glow* about you... like everything in the world just suddenly worked out for you.'

Offering a forgiving smile, Mia shook her head. 'No, we're not really ready for a baby yet...'

'Jesus, you guys must tell me your secret,' Miriam said. 'You both look so God-damn *fulfilled*. Hey — you know the Dunlops from Landscombe Avenue?'

'Uh... yeah...' Mia said. Landscombe Avenue was just around the corner from their street. They knew Irene and Greg Dunlop from church, and since Irene was a regular customer at Mia's art and crafts store.

'They're going to have a baby — isn't that exciting? Or at least, they're going to try for a baby.'

'Oh, right.' Mia glanced at Christian, offering him a brief smirk that confirmed that she thought exactly the same thing he did. *Why do people with kids always want everyone around them to have kids too?*

Miriam was saying, ‘I know you’re not supposed to talk about it, but they’re having this big party next month as their last big blow-out before they try to get pregnant...’

They assured Miriam they’d see her again at the Dunlops’ party, assuming that ‘everyone’ was, indeed, invited.

But Mia came away from talking to Miriam quietly pleased at the compliment she’d laid on them — even though it amused her thoroughly that their former neighbor had automatically assumed she was pregnant.

‘You think I look fat?’ she joked as they bought artisanal bread from a market stall.

‘Do *you* think you look fat?’ Christian laughed.

‘No. I think I look *well-fucked*.’

The woman at the bakery stall gave them a faintly shocked expression before pretending she hadn’t overheard their conversation.

Mia was laughing as they moved on following their purchase. Christian liked that she looked so happy. That it was obvious enough that other people noticed it.

They were watching a movie called “Deep Water.”

It was another selection made for them by the kind people — or artificial intelligence, if you believed the company blurb — at Marriage 2.0.

Here was Ben Affleck helping his beautiful wife, Ana de Armas, dress for a party. He chose her dress, watched her put on her stockings, and then slowly helped her put on her black stiletto shoes. It was all very sensually shot.

She told him she loved him, and then he drove her to a large house party where she instantly went off with another man.

And then here was Ben Affleck watching his wife making out with the other guy — a younger, blonder guy. She saw him watching them, too, but it didn’t come as a surprise to either.

‘I guess the message from this movie is clear,’ Mia said, her hand already pressing against the prominent bulge in her husband’s crotch as they lounged on the living room couch, watching.

‘You think?’ Christian grinned.

He was just happy they were watching this kind of movie after he had gone through his own assessment with Marriage 2.0. He’d enjoyed

the experience of taking Mia to a bar, and then believing that she'd gone home with another man to have sex with him.

She hadn't actually had sex with the guy, but that possibility was still on the cards.

And with Christian officially joining the program along with his wife, they were both fully in this adventure together. It wasn't going to be just her fantasy come real. It would reflect both of their preferences.

Here was Ben Affleck watching his wife through a window as she danced out by the pool with her blond guy. A friend of his standing beside him, warning him about his wife's conduct.

Mia said, 'You'd want me to fool around with another guy in public?'

'He's kind of denying that she's fucking the other guy.'

'He said it wasn't of his concern. That's not really denying it.'

Christian shrugged. 'I don't know... I guess I wouldn't have a problem with you dancing with other guys in public.'

'At a party?'

'I don't know... part of me finds the idea interesting...'

Mia giggled. 'You're just so desperate to get me into someone else's bed,' she teased him.

Now Ana de Armas's character was drunk and making herself the center of attention at the party. Her blond guy thanking Ben Affleck for letting him see his wife. Ben Affleck freaking him out by suggesting he'd killed one of the previous guys who had been seeing his wife.

Husband and drunk wife going home after the party, Ana de Armas pissed at her husband for scaring away her potential lover.

'The movies don't have to be exactly like us,' Christian pointed out, as Ben Affleck peeled off his gorgeous wife's clothes after the party, and advised her to find a date who had more brains.

'So you wouldn't threaten one of my dates with murder?' Mia smiled.

'I don't think so — but really, it's just that he didn't like that particular date she was with. He's still saying she's free to see other guys...'

'Maybe he's tired of it.' Mia's hand slipping into her husband's pants, finding the hardness hidden beneath. 'You're not tired of it, though,' she said, her fingers closing around his shaft.

'No, I'm not tired of it.'

By the time the movie had become a crime thriller — moving beyond the point at which the wife-sharing had received Hollywood's standard disapproval — Christian was on his back, Mia riding him hard.

Christian asking her, ‘You’d really do it next time?’

Mia answering, ‘Uh-huh.’

‘If you met a guy you liked, you’d actually sleep with him?’

‘Oh yes — I think I’d have to.’

‘You’d have to — why?’

‘Because it makes my husband so very, very hard...’

And then, of course, there was the party.

They hadn’t been to the Dunlops’ place since they’d had it all refurbished. It looked good with new hardwood floors and a more modern interior design.

‘It’s not really our style,’ Greg Dunlop was telling Christian. ‘But you know you gotta do all this neutral shit if you want to get top price for it.’

‘You’re putting it on the market?’

‘Well, you know how it is... once we start having a family... the houses around here aren’t exactly huge...’

The party was on the large side. Perhaps not quite the same scale as the one in “Deep Water,” particularly because the Dunlops’ home was not exactly a palatial Louisiana mansion. But, everyone who knew anyone in this neighborhood was here, filling the house and teeming out into the backyard, where the music was playing.

But here was Christian talking to Greg about the property market as they both gazed out the window at the backyard, where they could see Mia dancing with a younger man.

That was just like it had been in the movie.

Greg didn’t seem to notice Mia, however.

‘... there’s just no inventory at the moment. We’re ready to move, but there’s precious little out there, especially in our price range...’

Christian, meanwhile, was still thinking about how it had been watching his wife get ready while they’d discussed the possibility of Mia flirting with guys at the party. Mia concerned about what the neighbors would think of them if she was seen leading other men on. Christian surprisingly untroubled by the issue.

And now, indeed, she was dancing with a guy in front of everybody.

‘...but you know, as soon as they put the mortgage rates back down again — and they will, mark my words — the buyers will start coming

out of the woodwork again, and then the prices will edge up again, so sellers will decide to come back to the market...’

Mia looked up from the backyard, her eyes connected with those of her watching husband, and she gave him a little knowing grin. Hi you. You watching me with this guy? You think, maybe, he wants to come home with me?

Christian felt a little shiver of desire run through his body. A little burst of arousal spark between his legs.

She looked so beautiful. So beautiful when she was happy. So happy when she was flirting with a young, attractive guy who clearly couldn’t take his eyes off her.

Was this even real? It almost felt like a dream.

Later, long after Greg had been reclaimed by his wife Irene and tasked with bringing more wine up from the basement, Christian found himself out on the deck, watching Mia dancing with a different guy.

This one was about their age, or possibly a year or two younger, African-American, fun-looking. He seemed to have Mia giggling helplessly about something, which seemed to Christian to give him an even better chance with her than the guy who had danced with her earlier.

‘Mia looks like she’s having fun,’ came a familiar voice.

Christian turned to see Miriam Bywater join him at the edge of the deck, gazing down on the rest of the yard, where Mia had found a place to sit with her new friend.

‘Yeah, a lot of fun,’ Christian agreed.

‘And let me guess... you happen to enjoy it when she’s having fun...’

Christian gave Miriam a sideways glance and received a very knowing look in return.

‘Shouldn’t a husband always enjoy it when his wife is having fun?’ he remarked calmly, though he was mildly surprised that Miriam appeared to have caught on to what he and Mia were up to.

‘You’d think so. Of course, my Darren seems more preoccupied with his damn boat these days. But you seem to be educated in the ways of modern marriage.’

‘I like to think I’m fairly progressive. So you know who he is?’

Miriam nodded. ‘He’s called Brandon — Brandon Williams. Just bought the Canfords’ place over on Shepherd. He’s one of those flippers — buy a place cheap, do it up, sell it off.’

‘So he won’t be around for long,’ Christian smiled.

‘Long enough, seems like,’ Miriam said as they watched Mia laughing with Brandon Williams as though he were a stand-up comedian. ‘So is she... going to take him home with her?’

Christian shrugged. ‘If she wants to.’

‘Lucky girl.’ Miriam gave him one of those sideways knowing glances again, adding, ‘Maybe I should say... lucky you.’

Christian smiled. ‘Yes. Lucky me.’

Miriam’s eyes flashed. ‘You will have to become closer friends with my Darren, you know that? Maybe you could make him see sense...’

Shortly after that, Christian went inside to fetch a fresh beer, leaving Miriam to reconnect with a few people she hadn’t seen since she had moved out of the neighborhood.

Meandering through the various partygoers on the way to the kitchen, Christian felt a kind of buzz he hadn’t felt at a party since he was single. The buzz of possibility.

Would Mia really want to do something significant with her new friend Brandon?

Out in the bustling living room, there was a ‘Hey, buddy!’ And here was Darren Bywater, Miriam’s husband.

‘Darren!’ he said, doing the broad smile and manly handshake thing like they were old friends.

‘Miriam said you were interested in coming by sometime to take a look at the boat.’

Christian grinned, though it was Miriam’s tactics that brought the smile, rather than the prospect of checking out Darren’s dinghy. ‘Well, you know, I was thinking it might be a good thing to get into,’ he said, ‘but I really don’t know the first thing about boats.’

Darren’s eyes lit up at that. ‘Well, you should come out with me sometime — down to Plymouth. You’ll love it. I can show you the ropes...’

And now Christian was listening to Darren in the same way he’d been listening to Greg commentating on the state of the property market. God. And it really was utterly one-sided because Christian had not been kidding when he’d said he didn’t know the first thing about boats.

But then suddenly, there was Mia and her new friend Brandon, bursting in from the deck, all smiles and rosy cheeks and sparks flying

and chemistry fizzing.

Mia excitedly introducing the guy to Christian, ‘Hey, honey! This is Brandon — he just bought the Canfords’ old place.’

Christian trying to keep calm as he shook the guy’s outstretched hand. ‘Oh, hi, Brandon. That’s the place on Shepherd Boulevard, right?’

‘Shepherd — yeah, that’s right.’ The guy had something of a charming smile.

Mia said, all out of breath, ‘Brandon wanted me to show him our house — he’s going to do a kitchen extension like ours.’

Christian felt his heart skip a beat — then start pumping at twice the rate to catch up. ‘Uh... right. I mean, sure. Of course — you should show him whatever he wants to see.’

At that, Brandon gave Christian an oddly solemn look — respectful, somehow, as though Christian was honoring him deeply by allowing Mia to show him around their home.

He said, ‘Thank you, sir. I really appreciate it.’

Christian grinned. ‘Call me Christian, please. You’ll make me feel old.’

Thinking, *I’m not much older than you are.*

Then Mia gave Christian a mischievous smirk and an affectionate little peck on the cheek before leading Brandon away toward the front door — and out of the party altogether.

‘...the low shifting wind was a heck of a challenge, of course, along with the harbor’s rapid tides — I mean, we were getting nothing much more than three or four knots out there...’

Darren had his uses, though. For one, offering Christian an excuse to stand there and do nothing as he got to grips with the thought of his wife taking an attractive guy home with her. Was Christian jumping to conclusions to think Mia intended to do more than just show the guy around their home?

Perhaps this would be merely another test — not necessarily for Christian, but for Brandon, to see how he would react to the opportunity of fooling around with Mia, right under her husband’s nose.

Christian tried to see this as part of a long game. Getting a guy — a neighbor, no less — interested in her, to the point where they could have a proper affair.

The trouble was, as the night began to wear on, Christian felt obliged to stay at the party so that he might give Mia and Brandon the space — and the time — to do whatever they wanted to do.

The word ‘exciting,’ though, did not do the feelings inside Christian justice, despite Darren’s monologue.

Midnight. Christian was slumped on the Dunlops’ couch in the living room, the party beginning to wind down by now, the number of guests dwindling to a hardy few.

Greg was holding forth with more ruminations on the state of the property market as Miriam parked her behind down beside Christian.

‘She still giving our handsome property developer a tour of your lovely home?’ she asked under her breath.

Christian shook the daze from his head, realizing he’d been lulled into a kind of sleep state for a while. ‘Uh... yeah, I suppose,’ he said.

A peek at his phone told him that Mia had been gone for a good two hours — surely she would have returned, if she’d only been intending to show a new friend around their home to help him with his own house refurbishment?

Miriam slung an arm around his shoulders, and Christian was vaguely aware that she was trying to get her husband to notice — and perhaps become jealous from it.

‘How many times have you two done this before?’ she asked him.

‘*This?*’

‘You know what I’m talking about.’

‘If this actually happens, it would be the first time,’ he said, and she could tell he was being honest.

Miriam nodded. ‘I would say congratulations are in order, then.’

‘You would?’

She smiled. ‘If nothing had happened, they would have been back here inside twenty minutes — you and I both know that.’

That made Christian’s heart rate pick up again, significantly. It also started him on the road to a major erection, even sitting there on somebody else’s couch, while Mia was in another house entirely.

‘Why do you care?’

Miriam smiled. ‘Mia told me all about the program you’re doing,’ she said. ‘And if it all goes well, I’ll sign up for it myself, whether Darren wants to do it or not.’

He texted her again, of course. He'd texted her a few times, and she hadn't replied. It wasn't the best thing, but Christian could understand. She might have had some distraction, she might have forgotten all about her phone.

When he eventually escaped the party himself, he was actually hoping Mia had been too distracted to remember her phone.

He felt optimistic on the way home. He felt lighter than a feather — as though he was walking on clouds, and all that.

Had she done it?

Had Mia slept with another guy?

The walk home wasn't long. Here was their little house. No lights on downstairs — some hints of lights on upstairs. That gave Christian a little shiver of excitement.

Was he here? Were they still together?

He slid his key silently into the front door lock. Squeezed it open. What would he do if Mia was still in bed with the guy? What did he want to do? Christian decided he wouldn't want to go up there and catch them red-handed. Despite how curious he was, how keen he was to see something of Mia's permitted infidelity, he didn't want to interrupt them if something was happening.

He wanted the entire thing to run its course.

He wanted Mia to enjoy everything about sleeping with another man.

Christian had a massive erection as he took a step inside the house. Thinking maybe the guy's gone already. Maybe they did something, and Mia just fell asleep afterward.

Inside the house, he was immediately struck by an unusual scent in the air. It wasn't the usual smell of their home. It reminded Christian of the smell of cologne left by the guy who'd come to their house to quote them for new windows. That guy had left a presence that hadn't aired out for a good couple of hours.

This was also a guy's cologne.

Brandon's — Christian was sure of it.

There was also a slightly earthy, musky scent in the air that made Christian think of a gym.

Sex.

It had to be.

Mia had done it — she'd had sex with another man in their own home, in their own bed. God, she was so amazing. He just wanted to run upstairs and pounce on her.

But Christian put one foot on the stairs and heard an unmistakable sound.

He stopped in his tracks. It had been a sigh — a sigh from Mia. A sigh that enunciated pure sexual bliss, as clear as clear could be. Christian stood as still as a frozen statue.

‘Oh *yeah*... oh... just like *that*...’

His heart nearly seized up. There could be no mistaking it. Mia was up there with him — with Brandon — and they were clearly not yet done having full, dirty, illicit, adulterous sex.

EPISODE 6

Christian felt like every cell in his body was on fire. There could be no doubt, now, that his darling wife, Mia, was currently in the process of sleeping with another man.

And not just *another* man — the *only* other man she'd ever been with, apart from her husband.

It was happening right now — Christian could hear it.

He dithered about at the bottom of the stairs in their little suburban house, his ears pricked, his prick hard, his heart threatening to pump its way straight out of his chest.

Did he go up? Or was he supposed to leave them to it?

'Oh... oh... oh...'

He could hear Mia's heavy breathing, her little urgent-sounding moans — and the unmistakable pap-pap-pap sound of two naked bodies coming into repeated collision. Brandon, their new neighbor, was fucking Christian's wife.

It was tempting just to lurk at the bottom of the stairs — perhaps even pull down his pants, take his own cock in his hands, to fully enjoy the sounds of his wife's infidelity. The air was laced with the scent of their adulterous union — the earthy smell of sex, of cologne blending with perfume, of sweat, of female arousal.

But at the same time, Christian was curious.

Mia knew he would come home from the party at some point, he'd never been the kind to be the last one out, hanging on until the very end. She hadn't texted him urging him to stay away, to give her time to fully engage with her new friend.

Christian put one foot back on the staircase. From the sounds of things, Mia hadn't even closed the bedroom door while she enjoyed her

first ever sexual experience with someone other than Christian. The sounds were too clear.

If he stopped and really listened, he could even hear what he supposed to be the wet sound of the man's cock thrusting into his wife's soaking pussy.

'Mmm... mmmm... mmm... ohhh...'

What would Brandon do if her husband suddenly returned from the party? Would the guy bolt?

But from what Christian had seen of him at the party, he was the confident type — and athletic, too. Not the kind to be frightened of a returning husband, even if Christian did turn out to be the jealous type.

Slowly, Christian climbed the stairs. He knew how to step to the sides of the stairway in order to minimize the creaks. It wasn't that he was afraid of being seen, necessarily, more that he didn't want to disrupt them. He didn't want them to stop. At least not until he got the chance to see something with his very own eyes, if that was possible.

He was in too celebratory a mood to really worry, though. She'd done it! She was doing it! She was actually having sex with someone else. Having a real surefire sexual adventure!

Breaking out of their routine.

'Uhh... uh... uhh... ohh...'

The sound of Mia having sex was so unbelievably erotic. Christian pulled out his phone — he couldn't resist. Maybe she'd be upset afterward, knowing he'd recorded her adultery, but then he'd just delete it. No harm done. It wasn't like anyone else had access to his account.

As he neared the top of the stairs, he was holding up his phone, videoing what was going on.

He very nearly dropped his phone as he laid eyes on his wife straddling their neighbor.

Oh God.

Christian nearly came there and then, without even touching himself. The guy was lying on his back on the mattress, Mia perched on his thighs. Both were completely naked, now, although Mia was still wearing her black, thigh-high stockings, which only added to the wickedness of the whole thing.

Mia faced away from the door, away from her husband, pressing her beautiful behind down on her lover's body, gyrating her hips as though she was cantering on some thoroughbred stallion. The man's hands clasped her waist, holding her, possessing her.

He was young, athletic, in shape. Taller than Christian, perhaps a wide receiver if he still played football, or a tight end who did more than just block.

There could be no doubt his hard cock was buried inside her. Christian could see the guy's swollen balls there between his legs, nudged up against Mia's bare buttocks. He got the sense that he ought to be horrified — if this were a regular movie, he'd be seeking out some kind of a weapon right now.

Mia was cheating on her husband.

It seemed to shatter Christian's image of his wife as a quietly poised suburbanite, as the kind of woman who could go quietly into childbirth and family life without much spark in her life. And yet that was a good thing. A great thing. Somehow it made her so much more interesting a person in Christian's eyes — and so unbelievably desirable.

He watched her shift her balance, then lift herself up. Lithe, flexible, spry like he hadn't seen for a while. Christian could see the man's shaft emerge from between her thighs — impressively thick, and glistening with his wife's wetness.

There was no barrier between them. Brandon was fucking her without protection.

Mia plunged herself down on the guy's bare cock, hard, and then started a bouncing movement so that she was fucking him much more forcibly than before. Christian so wanted to beat his own meat, to tend to the incredible arousal flowing through his body — but he didn't dare risk it.

Mia's forceful fucking did not last so long. The two in the bedroom moved, and Christian had to duck to the side of the doorway to avoid being seen. When he chanced another look, he saw Brandon sitting up on the bed, Mia still in his lap. Licking her tits while she moved herself on his big cock.

But then they turned over together, moving gracefully like ice dancers, so that Mia was on the mattress, her knees lifted high, Brandon laying over her, squeezing his cock back inside her. It seemed all the more startling to Christian that he had no condom on. But Mia wasn't drunk, she'd made this decision consciously. She trusted the guy enough to let him fuck her bareback.

Christian enjoyed how besotted the guy seemed — how completely taken he was with Mia and her beauty. It gave Christian a boost to his own ego — this was his wife, after all, that the guy desired.

He watched the guy's muscles rippling in his thighs as he thrust into Mia again and again, her moans now turning to cries, ever more insistent, imploring him not to stop.

They were kissing, and that seemed even more intimate than the thrusting of the guy's cock into Mia's sex.

But then it all became too frantic, too intense for kissing. Brandon held her tight, nuzzling into her neck and powering into her as she panted and gasped and whimpered.

'Uhh... uhhh... uhh... uhhhh...'

The guy's thrusts were getting so powerful, Christian could see little glimpses between Mia's thighs of him entering her.

It was so insane.

So unbelievably beautiful to watch.

Why was this such a forbidden part of life and relationships? It was such an incredible experience. Why didn't all husbands let their wives have sex with other people — and watch while it happened? It seemed like the purest way to appreciate her beauty and grace.

And yet you never heard experts recommending that when you needed a little more passion in your relationship, you would do well to go out and find a new lover for your spouse.

Now Mia was back on top, though this time she was lying forward so that Christian could see Brandon's cock penetrating her.

It was so shocking, and yet so captivating watching it sliding into her over and over again, slick with her own wetness.

Mia — his Mia — fucking someone else on their marital bed.

Pretty, elegant, loyal, cautious, refined, understated Mia doing something so wild as having sex outside of her marriage. It was the hottest thing ever.

Christian found his legs getting weak. This was a marathon session. He had to sit, had to take a break from standing. As silently as possible, he eased his body down onto his knees. In the bedroom, Brandon and Mia were giggling about something. Rolling over again so that Brandon was on top.

Christian leaned toward the doorway to see the two of them kissing again, passionately. Mia holding Brandon's head in her hands as she sucked on his face. It was so sweet, so tender. Watching them made Christian wonder if Mia had missed out. Surely she'd made out with guys before Christian had come along? She must have had boyfriends in high school? But they hadn't really discussed it — the assumption had been that she hadn't had any experience before Christian.

She was enjoying herself making up for lost time, it seemed. Christian loved watching her have a good time, even if it wasn't with him.

Why didn't all wives do this? Out in the open, even. They could go to house parties and just flirt with the other guys there. Make out with them if they wanted to. But society had this thing about people keeping to their monogamous pairings, huh.

Now Brandon was kissing his way down Mia's body, over her chest, her stomach. Setting himself up between her thighs so that her knees went over his shoulders. Dropping his head onto her sex, pressing his mouth to her. Mia lay back and enjoyed his talented mouth. He was using his fingers along with his mouth, a lot more than Christian had ever done when doing this with her.

It seemed to have highly beneficial effects.

Christian smiled. He was learning things — hell, how about that? And how better for a husband to learn how to please his wife than to watch an expert doing it right in front of him? How could it be that such basic sex education was denied to husbands because of that ridiculous thing called jealousy? Because of society's addiction to monogamy.

Now he was sucking on her breasts and thrusting his fingers inside her pussy like he was playing an instrument. A maestro playing a carnal symphony. He had her making gasps and moans and cries that certainly sounded like music to Christian's ears.

And as the guy fingered her, she sounded so unbelievably wet.

Christian could smell her arousal, so thick in the air. The man's cologne, too, was strong. It really messed with Christian's senses — making him feel both exhilarated and somehow unsettled all at the same time. The all-pervading smell of another man seemed to underpin the challenge to Christian's territory in what was going on.

From the doorway, Christian watched the guy make his wife come with his fingers, and couldn't help but slip his own hard cock out of his pants for a little pressure release of his own.

The next time he glanced into the room, he saw Brandon lying on his back, Mia on her hands and knees over him, pleasuring him with her mouth. She had her pussy facing the doorway, so that Christian could see the beauty of it freshly defiled. Rosy red from the force of her adultery. Dripping wet from the thrill of it all.

Then Brandon's head was between her thighs, feeding on her pussy while she fed on his hard cock.

It was all so jaw-droppingly eye-opening.

Enlightening.

This was how it could really happen. How other guys would do it with Mia.

Christian nearly came himself, once again, and decided to force himself to stop watching. He'd seen enough. He could be happy, couldn't he? He felt a little bad, sneaking around.

What happened in that movie? But much of it was implied. It was implied that Ben Affleck's character had been allowing his wife to sleep with other guys before the events of the movie — but during the movie itself, there wasn't a huge amount of it happening.

What had happened in the other movies he had seen with Mia? In "Permission", the fiancé had kept away while his fiancée had dated the piano player. In "Newness", the guy had kept away the night his girlfriend had fucked someone else in their apartment.

What was Mia expecting of her husband tonight?

Brandon was on his feet now. Mia lining up on the bed on her hands and knees so that he could grab hold of her hips and fuck her from where he stood on the floor. The two of them fucking like animals.

Was he going to come inside her?

Christian crept back downstairs.

He saw Mia's coat hung up on the hook by the door — beside an unfamiliar jacket that could only belong to Brandon. The two of them were not hiding this infidelity. Had Mia told the guy that Christian was on board with this?

He saw Mia's chic high-heeled shoes tidily tucked under the bench in the hallway, and next to them were a pair of dark Timberlands that could only be her lover's.

Somehow, seeing Mia's coat and her shoes just sitting there, out in the open beside those of her lover gave Christian a new thought: what did it matter what happened now?

She'd already done it.

She'd had sex with another man.

She was exquisitely defiled, she was perfectly debauched, she was completely and utterly desecrated by another man. There was no squeezing that particular toothpaste back into the tube.

What did it matter if they now knew that Christian was back from the party? If Brandon suddenly felt scared, and flew the coop, so be it. Mia had already done the deed. If Brandon wanted to stay and rub it in Christian's face that he'd just fucked his wife, then what did that matter? Christian wouldn't let the guy humiliate him over it — he'd let him have

Mia. It wasn't a big deal. He wanted her to fuck someone else. Why should that make him feel like a lesser man?

Sure, he was nervous. Things might go wrong. Things might not go to plan. Maybe she'd kick him out of the house for the rest of the night, order him to a motel.

Maybe Mia had had her eyes opened by this first time she'd ever had sex with someone other than Christian. Maybe she'd choose a different life now that she knew that there were other guys out there who could fuck her like Brandon.

But Christian still trusted in their marriage. He still trusted in their love. He had to hold onto that.

This was all underpinned by Marriage 2.0. The experience wasn't supposed to harm their relationship.

Christian took a deep breath. He wanted Mia to know he was here, that he knew she was with Brandon. It was time to take things to the next level, one way or the other.

Christian purposefully opened the front door and then banged it shut loudly, so that there could be no doubt in anyone's mind within this house that Christian had come home from the party.

EPISODE 7

He heard them stop and, like a chess player, started trying to think a few moves ahead.

He went into the kitchen to fetch himself a glass of wine, making as much noise as possible without seeming obvious. In a small house like theirs, with thin walls and floors, the sound would travel. Mia and her lover would know that her husband was in the kitchen, getting a drink.

If Brandon wanted to flee, the way was now open for him to do so. The guy could grab his clothes and run.

This was the option that Christian was most expecting. Society wouldn't approve of a neighbor sleeping with another neighbor's wife. And the possibility of the two of them being caught in the act would only spice up the scandal. Brandon would want to escape and then make denials all around.

And yet, pouring himself a fine glass of Chilean red, Christian heard no rumble tumble of a man jumping out of someone else's bed, retrieving his clothes ready for escape.

He heard Mia giggling. She didn't sound anything but relaxed, content.

Christian hovered by the kitchen sink, not knowing what he was supposed to do. What would they think of him if he suddenly came upstairs? Found the two of them there in the marital bed. What would Brandon think of him? Would Mia's respect for him dissipate after he'd allowed another man to bed her?

Then came the sound of somebody coming down the stairs.

It had to be Mia from the lightness of her steps. Christian turned to face the kitchen door. Was she going to kick him out of the house?

Would she drop the bombshell that she'd reconsidered their marriage?

Christian's insides went cold with anxiety. Despite all the little pep talks he'd given himself since Mia had taken Brandon home from the party, he was suddenly nervous that this might have all damaged his bond with his beautiful wife. This was the first man she'd ever slept with other than her husband. What if she now decided her husband wasn't good enough?

He caught his breath as he saw her come around the bottom of the stairs and walk through the little living room toward him. The streetlight coming in from the window behind her emphasized the graceful curves of her silhouette. She'd put on a pair of dark panties and a tight, white tank top that only emphasized her delectable shape, driving her cuckolded husband's desire.

'There you are,' she said softly, and she didn't sound regretful or apologetic — and to Christian's relief, she didn't sound disappointed that he had returned.

'You've been having a good time?' he asked her, trying to keep calm and not show his fear.

'Uh-huh.'

She slowed as she approached him, as though giving him time to move back, to reject her. He stood his ground.

She stepped toward him, and the pungent scent of sex and another man's cologne suddenly seemed to engulf him. He shivered and felt his manhood thicken considerably.

'He's good?' he asked her.

'Oh, yes,' she smiled, though there was caution in her pretty face — she was still bracing herself against the possibility that her husband might have changed his mind about all this. That he might disapprove or perhaps fly into a jealous rage.

He looked her over, breathed her in, wanting to pace himself, enjoy this fulfillment of his fantasy steadily, not in a rush, so that he wouldn't miss out on the complete satisfaction. She patiently allowed him to run his eyes over her, to take it all in.

Her cheeks were flushed from the heat and effort of her extramarital sex. Her skin glimmered, even in the faint light, with the perspiration of their exertions. Her lipstick was smeared, her eyeliner was smudged. Her hair was mussed and wet with sweat.

He'd never seen her look so beautiful.

He so desperately wanted her — yet he was aware that Brandon was still in bed upstairs, and apparently not going anywhere just yet.

‘Is he staying the night?’ he asked her.

She pressed her lips together and looked into his gaze to silently admit that Christian had it right, while assessing how her husband reacted to such information.

‘Would you want to... sleep on the couch?’ she asked him, tensing up in case he angrily denounced such a suggestion.

He smiled warmly and could see the stress melting away from her expression. ‘Of course,’ he said, taking hold of her hands.

An electric spark seemed to pass between them as he touched her.

My adulterous wife.

It seemed so deliciously sexy to think of her in those terms. The memory so fresh in his mind of seeing her being penetrated by another man.

Her pretty eyes connected with his, offering a hint of apology, letting him understand that she was not yet his again; she couldn’t let her husband reclaim her just yet.

‘I’ll be okay,’ he said to her, though it took every ounce of energy he had to resist the temptation to take hold of her, shove her up against the counter and make love to her there and then.

She smiled appreciatively, lovingly.

Then suddenly, she pulled herself up to him and leaned in to kiss his mouth. Christian was nearly overwhelmed by a surge of excitement and passion as her lips pressed against his, and Mia slung her arm around his neck.

Her mouth was warm and sweet, but she tasted disturbingly — and thrillingly — unfamiliar.

She had the smell of a man all over her — not just his cologne, but his body, his physicality, his sweat, his cock, his come. His trespass into Christian’s territory. Somehow it didn’t disgust Christian; it only seemed to enhance his arousal, providing more firsthand evidence of Mia’s success in seducing another man.

Christian sucked on her lips and tasted her tongue, and though it seemed so wrong, so soon after she’d used her mouth on another man, it was just pure exhalation.

My wife cheated on me.

My wife is cheating on me.

My wife likes fucking other men.

She let him kiss her, and it was the most extended, most erotic kiss they'd ever shared.

But it wasn't just a gorgeous wife giving her husband a little treat to keep him going until the deed was fully done and she was back in his arms again. It felt way more than that. This was a husband telling his wife everything was okay — he loved her more than ever, and was 100 percent on board with her adventure in infidelity. It was a wife letting her husband know that while she was having a mind-blowing night fucking someone else, her husband was still number one in her heart, and she loved only him.

It was a husband telling his wife how proud he was of her. How much he wanted her. What she meant to him.

It was a wife showing her gratitude for him allowing her the gift of extramarital bliss.

As they kissed, Mia took her husband's hand and guided it between her legs. She pressed his fingers against the thin material of her panties so that he could feel the heat of her body, her sex. So that he could feel the copious wetness of her pussy seeping through.

'You're not using condoms?' he asked her as their kiss finally ended.

She gave a little shake of the head. 'He hasn't been with anyone for a year, so.'

'That long?'

She shrugged. 'Too busy renovating houses.'

Christian nodded.

She said, 'You'll be okay down here?'

'I bet you never thought the first time we'd use the sofa bed would be for me to sleep on it while you...'

She laughed and took a step back, indicating that it was time for her to return to her new lover. 'I thought we were going to use it together — when my parents come down to stay.'

She turned to go, but then paused in the doorway.

'I love you,' she said, suddenly solemn.

'I know,' he said, borrowing from the great philosopher Han Solo.

She smirked, then after half a beat, suddenly seemed to curtsy. It took him a moment to realize she was removing her panties. Straightening up, she tossed them over to him.

'You can have me in the morning.'

'Can't wait,' he smiled, holding her panties up to his face to sample her scent some more.

Then she was gone, leaving him to make up the sofa bed, and lie down in front of the TV, a movie playing on mute so that he could hear his wife upstairs as she resumed having sex with another man.

He had a restless sleep, naturally.

He woke every hour or so, it seemed. He'd wake and hear them fucking, and that would get him hard again, and there was no way he'd get back to sleep when he was hard.

Or he'd wake and hear them talking, giggling. He couldn't hear specific words or conversation, only the tone of their voices. He could tell that Brandon was charming Mia right off her feet. He could tell that Mia was happier than a kid at Christmas. He could tell that her lover was so into her, he could hardly let go.

If he woke and they weren't fucking, then they would be talking or laughing together, and it usually wasn't long before they were fucking again — either slow and gentle or fast and furious.

And that would get Christian hard again.

One way or the other, every time Christian woke during the night, he got hard. He'd get hard, and he'd have to stroke it, there was no other way to deal with it. Stroke it until he came — only after he came could he relax and drift back into sleep. But then, a little while later, he'd wake again.

Each time he woke, it was a real jolt, too. The kind of waking that felt like someone had just hooked him up to a car battery. Woah. A real shocker. In the fraction of a second it took to rouse fully from sleep, he was reminded each time that Mia was upstairs with another man, committing full-out adultery.

It was absolutely exhausting, waking up like that.

It was absolutely exhausting how turned on he became each time he knew his wife and her lover were fucking again.

It was absolutely exhausting every time he made himself come — each time he hit orgasm, and pumped his come out into a wad of tissues, he could feel his energy levels draining.

When would Mia and Brandon ever sleep?

But Christian could understand that she was excited. It was a real adventure for her — she'd never even French-kissed anyone else but Christian before tonight.

This was like the experience she should have had in college. All night getting fucked by some buff jock, with no worry about what would happen in the morning. She was exploring sex like she should have done back then.

Exploring sex in a different way than the way she'd explored it with Christian. With him, it had been slow and steady — a little more flesh exposed every time they spent a night together until they were finally comfortable being naked. Touching each other more and more intimately as time went along, taking weeks before anything even vaguely challenging toward her virginity was on the table.

Tonight, it was all go. It was sudden, quick, forceful. Touching, squeezing, licking, sucking, grabbing, piercing, thrusting. Sweaty, hot, frantic, unhesitating, full-on fucking, straight out of the gate.

Christian remembered being with a girl who'd been like that with him in college. Diana. Sex with her had been the most incredible experience. But she'd broken his heart. It hadn't lasted long with her.

Christian listened to Mia fucking Brandon so hard it sounded like the bed might go through the wall, and it reminded him of Diana.

He wouldn't want to be with anyone like Diana again. The sex had been something, sure, but he'd come to realize that even sex like that wasn't worth the pain that had followed.

Then, finally, the sun was coming up, and for the first time all night, Christian heard silence. He slept.

It was past noon when he woke again.

Woken by the sound of the front door closing.

He sat up on the sofa bed to see Mia walking toward him, wearing a bathrobe, looking more cheerful than he could remember seeing her.

'Morning, sleepyhead,' she said.

Christian looked confused. How was she so awake and so full of energy? He said, 'Brandon?'

She giggled. 'He had to go — has some guys coming over to do his floors.'

Christian nodded. He felt the excitement levels building inside him, dissolving his remaining lethargy as he realized he now had Mia all to himself.

'You seeing him tonight?' he asked. 'Tomorrow?'

‘Maybe,’ she said, smiling broadly. ‘He’s going to call me later.’

Christian pulled himself up to his feet. Mia looked sensational. She’d reapplied her makeup, but he could tell she hadn’t showered yet, judging by the state of her hair.

‘You guys were at it all night long,’ he said, putting a hand on her waist, pulling her to him.

‘I guess we did,’ she grinned, and now slipped the bathrobe off her shoulders, allowing it to fall to the ground. Beneath the robe, she’d put on a fresh pair of blue panties and a matching bra.

He kissed her beneath the ear, making her moan.

‘Can you smell him on me?’ she asked him. Her words made him tremble as the adrenaline flooded his system.

‘He’s all over you,’ he murmured, kissing her neck, breathing her in.

‘He was so strong, so physical,’ she said, her hands seeking out the hardness between his legs, craving confirmation that her husband was truly turned on by this.

‘You liked that about him?’

‘Oh yes. He was an animal at times. He fucked me so hard. My pussy, my mouth, my breasts...’

He was kissing the top of her breasts as she said this, and now he shuddered as he detected the strange aroma of a man’s come on her cleavage — it was faint, but there. It gave him a peculiar buzz to think the man had shoved his stiff cock between Mia’s breasts.

‘How many times did you fuck him?’ he asked, slipping a hand into her panties without any ceremony.

Mia gasped as she felt his fingers press at her soaking wet pussy. ‘I don’t know,’ she said, ‘I lost count.’

He pulled her to him, inhaling the powerful scent of her night’s sex, sliding a finger or two into her slick pussy, awestruck by just how well-oiled it was.

‘He came inside you?’

‘Sometimes,’ she nodded.

He kissed her mouth, tasting that strange, unfamiliar note he’d experienced when he’d kissed her on returning home from the party. Tasting a mouth she’d used to pleasure another man. It was so weird, so completely not what he’d expect to turn him on — but it did.

The proof of her wickedness.

She put her arms around his neck and kissed him deeply. She put her hands on his head, kissing him so hard he could hardly believe it. She

was taking him back, she was proving that her love for him endured, she was showing her appreciation for his allowing her such an adventure.

He lifted her up, and she clamped her legs around him.

He carried her toward the stairs — and he wasn't a big guy, not really. Adrenaline gave him superpowers. He could have carried her up the stairs, too, except that temptation became too strong. He continued to kiss her and pushed her up against the wall by the front door. He stuffed his hand down her panties again, only this time, his fingers slid inside her; it wasn't just about discovering how wet she was.

He started touching her like he'd seen Brandon doing the night before.

Fucking her with his fingers.

She responded, too, just as she had with Brandon.

'Oh... oh... oh...'

People don't tell you how much you can learn from watching another man fuck your wife.

He dropped down onto his knees, kissing her breasts just above the material of her bra. Still fucking her with his fingers. Mia reached around to remove her bra, then draped her hand over his shoulders and tilted her head down to kiss him some more.

She seemed impressed at how he was touching her. He enjoyed impressing her.

'Mmm... uh...'

Her nipples were so hard.

Christian squeezed her breasts and sucked on her nipples hard, treating her a little more roughly than he would ordinarily. She seemed to like it.

'Oh yeah...'

But then she was urging him down — her hands clenching around his shoulders, pushing him down in a way that was quite unlike her.

Christian glanced up at her, surprised, double-checking that he had it right, that she was almost ordering him to kiss his way down her stomach, toward her sex.

'Please...' she said, her hands moving to his head, urging him to plant his face between her thighs.

He couldn't believe she was demanding oral sex. She'd never done that before. It was sexy as hell.

He tugged on the waistband of her panties, dragging the scrap of material down past her hips, letting them fall to her ankles, leaving her

pussy right there in front of him, the scent of her evening's adultery suddenly almost strong enough to overpower him.

Her pussy was in a real state. He could hardly believe it.

But Mia was pulling his head toward her soaking strip of fur, apparently giving him no choice at all but to carry out her wishes — since when had she been so pushy?

‘Please honey... I *need* you...’

He had to admit, it was a thrill to have her demanding his services like this — but at the same time, this wasn't the Mia he'd dated. This wasn't the woman he'd married.

Had Marriage 2.0 changed her?

The question whirled around his head, morphing and mutating as it did so — if she'd had more experience in college, before she'd met Christian, would it have changed her as a person? Would she have still been the kind of woman he would have wanted to marry? Would she still be the kind of woman who would have wanted to marry him?

What if her new experience with other men changed her, so that she was no longer right for this marriage?

EPISODE 8

It was hot as hell, he couldn't deny it. She stood there, leaning back against the wall, and he knelt before her, clamping his mouth to her well-used pussy, making her come like he'd never made her come before.

She didn't give him an option, not really. She wanted it. He felt like he had to give it to her, even though she'd just fucked another man.

He could tell she felt deeply appreciated by him, precious. That he would reconnect with her in that way. Wiping away the cream of another man and then fucking her with his mouth, after another man had fucked her there all night with his enormous cock.

And the guy did have an enormous cock.

She told him about it the whole while as he was going down on her. Telling him how incredible it had felt, how she could never have imagined the pleasure possible with a man like that. A man who had a cock that stretched her, that could barely fit inside her, that grazed up against every sensitive place inside her as he had fucked her.

'Oh God, the first time he was inside me, I thought I was going to go insane...'

Christian didn't feel bad that the other guy had a bigger dick — he felt elated that Mia could have such an experience. It was strangely exciting that the other guy was different.

He envied Brandon, sure. But he was still Mia's husband. That gave him a unique status to cling to.

And how sexy was it, when he made her come with his mouth, and then she was hauling him up to his feet, kissing him passionately, his face still slick with her wetness — *their* wetness. And she dragged him upstairs, shoved him down on the bed, and then straddled him. He felt

her pussy engulfing his granite-hard cock — his cock lubricated within her pussy by another man's come.

She looked at him with wide-open eyes as she fucked him, and the connection between them seemed stronger than ever before.

She was amazed by him, impressed by him, grateful to him.

That he would let her have this experience. That he would even want her after she'd had this experience.

That another man's come within her most intimate place could somehow make their own bond stronger.

'I love you so much, honey... I love you so much...'

'I love you too, sweetheart...'

It felt like no other man in the world would be like Christian. Letting her experience sex with whomever she pleased, and worshipping her because she'd taken that freedom.

But she was different since she'd been with Brandon.

The confidence in her was astounding — like she'd taken some kind of pill for it. Dating one guy all her life, then marrying him, had given her a certain kind of mindset. Flirting with other guys, and ultimately sleeping with someone who wasn't her husband, had opened her to a new kind of assurance and self-respect.

The first time Christian made love to her after she'd been with Brandon, it was noticeable because Christian knew her so well. An outside observer might not have seen anything — sure, she was a little more demanding in bed than usual, but she was so full of sexual energy, she craved certain things, she had needs she'd never had before.

She had to initiate everything — her whole body had been awakened to a sexual power she'd never experienced before.

She had to feel his mouth on her clit, she had to grind her pussy on his face, it felt so good, it made her feel so commanding, so capable.

She had to pin him to the bed and ravish him like never before, she had to consume him before this incredible energy went away.

She had to ride her husband like she was a jockey in the Kentucky Derby.

And afterward, when she felt satisfied, she also felt exhausted. Completely drained. She had to ask her husband to join her in the shower, to wash her and dry her, because she needed his support. She had to ask him to fetch her a drink, something to eat. She was completely shot.

Then came the morning, and he was fetching her breakfast in bed. And she was joking about how good it felt to be waited on, hand and

foot. But then he asked if there was anything else she wanted, and she wanted his mouth on her pussy again.

She even crushed a fresh orange so that it dribbled down between her thighs, and he had to clean her up before it made a mess of the sheets.

It was heaven, worshipping her, but it was a dynamic that hadn't been in their marriage before she started seeing Brandon. And that was unnerving to Christian.

When she went on a full date with Brandon, Christian prepared her. It was intimate and sexy. He liked helping her get ready for a full night out with someone else — there was the strangest tension in the air. So erotic, but at the same time, there was a sense of danger, too. Risk.

It felt like juggling with one ball too many. If you kept the balls moving, and you got your hands to each one in time to keep it all going, it felt great, exciting, elating. But juggling four balls was a little trickier than juggling three. There was a lot to keep track of, and you were more nervous that you would drop something. And at any time, it could all go completely wrong.

Mia asked her husband to help her shave her pussy. Brandon preferred it that way, she said.

It left her looking quite different. Quite stunning. She'd never done that for her husband.

She wore a g-string, when she never even wore thongs for her husband.

She had a new perfume that made her feel sweet, rather than her usual floral — vanilla, hints of coconut, spun sugar — because she thought it was something Brandon would enjoy.

She looked magnificent in that moment before she stepped out the door. It was even exciting when she told him to wait for her, and not to touch himself while she was gone, that she wanted him ready for her, that she didn't want him tired, or depleted, when she got back.

But when she left, and the door closed behind her, Christian felt a little cold, and the fear threatened to take over. He felt the risk of dropping the ball step up to a whole new level.

What if she changed, but Christian stayed the same? What if the new Mia was no longer interested in the old Christian?

Christian tried to take his mind off things.

It was tempting to sit and dwell on what was going on — to think about the sexy side of Mia's date with another man. That she would be having so much fun, that Brandon would be sitting with her at dinner all evening, just desperate to get her into bed. That the two of them would eventually get back to his place, and she would strip off for him, and indulge in her basest desires.

But thinking about Mia and Brandon also brought with it the fear.

After a while, it seemed preferable to try to distract himself. He tried cooking Chinese food from scratch. He baked cookies, for goodness sake.

Yet he was never completely free from thinking about Mia and her new lover.

He watched "When Harry Met Sally" because it was on, and it had always been a favorite movie of his and Mia's. Men can't just be friends with women, right? The sex part always gets in the way.

The movie got him thinking — what if Mia simply had more friends, a busier social life? That would make her feel more fulfilled, right? More self-assured. More confident. And yet, at the same time, it was so profoundly sexy that she would have the self-assurance from flirting with other guys, from sleeping with whoever she liked.

Nine o'clock, Mia's mother called.

'She's not home? Oh — that's right, I forgot. She's out with Brandon this evening?'

It shocked Christian that Mia had told her about Brandon.

'That's right... I can pass on a message if you like. Or you could text her...'

'Oh, it's okay, sweetie. She's with Brandon tonight. I don't want to interrupt.'

From her suggestive tone of voice, Christian got the impression that Mia hadn't merely told her mother that Brandon was simply a new friend.

Not quite knowing what to say, he said to her, 'Is there anything you need help with? Anything I can do?'

Then Mia's mom said, 'Oh no, sweetie. You are doing just fine as you are. You're the perfect husband, you know that? Now you just have a wonderful evening. I'll be okay.'

And that had been that. Christian was left shaking a little, feeling oddly glad that he had apparently won the approval of Mia's mom — and yet, at the same time, somewhat disturbed that she seemed to know that he was allowing Mia the freedom to sleep with Brandon.

At ten, Mia sent him a text message to let him know that she and Brandon were going to a nightclub, and that he shouldn't wait up for her. He let her know he was fine, everything was okay.

She suggested maybe he should go out for a drink with one of his friends.

That was a good idea in theory, but usually when Christian was going for a drink with his friends, they arranged it ahead of time. If Christian suddenly asked his usual drinking buddies for company at this kind of time, they'd think something serious had happened.

Anyway, he sent a message back to Mia saying he thought it was a good idea, but neglecting to add that he would probably give it a miss on the grounds that it would prove overly complicated to arrange.

Twenty minutes later, while he was beginning to think about going upstairs to bed, there was a knock at the front door.

Miriam.

'Hey — I heard somebody might need a little company!'

Christian was surprised, to say the least. 'What are you...' he said. Then, 'I'm okay. I'm fine.'

Miriam grinned and walked past him into the house. 'I didn't mean you, buddy. I need a little company. And your sweet, sexy wife has nominated you for the gig.'

Miriam Bywater. Waving her phone at him as though it was a permission slip from Mia.

Christian hardly knew her, and yet here she was, quietly making herself at home on their couch — even pouring herself a glass of the wine that was sitting out on the coffee table while she did so — without so much as a by your leave.

Christian was more amused than annoyed. More intrigued than put out.

'What did Mia tell you?' he asked, surprised that Mia had even been communicating with Miriam.

'That you're going to help me with a little problem I'm having.'

'Which is?'

'I want to sign up for Marriage 2.0, and I won't be able to do that unless it's Darren's idea.'

'Why does it have to be his idea?'

'Because invariably he won't be interested in anything unless he's the one who came up with it. He's a bore that way.'

Christian poured himself a fresh glass of wine. ‘You know you can sign up for Marriage 2.0 without your husband — that’s what Mia did. They did a pretty good job of figuring me out even before I officially joined, too.’

But Miriam shook her head. ‘Eventually, the truth will come out. He’ll lose interest. No — this needs to be something he decides to do. And you’re going to persuade him it’s a good idea.’

‘How am I going to do that?’

‘Well, that is the question, honeybun.’

Christian took a sip of wine and thought for a moment.

Then he said, ‘Wait a minute... why do I have to persuade him?’

‘Because if I persuade him, he’ll think I’m manipulating him.’

‘You are manipulating him.’

‘Yes, but if he thinks that, this’ll never work.’

Christian nodded. ‘And why does Mia think I would want to do all this... persuading of your husband?’ he asked.

Miriam smiled. ‘Because you need someone to talk to about all this — someone other than Mia.’

They drank, and they did talk. And Miriam was right, he did need someone other than Mia to talk to about what was going on.

‘She’s changing. She’s not the person I first dated. She’s not the person I married.’

‘Of course she is. She’s just developing, evolving, that’s all. Everyone develops, nobody stays the same.’

‘**B**ut if she changes — develops — and I stay the same...’

‘You are not staying the same, buddy. You may not see it, but she does. I do.’

‘How am I changing?’

‘The person who dated Mia in college would not have let her sleep with someone else,’ Miriam said. ‘The person who married her would not have wanted her to be unfaithful.’

‘Only because I didn’t know...’

‘You weren’t the same person. You’ve changed. And she also has the right to change.’

‘But she’s become... more demanding...’

‘You love that about her.’

‘She doesn’t even ask me if she can see him. If she can go spend the night with him.’

‘It’s boring when everything your spouse does is predictable and routine.’

‘What if she prefers him to me?’

‘Are you kidding me? You let her fuck other men. Do you know how lucky she is to have a husband like you? Because you can bet she fuckin’ does, honeybun.’

It did make him feel better about the whole thing, talking to Miriam.

This time, Mia came home a little after midnight, and Christian could tell she’d been freshly fucked — she had that look about her, that smell about her.

Miriam kissed her on the cheek as they greeted each other, and Christian was surprised at how friendly the two of them were. When had this whole friendship developed?

It felt strange, that there was this woman between them, talking about Mia’s infidelity openly.

‘You went back to his place?’

‘Uh-huh.’

‘So he’s finished the bedrooms?’

‘He has a mattress down in the dining room.’

‘And he fucked you right there?’

‘Oh yes. And in the kitchen. And in the bathroom.’

‘He’s good?’

‘Best I ever had.’

‘Yet.’

Christian didn’t mind that she thought Brandon was better in bed than he was. He’d already had that talk with Miriam. He remembered what she’d said about it.

‘She’s had you so many times — and Brandon’s the only other guy she’s ever been with. Of course she’s gonna think he’s better. But you want him to be better, right? If he sucked, she’s just going to think, what’s the point?’

And that whole thing was key. If she went out and had a crappy time, ending up in bed with a guy with a tiny dick, she wouldn’t want to do it

again. And Christian wanted her to do it again — over and over. It was so hot, the way she was after she'd been fucked. It was so uplifting having her cheerful and confident all the time.

He liked having a wife who enjoyed sex. He liked the rush of a wife who enjoyed sex with other people.

How could he go back to a traditional marriage now?

'Honey?'

'Huh?'

He snapped out of his brief daze to find Mia standing right in front of him, one leg raised, her high-heeled shoe planted right between his thighs.

'He fucked me so hard tonight... would you mind... I mean...'

'Sure, whatever you want, honey,' he said, sweeping his eyes up her stunning form, taking in the sight of her in that dress so soon after another man had had his wicked way with her.

'I'd really just love you to use your wonderful mouth on me... and we could take a raincheck on much more than that...'

'Oh... uh... okay...'

Miriam wasn't even gone yet. She'd paused on the threshold, and now as he glanced over, she gave him a knowing wink, and then called out a fond farewell to the two of them before letting herself out.

What the fuck was that?

But he didn't have much time for that particular question. Mia was already straddling him, pushing him back, moving up so her knees were on either side of his head. Giving him the opportunity to examine her newly shaven pussy close-up.

Red, rosy, and freshly fucked.

It could have been worse, couldn't it? She could have come home and said she was tired, she didn't have enough energy left for anything at all, she just needed to get some sleep. She hadn't done that, had she? She wanted to make use of his mouth.

She sat on his face and gave him another sensational chance to enjoy her wickedness in the most intimate way.

He would remember this moment, he would memorize it. Even if she didn't want to fuck him after this, he would have this memory to enjoy in his own time.

'Did you have fun with Miriam, sweetie?'

'Mmm-hmm,' he said, though it was difficult to enunciate with his mouth full.

'She's so much fun, isn't she?'

‘Mmm-hmm.’

‘Can you imagine what it’ll be like when she and Darren are on the program too?’

‘Mmm-hmmm...’

EPISODE 9

She was seeing Brandon regularly, but it never became routine for Christian when he was waiting for her at home.

Every time, he'd feel that tightening of his throat when she mentioned that she was planning on going over to Brandon's again. He'd get a serious erection whenever she was getting ready for him, donning a short skirt or a body-clinging dress, and killer lingerie.

When she shaved her pussy to please her lover — or got her husband to do it for her.

When she went out at night and wore stockings and a dress that barely concealed the fact that she was wearing stockings.

When Brandon started telling her to stop wearing panties on nights they went dancing, so that he could enjoy the feel of her bare body as his hands slipped under her dress on the dance floor.

When she was all made up and ready to go out with her lover for the night, the final thing she asked for before she left was for Christian to French-kiss her pussy. To warm her up for her lover, prepare her for a big night out.

The waiting wasn't always the most fun part, but it all contributed to a powerful thrill when she returned to him, joyous and freshly fucked, makeup smudged and pussy leaking, always keen to reconnect with her adoring husband.

Christian loved how sexy she was, how her confidence was soaring with every day, every week she was dating Brandon.

She told her husband all about the time she spent with Brandon — little snippets about how the guy fucked her while Christian licked her super wet pussy, and then made her wetter still with his own load. More after he had reclaimed her, when they lay cuddling in bed.

He knew how Brandon dominated her, how he made her his little girl.

He knew how Brandon told her to dominate her husband when she returned home to him.

Brandon didn't want to meet Christian, but he wanted to influence how Mia dealt with Christian when it came to sex. He treated her roughly and then ordered her to go home and treat her husband roughly.

He tied her up and fucked her hard, and then gave her the rope to go home and tie up her husband, and fuck him hard too.

At first, Christian felt uncomfortable with the power that Brandon wielded. After a while, he came to appreciate it, savor its effect on Mia.

Christian noticed the dynamic changing when Brandon started telling her what to wear — for nights out, to begin with. When she was hanging out with Brandon at weekends. But then, more and more, when Mia was with her husband, or when she was at work.

Her entire wardrobe changed.

Out went anything loose, anything dowdy, heavy, frumpy. In came skin-tight, light, breezy, short, cropped, sleeveless, even see-through.

She wouldn't wear sweatpants and hooded sweatshirts anymore when she chilled out at home — nowadays, it was yoga pants and crop tops. During the day — and when she was at work — she wore light summer dresses that were often so short she couldn't sit down without fear of exposing her underwear.

She'd forego wearing her bra so that her nipples pressed against the thin material of her dresses, and Christian had to warn her that guys would stop looking at her in the face.

'Plenty of guys look me in the face,' she said. 'And if they want to look at other parts of me... well, I don't mind.'

There were times Christian thought she'd get sent home from her arts and crafts store for wearing inappropriate attire — like the time Brandon told her to dress up in an outfit that basically made her look like a schoolgirl.

But when he asked about it, she said her bosses were happy because sales were on the up. Anecdotal evidence — from occasions Christian happened by the store — suggested that more and more male artists and

crafty types were coming to the store to buy their supplies rather than shopping online.

One day, Mia mentioned that one of her managers at work kept trying to look up her dress. That after a while, she had just started giving him little flashes to help keep him in a better mood.

But she didn't stay in the job all that long.

At weekends, she started helping Brandon out with his property renovation.

The two of them would mix business and pleasure, getting this task done before stripping off for a quick, hard fuck. Or getting a project completed before a nice, slow blowjob. Or running into town for supplies before returning for an afternoon of casual sex.

Mia knew nothing about home improvement stuff, but she learned new skills each weekend. Christian noticed things around their own house were being fixed up.

Along with refurbishing his own house, Brandon would work for other people, in other houses, and other refurbishment projects. He started taking Mia with him. Mia began to come home with cash in her pocket from these jobs.

Occasionally, she even went away with Brandon for a few days at a time.

Christian would try to continue his normal life, trying not to spend all his time thinking about how much Brandon was fucking his wife.

Was she falling in love with him? She always denied it. She was obsessed with his huge cock — she would admit to that — and she was increasingly interested in the whole home improvement thing. She wanted to learn from Brandon, in business and in pleasure.

One little story that amused Christian was how Brandon occasionally liked to tell Mia to strip off and be naked around the house while he completed this job or that. She liked to submit to him, and had no problem carrying out his demands. Then when the day's work was over, the two of them would be so wound up and ready for sex, their union would be almost explosive.

Inevitably, it seemed to Christian, this little kinkiness was rewarded when some guys came to drop off a few pallet-loads of tiles, only to catch sight of Mia waltzing around in the nude.

The big surprise was when Mia suddenly announced that she wanted to use their life savings to buy a run-down two-bed condo in Brockton, and do it up herself to sell for a profit.

It wasn't just their marriage that was changing as a result of this whole Marriage 2.0 thing — it was their entire life.

He couldn't say no to Mia buying the condo. The fact that she quit her job to work on it was more than a little unnerving, too. Especially with the way the economy was at that point.

But while she was learning the skills from Brandon, helping him refurbish his house, Brandon was also helping her fix up the condo. They were definitely adding value to the property.

And she was happy, that was the main thing. For Christian, that made the whole Marriage 2.0 program worthwhile.

The big surprise came when Mia was home one evening, when Christian would have expected her to be out with Brandon.

She was chilling out in front of the TV in a pair of yoga pants and a top that showed off her beautiful midriff. She hadn't bothered with a bra.

'What's Brandon up to?'

She merely shrugged and said, 'He has a date.'

Here was where Christian's eyes widened.

'A *date*...?'

Christian half expected her to say Brandon had started seeing Miriam Bywater, or perhaps another wife in the neighborhood, but Mia simply sighed and said he'd asked out a barista at the local Starbucks. Talking like it wasn't a big deal.

'You know we're not exactly exclusive,' she said with a smirk, one hand toying with one of her nipples, which was stiff and pushing against the thin material of her crop top.

'No, not exactly exclusive,' Christian smiled, and knelt down on the rug in front of her, before leaning in to nuzzle between her legs — suspecting that she might enjoy his talented tongue between her thighs, as some kind of distraction.

Without a word, she accepted his offer by lifting her hips and slipping down her yoga pants.

But even before she'd pulled off the clothing below her waist, Christian caught a familiar scent — the smell of sex, and of female arousal, and of semen.

He gazed up at Mia and said, 'You just had sex?'

She smiled. 'He came over before his date,' she said, opening her legs to show him her soaking pussy. 'Well, I had to help him get ready

for his date, didn't I?'

Christian grinned and kissed his way along her inner thigh toward her deliciously freshly-fucked sex. 'How does that help him get ready for a date?'

'He's better when he's in a calm state of mind,' she said, leaning back as her husband slid his tongue inside her.

Christian was quietly pleased that Brandon was dating someone else. He cleaned up her exquisitely shaved pussy, and she came before he was done. Then they calmly watched a movie on TV that was, of course, selected for them by the kind folks at Marriage 2.0.

The movie was called "Amorous" and had one of the guys from The Crown in it.

In the movie, four young people move out of London into a cottage together in the English countryside with the intention of experimenting with partner swapping. Each night, they decided, a different couple would stay together in the cottage's "marital bed," free to do as they liked with each other. The rota included the pairing of same-sex couples.

Unexpectedly, the movie started slowly, rather than an immediate sexual free-for-all. The characters didn't know each other. Those in the marital bed the first night just slept. One of the women spied on one of the guys masturbating. The four got to grips with living in the countryside.

Mia stroked Christian while they watched, and he slipped a hand between her thighs. It made the movie more entertaining, more immersive.

And, slowly, steadily, the movie was strangely engaging, with interesting tension between the characters, and a gentle hint at sexual exploration.

It made Christian think about how it might be to be in such an arrangement — and, he suspected, it made Mia think differently, too.

Then Christian and Mia were on a boat, sailing out in Cape Cod Bay, along with Darren and Miriam Bywater, and Greg and Irene Dunlop.

The sky was clear blue, the wind reasonably light but sufficient to get them moving, and the sea relatively calm.

Christian had never been particularly interested in boats, but he had to admit it was invigorating being out there, the salt in the air, the sun

beaming down on them as they went.

Leaving the actual sailing part to Darren, there was plenty of time for relaxing and enjoying the ride. The men seemed to gravitate toward keeping Darren company at the back of the boat — the ‘stern’ — where he could steer, while the women stretched out in their swimsuits on the front of the boat to catch some rays.

When he did catch any gist of the conversation among the women, it seemed to Christian that Mia was openly discussing her flourishing sex life with Miriam and Irene, as though they were all talking about a soap opera on TV.

One thing that surprised Christian about what he and his wife were doing was that Mia didn’t seem concerned with keeping it a secret.

It wasn’t that she went around broadcasting the fact that she was sleeping with Brandon. But if anyone happened to ask, and really inquire about the details, she didn’t mind opening up. And she didn’t exactly sneak around when she was going over to see him a few times each week, or going out with him at night on the weekends.

At first, Christian felt terrified that she would let people know she was sleeping with someone else, yet he didn’t feel comfortable telling her to keep it a secret. To begin with, he was worried about anything that might knock her confidence or give her even mild doubts about what they were doing. He did not want to discourage her.

But as things went on, and he started believing that people in the neighborhood — and people among their family — knew what was going on, it didn’t seem so bad to him.

In fact, there were times that it even seemed like a good thing.

Mia’s mom, for example, knew what she was doing. Mia’s mom knew, and the result was that she seemed to appreciate and even — oddly — respect Christian way more than she had ever done before. Mia’s dad didn’t know, but her mom’s growing affection for Christian seemed to transfer to Mia’s dad, too.

In their neighborhood, Christian found himself getting odd looks from people occasionally, to the extent that it was almost as though he was a minor celebrity. But those looks came with little smiles, and there was no malice in them. Those looks also reminded Christian, every time, what Mia was doing — and so when it happened, it even started to give him little flashback thrills.

He and Mia seemed to be invited to more parties than ever before. And at parties, he and Mia seemed more popular than ever before — and

when Christian was on his own, someone would often catch up with him and ask him how things were going with Mia.

He didn't share explicit details, but he didn't mind sharing the general idea with them that allowing Mia some extramarital freedom brought a whole raft of benefits.

People even admired him for what he was doing. It was crazy. Women envied Mia — he could understand that. Liberals thought what he was doing was deeply progressive. Republicans were impressed that he seemed to be managing his marriage as though it were a business — outsourcing the labor, delegating the responsibility to keep the wife entertained.

Married men who enjoyed sex with their wives marveled that what Christian was doing somehow translated into more sex for him. Married men who did not enjoy sex with their wives were fixated on the possibility that he got other guys to do the hard work and keep the wife satisfied.

Anyway. Darren had invited Christian out on the boat again a few times, and with a view to finding a moment to talk to him about Miriam's personal interest in Marriage 2.0, Christian had eventually accepted.

Unexpectedly, Darren had said Christian should bring Mia along. And when they arrived, Miriam and the Dunlops were there, too.

The Bywaters had a big boat. Yacht. Whatever. Christian knew nothing about boats. It was nice, though, being out on the ocean. Even though Greg was still talking about the property market, and Darren just wanted to talk about how impressive his boat was. Yacht.

'A "boat" is what they use in New York to haul out the trash, buddy,' Darren kept reminding him. 'This is a yacht.'

But while Christian continued as part of the least interesting three-way in history, every time he glanced toward the women, he kept getting intriguing little smiles back from whichever of them happened to notice at the time — Mia, Miriam, even Irene sometimes. It was basically how he knew they were talking about Mia's sex life, rather than the kind of mundanities being kicked around on the guy's side of the boat. Yacht.

After a while, Christian just felt like going over there to join the estrogen crowd. Didn't help that they'd all changed into bikinis by now. The guys were all still wearing chinos and polo shirts.

Christian figured the only way to change the conversation would be to break it.

'So... you and Irene still working on having a baby?' he said to Greg, uttering the kind of question you just didn't.

I mean, Jesus.

‘Uh... well... yeah...’

Darren said, ‘Miriam and I didn’t have to work at all — I thought it would at least take a few months. But no, we stopped using condoms, and next month, she was pregnant.’

Greg raised his eyebrows. ‘Lucky you.’

Darren shrugged. ‘I don’t know. Ever since the twins came along, things between Miriam and me have hardly been... you know... kicking.’

‘Taking care of twins can’t be the easiest thing.’

‘Nope, and Miriam’s just miserable a lot of the time,’ the big man nodded. He glanced at Greg and chuckled, ‘You sure you wanna do this?’

‘Oh yes,’ Greg said.

‘You could get a boat instead.’

Christian said, ‘You mean ‘yacht’?’

‘Yeah, a yacht.’

Christian hadn’t meant to make Greg even gloomier, but apparently, he and Irene weren’t having the most straightforward time conceiving. Darren couldn’t understand his difficulties — ‘but your Irene, she’s gorgeous.’ But Greg explained that Irene was simply getting more and more depressed the more times she had her period, and they weren’t getting that plus symbol on the pregnancy test kits.

‘And the more depressed she gets... well, the less we’re in the mood to do it, you know what I mean,’ Greg said.

Christian suggested, ‘You don’t think trying to have a baby and trying to find a new house at the same time might be too much?’

Greg shrugged. ‘The house thing is just something I try to distract us from the baby thing.’

Then Darren joked, ‘Maybe you need to delegate the baby-making part — like Christian has.’

Greg looked shocked, and even apologetic on Darren’s behalf for the fact that he’d brought up the subject of Christian’s cuckolding in their conversation. But Christian wasn’t offended.

‘I’m not saying it’s right for everyone, but...’ Christian smiled. ‘And I don’t delegate all of it, you know that? Mia has a little fun, and some other guy warms her up for me, that’s all.’

Strangely, Darren seemed to understand that explanation more than he expected.

‘So you two are still...?’ he prompted.

Christian nodded. 'More than ever. I mean... she's happy now, like, all the time. And that means when we do it, it's seriously hot. And she's learning new tricks...'

'Seriously?'

'Uh-huh. And you know... one time, I came home a little too early... saw them doing it...'

Darren's jaw dropped. 'You saw...?'

Christian shrugged. 'Way better than porn. I mean... you see something like that, porn becomes as sexy as... I don't know... Emily in Paris.'

Darren said, 'I happen to enjoy Emily in Paris.'

Christian laughed.

But Greg said, seriously, 'That guy Brandon... he warms her up for you?'

Christian said, 'Uh-huh. When she comes home from seeing him, she's so on it, she comes in, like, five seconds. As soon as you touch her.'

Darren said, 'But he... fucks your woman.'

'It's only sex.'

'With your woman.'

'Miriam slept with guys before you, didn't she? I mean, before you guys dated...?'

'Well, yeah. But...'

'And Mia's happy... like, all the time...?' Greg said, gazing across at the women, who were all sipping Champagne and giggling about whatever, no doubt still talking about Brandon's huge cock, or something.

'All the time.'

Even Darren was impressed at that. 'A happy wife is a happy life,' he said, almost to himself. Then he asked, 'And this whole program... how d'you get into it?'

'Marriage 2.0,' Christian said, and explained.

Christian was surprised by how much he enjoyed the boat — and the company. A little alcohol along the way helped, of course. Champagne on board the yacht. Wine when they returned to the Yacht Club.

Cocktails when they all went back to the Bywaters' big new house.

Shots when they all started discussing what Marriage 2.0 might mean for Darren and Miriam — and for Greg and Irene.

More shots when Miriam suggested that Greg might better understand how Christian felt about Mia's erotic adventures if he got the chance to see his beloved Irene make out with another guy. Darren, for example. Or Christian.

EPISODE 10

Miriam and Darren lived in a house large enough that, for that day and overnight, their twins were being cared for by the nanny in another *wing*.

‘You didn’t just move because you had kids, huh?’ Christian said to Darren.

Darren shrugged and said, ‘I sold my company... for \$89 million.’

The place was furnished in a minimalist fashion, making it feel bright and airy. For Christian and Mia, and Greg and Irene, it was fun to be fish out of water in such a luxurious setting. Like they’d been upgraded to first-class out of the blue.

Hanging out by the pool as Darren grilled steak and burgers, swimming in the cool water, it was a step out of their everyday lives.

But while Miriam and Darren seemed to have everything they could ever want, they only wanted to talk about what Christian and Mia had been up to.

Miriam seemed quite content that Christian had done his duty and gotten Darren interested in the whole Marriage 2.0 thing. Though he was keen to point out to her that if they did it as a couple, their adventure might turn out very differently from that of Mia and his own.

During the early evening, Greg and Irene seemed to have gone a little quiet regarding Marriage 2.0. When he happened to be talking to either of them, Christian reflected their mood by keeping conversations off the topic of extramarital tomfoolery.

But as the sun went down, it seemed clear that Miriam, at least, wasn’t going to let the subject drop.

Darren wanted to show everybody the movie theater they had in the basement — they called it a ‘media room,’ but it was like one of the small screens you get in a movie theater. They had a 100-inch TV down

there, which was just astonishing to behold, and probably cost as much as a Tesla.

Mia asked a fairly innocent question about whether they could get Netflix on this TV, and as Darren demonstrated that, yes, they very much could get Netflix on it, Miriam asked what Mia would expect Marriage 2.0 to show them next.

Mia had no clue, so Miriam suggested they sign in to Mia and Christian's account and see if anything was showing.

And, as it happened, something was being offered for their viewing pleasure.

The movie was called "Swung," and while it didn't have any big stars in it, it seemed to be well made, with decent performances.

It started out somewhat depressing, with a late-thirties, early-forties guy suffering erectile dysfunction, which spoiled the romance of his relationship with a sexy Spanish woman. The guy, David, was also going through a divorce with someone else, separation from his young daughter, and the bankruptcy of his business and subsequent unemployment.

It took a while for something significant to happen — at least in terms of why they were watching the movie. But to Christian, the initial shared excitement for them all was the fact that they were watching a film chosen by Marriage 2.0 to be part of Christian and Mia's adventure.

There was a scene where David's girlfriend, Alice, discovered that he'd been looking at a site for swingers while he should have been working on getting a new job, which had made her angry, and she stormed off.

Darren said to that, 'This is fucking depressing. Why would they want you to watch this?'

Mia said, 'Just wait — it'll get better. Otherwise, they wouldn't have told us to watch this.'

Christian was amused that Darren was the one who seemed to be bored with the movie, but glancing over at the others, he noticed that Irene and Greg were riveted by the movie — totally engaged. He wondered whether the two of them had a problem with erectile dysfunction like the characters in the film. They were a little younger, but it wasn't unfeasible.

In the movie, Alice stormed off and went to a party across the street without David. When she came back, she was a little drunk and in a forgiving mood, and joining David in bed, she attempted to seduce him. She made up a story about watching a couple at the party having sex — and her story seemed to give her husband an erection for a while before the performance pressure set in, and he lost his hardness.

This seemed like the inciting incident of the movie. But then came an added little motivation: Alice had to pitch a story to her magazine editor to save her job, and the only story her editor seemed interested in was a piece about swingers.

Now Alice was posting a profile on the swingers website David had looked at, in order to meet swingers for her story.

Christian noticed that everyone now seemed to be interested in the movie — including Darren. He saw Miriam glancing around at everyone, too, and when their eyes connected, she gave him a knowing smile.

They watched Alice and David meet up with a pair of swingers at a pub, and even go back to their house with them. But it shocked them when the couple suddenly started to have sex in front of them. They ended up fleeing, much to the anger of the swingers.

But here was David once again responding to the situation by getting sexually interested in Alice again, and maintaining an erection for a short while. Christian surreptitiously watched Greg and Irene, who were utterly transfixed by the movie.

He was now more certain they sympathized with these characters and their central problem.

They all watched as David and Alice met up with a second couple through the swingers' site. This couple seemed more sophisticated. They met them at a strip club, which kicked off the eroticism of the meet-up into a higher gear from the start.

Christian felt Mia's hand on his thigh, stroking him, and when he looked at her, she gave him a sexy little smirk, and moved her hand up to the bulge between his legs.

They watched David and Alice going back to the impressive, luxury home of the swinger couple, Marcia and Tony. This time, the couples seemed to connect a little better, and Alice even whispered to David that it might be okay if they just watched the other pair having sex.

It was still a little shocking when Marcia and Tony began to strip off and get physical.

Shocking, but exciting, when Marcia, wearing only sexy lingerie now, stretched across the bed and demanded a kiss from Alice. Thrilling

when Alice reassured David that they could still just watch the other couple, and he told her to kiss Marcia.

Now David was watching like a cuckold as Marcia kissed Alice, and Tony sandwiched Alice between them. Tony kissing her back, Marcia peeling off her top and kissing her mouth.

Marcia peeling off Alice's panties.

Everyone in that media room was now watching, completely absorbed by what was happening.

But then, on screen, Marcia said she wanted to fuck David, and David's nerve suddenly crumpled. He had to escape. Cue awkwardness for Alice, and disappointment. Disappointment in real life, too, among the viewing audience.

Darren calling out, 'Go back, you idiot!'

And this was where the movie came back to its depressing tone. David unable to stop thinking about Alice cavorting with Marcia and Tony, but feeling aggrieved by it, rather than thrilled.

Alice having to pursue her magazine story alone, in order to save her job.

David signing his divorce papers. Alice failing to connect with his daughter. Alice finding out she was somehow pregnant, despite her failed sex life.

'So why did they want you to watch this movie?' Darren asked, his tone making his question practically a complaint.

Christian said, dismissively, 'We don't always pay too much attention to the second half of the movies...'

And Mia, who was stroking her husband's hard-on through his clothes at that very moment, said, 'the movies just offer up a suggestion for what kind of thing might be interesting for us.'

She glanced around, loving the fact that the other two couples were hanging on her every word. Then she added, 'I know which parts my husband finds sexy... and it just leads us to think about scenarios that might be a turn-on for us, if the opportunity ever arose...'

And Miriam said, 'And the opportunity does arise?'

'Oh, yes,' Mia giggled.

Then Irene, unexpectedly, said, 'So even though the movie's really depressing... you're just thinking about the part where Alice was making out with Marcia and Tony, and Marcia wanted to fuck David...?'

Greg smiled, and said quietly, 'That was *your* favorite part?' Which promptly made Irene blush.

Then Darren said, 'The guy's an idiot. It makes him hard, watching the others have sex. Should've just let the other couple fuck his girlfriend.'

Miriam laughed and nudged her husband, saying, 'That's what you'd do, is it?'

They watched the end of the movie in silence, but the whole thing was downhill after David rejected Marcia and Tony's advances.

'What the hell was the moral of that story?' Darren asked as the credits rolled. 'Life's miserable. You should just forget about what turns you on, and just grind it out until you're dead?'

Christian said, 'I don't think people who make movies like the idea of couples straying outside their monogamous relationships. That kind of thing often seems to go wrong in the second half of movies.'

Concealed by the darkened room, Mia was still stroking her husband's erect cock through his pants. She said, 'You have to remember that what we like doing together, most of the time, is watch movies. So our program comes to us through movies.'

Darren said, 'But shouldn't they just be showing you... you know... movies where the characters do something you like... and then enjoy doing that?'

'I guess they should. But we can watch a movie like this... and talk about how we would have written the movie differently... and it kind of clarifies what we both would like to see happen in our lives...'

Then the lights came on, and they were all getting up from their seats, and heading back upstairs. Mia had to stop stroking Christian's hard-on abruptly as the lights suddenly revealed everything.

Upstairs, they all lounged in extremely comfortable chairs out on the patio, gazing across the pool at the last vestiges of sunlight draining from the view.

Miriam said to Mia, 'So how would *you* have written the movie?'

Mia smiled, 'I guess... David would have stayed to watch Alice have sex with Marcia and Tony...'

Miriam said with a suggestive rise of an eyebrow, 'But would Alice have allowed Marcia to fuck David in your movie?'

Mia looked at Christian, and he shrugged. 'I don't know...' she said, and he could tell she was trying to gauge his feelings on the matter without being able to monitor the thickness of his cock in front of everybody.

Christian accepted some kind of rum-based drink, and he said, 'I'm not sure David would have felt the need to fuck Marcia in our movie...'

but to watch Alice...'

Miriam giggled and clinked glasses with Mia, saying, 'Sounds like your sweetheart wants to watch you have a threesome with another couple, honey...!'

Then Irene surprised them again by coming out with a question: 'Why is it that you guys don't seem to feel comfortable with Christian... you know... being with another woman... but Alice... I mean Mia — '

Mia laughed, 'You can call me Alice if you like.'

Irene smiled. 'But it all seems a bit one-sided, somehow. Like, it's not really *fair*...'

Christian glanced at Mia, who seemed to want him to explain himself as well.

He sipped his highly-alcoholic cocktail and said, 'I think... we both want different things out of all this. Mia wants to explore and discover new things... new people... and what interests me is the feeling I get when she's out doing naughty things with other people...'

Darren said, 'You like being jealous?'

Christian shook his head. 'It's not really *jealousy*. I mean... it's hard to explain... I guess the bottom line is, I feel confident that when Mia's out with Brandon — or whoever — she will always come back to me. So I don't feel bad when she's out. I want her to have a good time.'

Mia said, 'It's not just that you know I'm always going to come back to you, though. It does turn you on, that I'm with someone else. And when I come back... you're so freaking *horny*... like never before...'

Mia kissed Christian in front of everybody, and her hand slid between his thighs — and despite the whole PDA thing, it was kind of hot.

Christian liked that everybody else was interested in their situation. Even Irene and Greg seemed gripped. When Mia leaned back again, ending their kiss, he felt emboldened by the attention, and by the alcohol, and he said, 'When Mia comes back after being with... someone else... it's like she's never seemed more beautiful... she's just stunning. She's, like, glowing... and so happy...'

Mia said, 'And I can't wait to get back to my handsome husband... and know how much I turn him on... how much he wants me...'

Irene and Greg were giving each other looks that seemed so intriguing to Christian. Were they being persuaded by all this?

But then it was Miriam who said, 'I want to know how it feels, too.'

There was a sudden silence between them all, and Christian was aware of a tension that hadn't really existed before they'd all watched

that movie. The alcohol was encouraging them to consider things while their inhibitions were quietly fading out.

What did Miriam mean? Had she meant to say some throwaway comment to show she was merely sympathetic to what Mia and Christian were trying to explain? Or did she mean something more serious?

Then Darren said, seriously, ‘What are you saying, darling?’

There was real fear on his face — Christian got the sense that he was worried his wife would suddenly demand the right to have sex with someone else.

But Miriam said to him, ‘I’d like... to see you... maybe... have a little *fun* with someone...’

Darren looked stunned at that.

It was Greg who broke the stunned silence, saying, ‘I think... *I*’d like to know how it feels, too.’

Irene gasped.

Miriam looked at them all and said, conspiratorially, ‘You know... we could... I mean... nobody else would *ever* have to know about any of this...’

Mia glanced at Christian, and the two of them wordlessly shared their surprise and realization of what was happening in their midst.

Then Darren was up on his feet. They all looked sharply up at him — was he storming out? Was he acting exactly as David had at the high point of the movie they’d just seen?

But as they watched him, they saw him return to the bar in the living room to fetch a bottle and six shot glasses. He solemnly handed a glass to each of them.

‘We’re going to need a little more... *reinforcement*...’ he said, pouring them each a shot of Knappogue Castle.

EPISODE 11

Once they'd all gotten their breath back from knocking back a shot of whiskey, Darren asked Mia and Christian what happened next, after they watched a movie chosen for them by the Marriage 2.0 algorithm.

'Yeah, do they give you further instructions once the movie's over?' Miriam asked them.

Mia looked at Christian as though she needed reminding exactly how everything had happened during their adventure— it had all been a bit of a blur.

Christian explained, 'They don't really give instructions... more like the occasional pointer. Like they want us to be the ones deciding what to do. They just encourage us where needed.'

Mia said, 'After we talked about going to a bar so I could flirt with some other guys for the first time, they sent me a nice dress for the evening.'

Christian nodded, 'It basically confirmed we were thinking along the right lines. Then when Mia was trying to decide whether she wanted to go home with a guy she liked, Marriage 2.0 sent along one of my exes —

Mia gasped and put her hand over her mouth as he said that. 'You don't think they arranged *that*?'

Christian grinned. 'That made her so mad at me. When we first got together in college, she was the first person I'd fallen in love with, and I guess I didn't correct her impression she was my first *everything*...'

Mia said to him, 'You really think your ex was part of the program?'

Christian shrugged. 'Little coincidental, don't you think? It made you go home with that guy to get back at me.'

'I guess so... but... wow.'

Miriam asked Mia, ‘Did you... sleep with that guy?’

Mia shook her head. ‘We made out a little. But I wasn’t sure how Christian would react. You know — if he’d change his mind about the whole thing.’

‘I guess he didn’t.’

Christian said, ‘But that was the whole point — she got to test me out, and it demonstrated that I wanted her to do it. Then, we watched this movie called “Deep Water” — ’

‘We saw that movie,’ Irene said and gave Greg a look that made him blush. What was that about?

Christian nodded. ‘And it made us think about how it would be if Mia found someone particularly... fun... at your party.’

‘And that was Brandon, huh?’ Miriam smiled.

Mia said, ‘But we were the ones that decided this was what we would do. It was just that the movies really made us think. And talk. And then we were ready.’

Darren said, ‘What movies you think they’d show us?’

Mia shrugged. ‘Do you guys watch a lot of movies together? I mean, that’s what Christian and I like to do together, most of the time. But it might not be what’s right for other people.’

Miriam said, ‘But if you’re wondering what’s next, you just watch another movie?’

Mia said, ‘I don’t know. We watch movies anyway. When we’re not out, partying and so on. So when it’s time for us to think about the next thing, sure, they show us another movie.’

Darren went around to give them another shot of whiskey.

Christian was surprised that everybody took him up on the offer without question. But there was a tension in the air — all the talk of Marriage 2.0, the hint that others might want to experience the feelings Christian had felt as Mia had been unfaithful — and it made them all feel a little nervous excitement.

Miriam was the first to sink her shot. Then she suggested, ‘Maybe we should see what’s next on your Netflix watchlist?’

Christian took his phone out of his pocket. ‘I don’t think it really works like that,’ he said, tapping on the Netflix app as though to prove it.

Miriam snatched the phone from his hands to see what was on it. Then her eyes widened, and her mouth stretched into a bright smile.

She laughed and put the phone on the low table in front of them.

Christian read the white captions that emerged on the black background.

“Legacy Studios & One Small Step Films Present”

“7 Minutes”

The six of them huddled close to see what was on the small phone screen. Christian leaned forward to turn up the volume.

The scene showed the inside of a closet, with slatted doors that were opened only for a young man and a young woman to be shoved inside by a baying crowd of partygoers.

Darren said to Christian, ‘You *don’t* think it really works like this?’

‘Seven minutes in heaven,’ Miriam said, giving a title to the well-known game clearly being played at the party in this short film.

‘How do they know what to show us?’ Irene said, in awe.

They watched as the likable couple in the closet found it somewhat awkward to fill their seven minutes with small talk. The elephant in the room — or the closet, at least — was the traditional purpose of Seven Minutes in Heaven, and as they contended with that idea, an intriguing sexual tension developed between them.

‘So we’re supposed to do this?’ Darren asked, as they watched one of the characters in the closet reveal he used to have a crush on the other.

Mia said, ‘It’s just designed to give Christian and me something to think about, you know? It’s not necessarily what we have to do.’

But as they watched the characters on-screen fumble through some cute flirtation and edge toward a sweet kiss, Miriam got up and went into the house.

A couple minutes later, she returned carrying a bottle. An empty bottle.

Christian looked at Mia and saw her give him a smirk when their eyes connected.

She smiled. Don’t worry, it’ll all be all right, her eyes said.

He smiled back, feeling the alcohol flush in his cheeks, and suddenly recognizing that warm feeling of invincibility that his inebriation had given him.

‘Come over here,’ Miriam said, seating herself by the pool.

It felt like they were teenagers again. Trying alcohol for the first time. Contending with the first throes of sexuality.

‘It lands on you, you get seven minutes to do whatever you want with the other person,’ Miriam said solemnly as they circled around her empty

bottle.

Darren said, 'Seriously. Are we in middle school again?'

But Miriam gave him a look, and he shrugged his compliance.

Miriam gave the bottle a flick, and it was spinning. When it stopped, it pointed at her. 'Well, I guess it's me first, huh?' she said. 'Should've seen that coming.'

Then the bottle turned to Darren.

'Seriously?' he said. Everyone laughed.

Miriam said, 'Do-over?'

Mia shook her head. 'You guys get seven minutes...'

Miriam took the lead, getting up, putting out her hand to urge her husband up. This was the game, her expression told him. He gave a little nod. Let Fate decide.

'You can do whatever you want,' Mia reminded them as they went inside, and she showed them the timer she'd started on her phone.

The remaining four of them watched through the large windows as Miriam and her husband went hand in hand upstairs.

'You think they'll actually do anything?' Greg said dryly.

'I don't know... they've both had a few drinks,' Mia grinned.

Christian laughed, 'So what happens if they go upstairs and then, you know, fall asleep?'

'When seven minutes is up, we go up and bang on the door.'

Greg said nervously, 'And then it could be our turn.'

They were all looking at each other, and Christian could tell that the others, like him, were all thinking about what could happen if they were picked next. The guys had put on t-shirts since they'd returned to dry land, while the women had put shorts on over their swimsuits, but otherwise only had bikini tops on.

Christian noticed Greg run his eyes over Mia, no doubt wondering what might happen if he was picked to go with her for seven minutes upstairs. Greg's interest in Mia fed Christian's own arousal, making him thicken up, and feel that familiar tightness in his throat at the prospect of Mia going off with another guy.

How would he feel about it if it was Darren she went with? Greg was just a relatively normal guy, but Darren was on the big side.

Mia said to Irene, 'If Greg was up next, and he had to go upstairs with Miriam or me, what would you think, Irene? Would you be okay if anything... you know... happened?'

A flash of terror seemed to pass across Irene's eyes, but then she paused and thought about it before answering, and she seemed to relax.

She said, 'I guess... we're just trying things, right? And what happens tonight... none of us will talk about it to anyone else...'

'It's just among us,' Mia agreed, soliciting affirmative noises from the guys.

Irene looked at Greg and said, 'I guess I'd be okay... if you wanted to try something with Mia or Miriam.'

Greg said to her, 'I think... if it was you... I'd be okay too.'

Irene said to Mia, 'What about you? If Christian went with someone else...?'

Mia looked over at her husband, who offered her a bemused smile. 'I don't know... I guess I'm curious what it feels like... you know... if he were to be with someone else. And this seems like a safe place to... you know... try it.'

Christian smiled at her. 'And if you had to go up with Irene, or Miriam?'

Mia said to him, 'You do whatever you want when you go upstairs, right? You remember that movie Amorous. When they were locked in the bedroom for the night, they just talked. And slept.'

'To begin with they did. But by the end of it, they were all having sex when they were locked in. Even the guys.'

Mia shrugged. 'You do what you want when it's you.'

At seven minutes, the group of them went upstairs to break Miriam and Darren out of their exile. Both of them emerged from the main bedroom after a knock on the door, their clothes still very much in place.

The two of them were all smiles, though.

'What happened?' Mia asked them.

Miriam shook her head. 'What happens in this bedroom stays in the bedroom.'

'You guys just watched TV, huh?' Christian said.

Miriam flashed her eyes at him and then took his hand to lead him — and the rest of them — back downstairs, saying only, 'You'll never know, buddy.'

But the bottle picked out Christian and Darren next, and in the seven minutes the two guys had together, Darren didn't seem to mind revealing what had gone on during his seven minutes with his wife.

‘She was just, you know, saying we need to try this,’ he said. ‘You know — that this could be good for us.’

Christian nodded. ‘What, Seven Minutes in Heaven, or Marriage 2.0?’

Darren, ‘I don’t know... both, I guess. Maybe tonight... we figure out if this kind of stuff is really going to freak us out... and then we sign up for the program once we’ve figured it out.’

It wasn’t weird, having to spend ‘seven minutes in heaven’ with Darren. It was a chance for them to talk, just the two of them. Darren wanted to know what things were like for Christian before they signed up for Marriage 2.0. Whether he’d had any thoughts about wanting Mia to date other guys before the program.

‘Not at all,’ Christian said. ‘We were just a fairly normal couple, I guess. Whatever ‘normal’ is these days. I never even thought about Mia being with someone else.’

‘And then they just started showing you dirty movies...?’

‘Not even all that dirty,’ Christian grinned. ‘I mean, as dirty as it gets on Netflix, I guess.’

‘...and it made you want her to...?’

Christian shrugged. ‘It just opened our eyes to what it might feel like to think differently about our relationship, you know?’

‘And you just went out and did it?’

‘We talked a lot about it. A lot. And we never really talked all that much about sex before that. And then we figured it would be good to try something. You know, little steps...’

Seven minutes was quite a lot to fill with conversation when you were watching the clock like that. But his seven minutes with Darren definitely warmed him to the guy.

‘I told Miriam if she... you know... wanted to try anything with you or Greg, I guess it would be all right,’ he said.

Christian nodded. ‘And you really feel that way? Or you just feel like you *should* feel that way, ’cause of what we’re doing here?’

Darren explained, ‘Me and Miriam agreed... if something happened tonight... we wouldn’t see it as cheating. Because we’re both agreed about trying it...’

‘But if she said you could do something with Mia, but she wouldn’t do anything with anyone else...?’

Darren shrugged. ‘I don’t know. I think I want to know how it feels. And if we don’t like it... well, then, there’s nobody to blame. We both agreed to try.’

‘We’d all agree to just forget it ever happened,’ Christian said, though deep down he wondered if Darren was dead-set against this, whether he would be the type to forget.

The knock came, and the inevitable jokes about what the two guys had gotten up to while locked in the room together. But then they all went downstairs, and Christian felt better about the possibility of Mia getting locked in with Darren. He was a nice guy when you got down to it.

The alcohol continued to flow as the six of them sat in a circle around the bottle once again. It might have seemed a childish enterprise to some, but there was a real buzz around them all, an apprehensive tension.

Next up were Mia and Irene.

There were whoops and cheers as Mia led Irene upstairs, and the timer started. However, Christian got the sense that everybody assumed Mia and Irene would just spend their seven minutes talking.

Downstairs, Miriam sipped a glass of wine and asked Christian if he’d had a pleasant time with Darren. Christian looked over at Darren, and the two gave each other a silent toast with their wine glasses. ‘I think we straightened out a few things,’ Christian said to Miriam.

Miriam grinned and said, ‘Does that mean we get to have sex whenever the damn bottle finally chooses us?’

Cue the laughter.

Christian said, ‘I don’t know... what can you really do in seven minutes?’

Miriam said, ‘You sure as hell can do *a bunch* of talking.’

When they all went upstairs to knock on Mia and Irene’s door, they opened it to find the two women clinched together as though they’d been spending their time making out. That might have been staged for the others’ benefit, but Christian did find himself wondering whether his wife could have had any hidden bisexual feelings.

The bottle picked out Greg and Irene next.

Miriam joked, ‘This bottle really doesn’t want any adultery to go on, huh?’

But seven minutes later, when the rest of the group came to collect Greg and Irene, for the first time, it seemed like something physical had happened in the room.

Greg and Irene were flushed and flustered, and Irene was reapplying her lipstick.

As they all returned to the poolside patio, Greg and Irene seemed happy and energized by their little interlude. Christian sneaked little looks at them, trying to figure them out. Was Greg turned on by the thought of Irene trying something on with another guy? Or was Irene keen on experimenting with a bit of partner swapping? Had the whole idea made them so hot for each other?

But there was no talk about what went on in that room. For now, it was small talk and the clink of wine glasses. Christian looked at Mia and found himself hoping she'd do something with one of the others. It was exciting to think of it.

As they went back to spin the bottle again, it was clear that a bond between them all had already formed. They'd been practically strangers not so long before. Now, they were firm friends.

Next up, Darren and Irene were chosen.

Irene gave a little gasp when the bottle turned to point at her. Then she glanced at her husband, and the two of them were blushing furiously. But Greg gave her a little nod, and Irene was up on her feet. Taking Darren's hand. Going with him into the house. Upstairs.

Christian watched Greg gazing after them in what appeared to be awe.

'You okay, bud?' He said to Greg.

Greg swallowed. 'Uh... yeah. Yeah, I'm okay,' he said quietly.

'You and Irene... I'm guessing during your seven minutes together... you two agreed that something could happen if either of you went in there with someone else?'

Greg looked at Christian, a sizable dose of terror in his eyes, and he nodded.

Mia sat beside Miriam, and topped up her wine, asking her, 'You okay?'

Miriam breathed deeply and patted her chest with her spare hand, as though she was suffering from heartburn. 'Jesus,' she said. 'I never felt like this before.'

'Uh-huh?'

'Didn't really think I could feel like this about Darren.'

They were all silent for a few moments, trying to listen for signs that something might happen between Darren and Irene. The air was just electric. The tension was crazy.

After a while, Miriam looked over at Greg and said, ‘You know, there’s really not much that can happen in seven minutes. When it comes to that.’

Greg took a big gulp of his wine and said, ‘I don’t know. I’m guessing you haven’t watched much online pornography if you think something like that.’

It was a comment that seemed surprising, coming from someone like Greg. But then, all guys look at porn, right?

But it seemed like a milestone. It was Greg coming to terms with the possibility — probability — that something very real was happening between Darren and Irene.

Miriam said to Christian, ‘You like this? This is what turns you on, this feeling?’

Christian laughed. ‘It’s hard to explain why...’

And Greg said, ‘I think... I think I can understand it...’

The way he looked made Christian think of how he had felt the night Mia went off with that guy from the bar. And how he felt when she’d left the party with Brandon. Was Greg into it like he was?

Miriam, though, seemed excited under the surface, too. She certainly wasn’t upset, she wasn’t angry, she wasn’t agonizing over whether to go up there and drag her husband out of there.

Christian was fascinated to see how the two of them would react when Darren and Irene emerged from the bedroom again.

EPISODE 12

The door opened, and there were Irene and Darren, looking all flushed, adjusting their clothing, looking as though something had definitely happened.

Irene's lipstick seemed to have vanished.

And was there a hint of perspiration on her brow?

Christian and Mia hung back, waiting to see how Miriam and Greg would react to the sight of their partners like this. Would one of them explode? Would Greg storm off, horrified at what Irene had done?

He figured Miriam would be okay with it, although she might decide they needed to end the game right now.

But Miriam went straight to Darren, saying, 'Hey, baby, you have fun?' Then she pulled him to her, kissing his mouth, visibly reclaiming him as hers. And apparently, she was quite taken with him.

Greg and Irene reunited more quietly, but as Greg went in to kiss his sweet wife, Christian saw her hand move between his legs — and it was Irene who suddenly seemed surprised.

Was he hard for her? Was she discovering how turned on Greg was because she'd been intimate with another man?

'Okay, are we playing the game or calling it quits?' Mia said, finally, since the two other couples couldn't seem to get enough of each other.

Finally, they all went back downstairs again, Christian noticing how many smiles the other couples were giving each other now. Were they getting into this?

Next up — Miriam and Darren. There were disappointed groans that the bottle had picked their hosts again. Yet, Miriam seemed perfectly happy to take her husband upstairs for seven minutes alone with him. Her whole demeanor had changed since Darren had been in with Irene. She was jubilant now.

Out on the patio, Greg sat with Irene while Christian sat with Mia, and as they all chatted, Christian and Mia pretended not to notice that Irene was rubbing her husband's hard-on through his pants, or that they kept giving in to the temptation to kiss each other's lips while the others were talking.

It was Mia who eventually asked, 'So how was it for you, Greg?'

'For me? Oh, well... I guess... it was okay,' he said, giving Irene a little smirk.

'You felt good about her... being with Darren?'

He shrugged. 'It wasn't so bad.'

'You'd be okay if it happened again?' She asked, digging like some kind of reporter. 'Or if she spent the night with him?'

Greg looked at Mia, Christian, and then Irene before saying, 'Uh... yeah, I think that would be okay...'

Irene's eyes widened, but then she clearly felt something happen between his thighs, and it made her quietly moan while she thought nobody else could see.

Christian was excited for them. Perhaps something really would come of this.

When Miriam and Darren returned from their seven minutes — returning shortly before the seven-minute alarm went off — it seemed like the two of them had been making full use of their time away from the others.

They might not have said anything confirming that they'd just had a quickie, but their smiles at the others seemed to verify it.

What was next? The wine was being drunk, and the three couples didn't seem to want to stop.

The bottle picked out Greg next. Then Miriam.

'That bottle really doesn't like you at all, buddy,' Darren joked, digging his elbow into Christian.

But Christian found that he didn't mind so much. Watching the other couples come to terms with the possibility of playing around with their staunch monogamy was entertaining. This time, for example, he bore witness to Darren as the guy had to wait for Miriam to spend seven minutes alone with another man. He got to see Irene dealing with the possibility that Greg might get it on with Miriam.

Darren poured them all another shot of whiskey but seemed very calm about it all. Christian thought it might be because he'd just had sex with Miriam, and that, as a result, he wouldn't be in a position to be sexually aroused about anything until he recovered. But after a while, it

seemed to Christian that Darren just wasn't the type to be sexually aroused by his wife's infidelity.

On the other hand, Irene was all smiles and nervous energy, constantly asking Mia and Christian whether they thought Greg was actually doing something with Miriam.

It was sweet that she was so curious and excited by it all.

When Miriam and Greg came out of the bedroom, it seemed certain to all of the others — from the humidity in the room, the scent of shampoo — that the two of them had showered. Both of them still had damp hair.

'You showered?' Darren was surprised, but still not jealous or upset.

Miriam said, 'Uh-huh.' And gave Greg a seductive look of gratitude.

Had the two of them showered together? Or separately?

The next couple chosen by the bottle was Christian and Mia.

Mia said, 'Fate really does want me to keep you to myself,' as they were dutifully heading upstairs to the main bedroom to carry out their seven-minute duty.

He smiled at her. 'And it doesn't want you to get up to much, either, apparently,' he said.

Mia giggled. 'Who said nothing happened between Irene and me?'

Christian laughed. 'Do you like her?'

'Irene? She's sweet. Fun. I think this has all just come as a bit of a shock to her.'

'Greg, too. I don't think they were expecting this.'

Mia closed the bedroom door, sealing them inside the spacious suite, which still had the faint humidity and soapy fragrance of the shower taken by the previous occupants.

'Irene says they've been having real trouble trying to have a baby,' Mia said, taking a seat on the huge bed, which seemed to have enjoyed some kind of action that evening — though Christian's money was on Darren and Miriam only.

'Are they getting any medical treatment for it?' Christian asked as he ducked his head around the door to check out the generously proportioned en suite bathroom.

'No, not yet. They're still at the stage where they think it's just the stress, the pressure of it all.'

‘Greg having problems getting it up, huh?’

‘Did he say something to you about it?’

Christian came to sit by her on the bed. ‘No. Just something in how the two of them looked when we watched that movie.’

Mia nodded her understanding. ‘Because the guy in the movie had erectile dysfunction.’

Christian smiled and leaned into her to kiss her. She beamed, ear-to-ear, as he kissed her beneath the ear, taking in a deep chestful of her scent. ‘So,’ he said, kissing her neck, ‘what do you think’s happened here so far tonight — anything interesting?’

Mia giggled. ‘How should I know?’

‘Best guess.’

Mia lay back on the bed as Christian continued to kiss her neck and shoulder, his hands slipping under her bikini top to caress the soft flesh of her breasts.

‘I think Darren and Irene made out like horny teenagers, and maybe Darren got a hand down her panties.’

‘She’s wearing a swimsuit.’

‘You know what I mean. Then Miriam basically jumped on Darren and went all the way...’

‘Of course.’

‘And then Miriam and Greg took a shower together, because she felt she needed one after fucking Darren... and maybe she went down on him in the shower, but there really wasn’t time for anything serious...’

Christian slid his hand over Mia’s stomach, and managed to slip it beneath the waistband of her cream shorts and the bikini bottoms below. He found her hairless pussy hot and very wet, and as his finger slipped partway inside her, she parted her thighs a little and let out a low moan.

‘What’re you going to do if you get picked with Darren?’ he asked, sensing she was less attracted to the bigger man.

‘I don’t know... maybe he needs to recover after he was with Miriam.’

‘Greg, then. What’re you going to do with Greg?’

She moaned again as Christian’s finger sank deeper inside her slippery folds.

‘What do you want me to do with him?’

He laughed. ‘I thought you were the one who liked being in control.’

She said, ‘I’m not with Brandon. He tells me exactly what to do.’

‘But you come home from him and tell me what to do.’

‘Brandon tells me what to do when I come home to you,’ she explained, and suddenly something seemed to click. Christian was surprised that understanding about Mia’s situation had materialized like that.

‘Wow,’ he said. Then, after a moment, he said, ‘Has he told you what to do while you’re here tonight?’

Mia giggled. ‘He doesn’t know what we’re up to. I don’t need to think about him right now, anyway. This is just us.’

‘Us six.’

‘Yes, us six.’

Then he was on his knees, pulling down her shorts, and she was pleading quietly, ‘Please... you’ll have to be quick...’

Her bikini bottoms were the type that tied at the waist. They fell apart as he fumbled with the ties.

Then he was on her. She was so wet. She tasted divine, of course. He couldn’t get enough of her. He never could, these days. It seemed extra hot because their time was limited, and the other couples were waiting, imagining what they might be up to.

‘What... are you... going to do... with Greg?’ he asked her while he ate her.

‘Mmm....’ she moaned, and given his eager tonguing, it took her a while to reboot her brain sufficient to answer him. ‘What do you want me to do?’

‘I want you to suck his cock,’ he said, enveloping her clit in his hot mouth, slipping a finger inside her.

‘Mmm... oh yes...’

‘And... I want you... to fuck him... if he wants you to...’

‘Oh yes... I’d fuck Greg... and maybe even Darren...’

She must have been tightly wound up by the evening’s affairs, because Mia came very, very quickly with just a few minutes of him pleasuring her with his mouth and his fingers.

There was only enough time for him to splash a little water on his face and for Mia to pull her shorts back on before there was a hammering on the door, and it was time to rejoin the others for the next round of the game.

The bottle pointed to Miriam... and then to Irene.

Well, such for the randomness of things.

The rest of them watched Miriam and Irene head off upstairs, hand-in-hand, though it seemed a little late for more discussion in the bedroom.

Darren was pouring more drinks, but with midnight rolling around, it started to seem to Christian that they were beginning to hit the long downward slide as far as the effect of the alcohol was concerned.

There seemed to be a slight relaxation of the tension in the air as they waited for Miriam and Irene. Darren was talking to Mia about the wine they were all drinking. Christian found himself talking to Greg about a few houses he and Irene had looked around recently.

Was it assumed that Miriam and Irene were up there chatting until it was time for them to return to the group?

Christian started talking to Greg about whether it might be time to consider extending his existing home, rather than trying to find a new one, when Mia suddenly stood up.

She put her wine glass on the table and then turned back to Darren.

‘You know, Darren,’ she said, stepping up to him. Her voice was a little slurred, as though the alcohol had finally gotten to her, but Christian suspected she was exaggerating it a little. ‘I’m just looking forward to when you and me... get in that room together...’

Standing in front of Darren, she bent down and touched a forefinger to his chin to tilt his face up to hers.

Then she kissed him, right in front of Christian and Greg.

God.

Christian felt his manhood thickening up almost instantly.

The kiss was over almost before Darren knew it was happening — and as she stepped back from him, Darren was left stunned as he sat there. Mia smiled warmly.

Then she slowly walked over to Greg, and kissed him, too. ‘Maybe it’ll be you and me instead,’ she said to him, and sucked on his lips some more.

Greg seemed completely taken by Mia’s kiss, and she appeared to purposefully prolong it.

Christian felt his stiff cock throbbing inside his pants. It was the most thrilling thing that had happened all day.

But then the seven-minute alarm went off, and that was that.

Miriam and Irene returned to the group looking surprisingly spirited. In fact, as they rejoined the party, the looks the two women were giving each other raised many questions among the others.

And yet the unspoken rule of — generally — leaving what happened in the bedroom in the bedroom was sustained.

Christian wondered if those around him still had the energy to keep playing this game. Yet what Mia had just done with Darren and Greg seemed to have re-energized them both. And, whatever Miriam and Irene had just said — or done — to each other seemed to have given them a second wind too.

Now the bottle decided to send Darren upstairs with Irene again.

It was the fifth time for each of them, and their second time with each other. They seemed happy enough to go off together — and seeing Irene that way was clearly exciting for Greg.

As the group of them hovered by the bottom of the stairs, watching Darren and Irene disappear off toward the bedroom, Miriam said to Greg, ‘Your wife is quite the kisser, you know that?’

Greg looked at her, aghast.

Miriam grinned. ‘What? It’s boring, isn’t it, going up to that bedroom just to talk. We’re having a party. We’re trying new things!’

Christian said, ‘You guys made out?’

Miriam shrugged. ‘Maybe we won’t get this kind of opportunity again.’

‘You liked it?’ Mia asked, moving to stand beside Miriam.

‘Uh-huh,’ Miriam grinned.

Then Mia kissed Miriam, long and slow. Christian saw them using tongues, their arms encircling each other, hands sweeping over each other’s bodies.

They were breathless when they came up for air.

‘Maybe I’ll be with you next,’ Mia said to her.

‘My God,’ Miriam said, running her eyes all over Mia. ‘Christian is a lucky guy.’

‘I don’t know,’ Mia laughed. ‘He’s only been picked once tonight. And that was for seven minutes with his wife.’

Miriam grinned. ‘He’s obsessed with his wife,’ she said, reaching behind Mia’s neck, only to unfasten the tie and allow her bikini top to drop down, revealing her pert breasts. ‘So I guess he’s still having a fun evening...’

Christian’s jaw dropped. He glanced at Greg, who looked similarly startled by all this, despite the revelation that his wife had just been

making out with another woman.

Miriam said, 'Why so shocked? It's only us... nobody has to know...'

And now Mia reached up to unfasten Miriam's bikini top, saying, 'Yeah... you know, there's no rules in this game for what we're allowed to do when we're *not* in the bedroom...'

Miriam's top fell to the ground, and the two women shared a naughty smile before Mia ducked down to take one of Miriam's stiff, brown nipples into her mouth.

Christian could hardly believe what he was seeing.

Was his wife bisexual?

As she sucked on Miriam's nipple, Mia's hands moved to the other woman's fly button, and Christian caught his breath to see her unfasten it and pull down her shorts.

Miriam looked at Christian and flashed him a wicked grin. 'You want to watch me fuck your wife?'

Mia giggled and turned to her husband. 'You look so shocked, honey!'

'I just never thought...'

She shrugged. 'Neither did I. But maybe it'd be fun, huh?'

But then Mia sensed that Greg was being left out, and now she turned to him, saying to Christian, 'Or maybe... you'd prefer to watch both of us have a little fun with Greg...?'

Greg caught his breath as the two topless women moved to his side, and Mia pulled up his shirt, revealing his surprisingly trim torso.

Miriam made way for Mia to remove Greg's shirt altogether, then she took hold of his head in her hands and gave him a full-on kiss on the lips.

Greg did not pull away, but Miriam sensed his hesitancy.

She said, 'You know your wife is spreading her legs for my husband right now?'

Greg looked stunned, but Christian recognized the glint of excitement in his terrified eyes. He wasn't horrified by the idea of his wife being unfaithful, that was for sure, despite his anxiety.

Now Mia kissed him, and it seemed that what Miriam said lent him a little more confidence to kiss her back.

It was a long, slow, tender kiss, sweet but explorational — it seemed clear that Greg wasn't the most experienced lover, but he made up for it with growing enthusiasm.

As Christian watched his wife sucking on another man's lips, Miriam appeared with a shot glass for him.

‘You really do enjoy watching, huh?’ Miriam smiled warmly, knocking back her own shot to encourage him to do the same.

Christian downed the amber liquid and felt the alcohol scorch the back of his throat. ‘She’s so beautiful,’ he said earnestly as they saw Mia take hold of Greg’s shaky hand and guide it to her bare breasts.

‘You know, she’s pretty lucky having a husband like you,’ Miriam said.

‘You think Darren will want to watch you with other guys?’

Miriam shrugged. ‘I don’t know. I get the feeling he’s more about what’s happening to himself... he doesn’t get motivated by the thought of me being naughty with other people...’

‘How do you feel about him being with other people?’

Then the seven-minute alarm went off, and Miriam said, ‘I guess we’re about to find out...’

As much as he enjoyed a little fooling around with the other women, the real clue to how Greg was feeling at that time was how quickly he reacted to that particular seven-minute alarm.

Christian couldn’t help but notice that the guy almost immediately ended things with Mia, and led the way upstairs to let Darren and Irene know their allotted time was up.

It was Greg who knocked on the door and called, ‘Irene, that’s your seven minutes!’

When Darren opened the door, they found him red-faced and a little sweaty, and there was a distinct musty smell in the bedroom air. Christian raised his eyebrows — the two of them had had sex, albeit for only a short while, that was quite clear.

‘Sweetheart?’ Greg called for his wife, and she emerged from the bathroom, dabbing her face with a towel, having splashed water over it.

She looked flushed and her hair mussed up, and now that she saw her husband, she was suddenly afraid.

Miriam was already in a full embrace with her husband as Mia and Christian watched Greg walk across to Irene, scoop her up in his arms and press his lips to hers.

Irene was a little taken aback, but after a moment, she showed her true delight at how her husband suddenly desired her.

‘I guess everything’s okay,’ Mia said to Christian, and he wondered if this was the end of the game.

But then Miriam pulled apart from her husband and asked him straight up: ‘So did you come yet, hon?’

Darren shook his head. ‘Nope, not yet.’

Miriam grinned. ‘Then the game continues, huh?’

But this time, it felt different. Things had stepped up a gear. Despite all the alcohol they’d all had throughout the evening, they all suddenly felt strangely sober.

Everyone was clear that there were no limits on what they could try with each other now. Mia and Miriam were sitting there wearing nothing but bikini bottoms.

Irene had even had Darren inside her, for heaven’s sake. And Greg hadn’t been able to keep his hands off her since then.

This time, as they circled around the empty wine bottle out there by the pool, Miriam said, ‘I say we should choose *three* people to go in, from now on.’

She looked around at the others, and received only nods and quiet assents in reply.

Mia said, ‘And we should make it ten minutes in heaven.’

‘Fifteen!’ Miriam laughed.

The others shrugged and nodded.

And so it was. Miriam spun the bottle again.

Irene.

Mia.

Greg.

Christian felt a little shiver of arousal and nerves sweep through him as everybody looked at each other, taking in the latest decision of the bottle.

Irene was up on her feet first, a broad grin spreading across her face as she put out her hands to help up her husband.

Mia said to her husband, ‘That bottle really doesn’t like you, sweetie, huh?’

He laughed. ‘It’s Marriage 2.0, right? They’ve fixed the results.’

She laughed with him. ‘The damn bottle is *rigged*.’

Then she leaned in to whisper in his ear: ‘You think she’ll let me fuck him?’

Christian’s eyes flashed, and then he smiled, signaling his hope that such an eventuality might come to pass.

She kissed him only briefly on the lips, more like a peck than a kiss.

It was Irene who took her hand, and led her, along with Greg, into the house and up the stairs to the bedroom.

EPISODE 13

Christian was sitting with Darren and Miriam Bywater on the outdoor sofa on their patio, sipping on a glass of deep red wine. Watching the two cuddle up with each other as though they'd been apart for weeks.

He'd only really gotten to know them recently, and before today that had been through various neighborhood get-togethers. But he got the sense that it had been a long time since they'd been this passionate about each other.

Miriam, in particular, seemed quite taken with the fact that her husband had just spent seven minutes shut in a room with another woman.

But Darren's desire for his wife also seemed to have been rekindled by the experience.

Christian tried not to seem like a third wheel as the two of them kissed and fondled each other, and Miriam quietly grilled her husband for details.

'Did you fuck her, honey?... Did she make you *so hard*? Did it feel so *good*, sliding inside her?...'

After a while, he stood up and drifted away, wandering back inside the house on the pretense of needing to top up his drink.

Inside, he tiptoed to the bottom of the main staircase and listened. He couldn't hear anything from upstairs.

Yet.

What was happening up there?

Was Mia watching, semi-bored, as Greg reconciled with Irene after she'd experienced brief sexual intercourse with another man?

Or was Irene encouraging her husband to try things with Mia while she watched?

Or was Mia putting on a show with Irene for Greg's benefit? Taking her chance to experiment with another woman as part of this strangest of nights.

Christian couldn't tell what the most likely scenario was.

Perhaps it was a full threesome — Mia and Irene sharing Greg, straight out.

Whatever was happening, they had a full fifteen minutes to try it.

'Oh... oh... oh yeah...'

Christian turned his head toward the sound. It wasn't coming from upstairs, which was faintly disappointing.

On the patio, Miriam was having sex with her husband, where Christian had just been sitting. Darren was seated, and Miriam was facing him on his lap, and as she rode him, she was looking over his shoulder at Christian through the window.

Christian got the sense that she wanted to be watched.

He wandered slowly back toward the patio, and as she saw him approaching, Miriam gave him an encouraging smile.

It was strange — almost surreal — being there while another couple was having sex. Erotic, sure, but somehow it felt wrong. Like he wasn't supposed to be there, despite what had happened all night. And yet, it was an entirely natural process, right? Sex. And here was a married couple doing it entirely consensually.

They just happened to be doing it while Christian was present.

There was definitely something hot about the way Miriam gazed at him while she was fucking her husband.

These were people he knew. They were doing it right in front of him.

Though his reference point was pornography, this blew porn out of the water, even though the performers looked nothing like pornstars.

'Oh God... oh yes... oh God... oh yes...'

He leaned in the doorway, so close to them he could hear the wet sounds of her pussy sliding up and down her husband's hard cock.

Miriam smiled again, delighting in having an audience.

Christian grinned. 'Aren't you supposed to wait until the bottle sends you into the bedroom?'

She laughed. 'I told you already — nobody set any rules for people waiting out here during the seven minutes in heaven.'

'Fifteen minutes in heaven.'

'Whatever. You feeling left out, honey?'

She arched her back and pushed out her chest while she continued to ride her husband, and it was pretty clear she was offering Christian the

chance to kiss her, or perhaps fondle her breasts. She certainly had gorgeous breasts — a little larger than Mia's, but still not much more than handfuls. Her little brown nipples were stiff as steel.

Christian's eyes flicked back up to her face, and shared her smile, but nothing else.

The trouble was, he saw Miriam and Darren fucking, and could only think about whether Mia might be upstairs doing the same thing with Greg.

Christian said, 'You guys should be careful not to run out of steam — maybe you'll be picked to go upstairs next.'

Miriam giggled but did not stop fucking her husband.

Christian stepped back inside, turning away from them, hearing their host saying to her husband, 'God, it's so hot, I can smell her on you, honey. You must have fucked her so *good*...'

Another thought sprang to Christian's mind — prompted by Miriam reminding him that in the game of Seven Minutes in Heaven, there were no rules for those who were not the couple going into the closet.

Christian drifted inside. Miriam and her husband were focused on each other now. As he reached the bottom of the stairs, a glance toward the patio showed him that Miriam was now on her knees, sucking on her husband's cock.

As for Christian — why shouldn't he go upstairs? There were no rules against waiting outside the room where it was all happening.

In fact, wasn't it a party tradition for other partygoers to hover outside the closet when Seven Minutes in Heaven was being played — to listen out for signs that things were happening?

Christian felt his heart rate quicken with every step he took upward.

He hadn't even gotten to the top of the stairs before he started hearing the sound of Greg sighing and moaning. Something was definitely happening.

As he ventured down the hallway toward the primary bedroom, the sounds of Greg enjoying the attentions of Irene or Mia — or both — seemed very clear.

Ahead, he could see why: the door was open a crack. More than a crack, in fact.

Had the three of them been careless?

Or did they want to be watched?

Christian kept to the shadows, took a deep breath, and moved slowly toward the doorway. He could hear the mattress creaking. He could hear the soft sound of flesh rubbing on flesh.

He looked through the gap in the doorway.

All three of them were naked and entangled on the bed. Despite everything Christian had seen before, it was still startling to see them like this — people he knew, without a shred of clothing on.

Still shocking to see Mia lying against a naked man, kissing his mouth. Naked herself.

As they kissed, Greg was lying on his back, Mia by his side. Irene was on her hands and knees over her husband, one hand clutching his stiff shaft as her head bobbed down on it.

Christian watched as Irene came off her husband's cock and stroked it, examining it as though she'd never seen a man's erect penis before. He got the sense that, as in the movie they'd seen about the guy with ED, Irene hadn't seen her husband this hard for a while.

Mia was giggling, murmuring to Greg, though Christian couldn't hear what they were saying.

Then Christian caught his breath as Mia got up onto her hands and knees, and Irene happily made way as she took hold of Greg's cock in her hands.

Christian felt a wave of arousal sweep through his body as he watched his wife take hold of the base of the other man's cock, and direct it toward her parting lips.

She tucked her shoulder-length brown hair behind an ear and sank onto Greg's pole. Christian felt his own cock throbbing to see his wife taking the other man inside her mouth. She closed her eyes as she sucked on his tip and started caressing it with her soft lips.

Watching his woman pleasuring another man's cock made Christian feel a deep, powerful desire for her. He was so hard for her, desperate to take her for himself.

But that feeling went into overdrive as he saw Mia lift up, then move to straddle Greg's thighs. Irene sat by her husband's head, quietly murmuring encouraging words to him. Mia directed the man's hardness to her pussy.

Oh, God.

It was like that moment he'd seen her taken by Brandon. The arousal was so intense it felt like his entire being could be pulled into it like a star being drawn into a black hole. His biological urge to compete with

the man mating with his wife ignited as he watched the man's cock disappearing between Mia's shapely buttocks.

Mia put her hands on Greg's chest and gently stirred her hips, allowing a little more of the man's cock to slip inside her each time she sank. Working it so that her juices coated his stiff shaft.

And then Christian watched her take that whole thing inside her.

Greg was well endowed. Even bigger than Brandon, Christian would have said. It seemed like a marvel of biology that there could be room for it within Mia's tight frame. But here it was, pushing inside her again and again as Mia's moans grew louder and louder.

Irene was sitting up against the pillows, watching Mia fucking her husband, transfixed. She had her husband's hand lodged between her thighs, though Irene seemed to be doing most of the work in rubbing it against her sex.

Greg was a little more focused on Mia just now.

Christian gave in to temptation as he watched them, pulling his own cock out to stroke while he watched this other man fucking his wife.

It wasn't for long, however. The three seemed rushed, knowing they were limited by time.

After a few minutes, Mia lifted off and traded places with Irene. The blonde took her place over her husband's thighs quickly and slid his cock inside her with practiced familiarity. But as Irene sank down on it, she issued a cry of sheer delight that was definitely not borne out of familiarity.

'You're so hard, my love,' she said, breathless. 'She's made you all slippery... she's so wet for you, darling... Oh, it feels so good...'

Mia was sitting up where Irene had been, but as she watched the blonde start riding her husband, she shifted down on her back so that Greg's head was right between her thighs.

She was stroking her pussy just inches away from his face — Christian felt real envy for the guy. Could he smell how turned-on she was?

Then Greg seemed to confirm it, noticing Mia's shapely legs on either side of him, and now he turned his head, reaching to taste Mia's pussy while Irene rode him. It wasn't an easy position for Greg to enjoy Mia's sex, however. After a few moments, Irene drew his full attention.

But then Irene seemed to have a fresh idea.

The blonde climbed off her husband and went down on all fours — Greg seeming to get the idea as he watched his wife move between Mia's outstretched thighs.

Christian watched in near disbelief as Irene started kissing her way around Mia's inner thighs, exploring her as very much a beginner in the field.

Greg knelt behind her and entered her from the rear, making her moan long and low before she pressed her mouth against Mia's pussy.

Mia let out a sexy little gasp as the blonde pushed her face against her pussy. But as she gently placed encouraging hands on the blonde's head, Greg's thrusting seemed to be the driver grinding Irene's mouth against Mia's sex.

It was so hot to see — and yet hotter still was when Mia's eyes drifted to the doorway, and she caught sight of her husband watching them.

Now Mia gazed at Christian, flashing him a wicked smile as she made the whole thing seem like a performance for his personal benefit.

Christian stroked his cock and stepped into the light just enough for Mia to see what he was doing. Her eyes blazed, and her smile brightened as she saw him pumping his hardness.

There was an alarm — somebody's phone, somewhere in the room — and it was clear the fifteen minutes were over.

But Greg wasn't stopping just yet. His thrusting was getting more forceful as he slammed his big dick into his wife's soaking pussy, and his moans had become great panting grunts.

'Oh... oh... *oh...*'

Mia stroked Irene's face as the blonde lifted off her, needing more air for each gasping breath as a phenomenal orgasm developed between her thighs.

Christian shared a knowing smirk with his wife as the two of them became observers, taking in the sight of Irene and Greg sharing the most earth-shattering climax.

Irene yelling, 'Yes... come in me, my love... *come inside me...*'

Afterward, Greg and Irene just collapsed, completely spent.

Christian watched Mia extricate herself from the bed and quietly scamper out of the room, scooping up her bikini bottoms from the floor as she went.

Outside the room, she closed the bedroom door to grant the other couple some peace and privacy.

‘I guess they’re done for the night,’ she murmured with a smile as her husband approached her in the darkness.

He said, ‘Are you done for the night?’

‘Nope,’ she grinned and reached up to put her hands behind his neck and pull him in for a sweet kiss.

He moaned as he felt her hand on his exposed cock as she kissed him, her mouth warm and sweet, though her lips definitely carried an unusual flavor.

‘You went down on her?’ he asked her when they came up for breath.

She said, ‘Seemed rude not to.’

He sucked on her lips, tasting the flavor of another woman and the hint of another man there. It was thrilling, knowing how wicked she’d been, the image of her sucking on Greg’s cock burned into his consciousness as he kissed his wife.

But Mia pulled back, and put a forefinger to her lips to suggest they leave Greg and Irene in peace.

Christian allowed her to lead him back downstairs, where perhaps Darren and Miriam were done for the night, too.

As they descended, it seemed that the hosts of the evening had vacated the patio. Had they found themselves a guest bedroom to despoil?

But then they heard laughter from another direction, and turned to see Miriam and Darren were out there after all, cuddling up in the hot tub.

Mia laughed, and dragged Christian by the hand out to join them.

‘You have fun?’ Miriam asked Mia as she stepped into the hot, bubbling water.

‘It was hot,’ Mia grinned. ‘Shame we only had 15 minutes.’

‘Long enough for Greg and Irene, I think,’ Christian pointed out.

Since the others were naked, Christian shed his own shorts before joining his wife in the hot tub. The tub was large enough for four to sit comfortably, one in each corner.

‘Those two done for the night?’ Miriam asked.

‘Oh, yes. Greg finally let loose inside Irene, and... you know...’

Miriam giggled. ‘Well, they are trying for a baby.’

It took Christian a few moments to realize that Miriam was stroking her husband’s cock under the water. Glancing over at Mia, he saw that she’d noticed, too — and then Mia’s hand was venturing between his thighs, to seek out the hardness therein.

‘It’s been quite a night, huh?’ Miriam said, directing a beaming smile at each of them.

Mia laughed. 'Does this mean you guys are going to sign up for the program?'

Miriam looked at Darren, and the two of them shared a grin. 'I guess so,' Darren said.

'What if we get sent off to an island to spend time with no one but each other?' Miriam said.

'I can't see that happening,' Christian said. Miriam gave him a flirty smile, enjoying the fact that he knew she was jerking off her husband, and that she'd influenced Mia to do the same with Christian.

'So, do we get to know what everyone's been up to tonight?' Mia asked.

There was a moment as all four of them chuckled at the suggestion.

But it was Miriam who went first, 'Well, I had a delightful shower with our friend Greg.'

'Did you fuck him?' Mia asked.

Miriam shook her head. 'No, but I had some fun teaching him how to make a woman come...'

'He went down on you?'

Miriam's eyes flashed. 'It was a crash course, but I think he learned a thing or two.' Then she said to Mia, 'You fucked him?'

Mia smiled warmly at him before nodding to Miriam's question. 'I did for a little while before Irene took over.'

Miriam said, 'I think those two got the most out of tonight, huh? I know Irene was up there a lot...'

'You slept with her?' Mia asked Darren.

Darren shrugged. 'Sure. The second time. She wasn't as sure of herself the first time I went with her. We kissed and cuddled, and I let her play with my cock a little. The second time, she dragged me onto the bed.'

No sooner had he said that than Miriam leaned in to kiss his mouth — she seemed to enjoy the thought of her husband being with Irene.

Then Miriam said to him, 'You didn't get to try Mia, though.'

'I never got to go in with her,' he said.

Mia giggled, and then to Christian's surprise, she stood up, saying, 'Well, I'm here now, aren't I?'

Then Miriam made way, and Christian was a little taken aback to see Mia climb onto Darren's lap. As she gazed over at him, he watched her slip the man's hard cock to her hairless pussy, and then she sank down.

'Oh yeah...' Darren groaned as his manhood was engulfed by Mia's sex.

‘How does it feel, my darling?’ Miriam asked her husband, as Mia gently waggled her hips, still staring across the tub at her adoring husband.

‘Mmm... so good...’

Mia started to move on the other man, lifting herself up only to sink down again, working his stiff shaft with her pussy. The water covered up some of it, though not all — there was plenty for Christian to see. He wasn’t expecting the feeling of another hand moving to his lap, closing around his shaft.

‘You like watching her being fucked by somebody else?’ Miriam asked him as she slowly pumped Christian’s cock.

‘Oh yes,’ he said, still gazing into Mia’s eyes while she was being fucked. ‘She’s so *beautiful*...’

His words brought a bright smile to Mia’s face. Nevertheless, it wasn’t long before the sensation of fucking Darren made her look away and close her eyes, her jaw dropping as she let out a long moan of pure bliss.

Miriam continued to pump Christian’s cock as the two of them watched their spouses fucking, her other hand furiously stirring between her own thighs.

Christian found it interesting that she seemed more like him — interested in watching her partner with someone else more than the possibility of fucking someone else herself.

They watched Mia come to a halt, then stand up. She took a step forward and then bent over to kiss her husband.

While his wife was kissing him, Christian realized that Darren had started to fuck her again, this time from behind. Each of his thrusts shoved Mia forward, pressing against Christian while he attempted to suck on her lips.

Mia giggled as their kiss ended, but now Miriam was urging him up to his feet, guiding him back to sit on the edge of the tub, his erect cock sticking straight up before Mia took hold of it.

Now Darren was fucking Mia from behind while she sucked on her husband’s cock. Miriam perched on the tub’s edge herself, enjoying the sight of Mia being roasted between two cocks, stroking her pussy while she watched.

Mia couldn’t handle two cocks at once for long, however. Particularly since it was her first time experiencing it, and because it was getting late. She manhandled Darren so that he was sitting on the edge of

the tub, and now went back to sitting on his lap — this time offering Christian a full view of her sex.

Miriam went to kiss her husband while he continued to fuck Mia, leaving Christian to stroke his own cock. He almost lost it when he heard Miriam murmuring in her husband's ear, telling him to come inside Mia.

‘Come inside her, my darling, you know you want to... fill her up with your yummy cream...’

Darren did as he was told, but the combination of him coming inside Mia, and the fact that her husband was watching every moment, close-up, also pushed Mia over the edge.

She came with a tremendous shuddering yelp, which seemed well-orchestrated with Darren's low groan as he shot his come deep inside her.

Before they'd even come down from their orgasmic high, Christian was on his feet, tenderly kissing his wife on the mouth.

Sharing his affection for her, showing her how much she thrilled him.

Finally, it was time to find a guest bedroom, for Christian to shut himself away with only his sweet, freshly-fucked wife, to enjoy her depravity firsthand.

EPISODE 14

Mia needed a few nights off after that. That is, she didn't go out with any other guys for a little while.

She didn't abstain from all sexual activity — but it meant lazy evenings at home in front of the TV, with her husband kneeling between her thighs, taking diligent care of her needs with his increasingly talented mouth.

Christian enjoyed sucking on her beautiful little pussy, of course, and how wet she got for him. Her new dedication to keeping her pussy completely fur-free helped, although the aim was first and foremost about showing it off to others.

He wasn't always on his knees, of course. Frequently, yes. But sometimes Mia was on her knees. Or they just snuggled up on the sofa stroking each other, kissing, watching movies curated by their Marriage 2.0 program.

These days, there seemed less pressure to take lessons from the movies they were being shown. They had gotten to a place where they already understood what they should be doing.

So they just relaxed and allowed the erotic nature of the movies help their imaginations along as they spent their evenings with each other. “Palm Swings,” “The Big Swap,” “Forbidden Pleasures.”

Mia had seen Brandon on and off during the days, as he helped her with little projects at her condo refurbishment, and when she helped him with his house down the road.

The guy was dating a blonde named Anna, but that hadn't gotten to a state where he needed to close doors with Mia.

Christian would still occasionally come home to the delicious sight of his wife getting ready to go out with Brandon for the night. She even

offered him a little taste of her exquisite pussy before she disappeared for the evening, leaving him to his own devices.

It was like a dream for Christian when she returned from her date after midnight.

Sitting there on the couch, he'd watch Mia quietly enter and remove her dress. Underneath, she was often completely naked on returning from Brandon. She took delight in her husband's response as she slowly approached and stood before him in such a state.

'I have something for you,' she said, beckoning him with a finger.

He was more than happy to oblige, leaning in to enjoy the strange flavor of her freshly-fucked pussy, thrilled by knowing how recently another man had used her.

After a while, she led him to the bedroom to make more forceful use of his mouth — but he enjoyed even that. It was just beautiful how she was when she was overwhelmed by her sexual fever.

Following that, she stroked his cock while answering his questions about her evening with Brandon. Then, when he was ready to blow, she gulped his cock down her throat and swallowed every last drop of his cream.

All was well with the world.

Irene and Greg were the next couple in the neighborhood to sign up for Marriage 2.0.

For Mia and Christian, the initial benefit came from a referral credit, which took some of the sting out of their original program fee. But then, a few days later, Mia was invited for a night out with Irene and Miriam, and that turned out to be the start of Irene's Marriage 2.0 program.

'Did they tell you what you're supposed to do while you're out?' Christian asked his wife.

Mia simply shrugged and said, 'Nothing specific. I guess we just go out and flirt with a few guys!'

Christian was on board with that idea, though that first night out didn't result in much more than Miriam and Mia encouraging Irene to chat with a few guys. Irene spent much of the evening worrying that people might see her and think her some kind of slut.

On their next night out, Greg and Darren came over to hang out with Christian, and Irene seemed more resolved to actually pursue some guys

while the wives were out.

On that occasion, the women returned home at the end of the evening with tales of cheerful inebriation and fumbling with guys on the dance floor of a local nightclub.

It took a few of these girls' nights out before anything significant happened. But Christian was surprised by how much he enjoyed hanging out with Greg and Darren.

During these evenings, there was a perpetual sense of underlying excitement as the men contemplated whether their wives would get up to any high jinks on their night out. Even Darren, who'd never seemed particularly aroused by the idea of Miriam being with other people, got into the spirit of things.

They watched college football and drank beer, placing bets on what time their wives would come home.

One night, Miriam and Mia returned from their night out with the news that Irene had gone home with a landscape gardener from Norwood. Greg had been just beside himself with excitement at this development.

A few drinks later, during which Miriam had been joking about Darren taking Mia home for a bit of fun, Mia ended up taking her up on the offer. And Miriam ultimately decided to go along for the show.

That left Greg and Christian to their own devices.

It was oddly exciting, the two of them waiting for their wives to have sex with other people.

'You ever worry this kind of thing will get out of control?' Greg asked as they cracked open a bottle of Jack Daniels.

'I don't know. Since it's all part of the program, I guess I figure it will always be under control.'

'But the program's going to end at some point.'

Christian nodded. 'I guess it will.'

It was 2am when Greg got the text saying that Irene's one-night stand was gone. The guy was up on his feet as though he'd sat on a thumb tack — and then quickly out of the door and on his way home to reclaim his wife.

Mia came home soon after that, a little tired, a little mussed up, but with that sexy-as-hell glow from being freshly fucked.

'Miriam just watched us,' she said as she peeled off her dress in front of him. 'I think she's more like you than me.'

'She didn't do anything?'

Mia sat on her husband's lap and kissed him, and he throbbed with arousal at recognizing the smell and taste of a man on her.

'As soon as I was done with him, she was all over him... but while we were fucking, she just watched.'

Christian rolled her onto her back, making her squeal with delight at his evident craving for her. Then he started kissing his way down her body, fizzing with desire at the traces of her adulterous evening lingering on her soft skin.

'Are they going to sign up for Marriage 2.0?' he asked as he slid down between her thighs, and began cleaning up her well-used pussy with an eager tongue.

'Darren said they didn't need to. I guess Miriam's okay with it.'

But then, as he pleased her with his mouth, Mia talked more about Irene and the guy she'd finally plucked up enough courage to take home with her.

'You think she'll see him again after tonight?' Christian asked.

'I don't know. Maybe. He doesn't live so far away.'

And then Christian was kissing her mouth, sliding his brutally hard cock inside her creamy pussy, and neither of them was talking about anybody else the rest of that night.

Mia regularly went out with Irene and Miriam for the rest of the summer. It meant more time away from Christian, but he was perfectly happy about it.

Even if nothing much happened, she always returned cheerful and refreshed from her girls' nights out.

And there was always the possibility that she would have a little fun while they were out, or end up in someone else's bed.

The full success scenario didn't happen nearly as often as they might have liked. However, it was still always there as a possibility. And it was always fun to be with Mia while she was preparing for a wild night out. Giving his opinion on her outfits, her lingerie. Showering with her, shaving her sweet pussy, getting it all ready for possibility of being used by another man.

Christian might hang out with Greg and Darren during these evenings, but sometimes he just waited home alone.

The underlying sense of excitement was with them all, whatever happened.

Toward the end of the summer, Darren's work was getting a little busier, and when Mia went out with Miriam and Irene, more and more, he wasn't available to hang out with Greg and Christian.

It wasn't so bad, hanging out, watching movies, shooting pool in the Dunlops' basement, and so on.

The two of them shared an underlying excitement about what their wives might be up to. And after everything that had happened, they felt comfortable opening up to each other about it.

Then one night, Miriam could not get a babysitter, and it was just Mia and Irene going out, while Christian and Greg waited in hopeful anticipation.

The women still seemed up for a big night out, even just the two of them, so it was still a fun evening.

Then much to Christian and Greg's shared surprise, when midnight came around, so did Irene and Mia, accompanied by a younger man.

'This is Angelo,' Irene said.

Angelo offered them a faintly sheepish smile.

Mia added, 'We said he could fuck us both — if he let our husbands watch the whole thing.'

Angelo turned out to be still in college, and seemed a little green around the edges, though he was keen on getting to sleep with two women at once.

Greg and Christian felt a little stunned by the whole thing, but they were definitely supportive of the idea.

It took a few drinks to get everybody in the right mood — along with a little music to continue the mood of the girls' night out.

Then it was time.

The two women grabbed Angelo's arms and escorted him upstairs like security dealing with someone who'd just lost his job.

Then Christian and Greg were being beckoned along by their wives, and they followed the threesome upstairs to the main bedroom.

It wasn't exactly a large room, but there was an armchair in the corner that Greg offered to Christian. As Angelo sat on the end of the bed, removing his shoes, and the women sat beside him, removing his shirt, Greg fetched one of those stackable leather side chairs from another room.

Watching the three on the bed, Greg and Christian continued to sip their beers as though they were some kind of high-brow culture connoisseurs appreciating avant-garde performance art.

But this was hardly high-brow, even though the women looked stunning in their dresses and nylon stockings, their high-heeled shoes, their perfect makeup.

Irene kissed Angelo, and then Mia kissed him, and then the two women kissed each other. Christian noticed that Greg was already stroking himself through his pants, and Christian shrugged and did likewise.

Angelo stood, and his hands were all over their fine asses, while their hands were running up and down his crotch, checking out his goods.

Christian was so impressed by how confident both Mia and Irene were. Mia had grown in confidence with Brandon, of course, but Irene had also come on in leaps and bounds since her one wild night at the Bywaters' home.

Now Irene was happily making out with Angelo while he slipped down the straps on her dress to reveal her black and pink lace bra. Mia knelt down to work on his pants, her hand continuing to stroke the bulge between his legs.

Christian glanced across at Greg briefly to see how he was responding to the sight of Angelo stripping off Irene's dress completely. Greg was totally absorbed by the spectacle.

Mia stood and started making out with Irene, the blonde now working on removing Mia's dress, as Angelo moved to kiss her back and her beautiful behind.

Mia wasn't wearing a bra, leaving her gorgeous tits bare for Irene's enjoyment. But Angelo soon evened the score between the two women, standing to remove Irene's bra and release her small but shapely breasts.

Christian relished the sight of Mia playing with another woman — and yet it gave him a completely different feeling to the experience of Mia being with another man. It was deeply ingrained within him, he suspected — an innate difference in his responses, rather than a conscious part of his belief structure. At a biological level, his body

could not believe that a woman could threaten his relationship with Mia in the way a man could.

It meant there wasn't the same tension as he felt about Mia's interactions with Brandon, Darren, Greg, or Angelo himself.

He still got the buzz from seeing Mia savor her opportunity to explore this beautiful woman, and stretch her own experience levels and boundaries. He could luxuriate in the pleasing aesthetics of two beautiful women caressing each other, rubbing their soft skin together, sucking on each other's breasts.

But the deep thrill came from Angelo pawing at Mia's pussy through her panties, and then when the women dropped down onto the bed, and the guy was between Irene's thighs, wedging his face up against the blonde's black and pink lace underwear, Christian could see Greg felt the same way watching this threesome play out.

Angelo seemed to be in his own personal heaven as he nudged aside Irene's panties and began tonguing at her juicy sex, his right hand working its way into Mia's panties to find her own slippery folds.

Then the young college stud moved between Mia's thighs, to tend to her with his mouth instead. Irene moved up onto all fours to make out with Mia some more.

Angelo was a little rough around the edges, but very eager with it. Keen to learn. Mia glanced across to ensure her husband was fine with everything, and offered him a little smirk at how earnestly frantic the younger guy was being with his oral exploration.

But then Mia was sitting up and pulling open Angelo's belt, and Irene was up behind him, helping to haul his pants down to his ankle. And when the guy's big, heavy cock was unveiled, all was forgiven concerning his general lack of artisanal skills.

Christian found himself catching his breath as he watched his wife take the man's thick cock in her hands.

It just never got old, seeing your wife manhandle another guy's dick.

Then two women were kneeling on the floor licking and sucking on that dick, and it was difficult not to envy the guy. They were worshipping that thing.

Had they known he was this big when they'd invited him home from their night off? It could hardly be blind luck.

Greg was up, but only to move his chair over a little, to better watch his wife sucking on the guy's balls while Mia sank down on his massive shaft. The women swapped over a few times, taking a fully egalitarian approach to blowing the guy.

Strangely, they kept giving their husbands little smiles and looks, almost as though they were doing all this merely for their husbands' viewing pleasure.

There was something hot about how they kept their husbands included, though.

Christian had to be careful to avoid prematurely finishing when he watched Mia offer up her breasts for Angelo to rub his stiff cock between. Irene tried it, too, though her tits were a little on the small side.

There was something just plain obscene about a young stud painting his wife's breasts with his cock. Mia holding her tits together while he fucked them, smearing his slick precome all over her soft skin, patting his dick against her stiff nipples.

It was like he was marking her as his territory, even though she was Christian's wife.

The tension Christian felt was delicious.

It was Irene, though, who was first to lie back on the bed and spread her legs for Angelo to stroke his hard cock up against her pussy — and then sink it inside her.

Christian heard Greg gasp at the sight of another man penetrating his wife. This was the first time he'd seen it firsthand, after all.

'Oh yes... oh yes... oh...' Irene moaned as the young bronco thrust his massive cock inside her, her copious wetness quickly coating it.

Mia leaned over to stroke Irene's clit while their boy toy fucked the blonde, and Angelo started making out with Mia.

'Oh yeah... oh yeah... *oh*...'

Greg glanced at Christian, and he smiled, and Christian felt happy for him, that he had the chance to experience this, as he had when watching Mia with Brandon.

Angelo fucked Irene hard, and Greg was enjoying every minute — pumping on his own cock while watching his wife being debauched.

When he finally slid out to give Irene a breather, Mia took his huge cock in her mouth, tasting the blonde's wetness on the younger man's shaft.

But then Mia was turning, going onto all fours, and Angelo was squeezing that big dick inside her keen pussy, to begin fucking her from behind.

What a show.

What a performance.

What a thrill.

The two women taking it in turns having that huge cock inside them, taking it in turns sucking on it. Making out with Angelo, or with each other, along the way.

One of them sucking on him before lining up his dick to slide it into the other.

Angelo lying on his back while Mia fucked him, Irene kneeling over his head, grinding her pussy against his mouth.

They used him until his entire body seemed slick with their juices, and theirs too.

Finally, Angelo came into Mia's mouth, and Irene came to kiss her, to share his cream between them.

When the younger man grabbed his stuff and made his exit, there was no stopping Greg and Christian. There were no secrets between any of them by this stage — the two men reclaimed their women there and then, on the same bed.

On the way home, Christian noticed a message on his phone from the kind folks at Marriage 2.0:

Thank you for sharing your beautiful relationship with Marriage 2.0. We hope you have enjoyed your Experience.

Mia had the same message on her phone.

The last time they saw Miriam Bywater, she was introducing them to Aiden and Sarah Miller, a couple who had just moved into the neighborhood and didn't seem to know too many people yet.

This was at a party thrown by the Ramirez clan down on Orchard.

Brandon turned up, minus his blonde girlfriend, who had apparently flown the coop. The Millers were hanging out with Greg and Christian as the clock was winding on toward midnight, and they could hardly avoid the sight of Mia keeping Brandon company.

And then Irene came over, arm-in-arm with her pediatrician's neighbor, to tell Greg that she was heading home with the guy for some afterparty fun and games.

Greg and Christian explained why they happened to be so supportive of their spouses being so friendly with other men in the neighborhood. It turned out that Aiden had harbored a little secret fantasy concerning his wife doing similar, so that was that.

Christian and Mia were happy for Greg and Irene to take this particular referral credit, as the Millers joined their fun little neighborhood wife-sharing circle.

But after that party, they couldn't help but notice the strange disappearance of Miriam and Darren.

Neither of them was responding to text messages anymore.

Mia happened to drive past the Bywaters' mansion one afternoon, and stopped to see if Miriam or Darren were in. They weren't in, and it seemed they weren't the property owners, either. It had been rented out through Airbnb.

When she reported this back to her husband, Christian scratched his head and called Darren's number.

A voicemail message stated: *This is Darren and Miriam, your local Marriage 2.0 coordinators. Thank you so much for supporting us through your Marriage 2.0 program. We hope you had as much fun during your Experience as we had getting to know you.*

CARRIE AND BEN

EPISODE 1

There was a designated term for what she was — Katie had told her about it only the previous week, and it instantly seemed like a perfect fit for her.

Carrie Weaver was a ‘Game Widow.’

Her husband hadn’t died — far from it. But sometimes, it seemed like he had. He was unreachable most of the time, incommunicado. He didn’t help around the house, spend time with her, didn’t chat about his day, or ask her about hers.

He wouldn’t even sit on the couch with her to watch TV together in the evening.

Carrie got home from work, fixed dinner for them both, and then ate hers alone before crashing in front of Netflix for a few hours until she felt sleepy enough for bed. She might see Ben momentarily as he slipped out of his den to pick up his dinner from the kitchen counter, but then he’d slink back away, and that would be it.

She might hear him through the thin walls of their little townhouse, chatting with other people playing his video game, but there wouldn’t be any conversation for her.

Ben was addicted to video games. He had been since college. When they’d first dated, she’d understood it — she’d even tried to be a part of it. It was more fun back then. He spent more time playing video games with friends in real life. His frat buddies all camped out on the couch playing Call of Duty, or whatever.

These days, he rarely saw his friends in real life. These days, his friends were all online. He didn’t even know any of their real names, for God’s sake, just their handles.

He’d managed to make a living from his video games obsession by playing through the live streaming platform Twitch, and cultivating a

following and associated advertising income. He also took part in competitions. But only meant he disappeared from Real Life even more.

She still loved him. Back in the old days, she'd been able to entice him away from his gaming for the occasional night out. She hadn't needed much.

Back then, his college friends had been into things other than just video games, so he went too. These days, though, he'd gotten too accustomed to blowing them off for sketchy reasons, and they had gotten too used to not bothering to ask him if he wanted to do things with them.

Ironically, when they all got together once or twice a year, it seemed like Ben's friends blamed marriage for the fact that he'd become less socially available in recent years.

So here she was, complaining to Katie about him in a coffee shop after work, and Katie declared her an irredeemable *Game Widow*.

‘God, you make it sound like it’s my fault,’ she’d told Katie, but it was strangely affirming that there was a word for people like her. It made her feel less isolated, less alone.

There were enough women who were like her that there was a word for it.

‘You have to be firm,’ Katie had told her. ‘There’s no other way. Give him a choice: your marriage or the video games.’

God. Everything seemed so simple when it wasn’t your problem, huh.

‘I can’t make him do *that*,’ she’d sighed. ‘It’s his whole career.’

‘He could still take it in a different direction. He needs to do *something*.’

Katie was one of those people who didn’t take things lying down. It meant she’d already been through two divorces at 28 years of age, but she rarely agonized about her relationships in the way normal people seemed to.

But sometimes Carrie got the feeling Katie was keen for her friends to follow suit. When Carrie shared her problems with her, Katie’s advice often seemed to push the idea that she should just walk out on Ben and join Tinder.

‘You don’t have to worry that you’ll never meet another guy again,’ she would point out. ‘You need to do things for yourself. If Ben won’t,

there are countless men on dating sites who will.'

They had other friends who were married, but they were generally starting to pop out kids already. Lisa, Florence, Sara, Maddie. When Carrie talked to them, they seemed to want to push her into having kids.

'You can't understand how amazing, how life-affirming it is to have kids, if you've never had kids.' Whatever.

But every time she was at home and feeling like giving Ben an ultimatum, she just got so horrifically sad.

She loved him.

His goofy smile, his sense of humor. The way he made her feel safe and secure. His general goodness. If you took away his video game addiction — and that was a big ask — he was a nice, kind guy. You knew he would never turn into that guy from *The Shining*.

She still found him attractive, too, when he remembered to shower and put on fresh underwear. Somehow he always ate crap and still seemed to manage to stay in shape. Carrie ate half a packet of chips and had to run five extra miles a week to keep it off.

There was therapy, of course. And that was easier than ever these days, with online services like Better Help. It felt cathartic to talk about her problems. The trouble was, it still came down to what she was going to do about them.

'I should drag him to marriage counseling,' Carrie would tell Dr. Shaw, knowing it would never happen. She wasn't bold enough for that.

She was afraid that marriage counseling would mean the end of her marriage. That it would force Ben to make the choice that Katie had suggested: *the video games or her*.

When she thought about divorce, she just started thinking about all those friends and family members who had come to their wedding. So embarrassing. All those people made to feel they'd completely wasted a day attending Carrie and Ben's nuptials.

When Carrie Googled the term 'Game Widow,' among the search results was a suggestion to use a service called 'Marriage 2.0.'

She didn't fully understand what the program was at first, when she scoured the website for information.

Marriage 2.0 had started in New York before the pandemic, but these days they had an office in San Francisco and 34 other major cities

worldwide.

It seemed like a marriage counseling thing, but that didn't involve counseling or therapy. They arranged 'Experiences' for couples designed to 'dramatically' improve their relationships and foster a strong romantic bond between spouses.

And you could sign up as a couple or as a married individual — since *'married couples don't always agree on what they might need.'*

She liked the thought that she could sign up for the program without dragging Ben out of his troll cave — and she would still be able to get help for her ailing marriage.

Carrie took a day off to attend the San Francisco office, even though she could have had the assessment done all online. She preferred not to do it at home — even if there was only a tiny chance Ben might interrupt her evaluation.

So nervous, turning up at the office for her appointment.

But somehow, as soon as she entered the building, it didn't seem too bad.

For one thing, there were a lot of other people around, apparently signing up for the program, too. Couples, individuals, people of all shapes and sizes. The place was light and airy and modern-looking, like a giant Apple Store.

Walking through the sales floor to the check-in desks, Carrie got the impression that this wasn't only for couples whose marriages were in trouble. There were couples in healthy relationships here, too, to arrange fun adventures as though they simply wanted to go on a very different kind of vacation.

It meant she didn't feel so self-conscious as she went through to check in for an appointment using a touch-screen kiosk.

Then she had to go to a waiting room that seemed just like an airport terminal, complete with flatscreen displays indicating when and where people needed to go for their appointments.

Her assessment was in a little room one floor up. It started out like some kind of medical exam, or perhaps like a sight test at the optician.

They rigged her up to some kind of advanced medical machine or computer — a special helmet going over her head, monitoring bracelets going around her wrists, electrodes stuck onto her skin in various places to detect changes in her heart rate or whatever.

Once she was all connected up, they put some virtual reality glasses on her, and started showing her images and movie clips of various things.

At first, it seemed like they were showing her random things. The technician, Sally, explained that they were measuring her basic levels.

Then, when they were ready to start the assessment proper, she was shown various images and short video clips that seemed primarily focused on relationships and couples and all things romance. They started with fairly tame images — couples walking together in the park, on the beach, in the mountains, and so on. Various couples doing things together, leading their lives together, spending time in various places.

After a while, she noticed that more and more of the clips seemed to involve little stories — very short, very simple, but making it clear that something was happening to the couple involved. It was almost like watching a string of TV commercials, each designed to provoke certain feelings inside her through only a minute or two of dramatic events and associated music.

As the assessment progressed, however, the images and clips also became more and more erotic in nature — and more and more explicit.

It got to the point that she was being shown out-and-out pornography. Each clip showing a little scenario, highlighting some kind of sexual fantasy, kink, or fetish. It was like flicking through random clips on Pornhub — a website she had become intimately familiar with recently.

A couple having sex in a car, risking discovery.

A woman dragging a delivery guy into her house for adulterous sex.

Two college girls stripping off for a threesome with a male friend.

A man watching a couple have sex on the bed in front of him.

At first, Carrie felt a little embarrassed, watching these clips in front of Sally, the technician. But Sally was good at reassuring her, encouraging her to relax and allow herself to respond to the ‘inputs’ naturally. She gave the impression that none of this was unusual. Everyone assessed by Marriage 2.0 was exposed to this kind of imagery.

Before the assessment was over, however, Carrie had found herself pushed over the edge into a full orgasm — despite the fact that nobody was touching any of her erogenous zones.

Sally had momentarily left the room when that happened. It was a bit of a relief, because Carrie felt so ashamed of herself. To actually come while a technician was right there beside her would have been just awful.

Sally was all smiles as they detangled her from the machine, removing all the electrodes and the various pieces of monitoring equipment.

‘You did very well,’ she said.

Carrie had smiled back, trying to stop herself from blushing furiously. ‘That was *insane*.’

‘It’s just the nature of the assessment, I’m afraid. We need to work out what gets you going. What your preferences are. What will satisfy you.’

Carrie laughed. ‘I feel pretty satisfied already.’

Sally had replied, with a knowing twinkle in her eye: ‘You just wait until your Experience begins.’

Two weeks later, she received a text from Marriage 2.0 congratulating her on the start of her “Experience.”

The message after that came in the form of a 22-digit number.

What the hell was that?

She Googled the number, which automatically brought up a tracking page for the US Postal Service. Marriage 2.0 were sending her a package?

She tracked it, waited for it, and then made sure she was home from work to receive it without Ben knowing it was coming.

She still felt guilty about visiting Marriage 2.0 without him. Guilty about the unexpectedly hefty price tag for saving their marriage. If Ben found out, would he be angry? But Ben was safely in his video game dungeon when Carrie brought in her hefty package.

To her surprise, the package turned out to be a brand-new PlayStation 5.

‘*What* the — ?!’

For a few moments, she just stared at it. What a disappointment. Was *this* the solution to their marriage problems? Ben, of course, already had a PlayStation 5. So was this supposed to be for her?

What were they suggesting — that she spend all her spare time playing video games, too, to distract from being a Game Widow?

They could have arranged a romantic tour of Paris or Venice for the price she’d paid for the service. They could have staged a full intervention in Bora Bora to force Ben to recognize and deal with his addiction.

Instead, they’d sent her a video games console.

It seemed so *stupid*.

Later, after Ben had emerged to grab his dinner and haul it back to his cave like a dragon accepting the sacrifice of a virgin from a nearby village, Carrie's anger quelled a little.

She texted a wry message to Katie along the lines of, *I told a marriage counseling service about Ben's video game addiction, and they sent me my own fucking PlayStation5.*

Half an hour later, Katie was on the doorstep, a bottle of Chardonnay in her hand, a full tut-tut on her lips.

'Ben, you're a fucking loser!' Katie yelled down the stairs into Ben's troll cave.

Ben yelled back, 'Hi, Katie!'

Over some helpful and entirely cathartic white wine, Carrie and Katie unwrapped the new PlayStation and checked it out.

'Ooo, there's some of those VR headset things,' Katie pointed out as Carrie plugged the thing into the TV.

'This is the best kind of virtual reality,' Carrie joked, holding up the wine bottle.

When they finally switched it all on, and the software updates were complete, there was one game available for them to play — 'Elven Quest V.' It was some kind of epic fantasy adventure where they could roam around a spectacular landscape and fight monsters for rewards. They could perform tasks to earn game currency and level up their characters to make it easier to fight monsters.

Carrie had already been given a character with which to start the game — a mysterious sorceress named Yesenia.

They had to make up a character for Katie to use — Princess Xanax, a fair maiden with unfair principles.

And, okay, it was pretty fun to play. The scenery was lovely. It felt good killing fire-breathing antelopes and goblin bus conductors to earn money to supe up their characters' outfits or spell books.

More fun to play with wine.

You could meet other players playing through the magic of the Interweb. You could trade with them for things, you could entice them to part with food or other goods through a little girly sweet-talking. *Men were so easy.*

You could flirt with some of the guys whose characters were all ripped abs and square jaws, and who probably looked like Jabba the Hutt in real life.

Carrie and Katie almost forgot the entire reason why they were playing this game in the first place.

Then while they were sourcing fresh wine from the kitchen, Carrie noticed that she'd been sent a text message from Marriage 2.0 telling her to go kill a GorgoGoth and then find her way to the Lamb & Flag Tavern.

Ah, yes, hadn't all this been about saving her marriage?

By that stage, they didn't mind being set a quest. And perhaps, thanks to the alcohol, the fact it had been Marriage 2.0 who had sent them on the quest made it seem mildly exciting.

While Katie was asking one of their growing coterie of in-game admirers for suggestions on where their quest might begin, Carrie was back to pondering why Marriage 2.0 might want her to play this game in the first place.

'So what the *fried fuck* is a GorgoGoth, dork?'

'You're not supposed to call them dorks, Katie.'

'Jesus, when did my best friend become so *woke*?'

'They're nerds. Geeks if they have any class. Not dorks.'

'*Ben's* a big fucking dork.'

Did Marriage 2.0 want her to get into this video game so she had something to talk to Ben about? Something new to boost the bond between them? Did they think Ben would see her playing video games up here in the living room, and that he'd want to join her for the first time in ages?

'It is pretty addictive, you have to agree,' Katie said as they finally tracked down the fabled GorgoGoth, and dispatched it from this mortal world with a slice of poisoned baloney.

'Do you think they want me to play this thing just so I understand his addiction?'

'I don't know — maybe you're supposed to get addicted, too.'

Addictive it was: it hardly felt like they'd spent any time at all on it, and suddenly it was midnight, and Katie had to try to tear herself away from it all, so she could get some sleep before work the following day.

Then in the morning, as Carrie went to work, all she could think about was what they would find in the Lamb & Flag now that they had killed the GorgoGoth. She suspected it would have something to do with

the Jewel of Deniathlon, which they had been awarded upon killing the monster.

As soon as she got home after work, she immediately hooked herself up to the damn PlayStation 5 again, so she could try to find her way to a tavern by the name of the Lamb & Flag.

Dear *Lord*. She was totally becoming Keanu Reeves from the fucking *Matrix*.

It was just so easy to get into. And then you had all the benefits of normal social interaction, except that you didn't have to put on makeup, or pick out the exact right outfit, or venture out of your nice, warm, cozy little fleapit of a home to meet people and enjoy the little dopamine and oxytocin boosts that came from socializing.

You could sit on a sofa in your baggy sweats and stuff your face with greasy pizza while being a goddess of conversation — and flirtation — in the virtual world.

Was this what Ben spent all his time doing down there in his troll cave?

Christ. And even though her character, Yesenia, was hardly an accurate representation of herself, it felt good when one of these nerds started showering her with compliments and failed pickup lines and borderline inappropriate innuendo. And though she knew none of them would look anything like their steroidally enhanced avatars in real life, it was nice to get the attention.

She could stave off the loneliness, even if it all felt a little fake.

She could even flirt a little bit, if any of the guys she met turned out to have even half an ounce of charisma. It was pretty fun. It even made her feel a little warmth in certain places, something she hadn't felt in a long while.

In fact, more and more, when she got home from work and felt a burning need to fire up the PS5, it was from a desire to flirt with guys and make them truly want her.

That wasn't *cheating*, was it? Especially when it was only in a video game.

And sure, she didn't need to tell anybody, least of all Ben, that she'd taken to playing the game upstairs in the privacy of the bedroom. Well,

you didn't even need to connect the PS5 to a TV if you were using the VR headset.

She didn't need to tell anyone, including Katie, that sometimes flirting with guys in the game made her feel like quietly dipping a hand into her panties to take care of that warm tingle she was having down there.

She didn't need to worry that at any particular moment, there were dozens of geeks dotted around this city who would drop *everything* in their lives just to come over here and satisfy her carnal needs.

She only needed to give the word.

EPISODE 2

One morning Carrie got off the shuttle bus to find hundreds of people hanging around the entrance at work, looking weirdly scared or angry or something.

Here was Katie, coming up to her. She didn't look hungover from the night before. She looked kind of intense.

'They're not letting people in,' she said.

'What?'

'They've just laid off a whole load of people... and they didn't tell anybody. Just revoked our security clearance...'

'Oh, Katie!' Carrie was shocked her best friend had lost her job like this.

'What about you?' she asked.

Carrie felt a lurch in her stomach as she realized what Katie meant.

'They wouldn't fire me. I mean, we're so close to updating the algorithm... I just got *promoted*...'

But she felt nausea, the kind of nausea that came from knowing, deep down, that nobody's job in Silicon Valley was safe these days. Even here in Mountain View. Twitter had laid off thousands, Microsoft, Amazon.

And now, Alphabet.

She reached the door to the building, went inside, joined the line to get through the turnstiles. Most of the people in the line did not seem to be getting through.

Then it came to her turn to wave her fob over the reader. There was an ugly bleep, and the security guard gave her a solemn look and slowly shook his head.

Carrie felt sick.

Christ, why had she spent all that money on a freaking marriage therapy program when there was a chance that she might lose her job?

Despite the layoffs, they were able to take the Google shuttle bus back to San Francisco. It had to be the gloomiest bus ride ever — all the passengers reading the email that had just come in from the CEO announcing 12,000 layoffs.

‘What’re we going to do?’

‘We’re going to enjoy our severance package and not get down in the dumps about the next step,’ Katie said. ‘But, we’re going to need wine. *Lots* of wine.’

Carrie had to remind Katie that none of her usual haunts would be open for hours yet; it was still early morning.

They had to trudge back from the Dolores St bus stop to Katie and Ben’s place in Bernal Heights, and crack open another bottle from Carrie’s collection.

‘God, there’s no way I can tell Ben,’ she said as they sorted out the wine situation. ‘Not yet. The pressure he’s under...’

‘He’s going to wonder why you’re spending so much time at home.’

The two of them looked at each other, and then laughed.

‘But I can’t tell him to cut out the video games now,’ Carrie said, serious. ‘It’s the only thing that’ll keep us from losing the house and everything.’

Katie sighed. ‘If you can’t beat ’em, join ’em, eh? Why don’t you get out that new PlayStation of yours?’

Carrie blushed. ‘It’s... *uh*... upstairs.’

‘*Upstairs?*’ Katie pouted. ‘You’ve been playing without me?’

She stormed up the stairs with Carrie left trailing in her wake. In the bedroom, she pulled out the PlayStation from under Carrie’s side of the bed.

‘I was just trying to solve that quest...’

Katie opened the drawer in Carrie’s bedside table to reveal a PlayStation VR headset and a pink bullet vibrator. ‘Ah *huh*,’ she said, like Sherlock Holmes discovering the clue that solved the crime.

‘It’s...’

‘You’ve been blowing me off all week to hit on *Dungeons & Dragons* weirdos?’

Carrie sighed and sat on the bed. ‘But they’re so *sweet*. And horny, like all the time. And they always try to sound like Aragorn from *Lord of*

the Rings...

‘But in real life they probably look more like Gollum from *Lord of the Rings*.’

‘You can have so much fun teasing them. And if you ignore them and go after someone else, they just want you even more.’

‘You need to get on Tinder, my love.’

Carrie held up her hand to show Katie her wedding ring. ‘I am *not* cheating on my husband.’

Katie laughed. ‘Says the wife who spends all her evenings talking dirty online with Frodo and his hairy hobbit buddies.’

‘*That’s* not cheating. It’s practically no worse than watching porn.’

‘Okay, so if I went downstairs and told Ben you were spending your spare time talking to Gandalf wannabes online while they tug their magic wands...’

‘He probably wouldn’t believe you.’

‘When was the last time that got you laid?’

Carrie said, ‘Umm...’

Katie raised her eyebrows. ‘Grounds for divorce. Constructive abandonment of the marriage.’

‘I am not getting divorced. Jesus, especially not now I’ve just lost my job.’

They spent all morning drinking Carrie’s emergency wine supply — New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc — while fighting goblins and letting friendly nerds think they had a hope of getting into their panties.

It was fun.

It got to the point where Katie had managed to persuade a guy to send her a dick pic via the Kik messenger app — cue giggling at how the reality matched up to the guy’s claims online. And Carrie had a guy begging and pleading with her to meet him in real life.

And then, they were wandering through a cute little fishing village looking for sustenance when they stumbled upon a little tavern called the Lamb & Flag.

‘We’re supposed to go in,’ Carrie said.

‘We *are*?’

‘Remember — they sent me a text telling me to go to the Lamb & Flag after we killed the GorgoGoth.’

‘They did? Who did?’

‘Marriage 2.0.’

‘Oh, *that* thing?’

They stepped inside the tavern. It was gloomy inside but with a certain cozy ambiance. Made Carrie think of the pub from Harry Potter, whatever it was called. Jeez — ten years ago, she would have remembered the name of it in a flash. Probably could have told you the price of butter beer, too.

‘What’re we supposed to do in here?’ Katie asked.

‘Don’t know.’

They looked around at the various players gathered to chat and drink virtual ales, and couldn’t even see any usernames they recognized.

‘Why don’t they all just go to a *real* bar, in the *real* world?’ Katie said.

‘I don’t know... I guess in this game, you don’t have to worry about your real appearance. You can just be... whoever.’

‘Well, I appreciate that, but if any of these people ever want real sex, somebody somewhere will have to contend with their real appearance.’

‘Maybe they don’t want real sex.’

‘Everyone wants real sex.’

They weaved their way through the crowd, around the bar to a smoky back room, where a tall, musclebound man, who looked like superman had taken a load of steroids and then got addicted to crack, appeared to be telling stories to a large group of admirers.

‘Who’s the emo clown with the following?’

Carrie took a few steps forward, close enough that she could point at the storyteller, and a few details about him popped up in her in-vision info panel.

She gasped.

‘What is it?’

‘I think... that’s *Ben*.’

They purchased flagons of ale, sat on the fringes of the collective, and listened to him regale his followers with a tale about how he’d single-handedly tracked and killed the ferocious Mawlbeast of Gledonsfield.

His audience seemed absolutely rapt by what they were hearing from him.

Katie wasn't paying attention to a word of what he was saying. 'How can you tell it's him?' She was saying. 'Looks nothing like him.'

'That's how it is in this game. I look nothing like my character in real life.'

'You look way more like Yesenia than Ben looks like *that* dude.'

'His username...'

'SkyGuard84.'

'...it's the username he's always used. Or at least, it's the one he always used back when we used to play video games together.'

'Why would he use the same username...?'

'Why wouldn't he?'

'So he can... you know... hit on girls...'

Carrie looked at Katie, and then over at Ben, who appeared to be sharing tips with his followers regarding how to kill fearsome monsters without losing a load of life points. He seemed totally into it. And he seemed to enjoy sharing his experience with others.

There was a sort of wholesomeness to him that made Carrie feel a little dirty, a little ashamed of what she had achieved in the short time she'd been playing this game. She'd done little more than seek some pathetic kind of sexual release.

'Maybe he doesn't hit on girls here,' Carrie said.

Katie looked confused. 'What else is there to do here?'

Carrie rolled her eyes. Then she said, 'So what do you think I'm supposed to do now that we've found him?'

'I don't know. Did they tell you anything else?'

'No. I mean, do you think it's just coincidence that he's in this place now that we've come?'

'Can't be a coincidence.'

'So what... I'm supposed to spend time with him in the game? Is that the only way I can — '

'Maybe you're just supposed to tell him he's a damn loser.'

Ben — or SkyGuard84, assuming it was him — seemed to have come to the end of his story, and was now chatting with various small groups of admirers. Carrie was quietly marveling at how he was working the room — they all seemed to adore him, and he was making sure he spent time with everybody.

'They all *love* him,' she said.

Katie was on her feet. 'Well, I'm going to go over there, tell him he's got a wife at home — '

'*Don't!*' Carrie hissed. 'He'll think I'm spying on him.'

‘I won’t tell him who we are.’

‘Katie. He’ll recognize your voice a mile off.’

Katie grinned. ‘*Fiddle-dee-dee*, Carrie. I’ll just put on my best *Myrrh-kin* accent,’ she said, affecting her usual, terrible Scarlett O’Hara. ‘*Oh, if I wasn’t a lady, just what wouldn’t I tell that varmint?*’

Carrie cringed and cowered as she watched Katie sashay through the throng of SkyGuard fangirls and fanboys toward the hero of the hour.

For a moment, she hoped he wouldn’t notice her among all the hundreds of people crammed into this smoky pub backroom. But her gut told her he could hardly overlook a tall, big-breasted Amazon in an outfit so slutty it probably wouldn’t make it onto a Playboy cover.

Carrie sighed and pressed the exit button on her hand controller.

Maybe this whole PlayStation thing had been a bad idea.

She went into the kitchen to fetch more wine, waiting for the inevitable moment Ben came stomping in to accuse her of spying on her.

It was already past noon — time in the real world really did fly while you were playing Elven Quest. Carrie felt a sudden, strong hunger pang. She hadn’t felt at all hungry in the game. Seemed kind of dangerous, that.

After a while, there seemed to be no sign of Ben.

Carrie was thinking about taking a shower, seeing if Katie wanted to go out for lunch somewhere, perhaps to start perusing job ads over a bowl of oversalted fries.

Then Katie came in, seeking wine herself.

‘What did you say to him?’

‘I asked him if he fancied a threesome.’

‘You did *what?*’

Katie rolled her eyes. ‘I was just testing him.’

‘Oh.’

‘And, for the record, he said he was married.’

‘He *did?*’

Carrie was surprised, and then felt immediately guilty for feeling surprised. For assuming her husband would jump at the chance to cheat on her.

‘You know it’s afternoon already?’

'It is?' Katie looked surprised for a moment. But then she nodded and said, 'That makes sense.'

'Why?'

'I asked Ben if he's married, how come he spends all his time playing this game. He said he's only been here a few months.'

'A few months?'

'I guess when you play this game a lot, you tend to lose track of time. It's the fucking Matrix all over again. Anyway... better get back to it.'

Carrie was a little taken aback. 'Katie... don't you want to go to lunch or something? Or to a wine bar?'

Katie shrugged. 'SkyGuard's invited me on a quest with him. I gave him that Jewel of Deniathlon thing we got from the GorgoGoth. He was very impressed we'd killed it.'

Then her best friend disappeared back into the bedroom to play with her husband.

Carrie felt a little bewildered.

She went round to Bernal Star for a pulled pork sandwich, and started scanning LinkedIn Jobs for possible openings. There weren't any openings, possible or impossible.

She was stuck in a town where 50,000 people in her industry had been laid off at once and would now all be searching for the same scarce job vacancies.

Jesus. And she'd lost her husband — and now apparently her best friend, too — to the same fucking video game.

'Is anyone sitting here?'

Carrie looked up to find a rather attractive man standing by her table.

'Uh... no.'

'Mind if I join you?'

She glanced around. The whole restaurant was packed — but who just walks up to somebody sitting at a table in a restaurant and asks to sit with a stranger?

'Uh... *sure*...'

She gave him a neutral but accommodating smile. Well, he was probably hungry, and there was probably a 20-minute wait on the next free table. And the food here was great.

'Looking for a job?'

She did one of those are-you-talking-to-me double-takes, and he did, indeed, seem to be talking to her.

‘Uh... yeah,’ she said with a little self-deprecating chuckle. ‘You know... worked at Google until this morning.’

He nodded and smiled. God, he made her feel funny when he smiled. ‘Me too,’ he said, and it felt oddly reassuring. ‘Uh... Twitter, though, not Google.’

‘Thrown out by Mr. Musk?’

He laughed. ‘I went to the bathroom for five minutes, and when I was done, I couldn’t get back in the office.’

The waitress came along and took the guy’s order — a bacon sandwich — and then he introduced himself as Jon.

He said, ‘You remember when we were kids, and these new tech companies came along and made you think they were going to do everything differently? They were going to be nice.’

Carrie laughed. ‘*Don’t Be Evil*, right? Of course, my company got sued for breaking that motto, so they just hired a bunch of lawyers to redefine the entire concept of ‘evil.’

Oh, God.

Jon *was* nice.

They spent four hours together enjoying a long, slow lunch. Browsing job ads together. Gradually finding out more about each other until it started feeling almost like a date.

Except it wasn’t a *date*, because she’d told him she was married.

Jon was a widower whose wife had passed away two years before from breast cancer. He had made peace with it, as much as anyone could with something like that. It made Carrie want to cheer him up.

He was the perfect gentleman — paying attention to her, never overwhelming the conversation with stuff about him.

And his warmth, his smile, his serene blue eyes gave her a *very* pleasant ache between her thighs.

‘Hey, this was fun,’ he said when at last it was time to part — because if they didn’t part after that, it would start to seem suspicious.

‘Yes, it was,’ she said, smiling back at him, desperately hoping she didn’t seem like some pathetic little fangirl to him.

He offered her a card and said, ‘we should stay in touch. You can never have too many friends when you’re out of work.’

‘Right, yes. Of course.’

She gave him one of her cards in return, but only on her way back home did she realize what she’d given him was basically useless. It only

had her Google contact details on it.

Probably dangerous if she did stay in touch with him anyway, right? She'd only had lunch with the guy, and her panties were soaking.

She was expecting that Katie would be long gone by the time she got home.

Then again, all afternoon she'd been expecting a text message from her best friend revealing that Ben had seen through her online disguise, and the two of them had gotten into one of their blazing arguments.

She'd received no text messages, though, other than from her mom, asking if she'd heard about all these layoffs at Google, and whether she was affected.

Surprisingly, when she got home, Katie was still up in the bedroom with the VR headset strapped to her face, lashing out at invisible enemies as though she had completely lost her balance.

'Katie!' She called out.

Katie hit the exit button on her hand controller and removed her headset.

'Oh man, that is crazy fun. Hey — I'm hungry. Is it time for lunch?'

Carrie rolled her eyes. 'It's 5pm. I asked you if you wanted lunch hours ago, and you said you wanted to do a quest with my husband.'

'Oh, right. Wow. Can't believe it's that late. How about some dinner?'

They dialed out for pizza because Katie was ravenous at that point.

Carrie told her about her lunch with Jon, and Katie grilled her enough to know that she had fancied the pants off the guy, even if she felt guilty about it.

'You going to call him?' she asked.

'Katie. I'm married.'

Katie's eyes flashed. 'You know... that might not be such a problem anymore...?'

Carrie's brow wrinkled. '*What?*'

They ate pizza, and Carrie demanded that Katie tell her every single thing she'd done with, or said to, her husband during her entire afternoon playing Elven Quest with him. And when she did, Carrie could not believe what she was hearing.

Firstly, Ben seemed to have bought Katie's secret identity.

Secondly, the two of them hadn't started tearing chunks out of each other, or declared war on each others' growing army of fanboy or fangirl followers.

And thirdly, when Katie said, 'I'm pretty sure Ben *wants* you to cheat on him.'

'Uh... what?'

'You ever hear of something called a 'hotwife'?'

EPISODE 3

‘Ben, I’ve met someone.’

‘What?’

‘He’s... just someone else who got laid off by the tech industry, like me.’

‘Oh.’

‘We got friendly and... I... I guess I just enjoy spending time with him.’

‘Really?’

‘Well, I mean, you spend all your time playing video games... and sometimes I feel *lonely*...’

Katie nodded, smiled, and gave Carrie the thumbs up. ‘I like it,’ she said. ‘*Lonely*. Way to tug on the heartstrings.’

Carrie sighed and said, ‘I don’t want to make him feel *bad*...’

Katie’s eyebrows fell. ‘Why not? He’s been neglecting you for three years. When your husband is a workaholic and fails to spend time with his wife, it’s not because he’s being selfless, honeybun.’

‘But he... he just got *addicted*. He wasn’t even aware of how long he was spending away from me.’

Katie said, ‘And now that he is aware, he’s still under the impression that his work is more important than your sex life.’

‘It kind of is right now. Now he’s the sole earner in this marriage.’

‘Don’t think like that,’ Katie insisted. ‘A wife can have a husband who puts food on the table *and* keeps her satisfied in the bedroom. It’s not an either/or.’

They were having lunch again, this time at the sushi place on Precita. Katie had been coaching Carrie on how to tell her husband that she was planning on having coffee with a dreamboat of a guy she'd met the same day she'd been laid off as part of a wave of job losses at Google.

The thing was, in the days since she'd also been laid off by Google, Katie had also been coaching Ben on the signs that his wife might be thinking of having an affair.

Katie had effectively gone undercover in the video game Ben was obsessed with, befriending him as a character named Princess Xanax. Surprisingly, Ben hadn't responded to any of her flirting — or that of his legions of female admirers in the game, it seemed. But Katie had befriended him after presenting him with some trinket obtained by slaying a virtual monster. And that had given her the opportunity to grill him about his marriage under the pretext of new friends finding out about each other.

Katie had pointed out to Ben that if he was married and spent almost all of his time playing this video game, his wife was liable to be sexually frustrated. And that might make her look elsewhere for satisfaction.

The big surprise was that Ben didn't seem jealous when Katie warned him that his wife might be motivated to have an affair.

'But he didn't say he *wanted* me to have an affair,' Carrie had pointed out.

'Not straight out,' Katie agreed. 'But when I asked him how he'd feel if he found out you were sneaking off to get your sex elsewhere, he didn't seem angry. Or even upset. He asked me if I really thought you'd do it.'

'But wait,' Carrie said. 'As far as he knows, you never met me. He doesn't know who you really are.'

'No.'

'So what does he care if you think I'd cheat on him?'

Katie shrugged. 'Because he thinks I'm an expert on women. You know... since I am one.'

'God. Men are such idiots.'

On the way home, she kept checking her text messages in case one was from Jon.

There hadn't been any since he'd sent her a message asking if she'd like to go for coffee the following day, and she'd replied far too quickly that she'd be delighted. She wasn't expecting more messages from him, particularly. She just liked reminding herself that he had asked her for coffee. The attention felt surprisingly good — even if he had completely platonic intentions.

Katie didn't believe platonic intentions existed. When Carrie had shown her Jon's message, she'd said instantly that the guy wanted her.

Was it wrong that, deep down, Carrie hoped that he really did?

She couldn't stop thinking about him. She'd only seen him in the flesh once. Sometimes, she thought her imagination may have overspun his attractiveness because she was desperate. But she couldn't have just dreamt him up, surely?

The way he looked at her with those calm, blue eyes. The warmth in his smile. The unseen power in his tall, athletic frame just screamed how amazing he must be between the sheets.

Well, here she was at home again. She was supposed to tell Ben about her coffee date with Jon.

She was shaking with nerves.

Katie had been spending a disturbing amount of time with Ben recently, for someone who usually couldn't stand him. And Katie was sure that the best thing would be for Carrie to tell her husband that she was planning on seeing another man for coffee.

Inside the front door of their small, rickety townhouse, it was clear to Katie that Ben was safely entombed in his video game in the basement.

'I'm home!' she called.

No response, of course.

She'd only spoken to Ben once since losing her job, to tell him that Google had fired her and 12,000 others. He'd been understanding and sensitive about what she was going through. He'd told her not to worry, reassuring her they'd be okay. They'd get by. But he hadn't exactly upped the amount of time he was spending with her out of any kind of sympathy.

Maybe she'd never even get the opportunity to tell him she was going out for coffee with another man. Ben would just remain in his virtual world, oblivious.

Her phone rang.

Katie.

'Hey.'

'Hey. Did you tell him?'

‘No, he’s still immersed in Elven Quest. Not coming out.’

Katie said, ‘Go upstairs.’

Carrie was a little confused at first. The new PlayStation wasn’t up there anymore. She’d lent it to Katie so that Katie could spy on her husband.

But as she climbed to the next floor, Katie said, ‘Check the traps.’ It reminded Carrie of what they’d done.

Carrie said, ‘First one...’ and went to examine the top drawer of her dresser for hairs they’d put in place to check whether someone had looked inside.

‘Is it there?’

‘No. I can’t see it.’

‘So he’s checked out your underwear drawer...’

‘Maybe it fell off?’

‘Did you leave the window open?’

‘No. It’s shut.’

‘Then there’s no draft to blow it away. Babe, that hair was in place. Now it’s not. So we know he’s been checking on your lingerie. Check your bedside table.’

Carrie sighed but did as she was told. ‘I’m not sure I like this whole spying thing.’

‘He’s been spying on you. Is the hair in place on your bedside table drawer?’

‘No.’

‘Then he’s had a good look at where your vibrator’s at. So he knows you’re sexually frustrated, and you’ve bought some sexy new underwear, so...’

‘He might not believe that means I’m thinking about cheating on him.’

‘Sure he will... because I’ve been telling him that’s the kind of thing he’d find if you were thinking about cheating on him.’

As far as Katie was concerned, her plan of working both sides of the divide was succeeding. She had Ben searching for signs that Carrie was considering an affair, and she had Carrie purposefully giving him the signs that she was considering an affair.

It wasn’t just the new lingerie collection or the big new vibrator shaped like a realistic cock. Under Katie’s guidance, Carrie had started wearing short skirts instead of jeans and clingy tops instead of baggy t-shirts — and much of the time she sported makeup.

‘So what if he suddenly accuses me of cheating on him — or even of thinking about cheating on him — what am I supposed to say then?’ she asked her friend.

‘You tell him *too right you are*, because you’re not getting enough sex at home.’

‘Katie, there’s a reason you’ve already been divorced twice.’

‘Ben’s different. I tell you. I’ve talked to him enough to know the signs.’

Jeez. She had to knock around her home in a short skirt and tight top, with makeup and perfume on, until Ben eventually came up for his supper. She would have much preferred putting on sweatpants, cleaning off the makeup, collapsing on the sofa with a big bag of popcorn.

It was faintly ridiculous dressing up like this if she was merely cooking dinner in their little kitchen.

Katie was *insane*.

She got the feeling either Ben was just going to ignore Katie and this stuff about Carrie having an affair, or else it would go too far, and he would decide to end their marriage. She didn’t exactly have a good track record regarding long-term relationships.

‘You look nice.’

Carrie gasped.

She turned to find Ben standing there, looking pleased to see her.

‘Uh... thanks,’ she said. ‘I... uh... I’m going out with Katie tonight, so...’

Ben nodded.

Carrie blushed — that had been a complete lie. Not that she couldn’t, probably, just call Katie and arrange to go out with her this evening. But they didn’t actually have any plans at the moment.

He took a step toward her and smiled, ‘That’s good. You need something to take your mind off everything.’

Now he stood right behind her and put his arms around her while she was stirring the pasta. God, he smelled good — had he had a shower today? Miracles were possible.

‘Thank you for cooking,’ he said, kissing her just beneath the ear.

She nearly melted.

Oh, *God*. She was crazy for even thinking about another man, let alone the possibility of becoming a hotwife, or whatever it was Katie had called it. She had a husband, a husband she loved. A husband who made her feel amazing when he touched her.

Sure, he was just busy with work these days.

‘How’s... uh... work going at the moment?’

Why did she ask him that? She was supposed to tell him about meeting Jon for coffee. Why couldn’t she do what she was supposed to do?

Ben said, ‘Good... I’m sorry it’s taking so long to get this Level 8. I don’t think it should be that much longer...’

‘Oh, that’s okay. I know how important it is to you.’

‘To *us*,’ he said and kissed her neck, making her feel weak in the knees. ‘It’s important for both of us — you know how much my earnings will go up if I hit it.’

‘Of course...’

He gave her a little squeeze that seemed to promise her sex, if only she’d wait until he was done reaching Level 8 in Elven Quest.

Jesus, why was she now imagining being in a three-way between Ben and Jon? She was, as Katie might say, a complete trollop.

But then supper was ready, and she dished it out, and Ben thanked her, said he hoped she had a good time with Katie tonight, and then disappeared back into his den to eat his meal.

Hmph.

Now she was back to thinking she really should pursue Jon.

After she’d eaten, she decided to give Katie a little taste of her own medicine — by turning up on her best friend’s doorstep unannounced, bearing wine.

‘You’re here!’ Katie said, apparently not put out by her unannounced arrival.

‘I accidentally told Ben I was going out with you tonight,’ Carrie said. ‘He said I looked nice, and I felt like I needed a reason...’

Katie gave her a chiding shake of the head. ‘There’s not supposed to be a reason,’ she said. ‘This is the new you. Sexy, well put together. All the time.’

‘Oh.’

‘Because Ben’s got to think your confidence is super high right now, and you want to look good all the time — because you’re just about to start an affair.’

Carrie felt like she’d disappointed her friend. But, it was time to bury bad news, so she committed further: ‘I’m sorry, I couldn’t tell him about having coffee with Jon, either. I just couldn’t... make it come out.’

Katie handed her a glass of vino, and they adjourned to the sitting room — two paces away in this open-plan condo.

‘Wait — ’ Katie said, seeming pleasingly undefeated. ‘You told him you were going out with me tonight, right?’

‘Yes, I — ’

Katie pulled out her phone and held up a forefinger to call for silence. Then she dialed a number and clamped the phone to her ear.

After a few moments, she said, *‘Is Carrie there? Yes, it’s Katie — I was just wondering...’*

She smiled at Carrie’s state of confusion.

Then she said into the phone, *‘No... we weren’t planning on going out tonight. She told you that?’*

Carrie was bordering on *perplexed* now.

Katie said, *‘Uh... oh. But maybe we are doing something. Okay, my bad. Maybe I’ve got that wrong. She’s probably on her way now. Uh... Bye, Ben!’*

With that, she put the phone down.

Carrie said, ‘What the — ?’

Katie grinned. ‘You told him we were going out tonight. That’s why you’ve dolled yourself up. *I* just made it seem suspicious, right?’

‘Suspicious? Why would I want to seem suspicious...?’

‘So he thinks you’re starting an affair.’

Carrie nodded. ‘So he’s going to think I lied about going out with you because I’m really going out with another guy...?’

Katie laughed. ‘Whatever works!’

Carrie sighed and shrugged and took a big gulp of her wine. ‘If you really think so...’ she said. ‘So — are we going out tonight? I feel like I need to stay away from home for a while, now Ben’s under the impression I’m either doing something suspicious or going out with you.’

Katie said, ‘Well, I wasn’t exactly expecting you to come over tonight...’

The way she said it was a little unlike the Katie Carrie knew. When had Katie ever turned down the chance to go for a night out?

‘Have you met someone?’ Carrie said.

‘No, no, nothing like that...’ Katie said. ‘It’s just... I kind of have plans to do another quest with Ben. Uh... *SkyGuard*.’

‘*What?*’

‘You know... as Princess Xanax,’ she said. ‘He still has absolutely no clue it’s really me.’

Carrie slumped back on the couch, almost spilling her wine. ‘Well, can you postpone...?’

Katie said, ‘No, *wait*. I have a better idea. You can watch me.’

‘Watch?’

‘Uh-huh. If we connect the PS5 to the TV, you’ll see what I do while I’m using the VR headset.’

‘Okay... or I could just play as well.’

Katie said, ‘You want to know what Ben thinks about... you know... this whole affair thing, right?’

‘Yeah...’

‘So he’s not going to open up about it if there’s someone else on the quest with us, is he? He’s using Princess Xanax as some kind of therapist, but if somebody he doesn’t know comes along too...’

‘Right.’

‘Come on. Don’t you want to unlock your husband’s deepest secrets? Figure out how to make him completely crazy about you?’

‘I suppose...’

Carrie felt a strange tickle of arousal deep down, somewhere between her thighs. It was exciting that she could figure out how to draw Ben out of this world and maybe rekindle something hot with him. And judging by how he’d shown her affection earlier in the kitchen... perhaps something was working with all this.

But Carrie was still troubled by the idea of spying on her husband.

‘It’s not exactly *ethical*, though, is it? I mean...’

‘It’s a somewhat gray area,’ Katie said. ‘I mean, sure, spying on your husband is probably not something Mother Teresa would recommend...’

‘She’s dead.’

‘Christ. Greta Thunberg, then.’

‘What would Greta Thunberg know about spying on husbands?’

‘Anyway. Point is, you’re doing this to save your marriage. Sometimes you have to shoot the hostage...’

‘I am not shooting anybody.’

‘We’re not spying on him to bring him down. We’re spying on him so you can understand him. So you know what he really wants, and how

you can improve things between you.'

'I guess so...'

'And why would Marriage 2.0 send you a damn PlayStation if they didn't want you to do something like this?'

'Oh. Right.'

'Come on. It's fine. It's part of the program.'

There was something reassuring knowing that she was supposed to be doing something like this. It was science, right? Her whole life had been assessed by the Marriage 2.0 artificial intelligence systems, and this was the solution they'd come up with.

Katie fired up the PS5 and fitted the VR controllers and headset while Carrie made herself comfortable on the couch with her glass of French plonk.

Then, there was the familiar sight of Cyanor, the world of Elven Quest, in all its 4K ultra-high-definition splendor on Katie's television screen.

'Okay, when I'm with him, you'll have to make sure you're quiet,' Katie said. 'Otherwise, he might hear you in the background through my headset.'

'Sure.'

'So — ready?'

Carrie trembled with nerves. '*Ready.*'

EPISODE 4

‘So how’s it going with that wife of yours. Carrie, right?’

‘Carrie, yes. Well, I guess you were right about her...’

‘What happened?’

‘I had a look around our bedroom, just like you said. She’s got a load of brand-new sexy underwear in her dresser. She hasn’t worn anything like that for me before.’

‘Maybe she just hopes you’ll see her wearing that some night when you come to bed, and it makes you wanna wake her up...’

‘Carrie hates it when I wake her up in the middle of the night.’

‘Some women just like wearing sexy things under their normal clothes... makes them feel sexy.’

‘I looked in her bedside table drawer, and there was the biggest sex toy ever in there.’

‘Vibrator?’

‘I don’t know. Just a big cock. A really fucking big, realistic-looking cock.’

‘She’s getting desperate.’

‘I thought she’d wait for me. I mean... she knows how much work I’m putting into this.’

‘Yeah, but you made it seem like it would take you a few months. It’s been years. I told you. She’s thinking about outsourcing the job now.’

‘I saw her in the kitchen at dinner time. She looked so good — she was wearing this dress... she had the makeup on, some nice new perfume...’

‘Did you ask her what she was doing tonight?’

‘She said she was going out with her friend Katie. But a little later, I called Katie, and she didn’t know anything about it.’

‘Hmmm. Suspicious. But also, you probably shouldn’t have called Katie to check up on Carrie. They’ll think you’re spying on her.’

‘But shouldn’t I be worried? I don’t know where my wife is right now. She could be in trouble.’

‘I’m sure she’s okay. She can handle herself, can’t she?’

‘I guess so. Do you really think she’s... meeting someone tonight?’

‘I don’t know. She could be. I mean, it’s not beyond the realms of believing. Did you check the bathroom cabinet?’

‘No. I forgot.’

‘Maybe you should.’

‘Okay. Wait.’

On the TV screen, Carrie saw her husband’s avatar, SkyGuard, disappear from the mountainous scene in which he had been accompanying her friend Katie’s avatar, Princess Xanax.

Now, beside her, Katie took off her VR headset, and her character on the screen faded from view as the game view paused.

‘What is he looking for in the bathroom?’ Carrie asked her friend.

Katie smiled. ‘I put a box of condoms in there.’

‘You’re *kidding*. Ben and I haven’t used condoms in ages. I’m on the pill.’

‘Exactly. So why would you buy condoms — unless you’re planning on sleeping with someone new?’

Carrie caught her breath. ‘This is going too far, Katie. He’s going to leave me.’

‘No, he won’t. Wait and see what he does. Oh — and FYI, the box of condoms is open, and one of them is missing.’

Carrie nearly exploded. ‘*What!?*’

Katie shrugged. ‘It’s okay. I put it in your purse. If he accuses you of anything, you can say nothing happened — and you wouldn’t be lying.’

‘He’s really going to think I’m planning on cheating on him.’

‘And maybe it’ll shake him up a bit, and he’ll pay more attention to his marriage,’ Katie said sternly.

Then she added, with a mischievous smirk, ‘Or maybe he’ll be pleased you’re seeing someone else, and it’ll make him all hot for you!’

Carrie couldn’t believe what she’d let Katie get her into. Or maybe it was the fault of Marriage 2.0 for buying her a PlayStation in the first

place.

‘He’s back,’ Katie suddenly said, responding to the reappearance of SkyGuard’s username on the list in the corner of the TV screen. She hurriedly put the VR headset back on, touching a finger to her lips to remind Carrie to be quiet while Ben was in a position to hear.

On-screen, SkyGuard and Princess Xanax reappeared.

‘Well?’

‘There was... a box... of condoms...’ Ben sounded out of breath.

Carrie felt her insides being squeezed by anxiety. Was he upset with her? Was he furious at believing she had cheated, or was about to cheat, on him?

‘I *knew* it,’ Katie said.

‘Wait... the box was open. There’s only two left in the box.’

‘So she’s planning on something, huh...?’

Carrie was just horrified, and now she felt anger welling up inside her that her best friend was stirring this, that after all this, Katie was trying to engineer a break-up of her relationship. She should have known. Katie had always hated Ben. Katie had always wanted Carrie to be safely divorced, like her, so they could go out on the town again as single women.

Ben said, ‘You really think she is?’

Then Katie said, ‘Why would she have a box of condoms in the bathroom — and why would she have taken one of them out of the box?’

‘You think she’s used it already?’

‘I don’t know. It’s possible.’

Carrie threw a cushion at her friend, who flinched from the surprise impact. Without removing her headset, Katie wagged a finger at her friend, urging her to wait, to have patience, to see what would happen.

She said to Ben, ‘How do you feel about it?’

Ben sighed. ‘I don’t know. Confused?’

‘Why confused?’

‘Because... part of me kind of wants her to... you know... do it.’

‘To cheat on you?’

‘Sounds crazy, right?’

‘I don’t know. Lots of guys out there fantasize about their wives sleeping with other people...’

‘I mean... I don’t like the thought that she’d lie to me about it... or keep things secret, necessarily. But I like the thought of her having some fun, right? Particularly now, after she lost her job and everything.’

‘That’s very nice of you.’

‘It’s not just being nice... I don’t know... the thought of her doing something like that... you know, so totally against anything you’d ever expect... for some reason, it really gets me going.’

‘Gets you going?’

‘You know... I mean, when I saw her all dressed up like that in the kitchen... and she said she was just going out with Katie... Well. She often goes out with Katie and never really dresses up.’

‘Maybe Katie’s just taking her somewhere nice for once.’

‘Katie just wants to go to the same old places and drink wine.’

‘Maybe Katie’s... been misunderstood...’

Carrie jabbed an elbow into her friend’s side. Katie flinched and cried out.

‘Everything okay?’ Ben said through the game.

Katie said, ‘Uh... sure. I thought I heard the doorbell, but I guess it was just the dishwasher finishing its cycle...’

‘Anyway. I saw her dressed up like that, and it just made me go crazy. I mean, I wanted her so badly...’

‘So why didn’t you take her to the damn bedroom and have your way with her?’

‘I don’t know... I guess I thought she’d be suspicious that I was suddenly all horny...’

‘God, men are idiots,’ Katie said.

‘I probably should have done something, huh,’ Ben agreed, sheepishly. But then, suddenly, ‘Hey — look, there’s the cave. I think we’re here.’

For a long while, Carrie had to wait and watch Katie actually complete the quest with Ben, since it was supposed to be the point of their meeting up in the game.

But then, once they had slain the demon, and it was time for Katie to depart and return to the real world, Ben asked her what he was supposed to do.

‘What do you mean, what are you supposed to do?’

‘About Carrie.’

‘Oh.’ Katie pondered for a moment, then said, ‘You need to talk to her. Tell her how you feel. You don’t want her to be lonely. You want her to have fun when you can’t be around.’

‘Yes.’

‘And it turns you on to think of her sleeping with someone else.’

Watching this on the TV, Carrie felt her heart pounding in her chest. She could hear it pounding. Was her husband really going to confess to wanting her to sleep with other people?

Then Ben said, ‘Yes. For some reason, it really does. I can’t stop thinking about it.’

Katie said, ‘Just tell her she should try to meet someone. Maybe it would be good for both of you.’

‘Okay. I’ll try.’

Carrie felt her head spinning — the whole world spinning — as Katie pulled off her headset and closed down the PlayStation.

‘What. The. Fuck.’ She said.

Katie giggled. ‘I told you. A lot of men out there fantasize about their wives sleeping with other guys. It’s, like, one of the top fantasies among married men, apparently.’

‘According to who?’

‘Cosmo. And Vogue. And fucking Xvideos — the biggest porn website in the world. Look, they have a whole category dedicated to it...’

Katie retrieved her laptop, and they looked at Xvideos, which did, indeed, have a ‘Cuckold/Hotwife’ section right up front and central.

‘What does ‘cuckold’ mean?’

‘It’s a guy who gets off on his wife sleeping with other men.’

It was weird. Carrie had always said everything and anything to Katie, no holds barred. But they’d never looked at porn together.

There were scenes like *cuckold secretly records wife being fucked by black guy*, and *tiny hotwife meets new bull for the first time*, and *big dick fucks your wife*.

Hotwife fucked to moaning orgasm.

Cuck films hotwife being banged hard.

Making my husband a cuckold while I fuck another guy.

There were thousands of these clips.

Katie clicked on a scene, and they watched a pretty blonde kneeling on a hotel bed, kissing a handsome man, while another guy sat on a chair in the corner, watching. The other guy appeared to be her husband.

‘Jesus, that’s a big cock,’ Katie said as they watched the blonde pull out the handsome man’s dick and begin sucking on it.

Carrie said, ‘I don’t get it... why does he want to watch his wife being fucked...?’

Katie said, ‘Because guys like watching women getting fucked. And if they happen to find their wife attractive... why wouldn’t they like watching their wives getting fucked?’

‘They don’t get jealous?’

‘But what does it mean, being jealous? It means you’re afraid you’ll lose your wife to the other guy... but what if you know you would never lose her to the other guy?’

Carrie glanced at Katie. ‘You seem to know a lot about all this stuff.’

Katie laughed. ‘Do you know how hot it would be to have a husband who would allow you to sleep with anyone else — and it would only make him want you more?’

‘But...’

‘You don’t watch enough porn, honey,’ Katie said. ‘If you did, you’d know all about this stuff.’

‘I *guess*...’

Katie was on her feet, urging Carrie up. ‘Now,’ she said. ‘You’re going to go home, and when Ben asks how your night was, you’re going to act a little drunk and tell him that the two of us went out dancing, and maybe a few guys got a little too friendly...’

‘Seriously?’

Katie nodded. ‘And when he starts getting all hot and heavy with you, you’re going to tell him that if he’s going to spend all his time playing video games, maybe you’ll need other guys to keep you satisfied.’

Carrie gave a little gasp at that.

Katie insisted, ‘Promise me you will.’

‘Uh... uh...’

‘And when he says he likes the idea of you having fun with other guys, you’re going to casually mention that you’re having coffee with a nice guy called Jon tomorrow...’

‘Seriously, Katie... He’ll *never* go for it...’

It was late, much later than she thought it was — that video game really made time fly, huh — and she did feel a little drunker than she thought she'd gotten.

But then she was opening the front door, getting in out of the cool January night, and there was Ben, sitting there on the couch watching TV.

Waiting for her.

What was he doing out of his troll cave?

'Hey,' she said.

'Hey — how was your night?'

'Good,' she said, kicking off her shoes, tottering a little as she took a couple of steps toward him. Well, Katie had wanted her to pretend to be a little drunk. That wasn't going to be a problem. 'Katie and I went dancing. What're you doing out here?'

'Waiting for you.'

He stood up. Carrie felt a flicker of surprise and delight in her chest.

He kissed her. And not politely.

'What's all this?' she said, a touch breathless.

'How d'you mean?'

His hands sprawled all over her breasts. God, it felt good.

She said, 'I go out dancing one night, and suddenly when I come home, you're all over me.'

'Maybe I like the thought of you dancing.'

'Then why don't you take me some time?'

'Maybe I will.'

Now he was peeling off her dress. Carrie lifted her arms to assist, her heart pounding, her body fizzing all over, her pussy throbbing with need.

'You finish playing your video game?' she asked.

'No,' he said, kissing her neck, breathing her in, apparently entranced by her.

'Shouldn't you be down there playing?'

'I should be sleeping.'

'But you're not.'

He kissed her mouth again. There was some tongue in there. God, how you forget how hot it can be with a bit of tongue.

'I was talking to someone about you today,' he said, dipping his head down to kiss her between her breasts, just above her black lacy bra.

Thank God she put on sexy underwear.

'Someone in your video game?'

'Uh-huh. She said I've been neglecting you.'

‘She? Should I be jealous?’

‘Nope. But I should, or that’s what she said.’

Now he was down on one knee, kissing her bare stomach. Oh, it felt good. Just the fact that he was paying attention to her. His mouth on her bare skin.

‘She said you should be jealous of what?’

‘Of you. Because I don’t spend enough time with you. She said you might get tempted by other guys.’

He was down on both knees now, kissing her just above the waistband of her panties. His hands took hold of her hips. She felt her legs wobble a little. She was going to fall down if she didn’t sit down. The couch was there for her, thankfully.

‘I get tempted sometimes,’ she said. ‘Sure.’

‘Were you tempted tonight? While you were dancing?’

‘Plenty.’

She felt bold, answering his questions. She’d never be like this usually — except she’d been there when her husband told her best friend his darkest secrets.

‘...And it turns you on to think of her sleeping with someone else.’

‘Yes. For some reason, it really does. I can’t stop thinking about it.’

And now she was lying back on the couch in just her lingerie, and he was kissing her just beneath the navel, and she was so wet for him already. Wet because of what he’d told Katie.

‘Did you dance with any guys?’ he asked her.

‘Would have been rude not to,’ she replied, surprising herself with how she responded.

He tugged down her panties a little, enough so he could plant kisses over her mound.

‘I bet they wanted you so bad,’ he said, breathing in the scent of her arousal — inhaling it as though it was some magical elixir.

Gazing at her pussy like he hadn’t seen one in years.

She liked this kind of attention from him.

‘They kept trying to put their hands up my dress,’ she said and saw him flash her a wicked smile.

Oh, Ben. Where had he been all this time? It felt like they’d spent more time apart than together in this marriage.

But now his hot mouth was on her sex, and she felt like she was about to burn up, her temperature shooting through the roof.

‘Ohh...’ she moaned.

It felt so good. He seemed so into it. He'd never gone down on her like this before.

'Who... was this woman... you were talking to online?' she asked, breathless. 'What did she say to work you up like this?'

'I don't know... she's from Ohio, I think... just another player... level three... she's funny... she pretty handy in a battle...'

Carrie giggled. 'You're such a geek, hon. Does she have big tits?'

He smiled. 'I guess most female characters do in Elven Quest.'

Oh, this was heaven. Sure, she'd been starved of attention for months — years — but she could just stay here all night with Ben sucking on her pussy. It felt so good. She stroked his upper back with her feet, and he really didn't look like he wanted to go anywhere soon, either.

This was what marriage was supposed to be, wasn't it?

She gazed down at him and said, 'So she got you all jealous, you just had to wait up here for me?'

'Not... *jealous*,' he said, sliding his tongue surprisingly far inside her, making her gasp.

Since when had Ben been so good at this?

He said, 'What she said made sense... but... I guess I like the idea...'

'You like the idea?'

Well, now she was curious about how much he liked the idea. She sat up and urged him up from the floor.

He kissed her, and she tasted herself on his lips.

'You deserve to have some fun,' he said, kissing her mouth as though he'd never noticed how attractive she was before, and now he couldn't believe he'd married such a beautiful woman.

It felt to Carrie that every cent she'd handed over to Marriage 2.0 had been worth it.

As he kissed her, she unfastened the buttons on his shirt, and pulled it off him. Then her hands were at his fly, yanking it open, dragging down his pants just enough to reveal his cock.

Jeez, he was *so* hard.

'Mmm...' she beamed, taking hold of his shaft with both hands. 'So she told you I was probably having an affair?'

'She said...' he groaned as she slipped the tip of his cock in her mouth. 'She said you were probably thinking about it.'

She smacked her lips, coming back off his cock. 'Maybe I was.'

She sat back on the couch so that her back was supported, pulling him with her so that he had to kneel over her lap.

‘Hmmm...’ he groaned as she sucked a whole load of his gorgeous cock into her mouth.

It was just wonderful, having his manhood in her hands, in her mouth. Some women saw oral sex as a chore, but Carrie never had. And when it was her darling husband, who she felt like she’d been apart from for so long...

She gazed up at him and smiled sweetly, her mouth still full.

Then his cock slipped out again, and she said, ‘So it turns you on, thinking about me having an affair?’

As she drew his length back into her mouth, he put a hand to the back of her head and gently moved his hips, so it was almost as though he was fucking her face.

How had he remained in such good shape, spending all that time cooped up in his basement?

Then he paused again, said, ‘I don’t know why... I just like the idea of it...’

‘Me dating some other guy?’

He shrugged. ‘Or guys. Whatever.’

He stood to remove his pants altogether.

‘Is this because you’ve met some hot princess in your video game?’ Carrie smirked. ‘You want me to bang someone else, so you’re free to pursue Lady Elvira in some castle boudoir...?’

‘I don’t need anyone else,’ he said, and God, he looked magnificent without his clothes, his cock so stiff it was like a damn offensive weapon.

She scooped forward to the edge of the couch, she just had to get another taste of that thing...

He brushed her hair out of her face as she slipped his cock back in her mouth, and he said, ‘I just like the idea of you being naughty... having fun... and then coming back to tell me about it...’

‘You’re crazy,’ she said.

‘Maybe.’ He stooped to kiss her mouth and reached to remove her bra.

Oh, she liked having his hands on her bare breasts.

‘I’m sorry, they’re probably not as big as your Ohio princess,’ she smirked.

He smiled and squeezed her tits, ‘What’re you talking about? Yours are perfect.’

And the way he was looking at her, she believed him, too. God, where had Ben been when she’d been in high school, paranoid about her lack of cleavage?

She said, 'I wouldn't want any other woman to touch you. Is that selfish of me?'

He said simply, 'Your fantasy isn't sharing me. Mine is sharing you.'

It made sense.

She turned around, kneeling on the couch but facing away from him. Presenting her rear like some fertile doe trying to encourage a magnificent stag to mate with her.

She loved how he put his hands on her and stroked her as though he couldn't believe what a goddess she was.

Wasn't this enough? She didn't need other men.

Why would he need her to be with other men if he adored her like this? Wasn't there something vaguely disturbing that he would?

'You wouldn't feel threatened?' she said. 'If I went out to meet some gorgeous guy...'

'You love me, don't you?' he said.

'Of course.'

'Then how could I feel threatened?'

His hand swept down over her behind and dipped between her thighs, seeking out her wet pussy. Oh, it felt so incredible... had he drunk some magic elixir that made him God's gift to women? Or was it just because she hadn't had any action in so long?

'What if I slept with someone, and when I came home... you'd changed your mind?'

'I wouldn't.'

'But maybe you would. There's no taking it back if I sleep with someone else...'

'As long as we talk about it, there's no broken trust,' he said. 'There doesn't need to be any lying, any keeping secrets...'

She moaned as he fucked her with his fingers, and she tried not to think about the big secret that her best friend had been secretly playing video games with him, talking to him with her snake-charming ways. Persuading him that Carrie should be allowed to bed other men.

Would he be this way if Katie hadn't coerced him?

She closed her eyes and said, 'But how would you feel if I fucked some big, handsome guy and then came back to you afterward...?'

Then he put a hand on her lower back and slid his extraordinarily hard cock inside her hot, dripping pussy. There was no longer any point doubting whether he really wanted her to see other guys.

'Oh... my... God...' she gasped.

She came harder than at any point in her life so far.

And after that, she had no difficulty telling him that she'd planned to meet a rather handsome guy named Jon for coffee the next day.

EPISODE 5

She had breakfast with her husband.
This was unprecedented.
This was *ridiculous*.

He was sitting there at the little table in the kitchen, eating his Reese's Puffs. Not in his troll cave, not grazing while video gaming.

Was that it for Marriage 2.0, then?

It had succeeded in flushing her husband out of his hole, and, judging by the previous night, into hers. So to speak.

'So you're meeting him for coffee this morning?'

Oh yes, he had an agenda. But Carrie didn't mind that her husband wanted to spend time with her so that he could follow her progress with Jon.

She said, 'Maybe it'll turn into nothing. Maybe he really just wants some company while searching for jobs. Maybe you'll be disappointed.'

Ben smiled. 'You like him.'

'Well, I only met him once so far.'

'You find him attractive.'

'Uh-huh.'

'So you'll flirt with him.'

'Probably... I mean... unless it turns out he's gay or something.'

What if he is gay? She thought. That would be disappointing. But she definitely hadn't gotten anything but heterosexual vibes from the guy before.

Ben looked content that she was open to the possibility of something happening.

He was excited; that was obvious.

Well, she was excited. It was exciting.

‘Are you going to tell him about me on your date?’ Ben said. Carrie felt a strange little tingle of excitement — arousal — when he said the word ‘date.’

‘He knows I’m married,’ she said.

‘But are you going to tell him I know you’re meeting him for coffee? That I’m okay if anything... happens between you two.’

‘I don’t know... I guess I’ll see if it’s the type of thing he’d find too... *unusual*.’

After breakfast — and a relatively late one at that, since she didn’t exactly have to get to the office these days — she went upstairs to take a leisurely shower and get ready for her (date) coffee meeting.

Could this be construed in any way as a ‘date’?

It made her shiver just to think of the word.

Ben really wanted her to be free to date other guys? To meet them in coffee shops, bars, nightclubs. To flirt with them. To sleep with them?

It just seemed insane.

But here she was, putting on some sexy underwear — well, she wasn’t hopeful of anything happening yet, but she didn’t want to rule anything out — and finding some nice but casual clothes to put on. And here was Ben again, materializing in the bedroom doorway as though Scottie had just beamed him there.

‘You having second thoughts?’ she asked him as she did her makeup in front of her mirror.

‘Oh no,’ he said. ‘I just wanted to see you before you go.’

‘Are you going to give me a pep talk?’

‘Do you need one?’

‘I don’t think so.’ Smiles all around. God, she loved how he was looking at her. The desire was so clear on his face.

All married women should get to be like this.

‘Wow, you look amazing,’ he said as she finished applying a modest amount of makeup — just enough for a coffee meeting, but not so much that Jon would think she was trying too hard.

‘Maybe we should go on a date sometime,’ she said. ‘Then I can dress up nice for you.’

He grinned. ‘That could be nice.’

She laughed. ‘But you’d prefer it if I went on a date with someone else?’

‘You can have both, can’t you?’

She was about to kiss him, but didn’t want to mess up her lipstick, so she pressed her nose against his cheek affectionately. And clamped her

hand on his crotch.

He was hard. Rock hard.

‘Mmm...’ she moaned, her hand remaining right where it was squeezing his bulge. ‘You going to keep that safe so I can have it when I get back?’

‘Uh-huh,’ he replied.

She loved knowing he was hard for her as she left the house. Leaving him that way so he could be aroused while waiting for her to meet Jon for coffee. That was good. Sure, it got her a little damp, imagining Ben would want her when she returned.

And hey, if Jon turned out to be gay, maybe she’d just return home to Ben and make up something about the guy being so desperate that he’d taken her in the car. Or something.

Jon didn’t turn out to be gay. Divorced, but not gay.

‘That’s tough,’ she said, trying to sound sympathetic, trying not to seem to be obviously wondering why he was divorced. Whether there was something wrong with him. ‘Losing your job as well as...’

‘Oh. The divorce was a while ago,’ he said without a hint of awkwardness. ‘I just haven’t felt like getting into anything heavy since then.’

‘Right,’ she nodded.

He smiled. His smile made her jostle her thighs a little.

‘She left me for another woman,’ he said, answering her unasked question.

She nearly spat out her coffee, and was then very apologetic, but they were both laughing at her almost choking at what he’d said.

‘You put her off men, huh?’ she giggled.

He gave her another easy, charming smile. ‘I like to think that she felt safe enough in our marriage to challenge her preconceptions — and when she did, she discovered a new side of herself.’

‘A side that wasn’t compatible with your marriage?’

He shrugged. ‘She fell for someone very nice but who was strictly monogamous.’

‘Hmm, that’s too bad.’

‘We’re still friends,’ he said. ‘I guess it could have been worse... we hadn’t had kids yet.’

‘Would you have... I don’t know... shared her, if the person she fell for was open to the idea?’

Jon said, ‘Sure... why not? I mean, I hadn’t really thought about it before Sharina told me she’d met this beautiful woman... but why should people feel the need to limit themselves?’

‘I guess that’s true.’

‘What about you and your husband? Does he know you’re meeting me this morning?’

Carrie felt her heart start to thump slow and hard. This was one of those moments. Fork in the road. Things could go one way, or they could go another, but this was the point at which the choice had to be made.

She said, ‘Yes, he does.’

Well, fuck it. She never felt comfortable lying anyway.

Jon smiled. Jesus, it made her wet. ‘Did he give you a hard time for wanting to meet up with a guy to search for jobs together?’

Jeez, why did her heart have to beat so hard? It almost hurt.

Right now, she could make this whole coffee meeting thing seem entirely innocent. Or, she could open up and risk him thinking she was some kind of slut.

She said, ‘No... actually, he’s very happy I’m getting out there and meeting people.’

Jon nodded slowly, as though impressed at her husband’s supportiveness.

She said, ‘He’s not really a jealous person. I guess he’s more like you than... the woman your wife fell for.’

There was a little glimmer of something in Jon’s dark eyes that made her pussy throb. Was that lust? Hope? The recognition of possibility?

They did search for jobs together. They sat side by side at two little tables there in Progressive Grounds, laptop next to laptop, scouring the job listings on Dice.com, Hired.com, Angel.co, The Ladders, and so on.

It was nice. Nice to have company. Nice to breathe in his warm, sandalwood cologne while she was sitting beside him. She tried subtly tugging down her top a little, so he might be tempted to sneak a few glances down her chest.

She liked how he looked at her. Trying so hard to be respectful, but occasionally stealing a glimpse of her, clearly appreciating what he saw.

She liked the way he made her feel about herself. Desired.

It was different when it was a guy who wasn't your husband. He had no obligation to thirst for you. His was an independent view.

And she got to enjoy little glances at him, of course. At his big hands, his broad shoulders. His athletic frame, his square jaw.

Coffee turned into lunch.

They just talked and talked. It felt like she told him everything — about her career, her husband, about her life, her friends. The only thing she kept from him was the fact that she'd signed up for Marriage 2.0 to try to do something about her estrangement from Ben. Oh, and she didn't exactly open up about how aroused Ben was about her possibly dating other guys.

And he really listened to her — not only did he listen, but he seemed interested.

He even joked about Katie flirting with Ben while they were playing video games together.

'For someone who was so scornful of people who play video games all the time,' Carrie said, 'Katie really has gotten into it recently.'

Jon nodded. 'It's addictive. People see it as a safe space, where they can be themselves, and talk to people without preconceptions.'

Carrie said, 'Somebody should set up a dating app for people who spend their lives immersed in video games.'

'You know what — somebody should,' Jon agreed.

She texted Ben when she was finally on the way home again. It was late afternoon by then. Time had flown by while she was with Jon, just like it did for Ben when he was playing video games.

God, she felt invigorated. Spending time with Jon had been just wonderful.

She'd forgotten how blissful it felt to flirt. To properly flirt. She'd been a loyal wife. But flirting with guys gave her a flood of endorphins that almost made her regret being married for so long.

If only Ben had discovered this little kink of his earlier, huh? But he'd found it now. And if he didn't change his mind, how *incredible* it could be.

Allowing her to be with other guys.

The freedom, the sexual potential — it just blew the mind.

Even if Jon turned out to be a no-go, a genuinely platonic relationship while the two of them searched for jobs, she was still opening the door to something with someone.

But she was so hopeful about Jon. So optimistic.

A supposedly innocent meet-up for coffee had turned into a long, leisurely lunch and then practically an entire day together.

Surely he had to be interested in her beyond needing some kind of company to keep him from the lonely demons of unemployment?

At no point had he seemed doubtful about the fact that she was married. If that was the kind of thing that would push him to keep their relationship on a purely intellectual level, he wouldn't have been nearly so flirty, would he?

She took an Uber home, thinking about him all the way. Jon was so gorgeous. Should she have asked him about meeting up again? Pinned him down to some particular time? But maybe she would have seemed too keen. He was only a text message away.

She quivered. It felt just like they'd had a first date. They were interested in each other, but there were social norms to follow — protocols that couldn't be violated for fear of scaring the other person away. Can't be too keen. Don't want to be thought of as clingy.

When the right moment came, a message would be sent. How about meeting up again?

Oh, Jesus. She was really doing this. A married woman, who thought these days were gone for good. Getting into a new relationship, a new *sexual* relationship. It made her feel a little breathless.

She was shaking a little.

And all the way home, she felt the warmth between her thighs, the wetness in her panties.

Her anxiety intensified as the car neared home. Nervous about Jon's intentions, nervous about Ben's reaction to it all. Would her husband change his mind?

She had to pause outside her own front door to pull herself together. She had to take a deep breath before putting her key in the lock.

Then, there was Ben. Sitting on the couch in the living room, controller in his hands. Had he brought his PS5 up here from his cave to play while he waited for her?

‘Hey,’ she said, trying to act calm.

‘You have a good time?’

He smiled and put the controller down. She glanced at the screen — Gran Turismo. Not Elven Quest.

‘I did,’ she grinned, then added, ‘Aren’t you supposed to be working?’

He shrugged. ‘I couldn’t focus on it.’

‘Because I was out meeting Jon?’ She sat down on the couch beside him.

He took a deep breath. ‘I thought you were just going out for coffee.’

She felt her stomach lurch. Was she in trouble? Had he changed his mind about her seeing other people, after all?

She said, ‘Coffee, yeah. But you knew we would keep each other company while looking for jobs, right? It just went on a little longer than I thought it would.’

He nodded. ‘You like him, then?’

She felt butterflies in her stomach. Oh, God. What if things really took off with Jon, and suddenly Ben decided he was strictly monogamous after all?

But maybe Ben just had to get used to the idea. And none of it would work if she couldn’t tell him, honestly, what was going on.

‘I do,’ she said cautiously. ‘I think he’s really nice.’

‘Good-looking?’

‘Very.’

Ben reached over and stroked her chin, ‘So you want to see him again?’

She leaned in to kiss him. ‘Yes, I want to see him again.’

Ben smiled, so clearly delighted by what she’d said that it made her pussy throb. Oh God, does he really want this? He kissed her again, offering a little tongue, which she accepted gladly. Thinking, Oh my God, he’s really into this. He really is.

Then they were making out on the couch, and Ben was pulling off her clothes, so completely enamored with her, she could hardly believe it. It was like she’d given him a love potion or something.

She helped him pull her pants off, and when his hand rested between her thighs, his fingers moving over the thin material of her panties, he quietly gasped.

‘You’re so *wet*.’

She could have so easily told him it was because of him. She was turned on because he wanted her, because he was touching her, kissing her. She would have been partly right.

But deep down inside her — something dark and wicked — made her want to test him.

She said, ‘The way he looked at me... the way he talked to me... made me so horny...’

Ben looked just thrilled.

‘I don’t know for certain, but I think he wants me...’ she said. ‘I don’t think it matters to him that I’m married...’

Little tests. Well, if Ben couldn’t handle it, she could dial it back.

But he could handle it. Praise be, he was entranced by her. His hand running all over her body, provoking ripples of sexual energy wherever it touched her — over her stomach, over her breasts, against her nipples.

She said, ‘You’d be okay if I see him again?’

He nodded. ‘Uh-huh.’

She dipped a hand between her legs, wanting to show him that she needed attention there, badly. She tugged aside her panties, but it made him stop to gawk at her, rather than get busy with her. He was watching her, and so she stroked her exposed pussy, gave him a show.

Was he thinking about how it would be if another man had this kind of view? If another man got to touch her here, got to slide his cock inside her?

She dipped a finger into her slit. She really was wet. She coated her entire finger in her slick oil and then lifted it up to his mouth.

He moaned and sucked her finger into his mouth, savoring her flavor.

‘Next time, maybe I’ll have dinner with him,’ she said.

Teasing him. Finding it so easy to get a reaction from him.

‘You’d be okay with me having dinner with him?’

‘Mmm-hmm,’ Ben said and then dipped his head between her thighs.

‘*Oh...*’ she groaned as she felt his hot mouth press against her pulsating sex.

He ate her ravenously. God, he was like a man possessed. And she was practically spraying her juices all over his face, she was so badly in need.

‘What if he wants to take me home after dinner?’ She asked her husband.

It only made him lap at her pussy harder.

She said, ‘What if he wants to *fuck* me?’

And then he was on her, yanking down his shorts, sliding his big, hard cock up against her burning pussy. Steering it into her. Penetrating her so easily because she was so wet.

‘Will you want me after he’s fucked me?’ she asked.

‘Oh yes...’

‘Will you want me after he’s stuck his big dick inside me?’

‘Oh *yes*...’

She was panting. It felt so good, so intense.

‘Will you want me when I come home with his come still inside me?’

‘*Oh yes....*’

‘Dripping out of my pussy down my legs...’

She came before he did, but only just.

EPISODE 6

She had time on her hands, being newly unemployed.

Sure, there was still plenty to do — working on her resume, applying for the few jobs around, and looking into freelance gigs.

It was good to have Jon available via text to discuss anything from specific job adverts to the best platforms to pick up freelance work. And Katie was also there to share the pain, along with the occasional lunch or afternoon selection of wine. Although, Katie was less fun to flirt with during the job hunting.

But at the same time, she wasn't working the nine-to-five these days. One thing she could add to her schedule was the gym. An early workout made her feel invigorated, mentally sharp, ready to get moving to find a new job.

It also helped with her confidence, particularly given her growing interest in Jon, and the fact that Ben was open to her having a little fun with other guys.

Coming downstairs wearing tight gym shorts and a sports bra that left her midriff bare made Ben's eyes widen like a cartoon character checking out Jessica Rabbit. It was so fun teasing her husband.

'You think I should wear a t-shirt over this?' she asked, all innocent, loving how he was gazing at her over his breakfast cereal.

'You're going to the... gym?'

Carrie smiled. Who knew that teasing Ben could be so much fun? 'I have more time for it these days,' she said, then added with a wicked grin, 'and if I'm going to start dating other guys, I'll want to look my best...'

Ben looked as though he wanted to drag her upstairs and have his way with her. God, even if she never got to date anyone else, the way

that this whole thing made her husband see her as a sexual being again made it all worthwhile.

‘You look *great*,’ Ben said, trying to keep his tongue from unraveling. ‘I mean... you don’t *need* to wear a shirt if you don’t want...’

She smiled sweetly and trailed a finger down her chest toward her cleavage to guide his eyes that way. ‘Maybe there’ll be some cute guys at the gym,’ she said.

Oh, it was like shooting fish in a barrel. But it wasn’t, like, *mean* teasing. He liked it, she could tell.

He got up to kiss her before she went, and while she locked him in for a much longer smooch than he was probably expecting, she brushed her hand over his crotch and felt how hard he was for her.

How hard he was for her because she was going to the gym looking like this.

The gym was unusually full, particularly for a mid-week morning. Carrie suspected many of those present were like her, tech industry survivors. There were hints at people being there to stave off the depression of being out of work, or out of the belief that physical fitness would help them get back into something.

Previously whenever she’d managed to get herself to a gym, it had involved baggy clothing, and the use of machines located in shady or out-of-the-way locations. But this time, for once, she felt absolute confidence in her tight lycra shorts and sports bra.

And she got to enjoy the admiring-slash-lustful glances from some of the guys without having to feel guilty.

Maybe there were even a couple of guys here she’d feel comfortable trying to talk to, after a few more visits.

She went home to shower, and as was typical in their relationship, she texted him to let him know she was on the way.

They always texted each other whenever they were on the move, so they’d know where each other was — even when Ben had been stuck in his years-long video game addiction. But texting Ben to say she was on the way home felt different nowadays. She was tipping him off. She was opening herself up to the possibility that he’d want some of her.

Maybe he'd be playing his video games when she did get home, she told herself.

But her hopefulness was rewarded when she got in the front door, and there was her husband looking as hungry as a fox in a henhouse.

'Aren't you supposed to be working?' she said, feeling a rush of warmth sweep through her body in response to the look of desire imprinted on his face.

'I'm on a break,' he said, walking up to her, taking her in his arms.

'I need to shower — ' she insisted.

'No, you don't,' he insisted.

Kissing his way down her neck, peeling off her sports bra. He didn't seem to object to the perspiration drying on her skin.

'Did you have a fun workout?' he asked, and she knew exactly what he was really asking her.

'Oh yes,' she said, 'A lot of fun...'

And then she was on the bed upstairs, exaggerating about the guys she'd seen in the gym and how she'd flirted with them.

Ben had his head wedged between her thighs while she recounted her adventures. He really did seem to enjoy going down on her. That had been a pleasant surprise, too.

At lunch with Katie, she hadn't had to fake anything for her friend to say to her: 'You got *laid*?'

Well, she was glowing.

She smiled, but said, 'Nothing extramarital. Yet.'

'God, you look pregnant or something.'

Head shake. 'Still on the pill. Why would I want *kids* to come along when my darling husband can't even get enough of me right now, and I have other men knocking at my door...'

Katie laughed. 'You know Ben's working, like, three times as hard as normal in *Elven Quest* so he can make time to stalk you now?'

'He is?'

'I hardly ever get the chance to chat with him these days. He's always out killing this demon or that giant ghoul.'

Carrie felt the smile spread right across her face. 'Maybe he'll reach Level 8, and then he can settle down,' she said.

Katie said, 'He'll want Level 9 then. Anyway. You're okay. He's learned that making time for you is worth it.'

'Well, I'm pleased to hear *that*.'

'He's still keen for you to start dating other guys, though.'

'He is?' Carrie asked, though she knew that he was. It was good to get confirmation from Katie now that she was becoming best buds with her husband online.

'He's just obsessed with the thought of you as some kind of saucy siren,' Katie said. 'Lucky so-and-so.'

She liked it when Katie envied her. Usually, it was all too rare.

She departed lunch feeling on top of the world — and then she received a text message from Jon asking her out for dinner.

It wasn't that night, but the next one after that. Well, Jon had protocols to observe.

Ben was there in the bedroom watching her trying on outfit after outfit.

She found it challenging to strike the right balance in her clothes, between flaunting herself and being seen as a slut. And there was always the fear that she was assuming this to be some kind of proper 'date,' while Jon might believe it was just meeting up for a chat about job hunting.

At the same time, it was fun giving her adoring husband a fashion show, and getting him to choose the clothes she would wear to dinner with another man.

Even her underwear was subject to debate.

'If he gets to take my dress off, and I'm wearing a thong, he'll figure I was expecting to have sex from the very beginning.'

'No, he'll just figure you were hopeful. You hoped there might be a chance. You liked him enough — '

'But this one's practically a *g-string*.'

'If you get to the bedroom, and he takes off your dress, and you're wearing granny panties, he'll think you don't really care about sex. Or you had no real interest in him, but now maybe you do only because you're drunk.'

'That's what he'll think?'

It felt a little strange, her husband suggesting which lingerie she should wear for another man. But she loved how sexy it made her feel — he was showering her with compliments along the way. And also, it definitely proved that he was comfortable with her going on this date.

She just loved how he looked at her, the whole time she was preparing to meet another guy. He was besotted. Obsessed.

Her confidence was considerably bolstered as she finally left the house, and climbed into the waiting Uber.

Then she was away. The flutter of butterflies stirred her stomach, but at the same time, she felt the unmistakable lightness and clear air of real freedom.

Wow.

Her nerves were not about whether her husband would be okay with this — it was just the kind of jitters you'd expect going out on a first date. Her angst was over whether Jon would continue to like her, whether Jon would want to invite her back to his place at the end of the evening.

What if he really wanted to sleep with her?

She texted Ben just as the Uber drew up to the curb in front of the restaurant. Then when she was out on the street, she texted Katie. Well — her friend was sharing this adventure, too, in her own way.

Then she clutched her coat around her shoulders to keep out the chill wind and slipped inside the restaurant. Telling the Maitre D' who she was meeting — *Jonathan Driscoll*. Even the sound of his name on her lips gave her a pleasant little tingle.

I'm meeting someone who is not my husband.

God, what would her parents think of her? What would her family feel if they knew?

What would all her friends, other than Katie, say about her meeting somebody new?

She tried not to look nervous as she was led to the table. She tried to look as though she was here to meet a friend, a contact, a business associate. She was still wearing her wedding ring — should she have removed it? But Jonathan knew she was married, of course.

At the last moment, she glanced down at her dress and suddenly felt terrified she was overdressed. It looked obviously like a date outfit. Like

she was trying to impress him, she was actively attempting to seduce him.

What if he was wearing old jeans and a t-shirt?

But then her eyes reached the table, a few moments before she did, and there he was, looking delicious in a stylish black button-down shirt and charcoal gray pants. Effortlessly cool, elegant without looking flashy.

She felt a rush of warmth inside as he noticed her, took her in, smiled, and stood to greet her.

‘You look incredible,’ he said as he kissed her cheek.

‘Not so bad yourself,’ she grinned.

His scent made her catch her breath a little — so sexy, so manly. So different from her husband. It seemed to emphasize the fact that she was here without Ben, on her own, free to do as she wished — but without a safety net. Exhilarating, yet a little terrifying at the same time.

‘What are you drinking?’

‘A pinot from the Santa Rita Hills. Pretty good...’

Through their small talk, she tried to act calm, to look normal, to avoid overly expressive displays of sheer excitement. He was dressed for a date! Woo-hoo! They were at a chic restaurant where they served *excellent* food! They weren’t talking about the job-hunting, they weren’t talking about work, they were finding out about each other!

And he was so calm and collected, so charming and cheerful, so respectful and gracious — and yet she could tell, deep down, that he was attracted to her, that he wanted her.

The little glances he gave her, particularly when he thought she wasn’t looking.

When the food came, it was just awe-inspiring, and reminded her that she hadn’t eaten out anywhere really special for so very long. With Katie or anyone else from work, it was usually some wine bar somewhere. Bar snacks, tapas, nothing remarkable. With her friends from college — most of whom she could only entice out if the stars aligned and they could all get babysitters for the evening — they went to middle-of-the-road places that offered specials on food and cocktails.

Why come to a place like this unless you were genuinely trying to impress someone? But then you don’t need to impress someone when you’re married, so you don’t get to come to a place like this for ages...

Ben texted her, and she felt all embarrassed, but she had to check it in case he’d changed his mind and so on.

She excused herself to the restroom, one with a damn restroom attendant offering perfume, gum, mints, q-tips, or whatever. What the hell? This restaurant had a *restroom attendant*?

She went into a stall, pulled out her phone.

Ben: Hey, how's it going? Hope you're having fun xx

Part of her was irked that he'd interrupted her date — but this was her *husband*, for goodness sake. He was letting her go on a date with someone else.

She was surprised to find out she'd already been out for three hours. Time was just zooming on by. So maybe Ben did have reason to text her.

And his text was so sweet and supportive.

Aww.

Hope you're having fun xx.

He was checking in with her, making sure she was safe and happy. Reminding her that he was there if she needed anything at all.

He wanted to be a part of this strange adventure.

What could she text back to him to give him the most reward for being the best husband in the world?

Carrie: Having so much fun. He's such a nice guy, and I think he likes me :-)

Well, Ben was turned on by the thought of her seducing another guy, right?

A moment later, he sent another text in reply.

Ben: That's fantastic. Of course he likes you, you look gorgeous :-P I bet he's trying to work out how to invite you back to his place without it seeming like too much is happening on the first date :-)

She had to stifle a gasp when she read that message — she didn't want the bathroom attendant to think something odd was happening in there.

Ben's message made it clear he thought Jon might want to invite her home. It even suggested Ben was hopeful he would.

It laid it all out there in black and white: her husband was happy for her to have sex on her first date if she wanted.

God, what would Jon think of her if she did have sex on the first date?

But wait. He already knew she was married. If she was dating him, he knew it was on the side. It wasn't as though Jon was hoping she'd turn out to be some kind of Disney princess and perfect future housewife willing to end things with Jon for him.

If Jon was in this for her, then he was in this for sex. She'd made it clear she wasn't leaving her husband — in fact, she'd said her husband was supportive of her seeing other people.

So what was this all for, if not for sex?

Carrie texted back to her husband: *Maybe it doesn't matter if it's the first date. Or if it did, we could argue that this is the third time I've seen him. So not a first date.*

She felt her heart beating suddenly quite hard inside her chest. Wow. She'd just argued herself into the possibility of sex. Tonight. With someone who wasn't her husband.

God.

She felt all flushed. Her cheeks were burning. Her chest. She *really* didn't want to get all sweaty in the middle of the restaurant, but...

There was a buzz as another text message came through from Ben.

Ben: Sounds good to me. Did you remember to bring protection?

Protection. *Jesus*, this was getting serious. Her husband was asking her if she'd brought *condoms* to her date with another man. It was like hard proof he wanted her to sleep with Jon.

She felt breathless.

This was really happening?

She thought of that little box of condoms Katie had stashed in their medicine cabinet to make Ben suspect she was already having an affair. She'd put one of them in Carrie's purse — but not the clutch she was currently carrying.

Now she regretted not bringing it. She could have texted Ben a picture of herself holding a condom to emphasize that this could happen.

'You alright, dear?'

The toilet attendant. She'd spent too long in the stall. She probably thought Carrie was having a panic attack or something.

Carrie took a deep breath and emerged from the stall.

'I'm fine,' she said with a little smile.

Then an idea came to her.

'Do you happen to have any... you know... protection...'

Come to think of it, the woman could have smiled and offered her a can of mace, or a rape alarm or something. But she seemed to get the gist of the way Carrie said it.

She said, 'Of course,' and opened a little drawer in the counter — and there was box upon box of condoms, of various types and brands.

It felt so unbelievably wicked to accept a box of condoms from the restroom attendant like this. But she did, and she felt a shiver of

excitement and anticipation shoot through her as she did so.

‘Thank you so much,’ she said, slipping the woman a \$20 tip.

Just outside the restroom door, she paused to snap a photo of the box of condoms in her clutch, then sent it to Ben.

Ben’s message came back quickly.

Ben: Looks like you’re all set. Enjoy xx

When she returned to the table, she did so with a whole new kind of resolve, a basket full of confidence.

Jon smiled, ‘Everything okay?’

‘Oh yes,’ she said. ‘My husband just texted me — checking I’m having a good time.’

‘Demanding you come home?’ Jon asked, gently testing the waters.

‘No,’ she smiled, ‘Ben wants me to have fun, stay out late, do whatever. I guess so he can play his video games in peace...’

Jon nodded. He didn’t seem phased by her mentioning her husband. She suspected plenty of men would.

He said, ‘Would you like some dessert?’

They weren’t quite far enough along for her to offer herself as his dessert, but it was a sign that he wanted to spend more time with her, at least. He wasn’t dashing away because she’d just reminded him she had a husband.

They calmly ate sweet little lemon-creme things, and he introduced her to some dessert wine that made her want to forget the food anyway.

And she tried not to think about the box of condoms that seemed to be burning a hole in her clutch.

Tried not to think about it, even though her husband’s words were just whirling around her head constantly:

Did you remember to bring protection?

Looks like you’re all set. Enjoy xx

EPISODE 7

It just felt *right*.

They were having fun. They didn't want it to end.

After dinner, they went dancing — and this wasn't just at any old nightclub, this was salsa. Jonathan could dance — properly dance. And not only could he dance, but he could teach her how to do it along the way.

She hadn't had such fun in ages.

Those first few steps might have been awkward, but Carrie was surprised at how quickly she got the hang of it. And when it went right, it felt great. She really connected with Jonathan on the dance floor. She loved being held by him, working off his body language, moving with the fast, passionate rhythms.

It was so energetic and active — and made them intensely focus on each other. It felt like they were practicing for a full-on carnal dance in the bedroom.

What an experience.

She'd never done anything like this with Ben — yet, it wasn't a bad reflection on her husband that he'd never suggested salsa lessons. Wasn't this a benefit of expanding your social network — opening yourself to new relationships with new people? It brought you entirely new experiences, things you could try that would never happen if you kept close only to your husband.

If she casually dated other people, even after Jonathan, it seemed to Carrie that the world was her oyster. She'd get a glimpse at different aspects of life she'd never get as a loyal monogamist.

They danced until they were gasping for breath. They danced until her feet hurt.

‘We should try the Tango,’ Jonathan said as they piled into an Uber for the journey back to his place.

‘Tango?’

‘It’s a little more difficult, perhaps, but even more sensual. The dancers are more equal — they mirror each other. But I think we could handle it.’

‘Sounds good to me — if it’s anything like tonight was.’

‘Oh, it is and more. More intimate, more tactile, more sexual.’

‘Really?’

Jonathan smiled, ‘The dancers have to be in a close embrace, you know? Chests pressed together...’

Carrie’s eyes flashed. ‘I’ll have to wear more suitable shoes, I think,’ she giggled, unable to resist the urge to slip off her shoes and rub her sore feet a little.

Then Jonathan was taking her feet in his strong hands, taking over, and that felt just heavenly.

‘Oh *God*...’ she moaned. ‘You’ve done this before.’

‘I’ve seen it done,’ he grinned.

She would never have predicted that she’d ever be bold enough to let a guy massage her feet on a first date, but dancing with Jonathan had helped her really bond with him.

It wasn’t what she’d describe as a romantic bond, but there was definitely something passionate about it. Sensual.

She was completely open to the possibility of sleeping with this handsome man.

When they got back to his place — which wasn’t so far from hers and Ben’s, except that Jonathan had a view — there was chilled white wine, and more foot rubbing.

But now they were in the private sanctum of Jonathan’s home, and his hands were massaging more than just her feet.

‘That was really the first time you ever did salsa?’ he was saying as he coaxed the fatigue from her calves, enjoying the smoothness of her recently shaven legs.

‘Uh-huh. I did some ballet in school, a little in college, but nothing like that.’

His massaging was becoming more like caressing, particularly as his hands reached above her knees. And then suddenly they were looking at each other seriously, their hearts pounding, and the message was clear.

Are we really doing this?

Well, he was just a gorgeous divorcee, so the issue wasn't so much are *we* really doing this. It was, *are you really doing this, Carrie?*

She shifted her butt on that expensive leather sectional as he now ducked to kiss the upper slope of her right foot.

'Your husband knows you're here?' he asked quietly. Almost solemnly.

She caught her breath, and now she felt guilty she'd clean forgotten about Ben ever since the restaurant.

'I didn't tell him yet,' she said, surprised that Jonathan had brought up Ben.

She thought that most guys would just throw caution to the wind and start making out with her. But Jonathan was different from most guys; he'd shown that from the start. He was mature, responsible. He knew she was married, and that didn't matter to him so long as she was okay to spend time with him.

Now, his tone was clear enough: he wanted her, and didn't want anything getting in the way. Anything like husbands wondering where their wives were.

'You need to tell him?'

Was that a question, or an instruction? The wine may have made it ambiguous.

She nodded and reached for her phone.

Well, if Jonathan had been funny about her having a husband, she wouldn't be here with him, would she? And he definitely wanted her to be here with him.

She texted Ben.

Carrie: Sorry! Got distracted. We went salsa dancing! It was wild! And now I'm at Ben's place.

She added Ben's address in case it helped to reassure her husband.

Ben's reply came quickly again, making her fairly sure he was sitting at home with his phone right in front of him.

Ben: You having fun? Keeping safe? xx

Keeping safe.

Her husband was gently prodding her to ensure she used protection while sleeping with someone else. Just those two words alone were enough to remind her of the strangeness of this situation. Her husband was quietly waiting at home for her while she dated — and slept with — another man.

It was strange — but *so* sexy. She couldn't believe how hot a thought it was. That Ben was waiting for her, massively turned on because she

was with someone else.

And when she returned to him — what then? It had been insanely hot when she went back to him after merely having coffee with Jonathan.

How would Ben respond when she'd actually fucked another man?

She texted him back:

Carrie: Unbelievable amount of fun, and I promise to keep safe. But this is your last chance, my darling, if you want me to stop. It's about to happen, for real.

There was an empty silence for about two, maybe three heartbeats.

Then Ben's reply came back:

Ben: I don't want you to stop. I want you to do whatever you want, and enjoy every moment. Then come back to me after xxx

She nearly came there and then.

‘All good?’

‘All good,’ she said, and she moved to him, climbing over him on the leather sectional, putting her hand gently on the side of his head, bringing her lips to his.

And they were past the stage in the evening where they had to control themselves.

Now, it was time to just take what they wanted.

He kissed her back, his hand cradling her head, stroking her neck. Sucking on each other's lips, slipping a little tongue. So tender, so soft, so sexy. There was something different about kissing a guy who wasn't your husband. As hot as it was with Ben, it was just different. Erotic in another way.

The guy didn't need to be here. He'd made no commitment to her. He just wanted her. It gave her ego a lift, just because.

She pulled open his fly as they kissed. She was moving quickly, perhaps. But she'd waited a while. She was old enough to know what she wanted. And he was perfectly happy to give it to her.

He moaned as he sucked on her lower lip, and her hand encircled his exposed shaft.

They were both breathing a little harder as she started to pump him. He had a nice cock — it actually wasn't quite as thick as Ben's, but it was a good size. Uncircumcised, which was intriguing.

She sat up on his lap and peeled off her dress.

She enjoyed how he looked at her as she stripped, which motivated her to remove her bra, too. She sat still as his hand meandered around her chest, exploring her contours, indulging in the shape of her near-nakedness.

She kissed him and unfastened the buttons on his shirt, and when he pulled that off, it was her turn to gaze at his body, dazzled with lust. He worked out. He was buff, strong.

Strong enough to lift her and manhandle her onto her back, where he could kiss his way down her chest and suck on her breasts while he wrestled to completely remove his pants and his underwear.

She was trembling with desire as he yanked away her thong — the thing just snapped, for God's sake — and ducked down to plant kisses along her bare stomach, and over the little triangle of dark fur on her mound.

'Oh yes... *please...*' she moaned as she felt the heat of his mouth on her sex.

Was this really happening?

Was she dreaming it?

Was it Ben doing this to her, and she'd somehow managed to imagine someone else in his place?

But no — it was Jonathan. Tall, dark Jonathan. Tall, dark, buff, handsome Jonathan. His handsome face wedged between her thighs. His charming smile pressed against her soaking pussy.

He was a little rougher than Ben, his approach didn't seem quite as surgically targeted. But he was there. He was gorgeous, and he was not her husband.

It was so dirty. So *wrong*.

She put her hands on his head and gyrated her hips, grinding her wetness against his beautiful face.

She came in record time, and it seemed that much of the reason was that this was not her husband. It seemed so gloriously wicked. She was cheating on her dear husband — with his full approval.

This was Marriage 2.0?

This was the future of marriage?

Gasping for breath as a comparative stranger made you come with his mouth.

Wailing as he pressed his hot lips to her pussy and tongued her without mercy.

Coming like his face was a sex toy, one that she'd give a full five-star review on the website it came from.

Then he was pulling himself up her body, kissing her so that she could taste herself on his lips, pressing his beautifully hard cock to her pussy. She made little begging noises as he kissed her.

Only when he was grinding that thing against her clit, and she was so desperate for him to enter her, did she remember what Ben had said.

Keeping safe?

She groaned and reached out for her clutch purse. Jonathan looked a touch confused until she produced the box of condoms.

She urged him back, to sit on the other side of the sectional. She knelt in front of him, and now she got the chance to explore his cock with her mouth.

Peeling down his foreskin, gazing at it like it was the first cock she'd ever seen.

It was so beautiful.

She kissed its tip, and then ran her lips and her tongue around it, making him moan.

It was so stunning — perhaps most of all because it wasn't her husband's. It was like a symbol of her newfound freedom, as well as an arousing shape in its own right.

She sucked on it for a while, pumping his shaft with her hand. Appreciating it, and the strangeness of doing something she never thought she'd be doing again after she'd got married. Exploring a brand new cock.

Then it was time to tear open the condom wrapper, and roll it over Jonathan's gorgeous cock.

She'd never been much fond of condoms before, but for some weird reason, it seemed exciting to be handling one now. Probably because she wasn't supposed to be. She was supposed to be with her husband, on the pill, having no need for something like this.

But here she was, unsheathing it down the stiff shaft of another man.

Standing.

Straddling his thighs.

Guiding the tip to her pussy as she lowered herself over his lap.

Gazing into his beautiful, sky-blue eyes as she sank on his shaft, taking it deep inside her. Awed, wonderstruck at the fact that she was now, without any doubt, engaged in extramarital sex.

Adultery.

It was just sex.

Sometimes, when you read about someone cheating on their spouse, they'll tell you it was just about the sex. She'd never entirely understood why they said that — because of course it wasn't just sex. You cheated on your wife. Or husband. There was trust broken there. But also, Carrie had never before had sex with someone while she was in a loving relationship with somebody else.

This was a totally different experience.

Despite her powerful attraction toward Jonathan, she didn't love him. She'd really only just met him. And more to the point: she didn't need to love him. She already had a wonderful husband waiting for her at home whom she loved, and who loved her in return.

So with Jonathan, when he dragged her to the bedroom and then mounted her from behind like a mighty lion, it really was just sex.

Scorching sex. But still, just sex.

Riding his big, hard pole. Or laying there while he thrust it into her. Panting and groaning and gasping and moaning as he worked her body using his, and vice versa.

Jonathan was so strong, so fit. Just magnificent. She loved how he moved her, how he held her, how he took what he wanted from her. It was like salsa dancing all over again, only this time she was following his lead as he straddled the backs of her thighs and drilled that massive cock into her, or spun her onto her back and held her knees as he thrust powerfully into her again and again.

They got sweaty — really sweaty — but with Jonathan it was just part of the experience, and almost a badge of honor. They were animals, going at it based on instinct and impulse — they weren't a prince and princess trying to maintain some kind of decorum.

He came in the condom, and then she was on her knees, sucking him until he was hard again.

Then he came in her mouth.

It was a new experience for Carrie. Whenever she'd dated anybody before Ben, she'd always been at least looking for love. When she finally got somebody into bed, there were emotional attachments forming, or else already in place.

But this was just physical. Gloriously physical. Unbelievably satisfying — but for Carrie, it was more like an intense workout in the gym than particularly romantic.

Like furiously masturbating during a CrossFit session.

It left her saturated with sweat, but invigorated and highly content — but she didn't feel any guilt when it was over, and she got up to retrieve her clothes, and dressed, ready to leave.

Saying simply, 'It's getting late.'

Jonathan gazed at her appreciatively, admiring her as she slipped on her underwear, her dress. But he was entirely relaxed about her disappearing back home, too.

He said, 'Want me to get you an Uber?'

And she shook her head. 'It's only a couple blocks away.'

'I'll walk you.'

'I'll be okay.'

He was a nice guy. He did walk her home. But it wasn't because he craved every possible minute with her. It wasn't because he was terrified he'd never see her again. It wasn't because he worshipped the ground she walked on, and hoped to persuade her back to his place, where he could woo her away from her husband.

It all seemed very straightforward.

This was adultery, but without the broken trust. Her husband was fully in the know. It was wonderful. How was this arrangement not more common in society? How come newspaper articles weren't written every week stating that this kind of thing was the secret to a happy marriage?

She texted Ben while Jonathan walked her home.

She gave Jonathan a long, sensual kiss when they arrived at her and Ben's front door. Was Ben inside, watching them via the doorbell camera?

When she parted from Jonathan, he said, 'There's a seminar about starting your own business. Wednesday afternoon. It's down by Union Square somewhere.'

'Oh, right,' she said.

'We should go.'

'Yes, we should,' she said, delighted more that he was making plans for them to see each other again, than for the fact that she might learn about starting a business.

'Great — I'll text you the details!'

Then he was gone, and the front door was opening, and then there was Ben looking expectantly hopeful.

EPISODE 8

‘*S*o did you... did it... were you...?’ Ben babbled, the excitement bubbling up inside him to incapacitate his brain.

‘Uh-huh,’ she smiled, putting her arms around him, pulling him to her, kissing him as he gazed at her, stunned but ecstatic.

He kissed her long and slow and deep, and she could tell he was getting to grips with the fact that she had just slept with another man. Getting his head around that monumental fact as he breathed in the scent of her freshly fucked body, as he tasted her lips, assuming she’d been using them on another man not so long before.

‘Are you okay?’ she asked when he finally allowed her to come in off the street and close the front door behind them.

‘Oh, yes,’ he said, breathless.

He leaned in to kiss her under her ear, and she could tell he was inhaling that smell of sex that wafted up from her dress. The hint of sweat and come and another man’s cologne.

‘You’re so beautiful,’ he murmured as he kissed her neck.

‘Mmm... maybe I should get in the shower...’ she said softly. ‘I’ve been so *dirty*...’

But she sensed that Ben wouldn’t let her escape to the shower. He was back to kissing her mouth, sucking on her lips. Could he tell she’d had Jonathan’s cock in her mouth in the minutes before she’d left his place to come home?

Could he tell that the last time, Jonathan had come in her mouth?

‘So you went back to his place after the salsa dancing?’ he asked her, trying to start the ball rolling.

‘Uh-huh,’ she smiled. ‘He opened some wine and gave me a foot massage. Then, I guess, he was kissing me instead of massaging me...’

‘Yeah?’ Ben stepped behind her, pulling her to him, breathing in the musty scent of her mussed hair, his arms enclosing her, his hands exploring her body, running over her breasts, down her stomach, between her thighs.

‘Mmm...’ she moaned as she felt her husband’s hand press against her pussy through her clothes, stoking the heat as though stirring up the embers in a fireplace.

‘Was he good?’ Ben prompted her again.

‘Oh yes...’ she said as he kissed her cheek and squeezed her breasts. ‘He had a beautiful cock... so big... and hard... and uncut...’

‘Really?’

‘Mmm-hmm. I liked it...’

‘In your mouth?’

‘Mmm-hmm.’

‘In your pussy?’

‘Oh yes,’ she sighed as his hands delved between her legs again, lifting her dress and caressing her through her soaking wet panties.

‘Tell me,’ he growled, moving around her, kneeling on the floor before her.

She beamed from ear to ear as he slowly tugged down her panties to reveal her freshly fucked pussy. She heard him catch his breath as he laid eyes on the little patch of dark fur above her pink lips.

She loved having this effect on him.

‘He was so good in bed,’ she told him. ‘So strong, so *powerful*...’

Ben kissed the top of her thighs and then nudged his face against her pubic hair, breathing in the pungent aroma of sex.

‘His big cock felt so good inside me,’ she said, adoring the little moan of excitement her husband released in response.

‘He lay over me and pushed it inside me, and filled me up... it felt so *good*...’

Ben’s kisses moved to her soaking folds, and then he was eating her, going to town on her pussy, flicking his tongue over her, sucking on her lips.

‘Mmm...’ she said, putting her hands against the wall behind her to steady herself as she lifted one foot, and put it up on his shoulder, giving him easier access to her dripping sex.

‘Does it turn you on that he fucked me, my darling?’ she asked.

Her words only made him lap at her pussy more vigorously. She loved how he responded to her.

‘Do you know how good it felt when he thrust his big cock inside my wet pussy?’

He was going crazy for it.

But she didn’t want to stay on her feet. ‘Why don’t we find the bedroom?’ she asked him. ‘Then you can do whatever you want with me.’

In the bedroom, what he wanted was for her to climb onto him and then lower her newly desecrated pussy onto his mouth.

Boy. Had they ever done anything like this before?

She was riding his *face*.

He held her hips, pulling her tight to his mouth as he ate her. He was a man possessed. Oh, but it felt good. It felt good that he wanted her so much, as well as the heat and intensity of his mouth on her pussy.

As he feasted on her, she reached back to unfasten his fly, to release the towering erection that gave her proof of how into this he was.

How into her infidelity he was.

Such a buzz, sleeping with two different men on the same night.

But what surprised her most when her husband licked her pussy straight after another man had fucked her was just how good it felt to offer Ben exactly what he wanted.

It was so sexy that he was turned on by her like this.

That he was turned on by her sleeping with someone else.

His mouth felt so good on her pussy, particularly after it had been pounded by Jonathan so roughly. But what felt better was how he was moaning as he ate her, how much he was clearly getting off on it all. How hard he was while she ground her pussy against his lips.

Such a thrill that Ben wanted her so much.

After a while, she had to turn around and take his beautiful erection into her mouth. Oral sex had been a bit of a chore at times during their marriage — but now, she couldn’t get enough of it. Filling her mouth with his big, hard cock.

It only thrilled her more that it was the second cock in a night that she’d sucked on. That Ben’s was so different, free of a foreskin. Bigger in girth, though maybe not quite so long.

He came in her mouth, and she didn’t even mind that he hadn’t managed to hold on for longer. She liked that he was so aroused he came

so quickly.

But then she lay beside him, and he didn't just roll over and go to sleep.

He peppered her with questions — how did he fuck her? What position did she like with him? How long did he last? What did she do with him that she'd never done with her husband?

He started stroking her pussy, and she was amazed to see his cock slowly thicken up again just minutes after orgasm.

He asked her where Jonathan had come, and when she told him that as well as in the condom, he had finished in her mouth, Ben was all over her again, kissing her mouth, his manhood stiffening up as it pressed against her thigh.

She straddled him, sank down on his perfect erection.

'You feel that?' she moaned as her husband filled her so completely. 'I'm so wet, honey. He made me so wet...'

'Oh, that feels so *amazing*...'

'Can you tell I've had another man inside me?' she asked him.

'Oh yeah...'

'It felt so good when he was fucking me.'

'He fucked you hard?'

'Oh yeah, so hard.'

Ben didn't fuck her hard.

It was a completely different experience from the way it had been with Jonathan.

Her husband was slow, sensual, and dreamily affectionate, while Jonathan had been passionate, powerful, vigorous.

But wasn't it just what she needed after she'd been with Jonathan? She didn't want more of the same, she didn't want the roughness now. She didn't want a hard fucking when she'd already been ridden rampant.

This wasn't porn. She was going to get sore if she had a long, long night of men using her as their personal fuck toy. Ben was tender, caring, and his lovemaking was practically therapeutic.

A woman wants a stallion to ride her hard sometimes, perhaps. But other times, she wants her partner to make her feel secure, wanted, *adored*.

And after her first time actually taking the risk to sleep with another man — albeit with her husband's approval — how her husband welcomed her home afterward and showed her how much he loved her was the most important thing of all.

And how hot was it that he wanted her like this because she'd been with another man? She couldn't get enough of that.

They'd never spent this much time making love before. He kept going down on her; he was obsessed with it. He was connecting the center of his senses to the center of her sexuality. The place where she had truly breached the confines of their wedding vows.

She gave him the time — and hey, it felt good. He made her come three times with his mouth on her pussy.

But she also loved how hard he was because of what she'd done — and that meant when he wasn't head down between her thighs, she wanted his manhood in her mouth, or in her pussy.

And even when they were both exhausted, and he had come inside her, she just wanted to lie spooned against him, and keep him inside her as they drifted off to sleep.

Ben was almost more enthusiastic that she was going to a business seminar with Jonathan than she was.

Sure, she hoped something would come of it.

But she had to remind her husband that she also had to start thinking more about her career than just her sex life.

'Starting a business of your own, though?' Ben asked her.

She said, 'I never really considered it before. But if there's really no work around I can apply for, it's worth looking into?'

'Of course. I'm not knocking it. I'm just — I don't know — impressed.'

She smiled. She liked impressing her husband.

She had to fend him off as she dressed in a chic suit that gave her the look of a potential business owner. As much as she longed for a little more of his eager mouth on her pussy, once she'd chosen her outfit, there just wasn't enough time.

'Let me know how it goes,' he said to her before kissing her goodbye — and she knew he meant with Jonathan more than the conference itself.

‘Get some work done,’ she grinned, stepping away but loving how he looked at her with such longing as she went.

Then came the seminar.

It was more like a workshop, very interactive and informal. Most, if not all, of the people there were freshly laid off by the tech industry — though some were from the coding side of things, while others were from the financial end.

There were break-out sessions and chances to network as the seminar continued into the evening, past a buffet-style supper.

It meant plenty of flirting to enjoy as they went — with Jonathan and others. It wasn’t that she wasn’t focusing on the business side of things, but her underlying feeling that she was allowed to flirt with others, guilt-free, really seemed to boost her confidence and help all aspects of her networking.

From the start of the event, though, they were expected to have fully-formed ideas for what their business would be.

Carrie leaned on Jonathan, not least because he had brought her here, suggesting the seminar thought she might not have chosen something like this of herself. Jonathan seemed to approve of her sticking by him, and didn’t attempt to counter the automatic assumption of those around them that they were business partners.

As for an idea for a business, however...

‘Well, it was Carrie who really came up with it,’ Jonathan said when they were finally pressed for their idea by the seminar leader.

He looked at her as though she was about to explain their idea — but her mind was utterly blank.

Then he said, ‘It’s basically a dating app for people who spend their lives immersed in video games.’

The seminar leader, a guy named Graham, gently nodded his head. ‘Okay... I can see the potential there... but there’s plenty of dating apps out there...’

Carrie smiled at Jonathan — surprised but pleased he’d remembered her little suggestion from their coffee meeting.

She said, ‘Millions of people around the world are playing online video games against each other, rather than just individual games. And more and more of these games provide a social connection between

people from all walks of life. But what if you're on your own, and you want to meet someone to spend time with in one of these games?"

Jonathan said, 'It's just bringing like-minded people together, people who might not get liked or swiped-right if they're on something like Tinder.'

'And maybe it's not only for people who want some kind of romantic connection,' Carrie added. 'Maybe part of the service should be just for people who want to make friends in one of these games, you know?'

And not only did Carrie see the possibilities for an idea like theirs — but a little gaggle of other seminar delegates saw the potential, too.

After the event ended, there was a group of eight of them hitting a bar nearby, sketching out ideas for how to proceed with the app.

It was midnight before they all decided it was time to call it a night.

Then Jonathan was taking her home, both of them still just buzzing about the possibilities of actually starting a business of their own.

They got to Carrie and Ben's doorstep before Carrie realized she hadn't even thought about how the night with Jonathan would end.

'Uh... this is you,' Jonathan smiled.

'Right,' she said, feeling so energized about everything, she didn't want the night to end. Before she thought about the consequences of what she was saying, she suddenly blurted out, 'You want to... come in?'

Did he know Ben was in there? But Jonathan didn't seem phased by the possibility.

He said, 'Sure.'

And only as Carrie realized she had no option but to follow through and bring him inside did she realize her husband was going to be there when they went in.

How could she be so stupid?

Ben was sitting on the armchair in the living room, playing his video game without the VR headset on — just using the TV screen. Clearly, he had been waiting for Carrie to come home so he could grill her on what had happened with Jonathan.

Only, here was Jonathan.

Carrie felt incredibly awkward. They hadn't talked about Ben meeting Jonathan. They hadn't talked about her bringing the guy home with her.

Ben looked up at the man entering their home, astonished.

‘Uh... Ben... this is Jonathan,’ Carrie said.

Jonathan stepped over and offered a hand for Ben to shake. He seemed so self-assured, completely unbothered by the fact that Ben was here. ‘Hey, Ben. Nice to meet you.’

‘Nice to... uh... meet you too,’ Ben said. Then, attempting to find a distraction from the awkwardness, he added, ‘How was the... uh... seminar?’

Jonathan said, ‘Oh, it was great. We were talking to a load of people about Carrie’s idea for a new app — a dating app for gamers...’

And then her two guys were chatting freely and easily about this new app the group of them were hoping to develop. It was so weird. After an initial awkwardness, Jonathan and Ben seemed to get on like a house on fire.

Carrie fetched some wine to take the edge off things further, but when she came to sit down, the only place available was on the couch with Jonathan.

As they were chatting and sipping their wine, Jonathan put his hand on her leg. And if he’d been her boyfriend, and Ben had been her roommate or something, it wouldn’t have been in any way unexpected.

But Ben was her husband.

Jonathan stroked her leg like he was her lover, like *they* were the couple here.

She saw Ben notice it. She detected him getting slightly flustered by it, too, in how he spoke. But she could tell he wasn’t angered by it, he wasn’t annoyed by it, he wasn’t offended. In fact, as their conversation went on, she got the feeling Ben was excited by it.

Her husband said to them, ‘So you two will work on this as business partners?’

Then Jonathan came right out and said, ‘Well, I guess it’s not always a good thing to get into business with someone you’re *dating*, but...’

And there it was. Jonathan telling Ben he was dating his *wife*, right there and then.

And Ben said, ‘Right...’ Like he was accepting the idea completely, like he was fully on board.

Carrie felt a strange but exhilarating sensation blooming inside her — stoking the heat between her thighs.

Jonathan said, ‘I think if this thing really gets rolling, I can always step away a little, you know? Make sure there’s no potential for conflict while I’m seeing Carrie... you know... *socially*...’

He put her arm around her and kissed her on the cheek, right in front of her husband.

Carrie suddenly wondered if Jonathan had had too much to drink. Whether he'd forgotten she was even married.

But then, as she took another sip of wine to try to deflect from what Jonathan had just done, her new guy was asking her husband how long they'd been married, how they'd met, and other things you just didn't talk about with the husband of the woman you were apparently dating.

God, what was happening?

Ben chatting with Jonathan easily and freely about how he'd met Carrie, their life together. His descent into video game addiction. Jonathan stroked her thigh as he chatted with Ben. Ben, in turn, looking relaxed and happy as he asked Jonathan about this gamer dating app they were thinking about developing.

Then Ben gave her the strangest of smiles and said, 'Well, I'd better go and get on with some work... I should probably wish you two a good night.'

The two guys were shaking hands again, and when Ben disappeared down to his basement den, it was clear what he meant for Carrie.

It felt almost surreal.

She said, 'Should we... head upstairs?'

Jonathan said, 'Sure, that would be wonderful.'

And suddenly, Carrie was taking her date upstairs to the bedroom to fuck while her husband waited downstairs, in the same small house.

EPISODE 9

They went into the bedroom. Carrie closed the door slowly, feeling the nervous energy rippling through her body, the thud of her heart beating hard within her chest.

She turned, moving as though she were worried that overly quick movements would see her swallowed up by quicksand.

Moving slowly to give her husband ample time to jump in and tell her not to do this. Not to sleep with his man now in the same house where Ben was waiting.

Jonathan was lying on the bed, watching her.

She stood there by the door, gazing down at him.

‘Who are you?’ she said.

‘You know who I am,’ he said, entirely unruffled.

‘You’re gorgeous,’ she said. ‘You turn me on like crazy. And you don’t care that I have a husband.’

‘You’re beautiful. You’re smart. Why should I care if you happen to be married? If your husband doesn’t mind...’

‘But who dates a woman knowing she’s married—and still together with her husband?’

Jonathan shrugged. ‘More guys should. They’re missing out.’

Carrie stroked a rogue strand of her dark hair back behind her ear. ‘Who takes a woman into a bedroom for sex when her husband is downstairs and knows you’re here with her?’

‘I know that your husband’s okay with it. So it’s okay. In fact, I get the feeling your husband’s more than okay with it.’ Jonathan smiled. ‘He’d be disappointed if nothing happens in here, right?’

She smiled sweetly. Was he nervous that she was about to turn him down for sex? She peeled off her dress, leaving her standing there in fancy white lace lingerie.

‘I guess he would,’ she said, taking a step toward the man on the bed. Enjoying how he looked at her, not bothering to hide his desire.

She was still staring at Jonathan, unsure.

He removed his shirt slowly—taking his cue for a relaxed pace from her. She couldn’t hide her liking for his powerful physique, his muscular chest.

‘You look like a Greek God,’ she said. He smiled. She took another step toward him, but paused before getting to the bed. ‘You look like that... then you suddenly turn up in my life... just as I’m trying to find a way to entice my husband out of his shell...’

She rested a knee on the edge of the mattress.

‘You provide this perfect answer for a lonely wife in need of attention—and suddenly, my husband is interested in me again, because it turns out he’s got a secret fantasy for me to cheat on him.’

‘It’s not really cheating,’ Jonathan said.

‘Okay. But my husband has a secret fantasy about me sleeping with other people. And here you are.’

‘Here I am.’

He pulled himself up so that he was kneeling on the bed. He reached out for her, and she didn’t shove him away.

She kissed him. Her hands swept all over his buff torso, practically groping him. She trembled for him, she soaked her expensive lace panties for him, she ached between her legs for him.

What did it matter how he came to be in her life?

But as his hands took hold of her behind, and he softly kissed her neck—one of her secret weaknesses—her curiosity wasn’t forsaking her.

‘Did they send you?’ she asked.

‘What’re you talking about?’

She kissed him hard, as though taking her fill of him before he was torn away from her for good.

‘They sent you to me, didn’t they?’ she breathed, her hands tracing out the shape of his muscles, desperate to cling to this fantasy.

‘Don’t talk,’ he insisted, his hands moving to her breasts, squeezing her there, his fingers nudging her stiff nipples. His touch was just electrifying. It was like he knew how to turn on her switches in the exact way to make her helpless.

‘And now...’ she said, her hands dropping to his loins to check out what he harbored for her. ‘Now... you’ve found a whole group of people

who can completely transform my career... at a point when I should be on the scrap heap...'

'There's no way you should be on the scrap heap.'

She put her hands on his face, kissed him softly, gazed into his eyes. 'You can tell me,' she said. 'You're part of the program, aren't you?'

He kissed her, but she remained still, staring into his eyes.

'I don't mind,' she said. 'I... I'm having a wonderful time... and I'm sure, so is Ben... I just... need to know...'

'I'm dating you because I want you,' he said, taking one of her hands, putting it on the bulge in his crotch so she could feel how hard he was for her. 'That's all that matters. You know I'm not going to date you forever... your adventure is so much bigger than that...'

He wasn't denying it. He wasn't confirming it, but he was using some of the words they used.

She nodded. 'You can't talk about it,' she said. She nodded, accepting it.

She was disappointed. Wasn't she? It was hard not to feel crestfallen when it turned out that a gorgeous guy had not picked you up in a coffee shop simply because he was so attracted to you.

Was it basically akin to her paying for sex? She'd paid them to rekindle the passion in her marriage. They'd sent Jonathan along to sleep with her.

Jonathan kissed her again. 'This isn't about you and me,' he said. 'None of it is about you and me. It's all about you and Ben.'

She nodded, realizing he was right. Why should she get hung up about Jonathan? She'd only ever wanted to get Ben back into the game.

He said, 'When you've had enough of me, you're going to be able to date whoever you like—you know that? Ben will let you. Ben will want you to. You'll be fulfilling his fantasy by doing so. And you'll feel lucky to have a husband who lets you enjoy other guys.'

'I suppose so.'

'And probably, your relationship with Ben will be better if you see the guys you date as just that... dates.'

She nodded. 'Ben is my true love.'

He kissed her neck some more, and she knelt on the bed with him, her hand pressing at his bulge. Thinking: now it was more straightforward, right? Jonathan was here for sex, primarily. He was here to ignite things between her and Ben, he wasn't here to fall in love with her.

She squeezed his cock. 'Do they regularly test you?' she asked him. 'You know... so you're safe?'

He smiled. 'I get tests done regularly, yeah.'

Still being careful not to actively admit he was part of the program. Ah well.

She let him reach behind her to unfasten her bra. She let him suck on her tits and press his hand between her thighs to rub her pussy through the thin lace of her panties.

'So how's this going to go?' she asked him.

'How do you want it to go?' he said, panting a little as he kissed her chest.

'I guess... I still want you to fuck me...'

As though to prove it, she grabbed hold of his wrist, held his hand there to urge him to continue with his fingers. He didn't need a lot of encouragement, his fingers disappearing under the narrow band of material to slip inside her soaking pussy.

'That's good,' he said, 'because I still want to fuck you.'

She moaned as his fingers worked their magic inside her. God, he knew what he was doing. He was a tricking expert.

She let out a loud groan entirely involuntarily, and then suddenly worried that her husband would hear. It was only a momentary concern. Almost as soon as it had passed her synapses, she realized that her husband would be listening for these kinds of noises.

He wanted her to be fucking this guy.

Jonathan used his fingers to spread her moisture over her clit. Then he was shaking his wrist incredibly quickly, but with such tiny movements—shaking her clit, trembling the tips of his fingers against it. Turning his fingers into a goddamn vibrator.

She cried out loudly. Then again. She was doing it for her husband, wanting to share the experience with him.

At first, it was a performance for Ben's benefit. But the sensation of Jonathan's fingers on her clit was just incredible, and soon she was crying out without any kind of pretense. God damn it, he made her come, hard.

It was one of those fast orgasms where she lay there and held her damn breath until it was over. And then the climax exploded through her entire body, and only then did she allow herself to gasp for oxygen.

Then Jonathan was between her thighs, lapping gently at her pussy, sucking gently on her soaking lips. It felt nice, so lovely. But she wanted

that to be Ben, somehow. Jonathan wasn't supposed to make her feel nice, he was supposed to make her feel wicked.

'What happens next?' she asked him again, trying once more to feel out whether he was just going to leave, and never come back to her.

He said, 'You're going to get up, go downstairs, and see if Ben would like to join us.'

Well, that was unexpected.

Jonathan smiled as she suddenly strained her neck to stare down at him.

'He's going to say yes,' Jonathan predicted confidently. 'And then you'll tell him to sit in that armchair there.'

She was just aghast. This guy was really going to let Ben watch?

Turns out, he was.

Ben did just as predicted, and Carrie led him up the stairs and told him to sit in the armchair. He did exactly as told and looked absolutely enchanted by the prospect.

Oh God, she loved having two men in the same room focusing their attention on her.

She loved how Jonathan looked at her.

She adored how Ben did.

She sat down on the bed beside Jonathan, who was wearing only a pair of boxer shorts by now. He pushed himself up and took hold of her, kissing her bare breasts.

She gazed at her husband as he watched another man sucking on her breasts, and asked him if he was okay. Ben nodded and smiled.

Then she picked herself up and knelt over the man on the bed, her hands on his crotch. Jonathan lay back, and Carrie kept eye contact with her husband while she released the other man's hard cock from the confines of his underwear.

She was practically purring like a cat as she took hold of Jonathan's manhood.

'Oh, honey, he has such a beautiful cock,' she said, peeling down the man's foreskin, slipping out her tongue to take an exploratory lick around the tip of that thing. Thinking about how he'd confirmed he was regularly tested. He was safe. She wouldn't have to worry about condoms this time.

She glanced over at her husband, who was watching her so intently.

Then she moaned and took the end of Jonathan's cock in her mouth.

'Oh my *God*...' she sighed as she explored that gorgeous dick with her hands, her mouth, her lips, her tongue.

But she couldn't keep from looking toward her husband, seeing how he was appreciating this obscene sight.

'Honey... it's so good... sucking his cock...'

Her words were only helping his experience, she could tell. It wasn't just that dirty, filthy, wicked words were coming out of her mouth—it was also that she was directing them at him. She was talking to her husband while sucking another man's cock, and that meant engaging her husband in this whole experience.

'Mmm...' she moaned as she bobbed down on the man's shaft, trying to get as much of it into her mouth as humanly possible.

Ben was moaning quietly now. 'You're so beautiful, sweetie...' he said. 'I love watching you...'

'Mmm...' she grinned. 'I love you watching me...'

She was over-exaggerating everything. The way she sucked on that cock, the way she was using her face to stroke it, her hands to pump it, her lips to wrap around it. The noises she made as she kissed and sucked on it.

It was a performance. It was a portrayal of sex for her husband's benefit, it wasn't purely for hers.

And yet the way she did that seemed to get Jonathan going, too. Suddenly, he had to urge her to stop, so he could take a break before she had him going too fast and too soon.

He was up, removing Carrie's panties, then plunging his head between her thighs to savor his own taste of her.

Jonathan took her roughly with his mouth—it wasn't the way Ben would do it—but still, it felt good. It felt wicked. It felt particularly naughty because her husband was there to observe.

But Jonathan wasn't down there for long. He was up, directing her onto all fours, and then with the perfect angle for Ben to see everything, he was sliding that big, hard dick of his into her sex.

'Oh God...' she moaned, 'That feels *so* amazing...'

It wasn't just the physical feeling, either. Being fucked in front of her husband. It was the biggest turn-on she could remember.

Ben moved to the bed, and sat beside her head, as though supporting her through the process. Stroking her hair as another man rocked her body back and forth with his rhythmic thrusting.

‘Oh *honey*... it feels so *good*...’ she panted.

The wet sound of the man’s hard cock pummeling her pussy was so intense—how was Ben taking it? He seemed to be completely entranced by it all.

As Jonathan’s thrusting got more and more powerful, Carrie was up on her hands and knees, moaning and gasping at the shafting she was getting. One of her hands landed at her husband’s crotch, seeking out how hard he was for her, loving the determination that he was hard as a rock.

‘You’re so gorgeous...’ Ben was murmuring as Jonathan fucked her hard.

Her husband seemed so completely besotted with her, so completely taken by what was going on. He looked at her with such love, it just about made her melt.

Loving every moment of this. Breathing in the thick scent of their sex, of their perspiration, of another man’s cologne.

Then Carrie was on her back, her head resting on her husband’s lap, Jonathan lying over her to continue fucking her.

It was just a magical experience.

And to top it off, her husband kissed her so very tenderly, so very lovingly, as her lover finally grunted and jerked and bucked and released his hot seed deep within her sex. Hottest kiss ever.

Her husband was going down on her when Jonathan stepped out of the shower. It felt wonderful—not least because her husband was so into it, so into her.

She enjoyed watching Jonathan dress, knowing he’d just been inside her. That she’d had the opportunity to sleep with someone like him.

‘Will we ever see you again?’ she said, feeling a twinge of regret that she’d forced the end of this thrilling adventure by figuring out Jonathan’s secret.

But Jonathan smiled. ‘Officially, I’m in town for another week,’ he said. ‘So we can see lots of each other, if you like.’

‘That would be wonderful.’

‘Dinner tonight? I know a good place in Chinatown...’

‘Oh yes.’ She was answering Jonathan, but at the same time responding to the heaven that was her husband’s mouth on her pussy.

‘Would you have stayed with us longer, if I hadn’t...?’ she asked him. She had to ask.

He shook his head. ‘It doesn’t really change anything,’ he said, again confirming he was part of the program without saying anything that could ever be quoted or recorded.

‘So what happens now?’ she kept asking that.

He said, ‘You guys have an exciting time ahead of you, right? You’re going to start meeting people you’re going to want to date... and Ben’s going to enjoy it when you’re dating other people.’

Carrie felt a strange but exhilarating shiver of arousal sweep through her body when he said she’d be dating other people. It was still a bizarre concept for a married woman to think about—and yet there was no question her husband wanted it to happen.

‘But guys aren’t just going to come up to me and introduce themselves while I’m having lunch,’ she said, the glint in her eye making it clear she meant to say that Marriage 2.0 wouldn’t be arranging for any more gorgeous hunks to suddenly ask her out.

Jonathan laughed. ‘You are stunning, Carrie. You can go into a bar and have men lining up to introduce themselves to you. And while you decide which one to take home, Ben could be sitting comfortably somewhere else in the bar, watching you have fun with them, right?’

‘I guess...’

‘Or else you could join Tinder or some other dating service, and the two of you could lie in bed, deciding which guys you want to date.’

‘Mmm... that sounds like fun.’

‘Or maybe you could play Eleven Quest with Ben, and meet guys online while you’re playing, and Ben can enjoy watching you flirting with them until they’re desperate to meet you in real life.’

Carrie laughed, ‘That sounds best of all. I guess someone should set up an app to help women like me meet nice guys who like to play video games...’

‘I guess someone should,’ Jonathan smiled.

Carrie looked at him thoughtfully. ‘Was all that part of the program? The seminar? Everything that happened after it?’

Jonathan shook his head. ‘That was all real. Those are all real people who want to work with you on your business idea. All you have to do is call them tomorrow and start the ball rolling.’

She nodded.

He said, ‘And hey—you know what, I think I have an angel investor lined up to support your business.’

‘You do?’

He laughed. ‘A company that... let’s say... has some shared interests. A company that might be able to make use of a dating app for people obsessed with video games...’

Her eyes widened. ‘Seriously?’

He smiled, and now fully dressed, he walked over to the bed to kiss her.

‘I’ll see you guys tomorrow for dinner,’ he said. ‘We can talk about it more then.’

‘Can’t wait,’ Carrie smiled.

Then he was gone, and Ben was on top of her, sliding his beautifully hard cock inside her, making her feel like a goddess in human form.

HARPER AND JOEL

EPISODE 1

Joel Tarrant didn't have any doubts at all about what his particular sexual fantasy was.

For years, he'd been religiously tapping in the letters H, O, T, W, I, F, and E into the search box for the usual array of pornographic websites. He'd even been active on a discussion forum related to his particular kink — forever labeled as a 'wannabe.'

The other guys on the forum were amiable and supportive, and their own tales of consensual infidelity were often far more inspiring than a hundred video clips on pornographic websites.

But Joel had always assumed that his beloved wife, Harper, would never in a million years embrace the dark fantasy of her sleeping with other men.

Then, one fine month in the middle of a mild mid-life crisis, he decided to reveal his long-held secret fantasy to her. And, it turned out, he'd been right all along in supposing that Harper would be absolutely horrified to learn of his little kink about allowing other men into bed with her.

So here they were, signing up for a new kind of marital counseling.

Harper signed them up for a program called Marriage 2.0 — because that was the one her friends over in Brentwood had tried. And while they could not reveal too many details about what it had involved, all those friends were still married. And very happily married, as it happened.

Marriage 2.0 had started out with an office in the middle of New York, and now had offices all over. But these days, you could also register online. They even did house calls.

So while Joel could slip out of his office one lunch break and head to the new Marriage 2.0 office in Burbank for his assessment, Harper could do it all quietly and discreetly at their fine home in Malibu.

Discreet, private. Nobody need ever know.

Joel was somewhat surprised at what the assessment process had involved. They'd rigged him up with a kind of virtual reality headset, which apparently recorded his brainwaves or something like that. Then they'd shown him various images and video clips, sometimes virtual reality scenes that were just insane.

And what they showed him was, as the assessment went on, more and more explicit and erotic. Until it got to the point that they were basically showing him various types of porn and measuring his bodily responses.

When he got home that evening, Harper did not want to discuss her assessment. But she was unexpectedly cheerful that night — and much of the rest of the week.

And that night, for the first time in a long time, she wanted sex.

They still had sex, occasionally.

They didn't really like to talk about it.

At bedtime, Joel occasionally arrived in the bedroom to find that Harper was already under the covers. And when he peeled back the aforementioned covers, he'd discover that she was naked.

He'd say something like, '*Oh.*'

And she'd give him a faintly embarrassed smile.

Then he'd dutifully remove his clothes and climb into bed with her. Invariably, sex involved some amount of kissing between them. Her hand would reach for his manhood to ensure he was sufficiently stiff.

Then he would climb on top of her and, as the French might say, *Vive la France*.

It never took very long. If it ever dragged on more than a few minutes, Joel would soon get the sense from her drifting eyes that the clock was a-ticking, and that some of them had to be up early to ensure the kids got to school.

But as with his work as an independent movie producer, Joel could usually deliver on time and on budget. Harper was attractive, after all. She took good care of herself. She regularly visited the gym down in their basement.

And if there was ever a problem, and Joel really wasn't in the mood, then he could quietly bring to mind his particular sexual fantasy — and imagine there was another man in there with them, thrusting his big cock into Harper instead.

Joel only wished that his wife was into the whole sex thing a little more. That would have been better.

She didn't even seem to come — ever. And it wasn't an issue for her. She did the sex, occasionally, as though it was something to tick off her to-do list. Once she'd done it, it was done, and she wouldn't have to worry about that sort of thing for a while.

She did it because she was married, and that was what married women were supposed to do with their husbands from time to time.

The guys on Joel's favorite chat forum had suggested he could — *should* — someday casually reveal to Harper that he'd had a dream in which she'd slept with another man.

Maybe, went the theory, she'd respond to the idea. *Maybe* it would even turn her on. Then he could admit to her that he found the concept sexy. If she was amenable to it, he might then state that he'd harbored that particular fantasy for a while. That perhaps, if she was ever tempted by someone, she could someday fulfill Joel's fantasy. If she liked.

She didn't like.

When he finally found the courage to reveal he had had 'dreamed' that she'd slept with another man, she said simply that he shouldn't eat cheese before bedtime.

After that whole idea had died a death, he'd waited a few months until taking another suggestion from the website. His last roll of the dice had been to reveal, in the middle of a rare incidence of sexual congress between them, that he sometimes fantasized about her 'being' with another man.

That had immediately terminated that particular incidence of sexual congress.

In fact, it closed down all subsequent incidences of sexual congress, too — until well after Harper insisted that they sign up for a marital counseling program by the name of Marriage 2.0.

Joel read everything he could find about Marriage 2.0 before and after his assessment.

He was surprised that Harper had decided they should do it — did she even know what it was? Or had she simply gone along with something her friends had done without really taking in the detail?

It appeared that this organization arranged ‘experiences’ or ‘adventures’ for couples specifically intended to rekindle the passion in a marriage.

It wasn’t really ‘marriage counseling,’ which Harper had insisted they needed after Joel’s unfortunate decision to open up to her about his dirty little secret.

Marriage 2.0 tested Joel and Harper to determine what kinds of things turned them on, and how best to take advantage of that to restart the sexual fires in their relationship.

Joel wondered how on Earth they would attempt to get any kind of sexual flames going in their marriage. And his best guess — his most confident prediction, in fact — was that whatever happened, Harper would object and refuse to take part. They would probably end up going to regular marital counseling, where Joel would no doubt be scolded for his little bout of perversion.

Marriage 2.0 could not possibly succeed with them, Joel was certain.

They would have to be very clever to get Harper interested in anything.

Two weeks after their assessment, Joel received a text message from a number claiming to be Marriage 2.0.

Congratulations! Your adventure with Marriage 2.0 has begun.

That was it. Joel was in the car on the way home when he received it — and it was duly read out to him by Apple’s virtual assistant, Siri.

It meant for the rest of the journey home, he was wondering what would happen — how would their ‘adventure’ go? Had Harper received

a text message from Marriage 2.0, too?

How could they get Harper interested in taking her sexual relationship with Joel up a notch?

When he arrived home, he found Harper and the kids sitting at the kitchen table, eating dinner with their au pair Julie. There was a spare place laid out for him.

The fact that they were having dinner together when he came in wasn't unusual — or the assumption he would be home in time to eat with them. Harper liked them to eat as a family — it was one of the only times in the day they could come together like that.

What stopped Joel in his tracks as he came into the large, open-plan kitchen was that while the kids and Julie were eating normal-looking — burgers and fries, in this instance — Harper's plate, and his own, was piled high with raw vegetables and fruit.

Joel sighed. Harper had discovered a new food fad.

'What's with the rabbit food?' he asked as he nervously approached his seat.

Harper rolled her eyes. 'I had lunch with Georgina yesterday,' she said, 'and she looks *amazing*. I mean *completely* unbelievable. I've never seen her so full of energy. She has this new guru.'

Joel went looking for wine and stopped to sigh as his wife used the word 'guru' entirely without irony.

'So we're both supposed to eat like squirrels?'

The wine cooler was distressingly empty.

His dear, always-observant wife noticed him standing in front of the empty racks looking discontented.

'I have some drink for you here,' she said, pointing at my place at the table.

Joel peered over to the glass sitting there next to his plate of plant matter, and groaned. Some kind of juice — clearly part of the new fad diet.

'Didn't you think to ask me if I wanted to join you on this new diet of yours?' he said as he took his seat and picked up his glass. Pineapple juice. Well, it could have been worse.

Harper smiled at him sweetly, and he discovered that, surprisingly enough, he still couldn't resist it when she did that. It also made him realize she hadn't sent too many smiles like this his way for a while.

'For this one to work, we both have to do it,' she said.

Joel speared a carrot baton with his fork and sighed. If Harper had decided they were both going to become vegans, they would both

become vegans. There was no stopping her.

The only thing keeping Joel from a meat-free gloom was the thought, underneath it all, that they were due some kind of adventure that was supposed to rekindle their sexual desire for each other.

After dinner, the kids did their usual thing until bedtime, while Joel responded to a few emails about his current movie financing project. Once the au pair was done getting them ready for sleep, Joel went up to read them stories.

On his way upstairs, he passed Harper, who was clearly on her way out for the evening.

He assumed from her smart casual jeans and button-down shirt that it was simply an evening out with her girlfriends. If she'd had a fund-raiser or something of the sort, she'd be wearing a dress.

Citing their usual hangout, he said, 'Flavio's?'

But Harper smiled. 'Not tonight. We're all going to Georgina's for the complete rundown with her new guru.'

Joel raised his eyebrows. 'I guess I won't have to worry about you drinking too much.'

She laughed. 'I guess you won't!'

As she turned to go, he paused, watching her descend the staircase and then leave the house. There was a decided spring in her step. Was something going on with her?

It made him wonder what this guru guy was all about. You couldn't be cheerful just because you switched to a new vegan-style diet. Was it Marriage 2.0 pulling her strings? What was it getting her to do?

He tried not to think about it as he spent time with the kids before they went to sleep. But afterward, as he collapsed into bed without even bothering to remove his clothes, Joel couldn't stop wondering what Harper was up to.

He tried catching up on some more Academy Award nominees he hadn't yet watched, but the questions kept whirling around his head.

Was this new guru some kind of Charlie Manson?

Was she forming a new plant-eating cult with her girlfriends?

He vaguely fantasized about Harper being drawn into some kind of cult-based orgy. Surely Marriage 2.0 wouldn't have the capability to persuade her into anything like that? Even if her friends were all doing it.

Jesus.

He snapped out of his daze to find himself watching ‘The Fabelmans’ with an erection. What an idiot. There was no way Harper would get involved in anything risqué. She would follow her friends into eating bowls of shredded cardboard if she believed it would be self-improving and reputation-affirming. But sex was just embarrassing, wasn’t it?

And then Harper strolled around the bed wearing that white button-down shirt and nothing else. Sipping on a glass of something. Her tanned legs looked phenomenal without pants.

‘I thought you weren’t supposed to drink on this new diet of yours,’ Joel said.

‘Passionfruit juice,’ she said, turning toward him to show him her glass, watching his face as her unbuttoned shirt opened to expose her trim body and black, sexy bra and panties.

Now she came to sit on the bed beside him, her hand moving over the bulge his body made in the bedsheets.

‘What’s going on?’ he said, any ounce of sleepiness forsaking him as he saw that her black brassiere was see-through.

‘What do you mean?’ she offered him a mischievous, knowing smile. ‘Can’t a wife come home to her husband...’

She slid her hand over his thigh, finding the thickening erection beneath the bedcovers.

‘...and want to make him feel *good*?’

She climbed onto him, straddling him, her hands sweeping up his body to find the burgeoning erection under the duvet.

Joel was just a little stunned. He hadn’t seen her like this in years. The lust in her eyes as she pulled back the cover to reveal his stiffening cock.

‘Did Georgina hire the cast of Magic Mike as your evening’s entertainment?’

‘I told you,’ she said, removing his pants, draping herself over his bare legs. ‘Georgina’s guru gave us all a fascinating little seminar.’

She took his cock in her hands, gazing at it as though it was made of 24-carat gold, as though it had been sculpted by Michelangelo. Then she licked it.

‘And what, exactly, did this guru put in your fruit juice?’ he asked, moaning as she took the tip of his manhood in her hot mouth.

‘There’s nothing in the juice except juice,’ she said. ‘It’s not *about* the juice...’

‘What is it about?’

‘It’s a whole... *thing*...’

She squeezed his shaft and stroked it, flicking her tongue around its helmet.

“Thing”?’

‘It’s not a diet... it’s a lifestyle.’

He would have rolled his eyes and emitted sighs thick with sarcasm, since she’d said plenty of similar things over the years concerning various fad diets — from the South Beach diet to Volumetrics, via Atkins and Paleo.

And it wasn’t as though she hadn’t done the Raw Food diet before. But the Raw Food diet had never made her ravenous for cock like this.

‘So... tell me how it works...’ he said, trying to maintain his conscious thought as she sank down on his shaft, taking him surprisingly deeply in her mouth.

‘Mmm...’ she moaned, lifting her head to gaze upon his erection again as though it were a gift from the gods. ‘It’s all about self-worth,’ she said, licking his tip, smiling up at him as though he were Arthur to her Guinevere.

‘*Self-worth*... I’m all for self-worth,’ he said, trying not to come too quickly, though it felt incredible.

‘Are you going to come for me?’ she said softly, pumping his shaft, and her words nearly made him erupt there and then.

‘Oh God...’ he moaned.

He couldn’t remember the last time she’d given him a blowjob. It had been one of those things they’d long since abandoned in the pursuit of swift and efficient sex. It felt good.

It seemed so strange that Harper was doing it. His obscene phallus disappearing into her beautiful face. Her perfectly applied lipstick rubbing all over his thick shaft. His unseemly manhood jammed in her eloquent, educated, sophisticated mouth.

But it certainly wasn’t the case that she was holding her breath, pinching her nose, screwing up her face, and doing something she found distasteful. She looked as though she was loving every moment as much as he was, and as she sucked on him, and lashed him with her tongue, she was moaning and purring like the cat that got the cream.

‘Come for me, darling,’ she was murmuring, like some kind of medium trying to contact the spirits of the dead. ‘Come for me... Mmm... let me have it, my darling...’

He wanted this to last — he hadn’t felt this good in ages — but it felt so intensely good.

And then she paused in her pursuit of his orgasm and knelt between his legs, her hands slipping under the waistband of her panties, dragging them down her body to reveal her perfectly trimmed pubic hair.

To his astonishment, she removed her little black panties, wrapped them around his shaft, and started jacking him off with them.

It felt surprisingly good — unexpectedly wicked, feeling her intimates around his manhood, the expensive lace grazing against his throbbing shaft.

A little while later, she paused to remove her bra, exposing her gorgeous tits, giving him a show before diving back down to take his cock in her mouth some more.

What had gotten into her?

What the hell had been in that damn seminar Georgina’s guru had given them?

Had some kind of alien pornstar entity taken possession of his wife?

He’d never seen anything so insanely hot.

And then, when he couldn’t take anymore, he did his utmost to warn her that the end was nigh — ‘I’m coming... honey... I’m coming... I’m going to come... I can’t stop...’

He thought she would quietly reach for a hand towel, a wad of tissues, or a jay cloth or something, but she merely moaned and cooed, ‘Yes, my sweet... come for me... give me your come...’

She stretched her lips around his throbbing cock and sank down as deep as she was able — and then he was groaning and jerking and shuddering and bucking and letting everything go — his hot seed shooting out into her mouth, pumping down her throat as she fought valiantly to swallow every drop.

‘Oh, *God*....’

Where was the woman who used to hold his cock at arm’s length and direct his spray of semen all over his stomach before flinging a towel at him as she disappeared into the bathroom to clean herself up?

She was gulping it down.

And then, when he was done, she cleaned up every drop, every hint of stickiness on his manhood, and quietly lay down beside him, uttering an unmistakably contented sigh.

She said, 'Good night, my love.'

And that was it.

She wasn't demanding her own turn, she wasn't upset that he couldn't get hard straight away to return the favor, she wasn't even demanding he service her by hand.

It was as though swallowing his come was her intended reward.

What the hell had Georgina's new guru been saying to her and her friends?

EPISODE 2

Saturday morning.

Harper usually woke late at the weekend — it was Joel's turn to deal with the kids first thing since she did it during the week.

This morning, though, Joel could hear the shower running, and his dear wife's side of the bed was empty and cold.

He sighed and rolled over to glance at the alarm clock. Seven in the a.m. What was she doing up at this hour, on a Saturday? Was this part of the new regimen? This was very unlike Harper. Even in her most faddy fads, she had always stuck to her guns when it came to the weekend lie-in. It was her big reward for all her childcare during the week.

The sound of the shower ceased. Joel drifted a little, back into slumber. The kids had finally reached an age where they, too, were beginning to enjoy a lie-in at the weekend. Thank the Gods. Even Jessica, now 7, could sleep until at least 8 am when she knew no school bus was coming.

But then, a few moments later, he jerked awake, and there was Harper beside him, freshly showered, wearing gym clothes, long dark hair tied up, looking expectant.

'What're you...?' he said sleepily, feeling the cool air whispering down his bare chest since she had pulled the bedsheet off him entirely.

'Have you got something for me?' she said softly, running a hand down his torso to his crotch.

'Hmmm?'

He flinched as she cupped his flaccid manhood through his boxer shorts, an entirely involuntary movement related to his body's instinctive concern at the risk to his sensitive region. But Harper pouted, like a child being refused a new toy.

She sighed.

He protested, 'I only just woke up...'

He was thickening up, slowly. Her fingers explored his growing bulge, then dived inside his undershorts to take hold of his stirring manhood, skin to skin.

She said, 'I have to go out.' As though it totally explained her impatience. It didn't explain why she needed to give him a blowjob first thing in the morning. On a Saturday.

He wasn't actively objecting to it, of course. But it had been three days since she'd started this new thing with Georgina and her guru and their little circle of Malibu moms — and during that time, Harper had gone down on him five times.

She'd even done it before he'd gone to work a couple of times.

Sure, it was nice, but he was starting to sense a certain pressure to perform.

He gazed down at her, taking in the sight of the trim curves of her body in a tight sports bra and lycra shorts. She did look stunningly good. It helped him thicken up a little more quickly.

'Where are you off to so early?'

'We're meeting Myitzu over at Malibu Fitness,' she said, pushing herself up before reaching over to peel down his underwear.

'Myitzu?'

'Georgina's *guru*.'

He moaned as her fingers closed around his shaft again and squeezed. 'Sounds like a breed of small and extremely annoying dog.'

'She's a *genius*.'

'She?'

'Really? In this day and age?' Harper flashed him a wry grin, judging him for his accidental misogyny, though she didn't stop stroking his cock.

'I just always thought gurus were always men.'

'You thought wrong,' she said, ducking down to take his manhood in her mouth.

He moaned. It did feel good. He liked having a wife who was suddenly obsessed with sucking his cock — even though he hadn't actually been anywhere near her pussy since she'd started this new system.

But while it felt good, he was still waking up, so he still had to work on maintaining that hardness lest it fail — which he assumed would deeply offend Harper. He pushed himself up on his elbows to gaze down

at her as she sank her head on his cock. The sight of her breasts squeezed into that sports bra helped enormously.

‘You *are* aware we have a gym in the basement?’ he said to her as she bobbed up and down on his shaft, working his length with her eager mouth.

‘Mmm-hmm,’ she said, smacking her lips as she withdrew from his manhood. ‘But Myitzu says we get more benefit working out in public.’

‘In *public*?’

She smiled. ‘You know... because there are other people around. It boosts our confidence.’

‘It boosts your confidence...’ he had to take a moment to process the thought. Then, suddenly he realized what she was talking about. Amazed, he said, ‘You get an ego boost because guys in the gym are checking you out?’

She smiled and faintly blushed. ‘It’s not like we’d be *cheating*,’ she said.

He wondered if she’d entirely forgotten that all this had started because he’d admitted to her that he had always harbored a secret fantasy of sharing her with other men. Her horror at such a suggestion had resulted in her dragging him to Marriage 2.0 in the first place.

He said, ‘I don’t mind if guys check you out.’

Her eyes twinkled, and she went back to cheerfully bobbing her head down on his cock.

It felt so good — but thinking about Harper showing off her tight curves in her sports bra and lycra shorts to various studs in the gym got him close to orgasm in double-quick time. His wife was going to a public gym looking like *this*? Normally she’d wear leggings and a top to work out, not particularly going for *tight*. Sometimes she’d wear sweatpants or loose shorts since no one would see her working out in the basement.

Thinking about the guys drooling over her looking like this, thinking about how good it made her feel to flirt with them — his cock was so pumped full of blood, it was throbbing.

‘Mmm... you really *don’t* mind, do you?’ Harper said, marveling at the steel-like stiffness of his manhood.

She gazed up into his eyes, demanding an explanation. He shrugged, ‘You deserve a little... admiration. You’re *beautiful*.’

She beamed at that. ‘You’re so *hard*, honey...’

‘What? It’s hot, knowing other guys want your wife...’

She laughed. ‘You’re not jealous? All those muscle-bound hunks staring at your wife in her tight little gym outfit?’

God. She flashed him a wicked, impish look that almost *promised* she could be tempted by those jocks in the gym if given another opportunity.

And with that, he completely lost it. His hard, throbbing cock was jumping and jerking in her hands, and Harper was quickly stretching her lips around its tip as if worried she'd spill some of his seed, and waste the precious elixir.

He let out a long, low groan as her hot mouth engulfed his sensitive manhood and fired his thick cream down her throat.

And, as he'd come to expect recently, Harper dutifully swallowed every last drop, squeezing out the last remaining dribble so that she didn't miss an ounce.

Then she was on her feet again, looking blessedly cheerful and contented with her lot, and Joel was left wondering if this new guru, whatever her name was, had found a secret way to turn men's semen into cocaine.

When Harper returned home, the kids were hanging out by the pool with the au pair.

Joel had been trying to spend time with them, stretching out with his laptop on a sun lounger, but he kept being dragged away by phone calls.

The Spanish director they'd hired for the costume drama currently shooting in Milan, Italy, was not getting on well with their A-list actor, who was the only reason they'd been able to get the financing in place for the picture in the first place. The whole project would be caput if their little spat wasn't resolved soon. So there was that.

After various calls to representatives on all sides all morning, Joel thought he had things reasonably well patched up. He thought he might be able to relax and enjoy being with his kids.

Then there was a text message from Harper.

Harper: Don't make a fuss or make it obvious to anyone else, but look behind you right now.

Joel scratched his head, confused — but he did what she said. He turned, pretending to be an actor doing one of those solemn, stare-off-into-the-distance moments in a movie designed to make a character seem deep.

Behind him, he saw Harper, still wearing her gym clothes, lurking in the shadows of the kitchen, gesturing for him to come over to her. What

was she doing? She looked vaguely embarrassed — and very awkward — definitely in need of something.

Had she dinged the Mercedes?

He put the phone to his ear and signaled to the au pair as though telling her he had yet another call to take. The au pair — Kristina — gave him a nod, and he skipped into the kitchen to see what Harper was up to.

‘What’s going on?’ he said. ‘You only just back from the gym?’

Harper looked annoyed. It made his stomach sink. ‘We had a full workout, and then we all went to Julio’s for brunch,’ she said. She appeared to be jiggling — standing there shaking, like a toddler who needed the bathroom.

‘Are you okay?’ he asked her.

‘Come on,’ she said, turning on her heels and heading for the stairs.

He followed her, admiring her butt in those tight shorts while trying to determine what Harper wanted. His best guess was that an incident had occurred in their en suite — perhaps she’d broken the shower. Why she would act so embarrassed was beyond him — although Harper found many things in life demeaning that really weren’t.

In the bedroom, he walked on through toward the en suite, almost certain that some kind of plumbing emergency had happened. Harper closed their bedroom door and said, ‘Where are you going?’

He stopped. ‘Did you block up the toilet, or something?’

‘No — ’ she sighed. ‘I need you to... *do something* for me.’

‘Do something? Like what?’

‘Like take off your clothes and lie on the bed,’ she said.

Joel raised his eyebrows. ‘You want *more* — ?’

She glanced irritably toward the windows, perhaps concerned that the kids would come looking for them. ‘Not *that*,’ she said, but she was peeling off her sports bra, so he pulled off his t-shirt and unfastened the drawstring on his swim trunks.

‘You want to talk about it?’ he said, getting worried now. Had she been taking something like oxycontin, and now couldn’t keep up with her habit?

She sighed again, stepped up to him, and hauled down his trunks, crouching as she removed them from him completely, his cock inches from her face as it swung free.

‘Myitzu had us doing these floor exercises... and then on the machines... and there were these guys doing weights, trying not to look like they were staring at us, but, you know...’

She took in the sight of his thickening cock for a moment, then stood, and pushed him back onto the bed. Then she slipped her gym shorts and panties down her own thighs, revealing her well-groomed pussy complete with a trimmed little dark bush on her mound.

‘What happened?’ he asked her.

‘Myitzu encouraged us to smile at them,’ she said. ‘To... you know... engage with them...’

Joel chuckled. ‘She wanted you to flirt with them?’

She looked so awkward about it. But it was a hot thought. He lay there, and his cock thickened so rapidly you could see it grow. Her eyes widened as she saw it. Her jaw dropped.

She said, ‘There were three of them. They came over. They were asking if we lived around here, if we were new in town...’

‘Okay...’ Joel said. ‘So it was fun? Flirting?’

She noticed herself standing there at the foot of the bed while he lay there on the bed, naked as the day he was born, his manhood monstrously erect. Then she realized she was just staring, and clambered onto the bed.

‘I was talking to this guy called Vincent,’ she said, straddling his thighs. ‘He asked me if I wanted him to spot me...’

‘What did he look like?’ Joel asked her.

She took hold of her husband’s stiff cock, but seemed too distracted to quite know what to do with it. He could feel her still trembling, shuddering. What was up with her?

She said, ‘He was big and muscley... you know what those gym guys look like. He stood next to me by the bench press, and he took off his shirt like it was hot in there... and he was just, like, rippling...’

Now she was sitting over his cock, pressing herself down on it so that her pussy was crushed against the length of his shaft.

She was so wet. He couldn’t believe it. Her sex just glided on his shaft as she ground herself against him.

‘What did he do?’ Joel was entranced by her.

Entranced by the fact that a big muscle-bound jock had tried to hit on his wife.

Sounding vaguely shocked, she said, ‘He asked if my husband knew I was there. If my husband liked going to the gym too...’

Joel could smell his wife’s arousal. He hadn’t known her to be like this. It seemed that she had flirted with a guy at the gym, and it had turned her on like crazy — and she didn’t know how to handle it.

He pulled her down onto him and rolled her over onto her back. He expected some resistance — after all, typically, when they did this, she liked to be safely under the covers, the lights off, and so on. But also, she hadn't been entirely clear that sex was what she wanted right now — that the need for sex was what had made her all jumpy and awkward like this. He was reading her — or, take it another way, he was making assumptions.

But she went with it, accepting him maneuvering her. Then he was lying between her thighs, kissing her gently under the ear, and sliding his hard cock inside her.

It was easy going — she was seriously wet.

He breathed her in as he kissed her soft neck, enjoying the faint mustiness of her perspiration, and the spicy scent of her arousal emanating from between her legs.

She whimpered as he filled her, and then moaned as he started to move within her.

'Oh yes... yes... *please*...'

He wanted to ask her more about her encounter in the gym, about what the guy had said. About what the guru had said, about how it had gone. But Harper was just crazy under him, thrashing about, pumping her hips. It was pretty clear she needed a quick, hard fuck.

So that was what he gave her.

He drove his manhood into her. Harper lay back and closed her eyes, opening her mouth wide, gasping and moaning as he thrust into her repeatedly.

'Oh my God, oh my God, oh my *God*...'

He'd never fucked her like this before, never quite so rough. But it seemed like she needed it urgently, and as he pounded her, her face and upper chest flushed, sweat dampened her hairline, and she made the most joyous noises he'd heard in a long time.

For a while, he just rode the wave.

Then she began to thrash about, crying out desperately as though she couldn't breathe. For a moment, Joel was actually terrified she was having a seizure — that they would have to call an ambulance.

But it did subside, and she calmed down, her shock and horror thawing into contentment and elation.

To his great surprise, he realized that he'd made her *come*.

It was so unexpected, it underlined the fact that he'd probably not made her properly come since before they were married.

‘Oh fuck... oh fuck... oh fuck...’ she whispered as she recovered her breath.

Then as Joel lifted up, she pulled away from him, but rather than simply getting up to head for the shower, she lay back on the mattress, directly under him as he knelt there.

‘I want you to come, honey,’ she said, smiling graciously. ‘Come on me. Please...’

She just lay there, gazing up at him with pure delight, as though waiting for a fantastic birthday present.

For a moment, he was unsure what she wanted — then there was nothing else for it but to start jerking off, his hand gliding on the wetness she’d left all over his shaft.

‘Come on me, honey...’ she cooed.

It seemed so wrong — jerking off in front of Harper, *over* Harper. It was obscene. This was *Harper*, the most perfectly put-together mom in all of Malibu.

But she said softly, ‘Come on, my darling...’

And then he couldn’t hold back, and he was shooting his white cream all over her gorgeous breasts, and she was moaning with happiness, smiling brightly as she watched it, as she took it.

‘Look at that...’ she whispered, laughing as some of it splashed onto her face.

Then before he’d even finished releasing it all over her, she was rubbing it into her skin, coating her bare breasts with it, teasing it into her flesh. Acting as though it was the most exclusive, expensive lotion.

‘Ooo, *thank you*...’ she breathed, licking her fingers.

‘You gonna tell me what happened at the gym?’ he asked her.

She smiled. ‘He wanted me,’ she said. ‘Vincent. He really *wanted* me.’

‘And that was what drove you so crazy?’ Joel lay down on the bed beside her.

‘You don’t understand,’ she said. ‘Myitzu told us to flirt with these guys. And we *did*, all of us...’

Harper picked herself up, gazing down at her husband.

‘Okay,’ Joel said. ‘So you liked it, right? I mean the way you were when you got home — ’

She said, ‘The guys were hitting on us while we were working out... and Myitzu told us we should *enjoy* it...’

‘And you did, didn’t you?’ Joel smiled, leaning into her. Kissing her cheek. Amused at her fierce blushing.

Harper still looked awkward, though. She looked guilty.

‘But I’m a *married woman*.’

‘It’s just flirting. So what? So you get a little pick-me-up when you go to the gym. Isn’t that what this new program of yours is all about? Building your confidence?’

‘That is part of it,’ she said.

‘And the other part is, what, eating fruit and veggies?’

She reached out and put her hand on his softening cock. ‘The other part is... *well*... a special nutritional supplement.’

‘Oh, right. Something you’re taking?’

She was stroking him, and after hearing about how much fun she’d had flirting with guys at the gym, to his surprise, Joel was already stiffening up again in record time.

‘Myitzu showed us all the scientific papers,’ Harper said. ‘It’s an antidepressant, anti-anxiety mood enhancer... anti-inflammatory, anti-oxidant. Good for cognitive functioning, lifespan. And never mind all the zinc, potassium, magnesium, calcium and the vitamins...’

‘Wow,’ Joel nodded. ‘And she supplies it?’

‘Oh no,’ Harper purred, ‘*you* do, my darling.’

Then she took the tip of his stiffening cock into her mouth again.

EPISODE 3

Joel met Myitzu for the first time at one of Harper's fundraising gala events. This was a black-tie dinner in aid of the brave people of Ukraine.

Everybody who was anybody turned up for it, dressed in their finest.

Harper's friends were there, of course, looking stunning in short, very tight dresses. But Harper's friends' husbands were also there — and you could tell which husbands were the ones whose wives were in Myitzu's little guru circle. They were the ones who seemed bold and cheerful and full of vitality — and you could tell they weren't faking it.

Joel shook the hand of Georgina's husband, Todd, and Todd damn near took his whole arm off.

'Hey, man. Harper is looking phenomenal.'

'Thanks. Georgina too. This new diet of theirs, huh?'

'Hey, I am not complaining,' Todd said. 'You know, ever since this whole *thing* started, I feel five years younger? Maybe even ten.'

'Probably because they've got us on the vegan diet, right?' Joel pointed out.

Todd chuckled. 'Harper has you guzzling birdseed and almond milk?'

'And pineapple juice. Never-ending supplies of pineapple juice.'

The other man gave a hearty laugh. 'Georgina started that way when Myitzu came along,' he said. 'Then she decided she was less concerned about how it tastes and more about how much there is.'

Joel raised his eyebrows at this. 'So what're you eating?'

'Red meat, my friend. Good, tasty, grass-fed American red fucking meat.'

'And does it help? I mean with... you know...'

‘I guess,’ Todd shrugged. ‘The main thing is, I can eat burgers, and ribs, and steak — and bacon...’

‘*Bacon...*?’ Joel’s eyes widened.

‘I think a lot of that stuff they tell us is baloney, right? I mean, sure, you shouldn’t smoke. And probably, maybe don’t munch on the garlic bread so much. But a lot of the other stuff is just a myth.’

‘Probably peddled by the pineapple industry,’ Joel grinned.

Todd nodded. ‘If these women are serious about this whole deal — and God knows, I hope they are — then they’re gonna have to keep us with a good supply of protein, my friend. Right?’

‘Right.’

Even without coming right out and saying it in blunt terms, it was strange talking to another man about the fact that their wives had embarked on a new strategy to suck their cocks at every possible given opportunity. But in an odd way, it was something new they all had in common, and something that drew them together more than anything else had.

Along with Todd, Joel found himself chatting about the same issues at the fundraiser with Helena’s husband, Zach, Jessica’s husband, Austin, and Morgan’s husband, Kyle. It was something to pass the time.

The other husbands he spoke to seemed happy, healthy, and spry, but they all had one eye on the *supply* problem.

So when he was standing there with Zach and Kyle, and Harper brought over Myitzu to meet them for the first time, it was a subject that was very much on their minds.

‘Of course,’ Myitzu said with a twinkle in her eye. ‘You know, every day you go without release... a man produces 12% more volume. So you could just hold back your side of the bargain for a few days each time...’

Zach laughed at that. ‘Helena is only just willing to let me go to work for eight hours a day. I can’t see her taking a break for a few days.’

‘Morgan’s the same,’ said Kyle. ‘As soon as I get home from work... whenever I first wake up in the morning... she pounces on me.’

Myitzu, a calm, confident woman probably in her early 50s, nodded thoughtfully. ‘It’s all about supply and demand,’ she said. ‘If your demand levels are overheating, you must find a way to increase the supply.’

Zach said thoughtfully: ‘But it’s not all about the nutritional benefits, is it? I mean... I read that you’d need buckets of the stuff to notice a difference...’

Myitzu gently nodded. 'It's not all about what it contains, although the research hasn't yet picked up on the effect of small quantities over a long time frame.'

'Right, but in the short-term... I mean, there's been a noticeable effect in Helena already, and that's not because of the zinc, or the potassium, or whatever else is in it, right?'

'It's about the confidence of knowing how much you desire her,' the guru said. 'The intimate, physical connection strengthens the romantic bond between you, and when you produce for her, it gives her tangible proof of her success in making you feel good. And that also rebounds in her own sense of self-worth and wellbeing.'

'Jesus. They should teach this stuff in sex ed,' Kyle joked.

Joel grinned. 'I feel like our high school and college lives would have been a little different if they did.'

But Zach was serious. He told the guru, 'But Helena is already asking what I can do to... you know... increase production...'

'Morgan, too,' Kyle added. 'And I've looked it up: there's no proof that anything actually works to up a guy's production.'

Myitzu gave a cryptic smile. 'Then perhaps we'll have to think of an alternative solution to the problem,' she said, and Joel thought he noticed a certain, knowing glint in her eye as she glanced at him after saying that.

The other husbands didn't seem to catch any hidden meaning in what the guru had said. But Joel found himself reminded that Myitzu had only appeared in their lives after Harper had signed them up for the Marriage 2.0 program. And since Marriage 2.0 had confirmed that their 'adventure' had begun, what else had happened to them other than the arrival of this new guru?

Myitzu had to be part of Marriage 2.0. She'd been sent specifically to initiate an erotic adventure that would rekindle the passion in their marriage.

But where was this adventure going to go next?

As well as chewing the fat with the other husbands, Joel spent much of the time during the fundraiser observing how flirtatious Harper was being with the other men at the event.

She'd always been good in these fundraisers — she'd enjoyed a creditable career in the charity sector before the kids had come along.

But how she interacted with the men here at the event was a perceptible difference from before.

The way she looked at them, the way she spoke with them, the way she carried herself around them. The little smiles, the little touches on the arms, the way she twirled a rogue strand of hair, or fiddled with her silver pendant to draw their eyes to her.

Harper had never been like this before the new guru had come along. She was blossoming into a self-confident, provocative vixen.

And Joel also saw it in the other wives in Myitzu's circle. They were being *coached* to flirt. Coached to *seduce*.

Watching his wife flirting with other men — enjoying how the men looked at her, how they wanted her — made Joel hard as a rock. He just had to be careful he wasn't caught staring.

He suspected all of this was connected with his long-held secret fantasy of sharing his wife with other men. Marriage 2.0 was supposed to tailor their adventures to the couples' sexual preferences and fantasies. But was the program really going to find a way to encourage Harper to open up to new sexual fantasies?

Joel had to stick around for a while after most of the other people went home — Harper was one of the organizers of this event, after all. She had to ensure everything ran smoothly until the last paid guest had gone.

But while he was milling around the bar, watching the staff beginning to break down the empty tables, Harper breezed by on her way to supervise, and said to him, 'Don't have too much to drink, honey.'

He smiled. 'No?'

Harper had never really worried about how much he drank before.

His beautiful wife turned her head briefly and smiled sweetly. 'I'm going to have need of you when we get home!'

Joel felt his manhood stirring at that. He watched her glide across the ballroom in that elegant, flowing, figure-hugging dress and felt warmth inside his body flare up into flames of desire.

Her meaning couldn't have been more apparent: as soon as they got home, Harper would drag him to bed. She didn't want him drunk to the point he couldn't get it up.

'Uh... can I get a glass of water?' he asked the bartender, one of the few staff members still performing the same role he had during the

fundraiser itself.

And then there was Myitzu, appearing at his side so quietly that he hardly saw her arrive. 'I'll have one, too,' she said to the bartender. 'Thank you.'

Then it was just her and Joel. 'How are you, Joel?' she asked.

'Good,' he said, feeling a strange connection to her without really thinking about it. A connection that was stronger than just the fact that she was his wife's new lifestyle guru.

'Excellent,' she nodded, and accepted her glass of ice water from the bartender with a grateful smile. Then she turned to Joel and said quietly, 'You're doing very well for your wife.'

'Thank you. I'm doing my best,' he said.

She said, 'When it comes time to start... thinking outside the box... I know you'll support your wife with whatever she needs.'

It wasn't so much what she said but how she said it. Her tone of voice. The dark look in her eyes. Joel got the distinct sense that the curriculum for Myitzu's particular program of health and wellbeing would involve more than the women simply going down on their husbands a lot, and flirting with guys in the gym.

'I'm open to whatever is best for Harper,' Joel said, feeling a shiver of dark exuberance pass down his spine.

'Good,' the guru nodded, offering him an enigmatic smile.

When they got home after the fundraiser, the kids had long since fallen asleep, carefully watched over by the au pair.

Joel found himself dragged to the bedroom by a gorgeous wife who had been as exhilarated by her full evening of flirting with the donors as he had.

There was no beating around the bush here — Harper pulled him into the bedroom, closed the door behind them, then knelt on the edge of the bed to present her gorgeous behind to him, demanding his cock.

Hauling up her dress, yanking down her panties and hose, telling him, 'Don't mess around. *Please.*'

Joel didn't need time to prepare. He'd been warmed up not only by the little lust-filled comments his wife had made to him whenever she was in earshot during those last minutes wrapping up the fundraiser —

but also because she'd been stroking his erection through his pants during the Uber ride home.

So here he was, pulling down his pants, flopping out his big, hard cock, and directing between her beautifully rounded buttocks.

He slid straight into her, his progress eased by the copious wetness of her slick pussy.

'Oh *God...*' she gasped as he filled her.

As much as he enjoyed it when she sucked his cock, there was nothing quite like squeezing into her beautifully tight sex. Grabbing her shapely rear as he thrust into her, feasting his eyes on her graceful form, her trim curves, her seductive beauty.

There was something, too, about fucking her while she was still in the dress that had made men throughout the fundraiser lust after her all night.

They had all wanted her. But Joel was the one to take her home and fuck her.

'Oh yes... fuck me honey... *fuck me...*'

She came, of course. That was becoming more of a given these days. But when it came to his turn, she preferred Joel to finish in her mouth.

He was happy to oblige, but afterward, when they lay back to recover their breaths, she did mention something about his supply issues.

'What're you talking about?' he protested. 'You basically stopped me from eating any kind of protein except *tofu* — '

'I'm not blaming *you*, honey,' Harper insisted. 'It's only natural when you're being drained so regularly...'

At least there were no problems with Joel getting hard. Back when they'd been trying for baby #2, the pressure had been quite intense, and there had been specific difficulties in that department. Harper had heaped the stress onto her own shoulders — constantly getting upset when it wasn't happening.

Harper wasn't eating right, she didn't want to go out or see other people; she was in a real state. And that just made it even more challenging to get motivated to conceive.

Now, though, Harper and her fellow Malibu moms had *Myitzu*.

It was like having a special wizard in the background using magic spells to keep things exciting.

The guru had been encouraging Harper and her friends to dress provocatively — at all times. When Harper went out for a run, or to the gym for a (public) workout, she wore a sports bra and tight little shorts. When Harper went grocery shopping, to a clothes store, or if she took the kids somewhere, she would wear a little light summer dress that was usually short enough to get into trouble if she bent over.

Myitzu had the women taking regular field trips down to the beach to catch some rays — and flaunt themselves in front of any menfolk who happened by — and they would wear the kind of swimsuits that made guys' eyes pop out and their tongues unfurl.

Even when Harper was at the club, or involved in some kind of fundraising arrangements, she would wear stunning outfits that involved short skirts or dresses and low necklines.

It was all about boosting her self-confidence and the various health benefits that brought with it. It was about looking good — and about being desired.

Joel enjoyed knowing that his wife was going around looking devastatingly hot most of the time. He liked to think about other guys lusting after her. He even hoped some of them might pluck up the courage to hit on her.

If he had a spare moment during a lunch break, or between meetings, Joel might even take a little drive somewhere if he knew Harper was planning on being there. He'd look for her, and then catch a few glimpses of her from afar as she went about her business looking gorgeous.

He didn't get as much time to be a stalker as he liked, though.

But when he got home, and the kids were in bed, Harper also liked dressing up for her husband's personal benefit. Myitzu had been encouraging on that particular front, too.

Gone were the days when a somewhat embarrassed wife might be found — on days that she really, *really* needed sex — naked but covered up by the bedsheets waiting for him to come to her in the dark.

These days, Joel might come out of the shower after a long day at work to find Harper lounging provocatively on the bed in sexy lingerie — complete with garters and stockings.

She might perform a striptease for him, slowly peeling off her clothes while she danced seductively until he was desperate to pull her onto the bed and ravage her.

The Malibu moms had even had lessons in sensual dance and the art of removing clothing in the most erotic ways possible. God. He would

never have thought Harper would, in a million years, agree to *stripper school*.

Harper had dressed up as a sexy nurse for him, as a cheerleader, as Supergirl.

One night she'd even dressed up as a Catholic schoolgirl, complete with a plaid skirt, white blouse, and pigtails — something he would have said would go entirely against his wife's morals if you'd suggested it.

'Isn't this *problematic* — encouraging unhealthy sexual connections...?' he said, half-wondering if this was some kind of test, and that he'd fail if he displayed any sort of arousal.

But Harper had simply grinned wickedly and said, 'Doesn't it get you *hard*, honey? Thinking about me coming home from school and trying to seduce my *classmate*...?'

'I don't know... I mean...' he'd stammered as she flaunted herself in that tiny little plaid skirt, giving him flashes of white cotton panties beneath.

'What?' she said, crawling along the floor toward him. 'You fucked me as a *cheerleader*.'

'Yeah, well, I happen to *like* dressing up as a cheerleader,' he joked.

Harper smiled sweetly and started to unfasten his belt and fly. 'Myitzu said the schoolgirl fantasy is about connecting with the fantasies a guy had when he was first discovering his sexuality.'

'Okay...'

'And about giving you what you wanted when you were in high school or whatever, but probably didn't have the opportunity to get...'

She pulled his cock out, and there was nothing he could do — he was hard as a rock. If this was a test, he'd failed mightily.

But Harper simply beamed with delight and then kissed the tip of his manhood. 'Did you have a girlfriend in high school, honey?'

'Well... *no*...' he said. 'I was a hell of a nerd in high school. But girls in my school never had to wear a *uniform*...'

Whatever. It was hot that she was dressing up for sex — that seemed like the main thing to Joel. That she was being trained in seduction.

And he did get the chance to ask her if she'd had a boyfriend in high school — and unexpectedly, when she admitted she had, it had been quite a turn-on to find out.

'You really want to hear about this stuff?' she asked him. But the state of his cock — pulsing and throbbing in her hands as she confessed to losing her virginity to a surfer during a house party she and a few friends had sneaked into — proved to her that he did want to hear.

‘Did it feel good?’ he asked her.

‘Not the first time,’ she said. ‘But *after* that...’

She smiled, feeling his manhood responding to what she was saying.

‘Well, I didn’t see the guy from my first time again,’ she said, ‘But then there was Steve Dillon... and I dated him for a while...’

She licked Joel’s hardness, amused at how jumpy it seemed to be just now.

‘Now *Steve* had a nice cock,’ she said softly — experimenting with her words. ‘I guess it wasn’t quite as big as yours, honey... but we *were* still teenagers at the time...’

So hot, thinking about the guys who had gotten into Harper’s panties before him. Why was that so hot? But it was, and Harper could tell it was turning her husband on.

She said, ‘We would go into the hills, up Escondido Falls or wherever... and find a nice place away from the trails... and you know...’

‘Tell me...’ he’d insisted as she pumped his shaft in her tight fist.

‘He liked to do it standing up,’ she said before pausing briefly to slip the end of his cock into her mouth. ‘He’d have me up against a boulder, or bent over a fallen tree... he’d pull down my panties and slide inside me...’

‘Mmm...’ Joel groaned.

‘And he’d slip straight inside me,’ she said. ‘I mean, I was so wet... the whole way walking up the trail... looking for the right place... I’d be steadily soaking my panties in anticipation...’

Joel hadn’t lasted long after that.

Harper told him that her next boyfriend in high school had preferred to rub his cock up against her budding breasts, and that was when Joel had totally lost it, spraying his come over her face before she’d managed to get his tip inside her mouth, the rest of his come down her throat.

And so that was how they discovered that Joel liked to hear about guys Harper had been with before him. The schoolgirl outfit had paved the way for that little discovery.

Harper even liked to wear her schoolgirl outfit specifically to prompt stories about guys she’d enjoyed fucking during school and college before she’d settled down. Joel had had no idea she’d been so prolific during her tertiary education.

While Joel had been a nerd during high school and much of college, Harper had been a bit of a *Malibu Barbie*.

Joel had waited until his sophomore year of college before dating someone he could actually call his girlfriend. Harper had had sex with ten guys by that time. Double that number by the time she'd graduated and had first met Joel.

Harper wasn't interested in hearing about Joel's past relationships.

Joel, however, practically became an unofficial biographer of Harper's past conquests.

And it turned out that one in particular still featured in her sexual fantasies. A guy by the name of Mal, who happened to have had the biggest cock she'd ever seen.

EPISODE 4

When Joel had to travel for business, often it was at short notice, and sometimes he wouldn't even know how long it would take.

In the old days, it was never much of an issue. It wasn't as though his absence would make life difficult for the rest of his family. They had the au pair to help with the kids, and so on.

Previously, Harper had never seemed personally concerned whenever he had to suddenly fly away to sort out some production or other halfway around the world. It had got to the point that she wouldn't even feel the need to call him while he was away — he might expect an occasional text message update, but no more.

That had changed since Marriage 2.0 had come into their lives.

When Joel suddenly had to fly out to Milan at short notice because movie production had ground to a halt over 'creative differences' between their director and star, Harper had personally driven her husband to the airport.

And for an added bonus, she had sucked his cock in the airport parking lot on the front seat of the damn car.

'You better not be away for too long,' she told him as he'd pulled his pants back up, wiping her lips with a finger before slipping it into her mouth for good measure.

'I'm sure it won't turn into a big thing,' he said, trying to be reassuring.

'Can't you just send your assistant — what's his name, Danny?' she said, quite serious about it.

Joel gave a regretful shake of the head. 'It needs to be me. The egos involved... we have an auteur director and a diva A-lister... well, they won't deal with an assistant. But you'll be okay.'

'I'll get dry skin.'

‘It rubs the lotion on its skin, or else it gets the hose agin,’ Joel joked. Harper gave him a look. *‘It’s not the same using lotion.’*

He said, ‘I thought the main thing was boosting your self-confidence — you should just go down the gym, find a few weightlifters to hit on you.’

She sighed. ‘You know how horny that makes me. And then I’ll have no one to help me with it.’

Even after a full blow job, Joel felt the tickle of arousal returning to his loins at the thought of his wife getting horny as hell flirting with the guys in the gym. Deep down, he also felt a little flicker of hope that if she was flirting with other men while he was away, she might start getting tempted to take things further.

He gazed at his beautiful wife. Wasn’t it bizarre that the thought of her being wicked with another man made her so much more desirable to him?

At that moment, parked in a quiet part of the LAX parking lot, Joel almost came right out and said to his wife that maybe she should consider a brief, adulterous fling with someone while he was away.

But it was still too soon.

It felt like Harper was edging closer and closer to realizing that Joel’s long-held secret sexual fantasy might be good for them, but he didn’t want to jump too soon. He didn’t want to scare her away from this whole enterprise. When he’d opened up to her about that particular fantasy of his, she’d decided their entire relationship was in trouble.

He leaned over to stroke her cheek. ‘You know you can call me — practically any time.’

‘But you’ll be nine hours behind.’

‘As long as I’m not in a meeting, I won’t mind what time it is when you call.’

She nodded. He could tell it wasn’t a suitable alternative, but she at least accepted that there wasn’t much he could do about it at this stage.

After flying across the Atlantic into a production war zone — feeling a little like Captain Willard going after Colonel Kurtz in *Apocalypse Now* — he was actually being missed by his wife.

After checking into his hotel in Milan, Joel was getting ready to go out to dinner with the talent when Harper called him on FaceTime.

‘You see? I’ve been to the gym already,’ she said, her words corroborated by her skin-tight shorts and crop top. ‘And I’ve come back all worked up — just as I told you I would.’

Joel smiled and sat on the bed with his laptop. He still had a little time to kill before dinner.

He said, 'You look so hot, honey. I bet the guys in the gym couldn't take their eyes off you.'

Harper beamed and started tugging on her gym shorts as though uncertain about how they fit her — but in doing so, showed off her body to her husband via FaceTime.

'They were checking me out, I suppose,' she smiled. 'Does that make you jealous, honey?'

Joel chuckled. 'A little,' he said, offering a white lie to keep her sweet.

Harper was sweeping her hands all over her shorts now, and he could tell she was desperate for something. Would she really do something in front of a webcam with him?

She said, 'I like making you jealous, honey.'

'Yeah?'

She giggled. 'I bet you would have gone crazy in the gym if you were there this morning.'

'Oh yeah? Tell me what happened.'

She said, 'This guy came up to me and said he'd seen me around a lot recently. And he asked me if I wanted to go for a smoothie with him.'

'I bet you wanted a smoothie from him,' Joel joked.

'Mmm... maybe... he was kind of cute...'

Joel was gazing at his screen, astonished at the sight of his wife perched on the edge of their bed at home, stroking her pussy through her gym shorts. Harper. Of all people.

'Maybe,' Joel said, 'If I'm away for a while... you could just ask him if he wants to go with you into the parking lot...'

'I could?'

'And you could... you know... try with him the same kind of thing you did with me in the airport parking lot...'

'Oh, *honey*...'

Her hands now dipped under the waistband of her gym shorts — Joel's eyes widened. Harper was masturbating on a video call with him.

He said softly, soothingly, 'You know... if you just went down on a guy... that wouldn't really be *cheating*, would it?'

'I don't know...' she said, but she was too distracted running her fingers all over her slippery folds to think properly about what Joel was saying.

'I mean, it wouldn't be adultery in the *Biblical* sense...'

Now she pulled her shorts down her thighs, and he could see her slip her fingers inside her soaking pussy.

‘You see how hard I am for you, honey?’ he said, letting his towel fall open as he sat on the hotel bed, showing her his erection.

‘Oh yes...’ she moaned, apparently enjoying the fact that he was now stroking his cock while watching her.

‘I bet those guys at the gym would get so hard for you,’ Joel said. ‘If you took someone into your car for a short while... I bet they’d be firing their thick cream in your mouth in no time at all...’

He’d never really seen her touch herself before. It was *captivating*.

Despite the distance between them, Harper seemed to get off on displaying herself for him, and from his compliments, and the clear desire he showed for her as he watched and stroked his hard cock.

She looked so delicious on camera that he started feeling like a fool for flying off to Europe and leaving her behind.

But as she lay back on the bed and rubbed little circles around her pretty pink pussy, he found he could drop in a few naughty thoughts here and there — and she responded. He could tell her how much this ex or that ex would want her if he could see her now. How hard she would get Mal — for example — if she stripped off for him.

She liked to hear that he was a little jealous of Mal’s big cock — and so, sure, he told her things like that. He wasn’t jealous, particularly, but that was neither here nor there. In reality, he liked the thought of Harper being tempted into an illicit liaison with her well-hung college boyfriend.

But thoughts of her actually cheating on her husband had to be approached very carefully.

He watched his gorgeous wife go onto all fours, pointing her rear end toward him and the camera as she stroked her pussy. He told her again that maybe going down on a guy she met at the gym, at the beach, or someone she met for lunch — wouldn’t be classified as adultery by some.

It wasn’t like a blow job was *real* sex, he murmured to her as she arched her back, pressed her head into the pillows, and cried out as she came on camera. So how could it be seen as *real adultery*?

He was left in an excellent mood when it came time to go out for dinner and discuss the big stand-off on the movie set. And the

positivity in his mindset actually helped with the business at hand.

When he was back at his hotel later close on midnight, he felt the distinct possibility that he wouldn't need to be away from home for too long this time.

But at the same time, he liked the effect his distance had on Harper.

When Joel returned to his hotel, Harper was getting ready for her afternoon tennis session at the club. She texted him pictures to show him what she was wearing — and it was eye-opening how short her skirt was, and how tight her top was.

Too bad he couldn't see how her tennis coach responded to the sight of her wearing such a revealing outfit. Nevertheless, he enjoyed knowing she would be flirting outrageously with the guy.

After a little sleep, Joel was woken in the early morning by Harper's text message stating that she was meeting with her friends and Myitzu for a Girls' Night Out. Once again, he was treated to pictures of her dressing up in a sexy outfit.

Seeing her in such a tight little dress — and thigh-high stockings — was so hot. To think about why she was dressing like that — she certainly wasn't doing it to seduce her husband, since he was thousands of miles away.

Joel was quietly eating breakfast in the hotel bar when Harper sent him a message revealing that Myitzu was taking the Malibu moms group out to a strip club to help distract her from her missing husband.

Joel was somewhat surprised at that one.

It wasn't a gentleman's club that Myitzu was taking them to, however. It was a Magic Mike-style strip club full of women ogling male strippers. Harper sent him photos so he could see what was going on — buff performers stripping down to tiny thongs and the women going crazy for it.

This was full-on spring break, bachelorette party stuff.

Harper texted him a picture that showed the male strippers taking off all their clothes — and walking around the women shaking their big cocks around in the open.

Harper: Feeling a little jealous?

Joel texted her back, dodging her question but stating that he loved knowing she was having so much fun.

Harper sent him more pictures. The women were actually touching the male strippers. It was the kind of stuff that would probably get men thrown out of clubs with female performers. These were ordinary-

looking women, not adult performers planted in the audience. Pawing at the strippers, groping them — even taking hold of their cocks.

Joel felt out of breath, seeing what his wife was texting him.

He had to disappear back to the privacy of his room.

Then Harper texted: *Georgina touched one!*

Joel had to text her back quick. *She touched a stripper?*

Harper: She touched his cock!!

Wow. Joel felt his heart pumping hard. Was there a chance that Harper would be persuaded to touch a stripper's cock like that?

And now here was a video clip taken on Harper's phone — but it couldn't have been taken by Harper herself. Harper was in the picture — sitting on a chair in the middle of an audience of baying women, as she received a lap dance from one of the oiled-up, muscle-bound strippers.

Joel nearly had a heart attack.

His wife was sitting there as a naked guy rubbed himself against her. At first, she looked endearingly freaked out by it all, but then she flashed a nervous smile at Georgina and Helena beside her, took a deep breath, and put her hands on the guy's chiseled abs.

Then as she seemed to become more accustomed to touching him, the stripper took one of Harper's hands and put it onto his big, hard cock.

Harper's fingers closed around the guy's shaft. She started to pump it. Joel nearly came right there and then. His wife was touching another man's manhood. Never in a million years would he have thought she'd do such a thing.

It was only a short clip. If he'd been the suspicious type, he might have imagined Harper being tempted to do more than just stroke the guy's cock.

Then a text message came through from Harper:

Harper: I touched a guy's dick!!

Joel sensed she'd been drinking from her use of exclamation points.

Joel: Amazing! I saw the video clip! So hot I can't believe it!

Harper: You're not mad at me?

Joel: No, definitely not. It was awesome!

Harper: It was so huge!

Joel: Bigger than Mal?

Harper: Maybe. He was pretty cute — are you jealous, honey?

Joel: A little, but nothing I can't handle.

Harper: He was so hard. He told me I really did it for him.

Joel: I'm not surprised. You look so incredible.

Harper: He asked me if I wanted to go back to his hotel.

Joel: That's so unbelievably hot. Are you still at the club?

Harper: Yeah. Everyone's just dancing now. The strippers are in among the crowd, though. I see Georgina with one!

Joel: You should go have some more fun, honey. I love that you're being so naughty. I'm so turned on I'm shaking a little xx

Harper: Oh wow, honey, that's so hot! You're really turned on?

Joel: So hard, my cock's dripping a little.

Harper: God, I love driving you crazy! I can't wait to get you home again, sweetie xx

Joel: Go dance with some strippers!

Harper: Love you xx

A few minutes later, as Joel was trying to calm his heart before he suffered some kind of cardiac arrest, Harper sent a few more pictures through, along with some short video clips.

Joel had been to the usual denomination of strip club before, when forced to take certain clients while attempting to build trust and open their pocketbooks. But the scenes Harper was now sending him looked more like a conventional night club — except that most of the people dancing were women, and the small number of men amongst them were naked muscle-bound hunks.

And there were women making out with these guys, running their hands all over them. Women grabbing the guys' cocks and jacking them to the rhythm of the dance music.

Some women just crouched down and started sucking on their cocks.

Was all of this actually legal in the State of California? It seemed crazy.

Here was a picture of Georgina dancing with a stripper. Running her hands all over him. Next, there was a picture of Jessica with her hands wrapped around a guy's shaft, pumping him roughly.

Joel caught his breath as he saw a clip of Morgan making out with a powerfully-built black guy with a shaven head.

Was Myitzu going to send these images and video clips to the other husbands of the women in her group? Or was it only Joel witnessing this, because Joel and Harper were the ones on the Marriage 2.0 program?

He was pondering this when suddenly he found himself watching a video clip of Harper dancing with a stripper. She had her back to him, but she was moving sensually up against his ripped torso — and the guy had his hand in Harper's top.

The guy was groping her breasts.

The guy was kissing her neck.

Harper was smiling wickedly and letting him do it.

Joel watched, astonished, as the guy's other hand swooped down over her hip — and then dipped between her legs. She was wearing panties, presumably — but was the guy's hand circumventing even them? Was he touching her pussy?

The clip ended.

Joel suddenly felt just how far away from his wife he was at that moment. He felt every one of those six thousand miles. He was shaking with excitement and shivering with fear at the same time.

It was so hot to see his wife misbehaving, yet he had almost zero control over anything.

Here was another clip. He could see Georgina, Helena, Morgan, Jessica. It could only be Myitzu holding the camera, recording the scene. And in the middle of the shot was Harper, her arms slung around the neck of a naked stripper, making out with him as her hands ran all over his washboard stomach.

Joel watched, perching on the edge of the couch in his hotel suite, stunned.

He wasn't even *breathing*.

This was his fantasy, wasn't it? It was what he had been hoping for years would happen. And yet now he was being served everything he had ever wanted — on a silver platter — he was suddenly unsure whether he could handle the reality.

EPISODE 5

Joel was still stuck in Milan, dealing with an auteur director who wanted his movie shot word-for-word, as it was written in the script — while their A-list star wanted to re-interpret his own character as some kind of vegan kung-fu master.

The kung-fu didn't fit with the period drama they were shooting, but the money backing the movie was all behind the A-list star.

But at least while Joel was marooned in his hotel, waiting for one or other of the loggerheads to compromise their artistic vision, he got to appreciate a newly sex-obsessed wife.

Via FaceTime, at least.

Harper was lying on their bed in jeans and a tight gray t-shirt that beautifully showed off her breasts, teasing her husband about one of her ex-boyfriends. This had become one of their things — she liked to remember how it had been before she'd met Joel, how it had been when she'd fucked a ton of guys.

She thought it made her husband jealous, which made her wet.

Joel wasn't exactly jealous, though. He liked hearing about other guys having their wicked way with his beautiful wife.

'He had a big dick. I mean, even when he wasn't hard. *Damn.*'

'You like big dicks, hon?' Joel asked her.

'Uh-huh,' she grinned, her hand clutching at one of her breasts. 'Does that make you mad, sweetie?'

'It's okay. I mean, it's what you like.'

'I guess if I didn't marry you for your dick, sweetie,' she said, then realized she sounded kind of harsh, and apologized profusely, insisting, 'I love your cock, honey, it's perfect...'

'It's okay. I don't mind that you have a thing for big dicks, honey.'

‘I don’t have a *thing*...’ she insisted, then slid a hand down between her thighs and said, ‘Well... maybe an occasional *thing*...’

Her hand slipped inside her jeans, and her eyes closed as her fingers found her sex, her body undulating as she touched herself. Joel loved to see her like this.

She paused to unfasten her jeans and push them down her thighs, saying to him, ‘You’re really okay with me fantasizing about... you know... guys with big dicks?’

Joel said, ‘Sure. What’s the harm? Who you thinking about — Mal?’

Beneath her jeans, she was wearing a gray Calvin Klein thong. She wore thongs all the time now. It was part of her new look, under the guidance of her guru Myitzu. Joel loved it, she looked so hot. And to see her on his laptop screen like this — he felt so lucky to have a wife like this.

‘Mmm... he was so hot...’ she moaned, eyes closed as she stroked her pussy. The soft gray cotton of her thong was already dark between her thighs, she was so wet. ‘Sexy body, too...’

She moved her phone while she stroked herself to offer her husband a closer view of her pussy. Joel stroked his cock while he gazed from between her thighs up her gorgeous frame. It was nearly midnight in Milan — he’d called his wife after yet another failed meeting with the director. Early afternoon in California. He could see daylight coming through the bedroom windows in his view of Harper.

‘Ohhh... I’ll never forget how it felt when he touched me... when he held me... when he slid that huge cock inside me...’

Joel said, ‘I bet he remembers how it was with you, too.’

Harper cried out, squeezing her fingers inside her pussy, her body writhing on the bed, her breathing heavy panting.

‘You ever check him out on Facebook?’ Joel asked her. ‘I bet he follows you. I bet he wishes he could see you again...’

She cried out, stabbing her pussy with two fingers, pushing up her hips as she fucked herself on the bed, imagining another man’s hard cock.

‘I bet he sometimes fantasizes about being with you again,’ Joel said, loving how she responded to his words. ‘I bet he wishes he could slide his big cock inside you all over again...’

Then she was shuddering and shaking like an earthquake was going on, gasping for breath and squealing as her orgasm hit.

She was surprised he didn’t come yet, but he said he wanted to think about her more. He wanted to enjoy the sexual thoughts he had about her

for a while longer. If he came, his sexual appetite would wane, and he would waste the opportunity.

She smiled, wiping a dribble of sweat from her brow, and said, 'I can't believe you make me think about another guy while I... you know... *touch myself*...'

'What's the problem?' Joel chuckled.

'You're so bad,' she said. Then she added, 'I love it when you're jealous.'

'It's not so much about being *jealous*...' Joel tried to explain. He got the sense she wouldn't understand how he really felt.

'You know you're so much better looking than he is?' she said, trying to make him feel good.

'Apart from his 'sexy body'?' Joel reminded her of her words.

'He's not as handsome as you,' she said, blushing.

'But he's got a bigger cock.'

'Well, you know that. That's not your fault. Here... I'll find a picture of him. Then you won't feel so threatened...'

She leaned into his view of her — reaching to take her phone from its stand. He watched her tapping away at the screen for a while.

'You have a *picture* of him?'

'No — but he's on Facebook, right? I'll show you... maybe it'll drive you crazy...'

After a minute or two, her face brightened into a smile. 'Here we are. Oh hey — look, there's a picture of the two of us in college. God, he's *married*. How does his wife let him have a picture on Facebook of him with me?'

'Maybe she's like me,' Joel joked. 'She doesn't mind the thought of her husband when he dated other people.'

'Here...' Harper said, concentrating. 'I'll send you this one...'

Then suddenly, she looked confused.

Then horrified.

Her eyes widened, and she looked into the camera at her husband. 'I accidentally hit the '*like*' button,' she whispered.

Joel said, 'You liked one of his posts?'

'I liked the picture of him and me together.'

'Can't you 'unlike' it?'

'Oh Jesus, that would be even *worse*...' she said. 'He's gonna get an email telling him I liked his photo. *This* photo. Then if it tells him I *unliked* it...'

She groaned, and not in a good way.

‘Maybe he doesn’t have those notifications sent to him,’ Joel suggested.

Harper shook her head. ‘I bet he does.’

A moment later, Joel nearly jumped out of his skin as his wife suddenly squealed — shrill and loud.

‘He just liked *all* my photos,’ she said.

‘No big deal,’ Joel said. Why was he enjoying this so much?

‘Like... right after I accidentally liked his photo.’

‘He doesn’t know you did it accidentally. And it’s a photo of him *and* you.’

‘So what do I do?’

Joel felt his heart pumping hard. He said, ‘Like some more of his photos back.’

‘You’re *kidding*.’

‘What’s the harm?’ Joel laughed. ‘He knows you were stalking him — and he obviously doesn’t mind, because he liked all your photos back. So now you like the rest of his photos, you’re saying hey, just catching up.’

‘Just catching up?’

‘People like to catch up, don’t they? I mean... how did you guys leave it? Did you dump him, or did he dump you?’

‘I can’t really remember. We just kind of... moved on.’

‘So, no hard feelings.’

‘Okay...’

Joel continued to stroke his hard cock as he watched his wife focusing on her phone as she messed around with the Facebook account of one of her favorite ex-boyfriends. Maybe his advice wasn’t as entirely innocent as he was making it out to be to her. But she deserved a little more attention. According to her new guru, she *required* it.

There was a brief pause as Harper finished what she was doing and sat back for a moment. Joel quietly admired her breasts in that t-shirt.

Then Harper suddenly gasped.

‘What is it?’

She said, ‘He just messaged me. Hey, *how are you? Still in the LA area? Wanna come to a party tonight?*’

Joel felt a little explosion of pure heat inside his chest.

‘Friendly,’ he said.

‘He’s just that kind of guy, I guess. Probably didn’t even look to see if I’m married.’

Joel took a deep breath and, trying ferociously to seem calm — not like a man desperately hoping his wife might actually step closer to fulfilling his long-held sexual fantasy — said, ‘You should go.’

‘*What?*’ Harper said, somehow managing to turn the word into three syllables.

Joel shrugged and said gently, ‘You’d probably have fun. You know, catch up after all this time.’

‘What if he wants more than that?’

‘You said he’s married, too, right? It’s probably just a birthday party for his kid. He needs to bulk up the numbers.’

‘Even so. It’s suspicious.’

Joel chuckled. ‘You’re the one who liked his photo first.’

‘*Accidentally.*’

‘So what else are you going to do tonight?’

‘Myitzu wants me to go out.’

‘Out where?’

‘I don’t know. Anywhere. She says I can’t stop the program just because my husband’s away.’

‘She’s right. I have more meetings in the morning... I’m going to be tied up... You might as well go to a *party*. You can leave if you hate it.’

‘I guess.’

‘Take Myitzu with you.’

‘Maybe.’

Joel was woken painfully early by Harper calling him on FaceTime.

‘Hey,’ he said, sleepily rolling over to look at the alarm clock.

It said 5am.

‘Hey,’ Harper said, sounding lively and clear as a bell. It would be... about 8pm in Malibu just then.

‘What’re you up to?’

‘Myitzu and I are going to this party.’

Joel sat straight up at that.

On his laptop, which still lay beside him on the enormous hotel bed, he saw Harper in their en suite, standing in front of the mirror wearing a bright, crisp white t-shirt and pale blue jeans.

‘You’re going to *Mal’s* party?’ he asked.

‘Sure,’ she shrugged and started removing her jeans. ‘Myitzu already knew all about it, so I could hardly deny it. Did *you* tell her about it?’

‘I was *asleep*.’

‘Well, it was all over Facebook, I guess. So she’s going to go with me to it — and I don’t have a choice.’

‘You’ll have fun,’ he said, staring at the sight of her as she removed her t-shirt to reveal that she hadn’t been wearing a bra.

‘Probably won’t stay too long anyway,’ she said, and now she was slipping off her white cotton panties.

‘It’ll be great,’ Joel said, trying to be encouraging. ‘You’ll see Mal... he’ll feel awful about ending things with you...’

‘Myitzu said the same thing.’

He watched his beautiful wife put on the tiniest little scarlet lace g-string, then stand to look at herself in the mirror. She fluffed her long, dark hair and smiled at her reflection, and Joel felt a shiver of excitement run down his spine.

‘You’re wearing *lingerie*?’ he asked as she put on a matching scarlet lace bra.

‘Myitzu’s orders,’ she said. ‘We went out shopping this afternoon.’

Now she was putting on a scarlet lacy *garter belt*.

‘I thought you weren’t planning on staying long at the party?’ he said.

Harper smiled at him via the webcam. ‘Are you getting a little *jealous*, honey?’

He caught the sense that she was doing this to make him jealous, more than because she actively wanted to see Mal. Or perhaps he sensed that this was how Myitzu had sold the idea to her. *This will make your husband so jealous. Don’t you want that?*

But Myitzu knew Joel wouldn’t be jealous of his wife going to a party to see her favorite ex. The guru knew he secretly fantasized about Harper fooling around with another guy.

Now Harper sat down on the little white leather chair and started putting on thigh-high stockings.

She looked stunning.

She stood to connect them up to the garters, making sure her husband had a good view of her doing so.

‘Are you accidentally going to let Mal see that you’re wearing stockings?’ Joel asked her.

Harper gave him a cryptic smile. ‘It’s just a party, honey. I just want to feel good about myself while I’m there...’

He watched her put on a dress that was so tight you could see almost everything. And then she was telling him Myitzu was waiting for her, that she couldn't delay.

Then, with a blown kiss, she was gone.

A touch more than two hours later, Joel was woken by a text message from Harper.

Harper: Hey! We're going to stay longer at the party. Did you get some sleep? Xx

Joel groaned at the weariness that made his joints ache — and yet, he was pleased that she'd messaged him to let him know she was having a good time at the party.

Joel: A little sleep. Thankfully I don't have another meeting for three more hours. So you're having fun at the party?

Harper: It was a little weird at first. Especially when I found out Mal just got divorced.

Joel: Divorced?

Well, hello, Mr. Erection.

Joel felt his pulse quicken at the thought that his wife was at a party with an ex she'd been fantasizing about for years — and he was *newly* available.

Harper: He said it was kind of amicable. He and his wife had an open marriage, and it just got more and more open until it wasn't much of a marriage.

Joel: Too bad, I guess. I bet he wishes he could be with you now, huh?

Joel waited, but there was no reply to that text. At first, he thought she must have been busy talking to somebody, or getting a fresh drink or something. Then the longer his text message went without a reply, the more he started worrying that he'd somehow offended his wife.

After another hour, he texted her to ask if she was okay. He was about to attempt to formulate some kind of apology, though he didn't think his previous message was too forward.

But then Harper suddenly texted back:

Harper: Sorry. Talking to Mal. I guess it is fun to see him again. He's being quite flirtatious.

Joel felt his heart flutter and his manhood swell.

Suddenly he felt real regret that he was thousands of miles away from his wife. He texted her again.

Joel: Is he the same as you remember?

Harper: He's a lot better looking. He's aged well in the last few years. Says he's been working out a lot. Oh, are you jealous, my darling? ;-)

Joel: Only a little ;-) I'm glad you're having fun with him. Just wish I wasn't so far away xx

Harper: He wants me to dance with him. Would that be okay?

Joel: Of course :-) Have fun xx

Half an hour went by. Joel went down to have breakfast at the hotel bar, but didn't stop monitoring his phone for a minute. He was going crazy thinking about his wife dancing with her old flame.

He was fed and back in his room when Harper's next text came through.

Harper: He was touching me a little while we were dancing... I guess we got a little too close.

Joel's erection was back to full force. He texted his wife back:

Joel: Did you like it?

Harper: It's so weird, because it feels just like old times. Like, I know how it is to be with him, so I feel completely comfortable with him. And so I guess it's a little too easy to just go along with it.

Joel: Do you want to go along with it?

Harper: Maybe.

Joel felt his stiff cock throbbing inside his pants. Thinking, wow. Would she really go through with something like this? Getting something on with her old flame?

Well, she'd touched a guy's cock — albeit briefly — at that strip club Myitzu had taken them all to.

But then Harper texted:

Harper: I'm sorry. I should leave.

Joel sighed. He wanted to just text or call and tell her she could do whatever she wanted with Mal, or whoever. But at the same time, he didn't want to scare her off.

This was still Harper. She'd been a wild child in high school and college, but she'd become very strait-laced since then.

When he had told Harper of his fantasy to share her with other men, she'd declared that their marriage was in trouble.

He needed to go carefully.

He texted her back:

Joel: You don't have to leave.

There was a long pause. Harper texted back:

Harper: What are you saying?

Joel took a deep breath.

Joel: I'm okay with you dancing with Mal. I want you to have fun.

Harper: Really?

Joel: Unless you really want to go home right now.

Harper: I am having fun. I just don't want things to go too far.

Joel sat on his bed and gazed around his hotel room, wondering whether he really wanted his wife to do something with her ex. Because he got the distinct sense that if he said the right thing to her, there was a genuine possibility that she would.

He texted her back:

Joel: You know Mal. You're comfortable with him. You can tell him to go slow if things start going too far. Or that it's getting late, and you could pick things up with him again another day.

Harper: I suppose so. He's gonna be mad at me. He'll probably say I've been leading him on all night.

Then an idea came to Joel. He felt his erection twitch. Was he really going to suggest it to her?

He texted her:

Joel: Maybe you should give him something small, so he feels like he's had a successful night — only something that won't make you feel like you've gone too far.

There was another long pause. He could tell Harper was thinking carefully about what he was suggesting.

Harper: Something small? Like what?

Joel: You could kiss him.

Harper: Seriously?!

Joel was suddenly terrified that he had been the one who had gone too far. And that Harper would snap out of this, and start accusing him of trying to manipulate her. Shit. He should have quit while he was ahead. He should have encouraged her to go home after dancing with Mal.

But then Harper sent another message:

Harper: You would really let your wife make out with her gorgeous ex-boyfriend?

Joel felt like he'd never been this turned on before. He texted her back:

Joel: I would. But you have to tell me everything that happens.

Then she texted back:

Harper: I will. Love you xx

And Joel nearly came without even touching himself.

He had to get dressed, and head out for the start of the day's meetings knowing that his wife was dressed up like a Playboy centerfold, going out to a party to see the ex who had plagued her sexual fantasies ever since they'd been together.

It actually put a spring in his step.

In fact, it made him think more black-and-white about everything that was going on over there. It made him suddenly care very little for the problems of a film set thousands of miles away from home.

He wanted to go home.

In the day's first meeting, he told their director that this was a creative endeavor, and that other people involved in the project were also creative, not just the director. He said actors had to interpret their roles; that was their job.

He said that if the director could not work with at least some of the A-list actor's suggestions, he would be fired. And when he was fired, the rumor would go around Hollywood like wildfire that he was a Difficult Person To Work With.

And that could be enough to end his career — at least in Hollywood.

After lunch, he met with the A-list actor and his people. Joel told the actor that the director would start to take on board some of his suggestions for the character. But, if he persisted with this ludicrous notion of turning him into a kung-fu master, he would be sued for damages in court.

'You signed on to do a costume drama set in Nineteenth-Century Italy,' he told the star of the movie. 'If you refuse to do the movie, we'll *bankrupt* you.'

Then he was in a car on the way to the airport.

Before his plane was even in the sky, he'd received the message that film production was getting underway again.

EPISODE 6

Joel hadn't heard from his wife in six hours.

He was at the airport in Milan, waiting for his afternoon flight back to the United States. He was so looking forward to getting home and seeing Harper again.

But what had happened since he had heard from his wife last?

She'd been at a party, invited by her ex-boyfriend Mal. Mal was newly divorced, and available. He was also well-hung and had featured in Harper's sexual fantasies since shortly after they'd finished dating in college.

And Joel had told his wife explicitly that if she wanted to make out with him, she could.

Since then, she hadn't sent him a single text message.

Joel was shaking a little with nerves. What had happened? Had she been dancing with Mal at the party? Did he make a move on her? Did she do as Joel had suggested, and let him kiss her so he'd have something good to remember about the party — instead of outright rejection?

Why hadn't Harper messaged her husband if she had kissed her handsome ex-boyfriend? She had promised to tell him what had happened.

Joel texted her a simple 'good morning.' It would be about 5.30am over there on the West Coast.

He had to wait for a reply — well, Harper had had a big night; she'd had a lot to drink, of course she wouldn't wake up too early.

He was getting on the plane an hour after texting her when she shot back a quick 'hey.'

Then:

Harper: I just woke up.

Joel found his seat and buckled up before joining the conversation.

Joel: How you feeling?

Harper: Not bad — no hangover, surprisingly.

Joel: Wow, that's lucky. Sounds like you had a fair amount to drink last night.

Harper: God. Mal broke out the tequila. Just like old times.

Joel: Where are you now?

Harper: Uh... still at Mal's.

Joel: The party's still going?

Harper: Not exactly.

Joel felt his manhood thicken up all the way. Harper had stayed at Mal's place after the party had ended? Had anything happened between the two of them?

There was a long pause. Joel didn't quite know what to say to Harper. The trouble was, his brain was being commandeered by his throbbing erection, and his only real thought was whether his wife had actually slept with another man.

But he didn't want to come straight out and ask her — either because it might seem like he was suspicious, jealous, or both.

And he didn't want to scare her away from the possibility if she *hadn't* slept with Mal.

Then Harper texted again:

Harper: Actually, there is something I need to tell you.

Joel felt his stomach churn, and his heart skip a beat. Something had happened. What had she done? What was she going to say?

His finger was shaking a little as he tried to tap out a reply.

Joel: What happened?

His thoughts were inevitably going to a dark place, seeking out the worst possible outcome in order to prepare and protect himself from the most awful news.

Had she slept with Mal and decided to leave her husband for him?

Surely it couldn't happen that quickly?

Harper said: So... we were doing tequila shots... and you know how alcohol gets me...

Joel: I do.

Harper: I kissed him, since you said it would be okay.

Joel: So you did it?

Harper: Yeah, I did.

Joel: So what's the problem? I said you could. That's so hot that you did it. Was it good?

Harper: It was good. But that wasn't all that happened.

Joel caught his breath as his eyes took in the words in her message. Had she really done something significant with her ex-boyfriend last night?

'Uh... scusi.'

Joel looked up to see a 50-something woman wanting to get by him to sit in the window seat. He groaned silently — as per always, he'd been hoping that nobody else would be sitting in his row. Well, serves him right for not springing for business class tickets as part of his constant efforts to keep costs down.

He stood and shifted out into the aisle to let the woman by.

Her eyes widened as he stood up — and he saw she was glancing downward. She'd noticed his rather prominent bulge.

The woman was blushing when she sat down in her seat. Joel didn't care that much. It wasn't a long flight to Heathrow before the change to LAX.

Joel texted his wife:

Joel: Tell me what happened.

Harper: Everyone else had gone, and I was helping him clear up, and then we had a few more drinks, and he thanked me for helping him clear up, and then he kissed me again.

Joel: Sounds like fun.

Harper: And then he brought out this bottle of really nice tequila — like the stuff that's actually good to drink. And he was telling me how good I looked, and how much he'd been thinking about me since he got divorced.

Joel: I bet he wishes he never broke up with you :-)

Harper: I started telling him all about this new program we're on with Myitzu, and about how I'm supposed to flirt with lots of guys to build my confidence, and I'm supposed to go down on you as often as possible, and... anyway we got to talking about the nutritional benefits of semen...

Joel: As you do, that time of night.

Joel found himself smiling, feeling light-hearted. He was hoping his wife was about to confess to cheating on him. How ridiculous was that? And yet the thought of her bowing to temptation and bedding her hot ex-boyfriend was just too hot.

He had to sit differently so the bulge between his legs wouldn't be so prominent.

Harper: And I was telling him how unfair it was that you were away in Italy, so I didn't get to have my usual fix for, like, ages...

Joel: So what happened?

Harper: He said maybe I needed a backup. You know, for when the starting quarterback is unavailable...

Joel: I take it he volunteered?

Harper: I'd had so much to drink... and I remember how you were when I told you I touched that guy's dick in the strip bar...

Joel: So you went down on him?

Harper: Are you mad at me?

Joel: I'm incredibly turned on, sweetheart.

Harper: You are?

Joel: I'm sitting on a plane with the biggest hard-on.

Harper: Mmm I wish I was sitting with you ;-)

Joel: Tell me what you did with him.

Harper: We were making out a lot. And drinking tequila. And talking. And after I told him about my new diet... he suggested maybe he could step in whenever you were "ineligible."

Joel: Let me guess, he's a big sports fan.

Harper: Played football in college before his ACL blew out. I said you'd told me I could make out with him if I wanted, but nothing more. He said he hadn't had sex in a month, he probably had a ton of come for me if I wanted.

Joel: I bet that was tempting ;-)

Harper: Then we were talking about whether oral sex was cheating or not.

Joel: And he said it wasn't?

Harper: We were lying on the couch together and making out, and his hands were on my chest, and it felt so good, and then I brushed my hand over his crotch and felt how hard he was.

Joel: So hot, honey.

Harper: And he told me I could touch it if I wanted. He said it would be all right because of what happened at the strip club. So I helped him take his pants off, and his cock was so huge, and so hard. I started stroking him.

God, the thought of his wife lying on a couch with a guy who had no pants on, stroking his huge, hard cock made Joel crazy. He was strapped into his airplane seat — there was no release for him. He couldn't run to the toilet.

Joel: Then you went down on him?

Harper: It was so beautiful. And it suddenly seemed like ages since I last had you in my mouth.

Joel: Just a few days, honey.

Harper: And he told me you'd said I could kiss him, but you'd never said where.

That was true enough. Mal was more clever than Joel had given him credit for.

Harper: So I kissed it a few times. And it was so hard in my hands. I gave it a little lick.... And then I put it in my mouth...

And now the flight attendant was telling him to put it away so they could take off, and for a brief moment, Joel thought she was talking to the hard-on that was tenting his pants — but of course, she meant his mobile.

He had to send Harper a quick note warning her that he would be out of contact for a little while during take-off.

Joel had to wait half an hour before he could link his phone up to the onboard Wi-Fi and reconnect with Harper.

Harper: Are you there, honey?

Harper: Are you mad at me?

Joel: I'm back. Of course I'm not mad at you. I'm so turned on, sweetie. Thinking about you taking him in your mouth.

Harper: I wasn't thinking too much about anything at that point. I just wanted to make him come. I wanted him to come in my mouth. He told me it felt really good — better than when we were together. Better than his wife. Better than anyone he could remember.

Joel: You've picked up some skills. Did you enjoy it?

Harper: I was so wet. It was so weird, because it wasn't you. And because it was so big, so different.

Joel: But you've been with him before.

Harper: I wasn't with him all that long. I remember how it was, but I never had the kind of familiarity I have with you, my darling.

Joel: So you made him come?

Harper: He didn't last long. But he was telling the truth about not having sex for ages — when he started coming in my mouth, it was, like, gallons. I was swallowing, couldn't keep up.

Joel: I wish I could have seen you.

Harper: Seriously?

It was one of the most enjoyable flights he'd taken — and as he did, time flew by.

Getting Harper to talk about making out with — and going down on — her fantasy ex-boyfriend. She was lying in bed at their house in Malibu early in the morning, touching herself as she texted her husband about her nocturnal wickedness.

Joel kept her going until she made herself come. Then it wasn't long before his plane was making the descent into London.

That first leg of the journey was two hours long, though it felt like less than half that time.

After that, he was on an 11-hour flight from Heathrow to Los Angeles. As he flew, Harper sent him little updates throughout her day.

Mid-morning, she had coffee with her little group of Malibu MILFs, and the truth about her and Mal came straight out over iced brown sugar oatmilk shaken espressos.

It turned out that some of Harper's friends had been toying with the idea of expanding their menus beyond their husbands. But only Jessica and Morgan felt they had any hope of their husbands being on board like Joel.

Their suggestion for Harper, though, was that she should now take full advantage of her apparent 'freedom' and start harvesting come from as many ex-boyfriends, gym friends, tennis coaches, or pool boys as she could get hold of.

That thought amused Joel no end as his flight progressed back across the Atlantic.

During her afternoon, Harper was tied up with meetings for her fundraising activities before the kids got home from school.

But that evening, she texted her husband to let him know she was going to the gym.

So while Joel's plane flew over Wyoming, Utah, and Nevada, he was enjoying more updates from Harper, letting him know she was having a lovely time flirting with guys during her workout.

Some of the machines she was using, she could text him while exercising at the same time. She told him which guys there she liked, she flirted and let him know what happened — or sent him selfies, even some with the guys themselves.

Joel, for his part, texted her back to tell her how amazing she looked, and how turned on he was when she was flirting with other guys.

Then, toward the end of her workout, she started telling him which guys in the gym she'd give blowjobs to if she ever started getting desperate again.

At first, Joel sent half-joking texts back, saying she already had Mal for if she got desperate.

But as she started fantasizing about taking guys out into the parking lot after her workout, he sent her a serious message:

Joel: Honey, you know I'd be okay with it if you really did want to take things to the next level with any of them.

There was a pause after he sent that. He wondered if it had gotten through — the plane was beginning to descend by then, so perhaps the flight attendants would turn off the Wi-Fi at some point.

Then Harper sent a message:

Harper: Are you being serious, hon?

Joel had another one of those moments where he wished he could remind Harper of the time he'd revealed his long-held secret fantasy was to share her with other men.

But she had either forgotten that, or blocked it from her mind.

Now, this was about taking her step by step toward his fantasy, if she was willing to go there. And if he did things carefully enough, she might be willing to go there.

He texted her back:

Joel: I'm serious, sweetie. I wouldn't have a problem with you having a little fun with the guys you like from the gym. Just so long as you tell me about it afterward.

Harper: It would actually turn you on if I took one of these guys out to my car and sucked his cock?

Joel felt his heart thumping in his chest again. His erection was back in force, too. Nervous, but staunchly aroused.

What if she was grossed out by the thought of going down on random guys from the gym? What if she'd been testing him? What if she suddenly returned to the view that he couldn't love her properly if he was willing to let other guys do filthy things with her?

But Joel felt a new confidence. This was all part of the Marriage 2.0 program, wasn't it? Somehow, Harper's guru, who had started this whole new approach for her, was part of Marriage 2.0. So how could it damage his marriage?

He texted her back:

Joel: It would be seriously hot, honey. But only if you wanted to do it
xx

There was another long pause.

What was she doing? Was she upset with him now? Had she decided not to talk to him anymore? Or had the communication channels been cut?

Then came the overhead announcement: "The Captain has switched on the seatbelt signs, so would all passengers please return to their seats and prepare for landing."

Joel groaned. This was a bad time to be required to switch off his phone. He hid his phone and kept it on for as long as he could manage.

Then, at last, came Harper's text message:

Harper: I love you so much, honey. You are the best husband anyone could ever have. See you v soon xxx

It was 9pm local time when he got through passport control and picked up his luggage.

Then there was Harper waiting for him in arrivals, looking to Joel like the most beautiful woman alive. And her beauty was only heightened as her eyes connected with his, and the brightest of smiles spread across her pretty face.

He ran to her. They kissed.

He breathed her in and sucked on her lips, and as she kissed him back, deeply, so happy he had finally returned to her, he detected a certain unfamiliarity about her kiss.

'Did you...?' he asked her.

She nodded and blushed. 'Uh-huh. Just before driving here.'

Joel's eyes widened. '*Seriously?*'

She grinned. 'Uh-huh.'

Then he was kissing her mouth, knowing that the unusual scent on her face, the slight hint of something different in the flavor of her kiss

was because she'd just been using her mouth to pleasure one of the guys she liked from the gym.

What a strange thrill to know that Harper had been going down on other men.

'Come on,' she said, taking his suitcase from him. 'I need to get you home *right now* — I am so completely and utterly horny, you wouldn't believe it.'

Joel didn't need telling twice.

EPISODE 7

Joel stood in the doorway to the kids' room, monitoring the situation as the children got ready for bed.

As usual, at a time like this, his attention was split between the kids — who were old enough to get themselves sorted out for bed these days — and what was happening downstairs.

From his vantage point in the kids' bedroom doorway, he could just see down the stairs to the front door.

And what he could see was Harper — wearing tight leggings and a simple tank top that nevertheless magnificently highlighted her cleavage — open the front door to her ex-boyfriend, Mal.

'What's mom doing?' came the usual questions from the kids.

'She has a meeting, that's all,' Joel explained, as he always did.

'Another one? Who is she meeting?'

'Her therapist.'

'I thought she had her therapy on Thursday afternoons.'

'Well, this is another kind of therapy. Supplemental.'

'Why does she need it?'

'It keeps her happy. And we all want mommy to be happy, don't we?'

This whole thing had become a regular occurrence. It happened three or four times a week these days. Mal would stop by to see Harper on his way home.

It wasn't dating — he would only stick around for an hour or so — but both Mal and Harper seemed to enjoy it. Joel kept out of their way while Mal was here.

Usually, he spent the time with the kids as they got ready for bed. Making sure they brushed their teeth properly, reading them a story before lights out.

They were always curious about what mommy was up to, even though he always told them it was nothing to worry about. He could hardly tell them the sordid details of what was going on. Therapy was as close as he could get to describing what was happening.

Mommy saw her therapist for a short while, and after her session with him, she felt better.

And the kids could hardly disagree that mommy did seem particularly cheerful and content with life these days. She was rarely, if ever, in a bad mood.

Joel had to admit he was rarely in a bad mood, either.

How could he not? His very respectable, genteel, prim wife had reconnected with her inner college girl — and it turned out that she had been something of a promiscuous girl in college.

So here it was, every few days, she welcomed her ex-boyfriend into her home for a short while, then quietly closed the two of them in the privacy of the study. And there, in front of a cozy log fire, Harper would go down on her knees and suck her ex-boyfriend's massive cock.

It was an arrangement that seemed to suit everyone involved down to the ground. Mal didn't mind taking a little time out of his usual commute every few days to stop at the house of a beautiful woman who wanted to summarily drain his balls.

Harper got the usual boost to her self-confidence from servicing her old flame — and perhaps also a little sexual thrill from the wickedness of fellating a man who was not her husband. Most of all, she was happy to receive the nutritional benefits of Mal's production, which apparently was of a volume and quality that never disappointed.

And Joel was given the gift of a happy wife who regularly fulfilled at least part of his long-harbored sexual fantasy of sharing her with other men.

He felt such a buzz from watching Harper greet Mal at the front door, and invite him in. From knowing the guy was here, inside their house. Sitting in the study while Harper knelt in front of him, bobbing her head down on his hard cock.

He liked knowing that Harper was enjoying the cock of a man she had fantasized about since she had briefly dated him in college.

After tucking up the kids, he would get changed into his gym gear and go into the basement to work out. He didn't need to work out in public like Harper did these days. Harper liked to flirt with the guys at the gym, but Joel was all in it for the exercise. And when he could divert his attention to the thought of his beautiful wife being wicked with

another man's big, hard cock, he could completely forget about the burn of the exercise itself. It was better than listening to loud music during your workout.

After his gym session, he would head back upstairs and take a leisurely hot shower, using exclusively scent-free products.

Invariably, when he finally got out of the shower and dried off with a thick, warm towel, Harper would come into the bedroom after her visit with Mal — looking the very essence of desirable.

'You had a nice time?' he would always ask, as though her bright, shining smile hadn't told him everything already.

'Of course,' she would say, striding toward her naked husband, the sexual need in her eyes so clear.

And these days, Joel wouldn't need to ask her exactly what had happened during her meeting with Mal.

They would just kiss deeply, and he would smell the other man's scent on her face and her body, he'd taste the faint lingering hint of another man's come on her breath, on her lips, on her tongue.

They would kiss, and Joel would be thrilled at her for taking another man in her mouth and her hands. For making him hard and making him moan and making him gasp and making him come.

They would kiss, and Harper would be thrilled at her husband for wanting her so badly, for not only allowing her to enjoy regular oral sex with another man — but for actively enjoying it. Her hands would quickly find their way to his own hard cock. She would feel the exhilaration rippling through her entire body from grasping his stiff shaft, of beholding the incontrovertible proof that her husband was turned on by her, and by her naughty little meetings with Mal.

Tonight, though, as Harper started to pump her husband's hard cock, and Joel started nibbling her neck and fondling her gorgeous breasts, she diverted somewhat from the usual script.

She said, 'He said he wants to sleep with me.'

Joel's eyes widened. 'That's what he said?'

'Uh-huh.'

'He wants to spend the night with you?'

'He wants to *fuck* me.'

Joel slid his hand down beneath the waistband of his wife's leggings — and inside her panties. She was soaking wet, which wasn't unusual after one of her evening sessions sucking Mal's cock — but tonight, she was positively drenched.

‘You’re so wet,’ he said, in awe, his fingers slipping inside her oily folds. ‘You want to, don’t you? You want to fuck him.’

Harper’s eyes flashed. ‘It seemed like he wasn’t giving me a choice,’ she said. ‘I guess... all these evenings... it’s been driving him crazy.’

As he touched her, she turned, so her back was against his chest, her behind pressing against his hard cock.

‘So if he doesn’t get to fuck you...?’

‘I guess he’ll stop giving me his come.’

Joel kissed her beneath the ear. ‘You wouldn’t want that, would you?’

‘He’s a good supplier,’ she said, one hand reaching behind herself to find his hardness again.

Joel breathed deeply, trying to keep calm. He didn’t want to seem too eager in case she was reminded of why they started this whole Marriage 2.0 in the first place. He didn’t want her to feel like she’d been manipulated into complying with his original fantasy.

‘So you’d wanna do it?’ he asked her.

‘Would it be too much of a deal breaker?’

He could feel her pussy clamping on his fingers, squeezing them as he thrust them into her. She really wanted this. She wanted Mal. How things had changed.

Harper said, ‘Nobody would know, would they?’

‘I guess not.’

‘I mean, I already see him a few nights a week. Nobody knows that.’

‘That’s right.’

‘I already... take him inside my mouth...’

She turned, her hand working on his concrete-hard shaft, and gave him a knowing smile — knowing that he was hard at the thought of her taking things with Mal to the next level.

‘That would be crossing another boundary,’ he said to her, his hand moving to her breasts, to fondle her warm, pleasingly rounded flesh through her thin top.

‘It would.’

‘I think I’d have to set certain... conditions,’ Joel said, slipping the straps of her top off her shoulders. Exposing her breasts.

‘Like what?’

He cupped her breasts. Squeezed her stiff nipples.

‘I think I’d have to see it myself,’ he said.

Her eyes found his, her mouth opening in surprise. ‘You’d want to... *watch?*’

‘I think I’d have to,’ he said, his hand sliding down her stomach, into her panties again. Taking hold of her pussy as though he was claiming ownership.

Harper said, ‘I’ll tell him.’

‘You do that,’ he said, turning her to face the bed before pulling down her leggings.

Harper put her hands on the mattress, bending over the bed, letting her husband drag her leggings and her panties down her thighs. She was so wet when he thrust his hardness inside her, he slid straight in, up to the hilt.

As was often the case after she’d spent time sucking another man’s cock, she came incredibly quickly as he held her waist and pounded into her. However, Joel did not synchronize his own climax with hers.

Instead, he waited until she was done, until she was ready to take him in her mouth — kneeling on the floor beneath him, gazing up at him as she stretched her lips eagerly around his girth.

God, she made him feel good. Practice makes perfect, and all that. Gazing down into her beautiful brown eyes as she took him in her talented mouth.

Practice makes perfect. She’d been getting a lot of practice with Mal recently.

There were so many benefits from allowing your wife to shake off the shackles of monogamy. Why wouldn’t a husband want his wife to have as much freedom as she desired regarding sex?

There were negotiations, although if you’d asked Joel straight up, he would have accepted anything.

He just wanted to experience the strange pleasure that was sharing his wife.

But he started high, with the demand to watch. Mal wasn’t comfortable with the idea of him being there, so offered to send him pictures.

And the compromise came in at live video.

The au pair took the kids to stay with their grandparents for the night. This wasn’t so unusual for them by now. They often had sleepovers at their grandparents’ house.

It was even understood that while they were away, Joel and Harper would be enjoying date night together.

What they didn't tell anybody was that Joel would be enjoying Harper's date night with Mal.

That night, Joel stayed home while Harper checked into the hotel. It was better that way, they'd decided. Harper could have a little space to get ready for her date, and Joel could stay in the comfort of familiar surroundings during that nervous part of the evening.

When she got to the hotel, though, Harper called her husband so that he could keep her company while she prepared herself for her evening out.

This was just a dream come true for Joel. He could spend time on a video call with Harper as she made herself all beautiful for another man to enjoy. She took a shower, shaved her legs — and her pussy.

'I like a little fur down there,' Joel protested quietly. Still, something in the fact that she was landscaping her most personal area for another man's favor was intensely thrilling.

'It's how he'll expect it,' Harper said. 'It's how all the girls did it back in college.'

Once she was suitably groomed, she had her husband decide which final set of lingerie she would wear for her date, and even which dress.

Why was it so sexy to dress her up for someone else to undress? Knowing that the next time she took these clothes off, she would be in the process of sleeping with another man.

There was lots of talk about what they were doing — Harper kept asking him if he was sure about this, if he was feeling okay, or if the jealousy was getting too much. Joel kept on reassuring her that he was okay, that he wanted this, that he loved the idea of her having a little naughty fun.

'You know he's wanted this ever since I liked the photo on Facebook,' she said of her evening's date.

'And you've wanted him, too,' Joel pointed out.

'It's nothing crazy, though, is it?' she insisted. 'I mean. We dated back in college. I've slept with him before. How is that different from sleeping with him again?'

'I guess you could look at it that way.'

When she was ready, she looked stunning in white lingerie and a silvery blue dress that didn't leave a lot to the imagination.

The last thing was to agree on a place to put her phone when the date returned to the hotel room. Joel wanted the best possible angle to watch things develop — because once things started getting hot and heavy, Harper wouldn't have time to move the phone around to film herself having sex with Mal.

Then Harper was on her way out to the designated restaurant to meet her date.

Before she went in, she gave Joel a quick call to give him one last look at her. She looked just melt-in-the-mouth gorgeous.

Then, she was gone.

EPISODE 8

‘Y ou still want me?’

‘Of course. Look at you. You’re the hottest girl in LA.’

Joel’s heart nearly stopped as he saw them on his phone screen. Mal, wearing a dapper dark blue button-down shirt and khakis, clutching a bottle of beer. Harper, in that silvery-blue dress of hers, looking stunning. She was also drinking, but from a glass.

‘I have news for you — I’m not really a *girl* anymore.’

‘You look the same as you did in college.’

‘You didn’t want me in college. Not after, like, two weeks.’

‘Two months. We were together two months.’

‘Still. That blonde girl came along...’

The two of them were just chatting, like old friends. But these two had dated. They had fucked. And for several weeks, Mal had been visiting Harper at home for secret oral sex. Joel slipped his hard cock out of his fly as he watched them together.

This really was going to happen.

Mal was saying, ‘You were just the same during college. I turned my head, you were with that black guy.’

‘Drew. He was Hispanic.’

‘No, the other guy, his roommate.’

‘Oh, right. Lamar. *God*, I forgot about him.’

‘You’d’ve stayed with me, you wouldn’t have met your husband, right?’

‘But I’m not saying we would’ve stayed together. Just that... you know... we could have dated for *longer*.’

‘I don’t know. You went with that actor guy for a while... don’t tell me if we were together, and he came along, you wouldn’t have gone with him anyway.’

‘Well, yeah. He was kinda well connected.’

‘Not well-hung, though.’

‘I don’t have to worry about *that* kind of thing anymore.’

‘Your husband really wants you to do this?’

Joel’s ears pricked up at their mention of him. They couldn’t see him — the set-up was strictly one-way. Harper’s phone was pointed at the bed, the FaceTime video call switched on, though on Joel’s end, his video and microphone were muted. They couldn’t see Joel stroking his hard cock as he watched their small talk.

Harper told Mal, ‘He’s wanted me to do this for a long time. I had to get therapy to figure out why.’

‘And you figured out why?’

‘Yeah. Because he’s the best husband in the world, that’s why.’

Joel felt surprised at what Harper was saying. She’d been having therapy ever since he’d revealed his secret fantasy, to deal with it? Had that led to the whole Marriage 2.0 thing? That had led them down this path in which Harper had transformed into a flirty, cock-obsessed sex goddess?

Joel smiled. Hell of a therapist, he thought.

But which had come first — Marriage 2.0 or the therapist?

‘So you’re doing this for him, or for you?’ Mal asked her.

‘For both of us. I guess it took therapy for me to understand that. We always think other people are just plain selfish, right? I did, anyway. Even my husband. I assumed he wanted me to see other men because he wanted to see other women.’

‘He doesn’t?’

‘No. I mean, I was surprised. But he really doesn’t. He gets off on me fooling around with other guys.’

‘You have a husband who gets off on you cheating, and for so long you just wanted to suck my cock?’

‘I forgot how fun it is. And anyway, I had to be sure about Joel.’

‘Sure?’

‘My therapist told me there’s a gap, sometimes, between fantasy and reality. Sometimes what people think they want... is not what they *really* want.’

‘So now you’re sure this is what he wants?’

‘I’m pretty sure. He can call us if he suddenly changes his mind, though.’

‘And you’d stop?’

‘Sure. But I know he’s alright with me sucking your cock, so...’

Joel's heart started beating furiously hard in his chest, threatening to break a rib or two. He watched as Harper and Mal put down their drinks on the bedside tables, and then Harper climbed onto his lap, kissing him deeply.

'Mmm... you're so much better than you used to be at this,' Harper said between kisses.

'I was with other people after you.'

Harper sat up and started unbuttoning Mal's shirt. She asked him, 'so who was it taught you to kiss like that?'

'My wife, I guess.'

More kissing. Mal pulled up Harper's dress as he made out with her, giving Joel a nice view of her shapely rear. Then they sat up again, and Mal was peeling off her dress.

Then he removed her bra.

It was so intensely sexy to watch. Joel had seen Harper flirting with other guys and the after-effects of her oral sex sessions with Mal. But he'd never seen her actually being intimate with another man until now.

Somehow, seeing them together seemed to trigger his arousal like nothing else he'd ever experienced.

This was his *wife*, his prim and proper, highly-respected, beautiful wife — topless and in the arms of a man who was not her husband.

The guy was sucking on her tits.

'Oh God, I might even enjoy this *too* much,' he heard her say.

Joel felt a burst of fear and excitement explode inside his chest — she was teasing him, he knew it. But while this was as arousing as anything could be, there were still the underlying nerves to contend with. The base layer of fear was that he was giving his wife away to another man, that there was a needless risk she would want to stay with that other man instead of returning to her husband.

Now he watched Mal pick up Harper, who was fairly petite, particularly in comparison to her muscular ex. He turned her and laid her out on her back.

Off came his pants. Off came Harper's panties.

Jesus.

Harper was naked on another man's bed. Ready for him to fuck her.

Joel felt a chill pass through his body. He dropped his phone. The call ended.

Damn.

For a moment, the fear that he felt threatened to overwhelm him. He'd lost the picture of what Harper was doing. He was going to miss it.

He groaned. He hadn't wanted to interrupt them. But now he had to. He touched the button to call Harper back.

Waiting.

What if she had her phone on silent? What if she was already fucking Mal, and either accidentally or purposefully ignored his call?

He groaned again. He was going to miss it —

But then there was Harper's face on his screen again. Smiling brightly. Looking phenomenal in the 2,532 by 1,170 pixels of his 6.1-inch screen.

'Hey, honey! You okay?' she said.

He said apologetically, 'I dropped my phone.'

She grinned. 'Maybe you should put it down somewhere while you watch, huh?'

'Yeah, maybe.'

'Have you been watching?'

'Uh-huh.'

She smiled sweetly again. 'Show me,' she said, and he knew exactly what she meant.

He angled his phone down his body, showing her how he was sitting there on the bed. Showing her the full erection in his hand.

'Mmm...' she purred. '*Beautiful*. Now you promise me you won't finish until I get home.'

'Of course,' he promised.

'I don't want you *wasting* anything, hon.'

'No, I won't.'

'Good. You ready for him to fuck me?'

'Yes, my sweet.'

'Good. Put your phone down somewhere safe, okay? I love you.'

'Love you too.'

Joel propped his phone up against a pillow, in the perfect place so that he could watch hands-free. On-screen, he saw Harper hand her phone to Mal, who was standing at the foot of the bed wearing only underwear.

The guy was holding the phone — filming it himself — as a naked Harper sat on the end of the bed and pulled down the guy's boxer shorts.

Joel caught his breath.

Despite how sexual Harper had been with him in recent months, it was mentally challenging to adjust to seeing her sitting there naked in front of another man's big, hard cock. And though it was not his own

manhood impressing her, Joel was aroused at the sight of delight and desire lighting up Harper's face as she laid eyes on her ex's cock again.

'It's so *perfect*,' she said with a contented smile. 'Tell me why you got divorced again?'

Mal chuckled. 'My wife couldn't handle the idea that other women might want this cock, too.'

He kept the camera in position as Harper took hold of his cock and slipped it into his mouth.

'Mmm...' she moaned briefly, then took his cock out of her mouth to say, 'Wives are like that, I guess. I don't think *I* could handle another woman having my husband's.'

Watching her, Joel smiled, feeling the warmth of love and affection swell inside him from what his wife had said.

As Harper jammed his hard cock back in her mouth, Mal said, 'But he's okay for you to have other guys?'

Harper shrugged. 'That's his kink,' she said. 'Took me a while to understand it, but I think I do now...'

Though she was allowed to fuck Mal tonight, Harper was taking her time enjoying her former flame's cock orally — even though she'd been experiencing it that way regularly for a while now. There was no doubt in Joel's mind that his wife just happened to really enjoy sucking cock — and that was hot in and of itself.

The petite brunette was holding onto Mal's colossal tool with both hands at this point, using both arms to pump it while her lips and her tongue worked the upper few inches. Mal gently held her head in one hand, stroking her hair, guiding her rhythm, while his other hand held the phone to show Joel a close-up view.

Then she was saying, 'I want to get it extra wet before you fuck me.'

'You don't have anything to worry about,' Mal said. 'I know you're wet for me.'

'But you're so *big*,' she said, in awe. 'You know, I'm only five foot two.'

'You never had a problem in college.'

She sucked on him some more, then, 'I had a lot more guys in college. I was used to it.'

'Your husband is small?'

She shook her head. 'Average,' she grinned. 'When you're with a guy long-term, you know, average is *good*.'

'Oh yeah? But sometimes you need *more* than average, right?' Mal pushed her onto her back, and she squealed with delight.

‘Go slow,’ she insisted.

Joel perked up as he watched Mal grab Harper by the knees and pull her toward him, so her butt was on the edge of the bed. Then the big, powerful guy crouched slightly, and Joel saw his huge cock approaching Harper’s beautiful, freshly-shaven pink pussy.

And while the guy had objected to the idea of Joel being in the room while he fucked Harper, right now he was filming them for Joel’s benefit.

And as this other man touched the tip of his cock to Joel’s wife’s sex, he was even filming in close-up.

Joel gripped his own hardness and gasped as he saw the tip of the man’s organ disappear between Harper’s glistening pink petals. Then, slowly, inch-by-inch, Mal’s hard cock sank into her pussy.

Joel nearly came as he heard his wife gasp at the sensation of this enormous thing slowly filling her.

‘Oh God... Oh *Jesus*...’

It was impressive that the guy could slide inside Harper all the way like that. Female anatomy was a true wonder. But then there he was, his stiff manhood almost entirely inside Joel’s wife.

Joel was just breathless.

‘Slow... go slow...’ Harper pleaded, but she moaned loudly as the muscular guy started moving his hips.

‘Oh... oh... *oh*...’

Wow. It was just incredible to see.

Harper having full sex with another man.

‘Oh... oh...’

Her moans turned to cries in next to no time.

She must have been wet, however, because as he fucked her, his pace gradually quickened, and Harper was spurring him on with her heels and her cries.

‘Yes... yes... *yes*...’

Then, so very quickly, Harper’s high soprano was at the top of her vocal range, and she was shaking under the big man.

‘Oh my *God*... oh my *God*...’

Mal pulled himself off her, and she was left gasping for breath.

‘That was quick,’ Mal grinned.

‘Well... yeah,’ Harper replied, but then suddenly looked concerned. ‘Did you...?’

Mal propped Harper’s phone up on the desk in the corner of the room so that Joel would get the original view, of the whole bed once again. Then he lay down on the bed on his back.

‘Did I — ?’

‘Oh, thank God, you didn’t come yet,’ Harper said, kneeling between his thighs to take his cock in her mouth some more.

‘Oh, I’m in no rush,’ Mal said, leaning against the pillows.

Joel watched his wife straddle the guy’s thighs, and then direct his cock between her ass cheeks. Then she was riding him, and her husband had a superlative view of her impaled by that massive pole.

Joel knew that he would have to pace himself if he was going to watch them all night.

‘I t’s still good.’
‘Uh-huh.’

They were good together. There was an undeniable chemistry. It fed the fear side of the emotional dichotomy Joel experienced all the way through.

‘You gonna come?’

‘Soon. You want me to use a condom?’

‘Why, you been fucking other women recently?’

‘Not recently.’

Joel enjoyed it particularly when one or other of them hit orgasm. Mal only came three times that night, though. It seemed like Harper came a lot more.

This first time, though, she rolled off him and had him come in her mouth.

‘Oh, *man*...’

‘Mmm...’

The second time, Mal came in her pussy, unable to stop himself as he fucked her hard, his thrusts wild and powerful, his muscles suddenly seizing up as he fired his thick cream deep within her.

‘You’re on the pill?’ Mal asked her that time.

Harper giggled. ‘You ask me that *after* you come inside me?’

‘I guess.’

She laughed. ‘It’s okay...’ then she was touching herself, masturbating to the thrill of feeling another man’s come inside her, leaking out. ‘I *am* safe, if you really want to know.’

‘Uh-huh,’ he nodded, pulling away from her for a rest stop.

Then Harper looked over at the camera, directly at Joel, as she continued stroking her come-filled pussy. ‘Hey, honey. You still watching? Did you see him come in me? Oh my God, he has *so* much come in him...’

Here was another moment Joel nearly came. He had to stop touching himself, pulling back like a pit crew when a race car is about to accelerate away.

‘Are you having a good time?’ Harper was asking him. ‘I guess you would have switched off by now if you weren’t...’

She shuffled forward until she was perched on the corner of the bed. Then she parted her thighs, showed him her pussy.

Showed him the white cream leaking out from between her pink folds.

‘You see, honey? He came inside me... it felt so *good*...’

Oh, God. The fire in Joel’s chest flamed up, torching his heart.

This was the hottest thing ever.

‘You know I was pretty angry at you when you told me this was your fantasy,’ Harper said. ‘I guess I just didn’t understand... but it’s so hot honey... you get off on this?’

In a long-term marriage, vindication can feel like a class-A drug.

Joel had never been in this for the vindication, though. Right now, it was all about the sex. The sex between his wife and another man.

And as he watched Mal return, and begin to fuck Harper doggy-style, Joel knew it wouldn’t be easy being the only one of the three unable to come.

But he was well-motivated to hold his side of the bargain, even when the two lovers started filming themselves again for Joel’s benefit.

Harper murmuring into the microphone as she shot another close-up of Mal’s cock squeezing into her, ‘You know now I’m going to need a lot more cock than just this, honey. Are you going to be okay with that? Are you going to be okay with your darling wife sleeping around?’

Every minute that Harper spent in bed with her ex-boyfriend, Joel only wanted her more and more.

He wanted her more whenever she opened her mouth and said something depraved.

‘You think I could get one of those nice guys from the gym to be my personal trainer at home, honey? I bet he’d be willing to give me the full service...’

Joel just about went crazy when she started talking about Mal fucking her during his regular visits to their home. Mal waiting until later

in the evening to arrive, so that Joel would be able to watch everything.

Then Mal took her in the shower, slamming her up against the wall so it proved very difficult for her to actually get clean.

And then when she was getting dressed, ready to return home to her husband, Mal took her again, rendering the whole shower idea essentially pointless.

He didn't allow Harper that last orgasm, however.

'You can't stop *now*,' she was almost hissing, her need to climax one more time was surprisingly intense, despite the number of times she'd come already.

'You'll just have to go home and find someone else to take care of it,' Mal joked — and then directed his hard cock toward her, and shot his come all over her, so that it splashed all over her face, her chest, her clothes.

She gasped. 'Hey — *that* was not nice.'

'Go home to your husband,' he said, blocking her way to the bathroom.

Joel was physically shaking with need as he watched his wife try to get herself together, grab her phone, and then leave the room, trying not to look as though she had come stains all up her dress.

EPISODE 9

He was there to greet her at the front door when she returned home. For a moment, she just stood there, and he just gazed at her, taking in the extraordinary sight of a woman he could never have imagined having any kind of affair or extramarital fling freshly fucked by another man.

Her hair tousled, mussed up, still damp. Her makeup smeared. Her complexion flushed and a touch greasy from perspiration. Her dress streaked with another man's come.

She looked at him meekly, like a doe caught out in the open. Wondering what he was thinking, now she'd taken the ultimate step, she'd broken the unfixable boundary, she had risked their marriage to satisfy immediate urges.

There on the doorstep, he held back from her, and saw that it clearly made her afraid.

'I've changed my mind,' he said, his face impassive, his emotions controlled.

His words made her gasp.

'I... it was what you *wanted*...' she protested.

He just looked at her, running his eyes all over her used body, noting how her thin satiny dress clung to her skin because her skin had been rendered sticky by come and sweat.

To anyone else, she looked like a wreck. A cat who had accidentally fallen into a pond. A graceful, elegant creature who had been well and truly chewed up and spat out again.

To Joel, she looked like the most beautiful thing he'd ever seen.

'I'm sorry...' she said quietly, panic thick in her voice. 'I thought... I thought you *wanted* me to... Please, honey... *please*...'

He held up a finger to his lips.

She was silent.

She waited for his judgment.

He stepped slowly around her, examining her shivering frame. She just stood there, sensing the need to do as he demanded. To play the dutiful, loyal, penitent, obedient wife.

He leaned in closer to her, breathing in the strong scent of sex that had acted like a second set of clothing for her during her ride home.

She held her breath as he put a hand on her breast and squeezed. He touched her neck, and brushed his fingers down to her upper chest, feeling the clamminess of her skin, the slight stickiness on her flesh.

‘You’ve been very selfish, honey,’ he said, putting his face beside hers, sniffing like a curious hound. ‘I mean... all of this... it’s a new diet, a new plan to make you feel better. To make you healthier. To make you more confident and to let you experience everything life could offer...’

‘Yes, but...’ she said, but then a slight shake of his head silenced her again.

He laughed, but without humor. ‘You’ve gotten to enjoy other men... suck their cocks... fuck the ex-boyfriend you’ve fantasized about for years...’

‘I...’ she tried again, but now he silenced her with a look.

‘I think,’ he said, ‘there’s a real danger our marriage will unravel if we aren’t careful about all this.’

She nodded respectfully.

‘You know I enjoy it when you have fun flirting with other guys... leading them on.’ He flicked the strap of her dress off her shoulder. ‘I like it when they want you so desperately. When you give them a little *sugar*...’

Now he slipped the other strap of her dress off her shoulder. The garment stayed where it was, supported by its tightness and the bodily emissions that glued the thin material to her skin.

He peeled it down to expose her bra.

Harper glanced around, aware they were outside, though on the doorstep. Though it was late, there was a slight chance that someone happening along the road might see.

‘It turns me on to know you’re enjoying a little... wickedness... with someone else,’ Joel said, sliding her bra straps off her shoulder too. ‘You know that. Watching your old squeeze take you for himself... that was so hot.’

He noticed the corners of her mouth twitch upward in an involuntary smile before she corrected herself.

‘But if I just let you do whatever you want... suck whoever you please... fuck whoever offers you the biggest cock...’ he flicked the catch of her bra, allowing it to fall to the ground. ‘Well, I might start to worry you’d forget who you’re really married to...’

‘No, I *wouldn’t*...’ she insisted, fighting the natural inclination to hide her exposed breasts with her arms — because he had not allowed her to.

He gazed at her small but magnificent tits. Gently flicked her impressively stiff nipples with a forefinger.

She moaned softly at that.

‘Well,’ he said. ‘We could hope for the best, I suppose. But I like more certainty than that.’

Her eyes met his again, curious about what he meant.

He stepped beside her, again breathing her in as he drew close to her body.

Then he peeled her dress down, exposing her stomach, her hips, her panties. Finding it oddly gratifying the way the material came away from her skin — in the manner that some enjoy popping bubble wrap or stepping in iced-over puddles.

Again, she had to fight the urge to cover herself. At the same time, he sensed that the danger of discovery was exciting to her.

As was the authority in his voice, as it happened.

‘I think,’ he said, stepping around her again to watch as her dress slipped down her thighs and tumbled to her ankles, ‘that we need to set some ground rules.’

‘Yes,’ she said. ‘Of course.’

He nodded.

From behind her, he put both hands on her breasts, fondling her. She moaned as he leaned in to inhale the scent of her hair, of the back of her neck.

‘First of all,’ he said, ‘we agree that you are mine, first and above all else. You are my wife. You are here to fulfill my sexual needs before anyone else’s. And when it comes to sex, you always do exactly as I say.’

There was a slight movement of her eyebrows, as though she hadn’t been expecting this as a ground rule.

‘Do you agree?’ he asked her.

‘Of course,’ she said, stubbornly standing to attention as he cupped and squeezed her breasts.

Now he stepped in front of her.

‘I will allow you to continue your special program with Myitzu,’ he said, peering closely at her breasts as though he’d never seen any before.

She gave a slight nod of gratitude, and a quiet breath of relief escaped her before she stifled it.

‘But you will need my permission if you want come from another man.’

‘Yes, my love.’

‘And if you fuck someone else, it’s because I want you to,’ he said.

‘Yes, my love,’ she said, gently biting her lip at the thought of her husband wanting her to fuck other men.

She’d come a long way from the woman who had signed them up for marital counseling just because her husband had revealed a secret fantasy of sharing her.

‘Good,’ he said, slowly crouching before hooking his fingers in the waistband of her panties to peel them down.

Now, as he unveiled her beautifully shaven and freshly adulterated pussy, as he took in the sight of her panties smeared with another man’s cream, it was his turn to quietly moan with pleasure.

When her panties were around her ankles, he rose again to stand before her.

‘You will never keep secrets from me,’ he declared. ‘You will never so much as want another guy without telling me.’

‘Yes, my love.’

‘And if I want you to fuck somebody, you will.’

‘Yes, my love.’

‘And if I want you for myself — I will have you for myself.’

‘Yes, my love.’

He pressed his hand between her thighs, cupping her pussy now, feeling the sticky, slippery oils of her sex, of her infidelity. It made him so hard — she made him so hard. He’d never known such arousal.

It was like freebasing cocaine.

He slipped a finger inside her, making her gasp and then moan, and he stroked her on the inside, feeling for himself a pussy that had only just welcomed the cock of another man.

‘Okay...’ he said. ‘So you agree to all my terms?’

‘Yes, my love.’

‘You may come inside.’

She seemed relieved to get inside, away from the threat of prying eyes.

He led her upstairs, sensing an impatience in her that he quietly enjoyed.

He also quietly enjoyed the little gasp she let out when she entered the bedroom and saw what was lying on the bed.

‘Put them on,’ he said to her.

Not only cuffs for the wrists but also for her ankles. When she’d finished putting them on, he told her to lie on the bed — and then he connected them all together.

‘Are you going to be a good girl now?’ he asked her.

‘Oh, yes,’ she promised, unable to hide her broad smile or the flames of excitement in her eyes.

‘You’re going to do exactly as you’re told?’

‘Yes, my love.’

One last finishing touch was a collar of the same soft black faux leather as the cuffs. And a leash to attach.

Now he could lead her and put her in any position he desired. She seemed to enjoy giving herself up to him in this way.

‘You’re mine,’ he said. ‘To do with whatever I want.’

And she said, meekly, ‘Yes, my love.’

He enjoyed his sense of power more than he had expected he would.

Despite Harper’s desperation for release, he preferred to take his time, and enjoyed the added pressure it induced in her. Mal had kept to his word, ending his time with her by getting her close to the crest of a climax, without going over it. It had left her shaking and shivering with need.

But at first, Joel only wanted to explore her beautiful, yet sullied body. He just wanted to touch her, to stroke her, to breathe her in.

To revel in the reality of his wife’s infidelity.

He wanted to suck on her tits and squeeze her ass. To taste the lingering hint of sweat and come on her debased flesh, to feel the heat and wetness as he slid his fingers inside her tainted sex.

He wanted to kiss the mouth that had pleased another man that night. Toying with the tongue that had lashed his hard cock, sucking on the lips that had stretched around his girth.

He gloried in the little whimpering moans she made as he consumed her, and in the way her body quivered at the feeling of his hard cock pressing against her, or his fingers sliding inside her.

She nearly came a few times from simply stroking her, kissing her, licking her. But he carefully kept her back from the precipice.

He did not want to rush.

He possessed her, she was his to enjoy. She was like a sensational masterpiece of the art world, and yet his alone. His very own Sistine Chapel. The form and texture, the color and the perspective were just divine. And add to that the warmth and the softness and the incredibly alluring scent.

By the time he parted her thighs and surveyed her exquisite flower up close — seeing for himself where another man had penetrated her, filled her, and emptied himself inside her — she was begging him to let her come.

And still, he took his time appreciating her sex, gliding his tongue along her slippery folds, taking her clit into his hot mouth.

Taking the time to see her full beauty so she would never entirely fall over the edge into her long-promised orgasm.

When he finally allowed her release, slipping two fingers inside her while he bathed her clit in his warm and welcoming mouth, a funny thing happened. She came... and then she didn't entirely stop coming.

It made her gasp, her eyes wide.

It made him laugh. Saying, 'What is it?'

'I don't know...'

It was like a glitch in the Matrix. A hiccup. The kind of process error that would make you switch an appliance off and on again to correct. But they didn't need to correct this glitch.

He had her kneel on the floor and take his hard cock in her mouth — and she was kneeling there jiggling as her orgasm, most unexpectedly, continued.

He had her sit on the floor and lean back against the side of the bed, and he thrust his cock into her mouth to enjoy its warmth. And she was still coming.

He fucked her face, which seemed so gloriously filthy and depraved because her face was so pretty and respectable — and still, her orgasm seemed to continue.

It seemed to take a lot out of her, though, this prolonged climax. When he ordered her up onto the bed, adjusting her shackles so that he could have her on all fours, she seemed exhausted from it all.

He slid his stiff cock into her from behind, indulging in the animalistic nature of that position, but after a while, he had to allow her down on her back in case she collapsed.

Her orgasm only extended as he pounded her well-used, creamy pussy with his hard cock. And thrusting into her like that only seemed to add fuel to her fire.

Neither of them had ever known anything like it.

There was a moment where he wondered if they would have to go into hospital and declare a bizarre medical emergency — almost akin to a man going in to report an overdose of Viagra.

But then Joel felt his own climax approach, and when he turned her over so that she lay flat on her front and he entered her from behind, he felt her body respond, her climax intensifying toward a new peak.

He whispered into her ear how much he loved her, how incredible she was, how much fun they were going to have, how many men she was going to fuck — and with that, by the time he flooded her pussy with his own cream, she was hitting a final peak that left her feeling blessed closure, release and then relief.

‘What have you done to me?’ she murmured, drunk with fatigue. But she was smiling.

He squeezed the pleasing roundness of her ass, saying, ‘Well, I guess I broke it, so I own it.’

She had a lot of questions for her husband in the morning.

But they would have to wait, since she woke up early, and he did not. She was unable to sleep late, as he had, because of all the thoughts whirling around her head.

Instead, she attempted to distract herself by going for a run.

When she returned, he was awake, lying in bed, watching CNN.

‘Did you mean what you said last night?’ she asked him as she began stripping off her running gear, intending to take a shower.

‘I always say what I mean,’ he smiled.

‘You were so possessive,’ she said, feeling her pussy beginning to tingle with desire merely at remembering what he said.

‘You seemed okay with it.’

‘Oh, I’m okay with it,’ she said, enjoying how his eyes languished over her body as she slowly removed her tight lycra shorts. ‘I just didn’t know... you know... if you were only role-playing.’

‘Role-playing?’

She could see from his expression that he had not been role-playing. Somehow that made her feel jubilant, ecstatic.

‘What made you... decide it should be this way?’ she said.

‘I was dealing with a few things,’ he said. ‘You know. Anxiety, I guess. I talked to your friend Myitzu about it.’

‘And she said...?’

‘She said taking control would give me the confidence that what we’re doing is for *us*. As a couple.’

Harper pulled off her sports bra, and he had no qualms about watching her intently. She remembered the way he’d said she was his and made it clear she would do whatever he wanted when it came to sex.

Her nipples were as hard as pebbles.

‘You were serious when you agreed to my terms?’ Joel asked her.

‘Uh-huh,’ she said, feeling an unexpected lightening of her spirit as she confirmed it.

The way her husband had made her feel the previous night... that was what she wanted. Above all.

She hesitated when removing her panties, though she wasn’t sure why. It was old inhibitions, it was learned behavior, conditioned reserve. Joel noticed her hesitation.

‘Take them off,’ he told her.

Now she felt full-blown arousal ignite between her thighs. There was something in the way that he told her what to do that really got her going.

‘Yes, my love,’ she said, slowly peeling off her underwear, letting him see everything.

God.

Mal might have haunted her fantasies ever since college. But now she was past that. She’d had that particular itch scratched — and while she’d never say no to another roll in the hay with him if her husband wanted it, she was beyond that now.

Now she was all about her husband.

She’d always been a confident, bright, liberated woman — but the feeling of her husband controlling her, dominating her, *possessing* her had taken her by complete surprise. Why had it been so intensely thrilling to her? Because it had shown her how much he wanted her? How important she was to him? Or something that was somehow innate, deep within her, reacting to the sudden emergence of the alpha in the pack.

Whatever. It was what she wanted.

As she stood there in the bedroom, naked, waiting until he was finished gazing at her, all she wanted was to do what her husband wanted her to do.

‘You’re incredible, you know that?’ he said.

She smiled. ‘What can I do for you, my love?’

He pulled back the bedsheet, and it was quite clear what he wanted her to do, even before he told her in no uncertain terms.

Her mouth was watering even before she climbed onto the bed.

ROBERT AND CLAIRE

EPISODE 1

Robert had just given baby Pete his night feed and lulled him back to sleep when he heard Claire return from her night out.

Clutching the baby monitor, he tip-toed downstairs as quietly as the squeaking wooden steps would allow, since there was no way they could hold any kind of a conversation upstairs in their bedroom.

Claire, dressed casually but nicely in dark jeans and a stripy white top, was stooping to remove her boots as silently as the creaking leather would permit.

‘Hey,’ he said, in the kind of near-whisper they always used when one or both kids were sleeping. ‘You have fun?’

‘Yeah, it was good.’

‘The ladies in fine form?’ he asked as he sat back down on the couch in their tiny living room, just a few yards away from the front door.

‘It was just Gillian and me,’ she said, smiling as she straightened up after removing her last boot.

‘Oh, right,’ he nodded. ‘I forgot she was gonna be in town this week. How’s she doing?’

Claire sank into the other corner of the couch and quietly massaged her feet. ‘Good,’ she said. ‘You know she’s working for Marriage 2.0 now?’

‘Oh, those guys?’

‘Yeah. She loves it. They’ve been expanding a lot since the Pandemic, apparently.’

A burble of noise from the baby monitor made them both suddenly freeze, listening for any further hint that baby Pete might have woken again. After a moment or two of absolute silence, they both relaxed again.

Robert looked at Claire and smiled, relieved at the false alarm. 'What's she doing for them, exactly?' he asked, feeling an unexpected flicker of warmth inside at the thought that Claire had been with Gillian, of all people.

'Human resources. She says they're currently working on expanding their pool of performers. It's why she's in town, apparently.'

'Performers?'

Claire smiled. 'Well, it was just you, me, Gillian, and Mason in Rome. We were all clients — but some couples have experiences needing performers to play certain roles.'

Robert nodded. 'Oh, right. Like actors?'

'Something like that. Some of the roles are just acting... some of them are a little more... *physical*...'

Robert chuckled. 'You mean... like they *get involved* with the couples?'

Claire grinned. 'Depends on the narrative...'

'Narrative?'

'Apparently, sometimes, there's just more certainty in being able to control the narrative, using a performer instead of a regular person.'

Robert raised his eyebrows. 'Wow. So these performers have to be able to act, and... uh... *perform*.'

Claire nodded. 'Gillian made it sound like organizing a movie production... with... you know... occasional sex scenes.'

Robert grinned. 'But not simulated sex, I bet. Sounds like interesting work for Gillian. Wasn't she in insurance before?'

Claire nodded. He noticed her toying with a strand of her hair. She looked good in that top. And in those jeans, though they were only jeans.

She said, 'Funnily enough... when we were talking, she asked if we'd like to... you know... make use of her staff discounts.'

'Staff discounts?'

Claire blushed fiercely. It was sweet. She said, 'Well, she's not in sales or anything. But she and Mason did a couple more adventures last year, so she said...'

Robert thought back to their own adventure in Rome. Swapping partners with Mason. Sleeping with Gillian. And the thing that had his heart pumping and his manhood stiffening was the memory of Mason having sex with Claire.

Jesus. Claire wanted to do something like that again?

'Wow,' he said, feeling the sudden awkwardness between them.

It had been a few years since that dreamy vacation in Rome when they'd cast aside their inhibitions. And since baby Ashley had come along not long after it had happened, they hadn't had opportunities to follow up their dramatic sexual liberation.

They were back to being a little awkward about it all.

'It was just a thought...' Claire said, still twirling the end of her hair nervously, which had the effect of guiding his eyes to her cleavage...

'Maybe it would be fun,' he nodded, trying not to shoot down the idea, but avoid sounding too keen. He was undoubtedly drawn to the possibility of doing something thrilling like that again. Still, he didn't want her to think he was *too* hopeful about sleeping with someone else. What if she got offended?

'We don't really need to,' she said, aimlessly scratching at the neckline of her top in a manner that some might even describe as flirtatious.

There was a moment when he looked at her, and she looked at him, and neither of them knew what to say. Both of them wanted to avoid offending the other by suggesting they fancied the idea of another erotic adventure, whatever it might be. Because they knew from past experience that if they signed up for Marriage 2.0 again, it might very well involve them sleeping with other people.

'Well, it's a thought,' Robert said at last, if only to break the awkwardness.

Claire smiled and agreed. And, frustratingly, that was that for that conversation.

They watched the new episode of *The Mandalorian* together — both donning wireless headphones to hear the TV without waking the kiddos. They looked like a couple of helicopter pilots sitting there on the couch. However, Robert couldn't entirely concentrate on any of the characters in the *Star Wars* spin-off.

He couldn't stop thinking about how it had been to watch Claire in the arms of another man. Claire taking hold of Mason's manhood. Claire letting him fuck her.

God.

And now he had a big hard-on he had to try to conceal from his darling wife, for fear she would figure out precisely what he'd been thinking about while they'd been watching Din Djarin search for the mines of Mandalore.

Once the episode was over, and it was time for them to creep upstairs to bed, Robert felt completely awake — he wouldn't be able to sleep for

ages.

He sat on the bed and watched Claire peel off her top to reveal her bare midriff and a simple white bra covering her shapely breasts. She was still in really good shape.

‘You okay?’ she asked him, that little crinkle between her eyebrows suggesting she was concerned about him sitting there like he’d forgotten what he was doing.

‘Yeah,’ he nodded. ‘Just... you know... not very sleepy.’

‘You need a pill to help get you there?’

He shook his head at that. ‘I’ll just oversleep — and I’ll end up feeling all groggy in first period.’

He’d watched her pull down her jeans to expose little white cotton panties and her slender thighs before he realized that she didn’t usually undress in front of him these days. Normally, she went into the bathroom to change into her PJs.

As she calmly folded her jeans and placed them on the little wooden chair in the corner, Robert was reminded that they hadn’t had sex for... what... a week? Two weeks? Maybe even three?

That was just the effect of having two young kids, though, wasn’t it? And they weren’t getting any younger — Robert would be 44 next birthday. Claire was heading toward the big four-oh.

He still found Claire attractive. Of course he did. She hadn’t changed much since they’d first dated — she liked to keep in shape, eat well, exercise regularly, and all that. And, sure, she didn’t often put on makeup or dress up since they rarely did much socially these days...

‘Are you sure you’re okay?’ she said again.

He looked up, his eyes traveling up her fine form until they connected with hers. He even blushed a little for being caught ogling her undressing.

He tried to distract her from the awkwardness, saying, ‘We don’t really *need* them, do we? Marriage 2.0, I mean.’

Claire stepped right in front of him, wearing just bra and panties. She *was* wearing makeup tonight, and even a light splash of perfume. He felt the spark of arousal firing up his manhood as he took in the sight of all her smooth skin, her delicate lines, her womanly curves.

‘We don’t *need* them,’ she said quietly, removing her bra in a distinctly seductive manner.

God. He hadn’t seen her be like this in a long while.

She tossed the bra aside and stood there in just her panties, letting him gaze at her bare breasts, her stiff nipples. She looked just divine,

making him feel like he'd taken her for granted for ages, like he'd only just had his eyes opened to her beauty.

She was as horny as he was, he realized. Because she'd been talking to Gillian about Marriage 2.0?

He gazed up at her and put his hands on her hips. Pulling her a touch closer to him. She looked down at him and smiled.

'Gillian says they're trying to get away from the image of being some kind of marriage counseling,' she said.

'Oh, yeah?' he slipped the tips of his fingers under the waistband of her panties, feeling the urge to peel them off her.

'She said there's going to be a new marketing push that tries to position them as a kind of *vacation experience* for married couples, even if their relationships are already as strong as possible.'

Robert hesitated — they didn't usually have sex in the bedroom when the kids were asleep. In fact, since baby Pete had come along, it had been almost unheard of. Usually, when they felt the urge, Claire would drag him down to the guest room in the basement.

But all this talk of Marriage 2.0 — and Claire seeming to push it — had made him vibrate with lust. And the way she was looking tonight...

Robert glanced up at her, and she smiled so beautifully.

He slid her panties down her thighs, exposing the pleasing sight of the little patch of dark fur on her mound.

'If we were to try it again,' he said, leaning in to kiss her bare stomach as she stepped out of her panties, 'what would happen to the kids?'

'I don't know...' she said, putting her hands gently on his shoulders as though to steady herself. 'But Gillian said they often arrange experiences for couples with young kids.'

She leaned down to kiss him, and took hold of one of his hands in hers, moving it from her waist down to between her legs. He felt his pulse quicken as his fingers glided through her soft fur and then dipped into the soaking heat of her sex.

She was seriously wet already.

She moaned as he slid his fingers inside her, and as he stirred her honeypot, he was rewarded with a waft of her spicy scent.

'Maybe we should try it again,' he said, slipping his fingers out of her pussy, and into his mouth to sample her delectable flavor.

He glanced up at her, and she smiled warmly. Then she pulled away from him and climbed onto the bed, lying on her front but pushing up her beautiful ass invitingly to flaunt her curves.

Now it was her turn to watch him undress. Again, he was aware that he rarely undressed in front of her these days. He liked her watching him, though. The suspense of her clear desire as she was forced to wait for him to remove his clothes.

When he pulled down his undershorts and his sweatpants in one single move, revealing his already stiff cock, her eyes flashed with lust.

There was another burble from the baby monitor — and the two of them duly froze.

False alarm again.

But now, as Robert pulled himself onto the bed and started kissing his way up Claire's ankles and calves, he glanced up at her face and whispered: *'Are you sure about this?'*

Of course, he didn't want her to reconsider. She just looked too irresistible right now. But the question had to be asked.

Claire stifled a giggle and pushed her gorgeous behind even higher to encourage him. *'Just try to be quiet!'* she hissed.

He completely gave in to temptation and grasped her cheeks with both hands, groping her, making her press her face down in the pillows to stifle her amused squeal. Then he curled his hands around the top of her thighs, lifting up her hips so he could duck down and wedge his face between her cheeks and suck on her pussy.

He felt her wriggle under him and heard her moan with pleasure, the sound muffled by the pillows but still audible to him. She wriggled as though trying to get away from him, and yet he could tell she was enjoying it. As she lay there, she pushed up one of her knees to spread her thighs wide and make it easier for him to get in and lash her pussy with his tongue.

It had been a while since he'd gone down on her — and yet, as the memory of their time in Rome fueled his desire for her, he just wanted to eat her up.

They were going to do Marriage 2.0 again. It was an exciting prospect. What would happen?

Would they be re-tested, or would the adventure be based on their first assessment?

Would the program require them to swap partners again?

Claire was going wild underneath him, but it became too much for her after a few minutes. She curled up into a ball, pulling away from him, and then turned to face him. *'Too much,'* she whispered.

He nodded, and pouted in protest.

She grinned, reaching for his cock, and urged him to kneel up so that she could take it in her mouth. It felt good. He remembered when he'd been with Gillian. Would they find him another partner the next time? And yet ever since Rome, his fantasies had been filled with images of Claire fucking Mason — not himself fucking Gillian.

Claire seemed ecstatic at how hard he was, as though it was a personal victory for her. She swirled her tongue around the end, then sank down on it, engulfing it with the heat of her mouth.

It felt sensational. But he found himself picturing how it had been to watch her doing this with Mason.

Gripping his shaft tightly, pumping his base as she worked his girth with her lips.

After a few moments, it was his turn to urge her to stop for fear that he would start moaning loudly. She smirked and then pulled back from him, taking hold of his cock so that when she lay on her back, he went with her.

He lay between her splayed thighs and sank his hardness straight into her. She was seriously wet, and he was seriously hard. She beamed as he lay over her, and thrust his manhood deep into her quivering sex.

'Are you thinking about her?' she asked, smiling expectantly.

'Thinking about who?'

She grinned. 'Gillian, of course. You're so hard...'

He laughed. 'No, actually. I was thinking about you when you were with Mason.'

Her eyes flashed at this news.

'Me and Mason?' she asked.

'Uh-huh,' he said, kissing her neck before whispering close to her ear, *'When we watched you sucking his big cock...'*

'It's not as big as yours,' she grinned.

Then he whispered into her ear some more, *'When he stood behind you and slid that big cock inside you... when he started fucking you...'*

She moaned quietly in delight, her hips moving under him as he thrust into her, doubling the force of their connection. *'You loved watching that, didn't you?'* she whispered.

'Oh yeah... it made me so hard... watching you take him like that... he was fucking you... you were being so bad...'

They were both moaning, and both trying not to, but even when they weren't, they were panting for breath, and their bodies making clumping and thumping noises as he pounded his huge cock into her again and again.

‘We need to be quick,’ Claire warned, figuring speed, at least, might minimize the risk of their noises by reducing the time taken.

‘Tell me again how good it felt when he was fucking you,’ Robert said.

She smiled, kissed his mouth, and said, *‘It was amazing... it felt so good... when he squeezed that big dick inside me...’*

As she murmured in his ear, she shoved a hand down between their bodies to press it against her clit, and then her hips were working him while he plunged his rock-hard cock into her over and over.

‘...I felt so naughty, honey... I was cheating on you... taking another man’s cock... so deep inside me... I just loved how wicked it made me feel... fucking him so hard...letting him do whatever he wanted with my sweet, married pussy...’

And this was Claire, his beloved wife, who didn’t say such filthy things — and so in next to no time, Robert felt his orgasm approach with fierce heat. He gripped her hips and powered his cock into her, shooting his hot cream within her shivering, shuddering sex.

She came when he did, as though triggered by his come spurting inside her, and only a pillow saved her from screaming the house down as it hit.

The power of their joint climax left them collapsed on the bed, sweaty, flushed, and gasping for air.

And before they had even switched out their bedside lamps to get some sleep, Claire had signed them up for another adventure at Marriage 2.0.

EPISODE 2

The headsets arrived in the mail after a few days. They looked like those virtual reality things you could hook up to PlayStations — except there were stick-on sensors they had to place all over their bodies.

It was impressive that the company had developed this kind of tech in just a few years. They wouldn't have to go into the middle of the city to have their assessment done — they could do it in the comfort of their own little home in Glen Cove.

With the kids safely with Claire's sister, Auntie Jayne, Claire set herself up in the main bedroom while Robert camped out on the couch in the living room to do the assessment.

It was a surprisingly exhausting process, even though they only had to sit and watch something. But they knew what they were up against, having done it before. They changed into gym clothes before donning their headsets and the sensors — they knew they were in for a complete workout.

Then things progressed slowly and steadily, as expected, as they were shown various images and video clips of different couples and individuals doing various activities.

As before, the nature and the intensity of what they were being shown became more and more powerful and provocative as the hours of assessment went on.

As morning turned into afternoon, following a short lunch break, almost everything they were being shown was erotic in nature — getting more and more explicit as various kinks and fetishes were explored in front of them, among all kinds of arrangements of lustful people.

A woman waking a guy up by giving him a blowjob.

A man having a massage only for the masseur to start stripping off in front of him.

A woman lifting up her skirt before leaning over a windowsill so a man could fuck her from behind.

Claire couldn't remember getting quite so turned on by the assessment they'd done at Marriage 2.0 headquarters the first time. Perhaps it was because she was in the privacy and familiarity of her bedroom at home that made her feel more comfortable opening up to what she was being shown.

A man tied up and fucked by two women at the same time.

Three women engaged in sweaty lesbian sex.

A woman being penetrated vaginally and anally at the same time.

It was arousing and disturbing in equal measures. Some of it definitely appealed, while other scenes did not. Some made them unexpectedly excited, some made them crazy excited, while some made them feel a little queasy.

From what Robert remembered of their first test, this time, there definitely seemed to be longer spent watching women having sex in front of their husbands. Women being shared by multiple men. Women being fucked by one guy, then offering themselves to another straight afterward.

Had Marriage 2.0 caught on to his changing tastes since he'd seen Claire fucking Mason?

Then, finally, it was done — and so were they. After that, they slept until it was time for the kids to come home.

A mere one week later, they both received a message from Marriage 2.0 congratulating them on the start of their new adventure.

That evening, they both waited with crazy anticipation to see what instructions they would get regarding their new adventure.

By bedtime, however, they were still waiting.

It was exciting, though, knowing that something was going to happen. Claire was sitting on the edge of the bed, looking through the Marriage 2.0 website to see what kinds of adventures they arranged these days — whether anything had changed in the fundamental process since they had done this nearly four years ago.

She glanced up to see her husband stripping off his clothes, and it was difficult to avoid noticing the magnificent hard-on he was sporting.

‘You want to... visit the guest bedroom quickly?’ she asked him. ‘So we can deal with that?’

He was about to agree when baby Pete started crying.

Well, that was that for the night.

It wasn’t until the morning, until after Robert had gone to school, that Claire received the most anticipated text message in her life.

Marriage 2.0: Your au pair will arrive at 11am this morning and will stay with you for the duration of your adventure. Enjoy!

Claire read her message a couple of times, somewhat confused and — if she was honest — a little disappointed.

An au pair? This was their adventure?

‘But we don’t want an au pair,’ Claire said out loud.

She texted her husband to let him know what her message had said. Robert suggested that the program was sending them an au pair so they could get on with their real adventure without worrying about the kids.

Claire: But we talked about this. I don’t want someone else raising our kids.

Robert: I realize that — but maybe this is just temporary.

Claire: Even if it’s temporary. The kids are going to freak out if we suddenly go away and leave them with someone they don’t know.

Robert: I’m sure whoever it is will be nice. And the kids will get to know them.

Claire: And anyway, we already have Jayne.

Robert: Jayne’s not always available. Look, just see how it goes, okay? They assessed us, didn’t they? They know what they’re doing. If they say this is what we need, maybe we should try it.

Claire sighed. Her husband was right. Maybe she just needed to be patient and see what happened. What if it turned out the kids were okay with an au pair? She and Robert could go out for the evening together rather than always socializing separately. That might be nice — going on proper dates again.

And maybe while they had an au pair... something sexy might happen like it did when they were on vacation in Rome...

Then it was 11am, and the doorbell rang.

Claire felt a flutter of nerves inside her chest — she'd built it up now: she was desperately hoping she'd like this new au pair, whoever she was.

Before opening the door, she stopped and took a moment to calm herself. Deep breath. Everything was set, right? The guest bedroom was all ready for someone to stay. Ashley was happy enough, ensconced in front of the TV watching Peppa Pig.

Claire opened the front door.

Outside on the doorstep was a young man.

'Oh,' Claire said, confused.

'Mrs. Sayers?' the young man smiled genially and held out his hand for her to shake. 'My name is Jean-Luc.'

Was that an *accent* she detected?

Politely, she shook his hand. 'Uh... *you're* the... au pair?'

He grinned and nodded. 'Yes, I am the au pair.'

She seemed to freeze for a moment, not knowing what to do. Then she asked herself why she was acting like an idiot — because she'd assumed an au pair would be female, and it turned out he wasn't? She flushed slightly, feeling a touch of embarrassment.

'Uh... come in... please,' she said, stepping back to invite him inside.

'Thank you.'

He seemed pleasant enough — a friendly smile, tidy clothes. He was sent by Marriage 2.0, right? So she had to trust that he was legit.

He was carrying a little suitcase that she found hard to believe could contain everything he needed. It reminded her of Mary Poppins and her magic carpet bag.

'Would you like to sit down?' she said as she led him into the little living room. 'I'm afraid we were caught a little by surprise...'

'Perfect,' he nodded, leaving his case by the bottom of the stairs before stepping into the living room to take up the armchair.

'Can I get you a coffee or something?'

'Oh, no, thank you,' he smiled. He had something of a charming smile, she had to admit.

Claire took a seat on the little couch. 'So... I guess I should say we never had an au pair before... I'm not even fully sure what kinds of things an au pair does...'

Jean-Luc smiled again. She didn't know how he did it — somehow, he just put her at ease. 'Of course — it's no problem. I am here to make your life better. I can cook and clean and take care of anything you need, really.'

His French accent made her melt a little inside. God, she was pathetic.

Apologetically, Claire said, 'My husband Robert and I... We never really liked the idea of someone else bringing up our kids...'

But Jean-Luc merely smiled. 'I wouldn't really be bringing up your kids, Mrs. Sayers. Only helping out. And I can help with all kinds of things so you can spend more time with your children.'

'Oh,' she said, thinking how perfect he made it seem.

Then, in the background, they heard something that sounded very clearly like a baby throwing up all over the kitchen floor.

'Petey, what the heck...?' she said, rushing through to find the baby sitting cheerfully in the middle of the linoleum floor, right in front of a pool of vomit.

But then, as she picked him up, there was Jean-Luc with a mop — how the hell did he even know where they kept it? And the mess was cleaned up as if by magic.

Well, that was nice.

When she had Petey suitably cleaned up and changed, she gave Jean-Luc a tour of the house. He seemed delighted with the guest bedroom in the basement — especially that it had a little window offering some natural light.

He batted away her apology that the basement had no bathroom, saying he had no problem using the stairs.

Then after he'd settled in, he made lunch for everyone while Claire fed Petey with the bottle, and then played Noah's Ark with Ashley and her Playmobil set before it was time for both kiddos to take their mid-day nap.

Claire was pleased with how well Ashley seemed to click with Jean-Luc — she seemed to like his foreign accent, but Jean-Luc also seemed like a natural with kids.

Claire herself tried not to react to the young Frenchman's accent — and when she said something to him that was a little on the flirty side,

she had to stop herself. Thinking: *how would I feel if we had a pretty young French girl as an au pair, and Robert started hitting on her?*

But the rest of the day, as Jean-Luc helped with various chores and let Claire spend most of her time with the kids, it seemed like a highly favorable arrangement.

When Robert came home, he came home to a spotless house and a completely chilled, entirely unstressed wife. And seemingly, as a result, he took an instant shine to Jean-Luc.

Claire was relieved that her husband seemed to like their new au pair.

‘You think he’d do our taxes?’ he joked to Claire that night as they settled down for bed.

‘I wouldn’t be all that surprised if he said yes,’ she smiled.

But that night, they discovered a potential downside to having an au pair staying in their guest bedroom for a while.

That evening, Jean-Luc cooked dinner and then cleared it all away while Robert and Claire sorted out the kids’ bedtimes.

Then Jean-Luc was off the clock, so they left him to his own devices while they watched a little TV before their own bedtime.

When they went upstairs, Robert was teasing Claire about her crush on the new au pair and his sexy French accent. Claire insisted she was merely being friendly with him, making him feel welcome, dismissing her infatuation with the handsome young man as Robert trying to project some kind of kinky wife-sharing fantasy on the situation.

‘If we had a young woman as an au pair and you started hitting on her, it would be *so* inappropriate,’ she pointed out.

‘Yeah,’ Robert grinned. ‘But we don’t.’

But then, when Robert came back from the bathroom after brushing his teeth and donning his PJs, he found that Claire was getting undressed in the bedroom.

A sure sign that she was horny.

‘Look at you,’ Robert smiled, quietly closing the bedroom door before approaching his pretty wife to assist her in removing her bra and panties. ‘Someone’s got you all worked up...’

Claire giggled. ‘Look at you. Just because I’m getting ready for bed... looks like someone’s got you all worked up.’

Robert crouched as he peeled down her panties, and leaned in to kiss her inner thighs, breathing in the thick scent of her arousal.

But then, as his mouth reached her already-dripping pussy, they both realized her moans were getting a little loud.

Usually, at a time like this, one or other of them would drag the other down to the basement for a little chicanery down in the guest bedroom. But that was not possible now.

‘We can be quiet,’ Claire insisted, climbing onto the bed.

The bed springs creaked even while she was simply moving onto the mattress. When Robert lay between her splayed thighs and then slid his hard cock inside her, the creaking was awful.

‘We did it before,’ Claire said. ‘The kids were okay...’

‘Jean-Luc will *hear* us,’ Robert pointed out. ‘Especially if he comes up here because he needs the bathroom...’

‘*Damn*,’ Claire hissed, cursing their decision not to buy the house four blocks over that was smaller, but had a half bathroom in the basement.

They tried doing it away from the bed — Claire leaning over the dresser, Robert fucking her from behind — but even the floor was too creaky. Damn hundred-year-old house.

They had to give up on full sex. They found that Claire could use her mouth and take Robert to his full conclusion. But when he tried to reciprocate, there wasn’t anywhere they could be in that room where it wouldn’t creak or squeak too much. Even if she could keep her mouth tight shut, she couldn’t keep her body still, particularly if she got anywhere close to an orgasm.

It left Robert feeling okay, but Claire feeling distinctly frustrated.

‘We could take a shower,’ Robert suggested. ‘The noise of the shower would hide anything...’

Claire simply sighed and put on her nightwear. ‘A shower, this time of night?’ she said.

‘How does he know we don’t always take showers this time of night?’

‘Even if we did,’ Claire pointed out, ‘the bathroom floor is just as creaky — it’d still be obvious what we’re doing in there.’

Lying in bed, Robert couldn’t help teasing her by suggesting she head down to the basement to see if Jean-Luc wouldn’t mind helping her with her needs. After all, he’d been sent to them by Marriage 2.0.

She only sighed at that. ‘As far as we know, he’s from the Au Pair Program, not Marriage 2.0. They might have sent him, but what’s to say

he's one of their actual 'performers' and not just some ordinary au pair who expects to be treated with common decency and respect?'

The following day, Claire did manage to relieve her frustration during a shower after Robert had gone to work.

But then she spent a day with Jean-Luc, and despite trying not to think about him that way, and feed the monster that was her crush on him, it was damn near impossible.

He was just a good-looking guy.

And he was charming as heck.

And that *accent*.

By the time her husband came home, she was back to feeling crazy-horny and seriously frustrated again. Then, when the kids were asleep, and it was just Robert and Claire, she was positively exasperated.

Robert was amused, and that only made Claire feel irritated. 'Well, you're not getting any, either,' she declared.

When he shrugged at that, she suddenly looked suspicious.

'How come you don't care?' she asked him, then looked shocked. 'You're thinking you're just going to slip away to the bathroom and jack off?'

He shrugged again.

'Hey — that's not fair,' she pouted.

Robert laughed. 'You need to learn to come without crying out and shaking like an earthquake hit.'

Claire put her hands on her hips. 'Okay... show me how you do it without making any noise at all in *this* house.'

'Okay...'

Claire dragged him upstairs and told him to get on with it, standing there with her arms folded to watch him.

'What?' Robert laughed and said quietly, 'You don't think I can do it?'

'Nope.'

Robert stifled his laughter, and as Claire watched, he slowly stripped off his clothes. Was she really going to watch him... *masturbate*? They'd never done anything like this before. Even though they were man and wife and had sex reasonably regularly, they'd never really *talked* about masturbation before — let alone watched each other doing it.

But she stood there, watching him undress. And when he was down to his boxer shorts, and he hesitated before removing them, she said eagerly, 'Aren't you going to take those off, too?'

So he shrugged and took his boxers off too.

Then he sat on the bed, watching her eyes fix on his naked form. Her stubborn pout seemed to soften as she saw him do what she wanted.

But the bed was still too creaky — even when he sat on it. When he took hold of the base of his thickening cock in one hand and started stroking his shaft with the other, the creaking proved too much.

'There,' Claire said, as though he was proving her right.

But not yet giving up, he knelt on the floor and began slowly stroking himself — and he did manage to do it without making a sound.

Claire watched, mesmerized by the sight of her husband jacking his big, hard cock in front of her. After a few minutes, Robert found his initial inhibitions had vanished. He actually enjoyed having her watching — it was pretty clear that it was turning her on.

Quietly, he told her to remove her top. She did so without question, revealing the pleasant sight of her bare midriff and a plain black bra that was sexy merely because it was exposed like this.

He smiled at her as he continued to silently jack his cock. She smiled back dreamily as she watched him. He saw one of her hands slide between her thighs, her fingers pressing against her sex through her clothes.

'Take off your jeans,' he told her.

He wondered if she might refuse — realizing that he was turning her on and that if she stripped off, too, she'd get frustrated when she couldn't do anything about it.

But she didn't question it at all. Just unfastened her fly button, then quietly hauled her jeans down her shapely legs.

He squeezed his big, hard, throbbing cock as he laid eyes on the delicious sight of her in just her bra and panties. Stepping out of her jeans, Claire suddenly seemed to recognize that he was getting off on the sight of her stripping off.

She liked that she was able to turn him on like this. She was delighted that he was tugging himself off to the sight of her.

She did a slow twirl for him to show off her rearview, then she stood facing him, legs slightly parted, letting him ogle her.

'Like what you see?' she grinned, teasing him by slipping one of her bra straps over her shoulder.

'Mmm...' he moaned quietly. 'You're so beautiful, honey.'

‘What d’you want me to do next?’

‘Take off your bra.’

It was probably just ego, but it felt surprisingly good to tell her what to do, and then she did it. Slowly slipping the other bra strap off her shoulder before reaching behind her back to release the catch. Letting her bra fall to reveal her bare breasts and tempting stiff pink nipples.

Still, he *was* able to jerk off without making the floorboards under him creak.

She stepped up to him, teasing him with a closer view. Leaning over him to let her bare breasts hang over his face as he pumped his shaft. Letting him slip one of her nipples into his mouth.

‘Hey!’ she said when he did so, and stepped back. ‘You’re only supposed to be jerking off.’

Robert chuckled quietly. ‘I *was*.’

Then he told her to take off her panties. She thought for a moment before deciding to comply with his command.

When she took them off, she did it incredibly slowly, teasing him all the way. Sliding them down and then pulling them back up before he could see anything. Tugging on them this way and that to stretch the material and pull it close to her sex.

Why had they never done this before?

She finally removed her panties and tossed them to him, half-jokingly. He pressed them up against his face and breathed in her sexy scent, feeling how damp they were — and it was no joke how much it turned him on.

She stepped up to him again, not close enough for him to touch. She teased him, enjoying the power she seemed to hold over him, the way he looked at her and wanted her. The way it thrilled him.

She stepped up close so he could see everything — her breasts, the fur between her legs, her soaking pussy.

He inhaled the spicy scent of her arousal and noticed that she could not resist slipping a couple of fingers inside her glistening pink slit.

‘*Come*, my darling,’ she cooed, never taking her eyes off his hard cock as he stroked it. ‘I want to see you come without making a sound...’

But Robert wasn’t ready yet. He put one hand on her hip as he stroked his shaft with the other.

He slid his hand over her stomach, enjoying the shape of her body and the softness of her skin, before running the backs of his fingers through the soft, dark fur over her mound.

‘I’m so wet for you, my darling,’ she said as his fingers reached the molten fire between her legs and slid between her dewy lips.

‘Are you wet for me, or for him?’ he said, gazing up at her with a smile.

She looked shocked, and whispered, ‘What’re you talking about?’

Robert grinned like a fox who’d caught a beautiful hen. ‘You enjoy flirting with him, don’t you? And that *accent*... I bet that just melts you inside...’

‘No...’ she insisted, but her insistence was somewhat undermined by the moan she let out as her husband stroked her pussy from within.

‘I don’t blame you, sweetie,’ Robert said. ‘He’s very handsome, isn’t he? And charming, too...’

‘Robert... he’s...’

‘I know. The *au pair*. But you can fantasize, right?’

‘Hey, that’s *dangerous*...’ she warned as he thrust his fingers into her, starting a rhythm.

He leaned in and clamped his mouth to her pussy, tilting his head to get the best fit to slip his tongue inside her and taste her savory goodness. As he sampled her flavor, he could hear her stifling a moan.

Then she said, ‘No...’ but as she said it, she put her hands on his head, pulling his face tight against her sex, not allowing him to stop.

This new *au pair* might have stopped them from their usual efforts in the guest bedroom, but he had turned Claire into a horny minx. Robert was loving it. And now, as he did his best to fuck her with his tongue, she was holding his head and pumping her hips to grind against his mouth.

She was fucking his face.

When he felt her legs begin to weaken, he pulled back and urged her to come down, to lower herself onto him.

He was still kneeling as she impaled herself on his oh-so-stiff cock, though he spread his thighs a little for added stability.

As he felt her hot pussy engulf his manhood, he gazed into her desperate eyes. He touched a forefinger to his lips to bid her to remain silent. It was a big ask, but she clamped her mouth shut and gave him a little nod in compliance.

He said, ‘Try not to move, my sweet,’ he said. ‘Don’t move at all.’

She did her best. He stirred his big, hard cock within her, jiggling his hips a little without any dramatic movements. They’d never done it like this, but the size of his cock was very much in their favor — along with the amount Claire had been wound up by the presence of their new *au pair*.

Robert rocked his lap underneath her, and managed a kind of limited-torque action that might not feel earth-shattering immediately, but somehow developed cumulatively until Claire started quietly whining, her body shivering as he held her.

‘Don’t move, my sweet, don’t move,’ he ordered, holding her tighter in his arms.

She did as he said, though it wasn’t easy for her. Somehow, though, the fact that this wasn’t easy only enhanced the heat between them. That and the fact that in this position, Robert was deep inside her — and he wasn’t pulling out his cock, only stirring it within her, so he was able to shift so that it felt deeper than she’d ever felt before.

It was just breathtaking.

‘I bet he’s down there right now, thinking about you, my sweet,’ Robert murmured in her ear, making her whimper. ‘I bet he’s lying in bed, picturing your face as he strokes his big, hard cock...’

‘Oh, *God*...’ Claire moaned, a touch too loudly.

Robert clamped a hand over her mouth and flashed his eyes in warning, but he broke into a broad smile all the same.

And he didn’t stop murmuring in her ear.

‘You think he’s so good-looking, don’t you Claire? A beautiful young man... he’s got to be 15 years younger than us, right? I bet he could go all night long...’

‘Mmm...’ she moaned, muffled by his hand.

‘You could sneak down there at night. Nobody would know,’ her husband said. ‘I bet he’d be *thrilled* if you did... can you imagine how it would be? He’d be speaking to you in French as he pounds his big cock into you again and again...’

Robert could feel Claire’s orgasm coming, he could feel her body beginning to shudder and shake.

But he tensed his muscles and held her tight while continuing to tell her how it would feel if she gave herself fully to the young Frenchman.

And so she did manage to come without making the room tremor and the floorboards creak. Robert could remove his hand from her mouth, and she was just panting and gasping, somehow keeping herself from whimpering or crying out.

They’d never ever done it like this, but it felt just sensational. They held each other, clamped their mouths shut, and gazed into each other’s eyes as they came powerfully, and Robert filled her so deeply with his hot cream.

‘Oh, Jesus... Oh, Jesus... Oh, Jesus...’ she whispered as the wave broke all over them.

Claire unable to shake the mental image her husband had placed in her head: of sneaking down for secret sex with their hunky au pair. Robert picturing his wife being tempted into wicked, adulterous sex in the basement.

Maybe it wouldn’t be so bad having a guest in the house.

EPISODE 3

I t wasn't her fault.

It *totally* wasn't her fault.

There was this guy around the house now, the whole time — and he was gorgeous. He was a little on the young side, sure, but just stunning to look at — and he had the kind of effortless charm that could have won over the Ice Queen of Narnia.

And he was *French*.

For a few days, he really did take care of practically everything around the house without getting particularly involved with the kids, so that Claire was the one spending time with Ashley and Petey. It was just fantastic. Help around the house — without guilt.

And though it was still tiring being the constant mom-of-two, the comparison to how it had been was just life-changing.

And yeah, the fact that she was more relaxed and cheerful all day might have added to the fact that Jean-Luc was around her all the time, resulting in how she was now.

How she was now horny *AF*.

All the time.

Jesus, he only had to walk through the room. She'd be sitting, minding her own business, before suddenly noticing this gentle but oh-so-manly scent that just made her insides turn to goo and her pussy start buzzing like a beehive. And, of course, she'd glance up, and there he'd be.

What kind of cologne did he wear? God, her panties were damp from 9am when he clocked on, to 7pm when he was officially off duty.

And it wasn't just that he got everything done — the cooking, the cleaning, the grocery ordering, the laundry, the paperwork — but he was subtly flirtatious with her non-stop. And often, not-so-subtle. And that

meant that as well as feeling relaxed and entirely without anxiety, she also felt desirable.

So when Robert came home, dinner was done, and the kiddos were finally asleep, of course she would drag her husband straight into the bedroom to try out some more of their new, patent-pending silent sex.

They were actually getting pretty good at getting each other off without making a sound.

But that didn't deal with Claire being still horny *AF* all day with this gorgeous young Frenchman constantly around her.

Robert liked to tease her about it — he'd send her text messages from work telling her to stop staring at the au pair. And the most annoying thing was when he sent a text message like that, invariably, she would realize that her husband had been bang on the money, without even being there to tell.

Jean-Luc didn't seem to mind when she was staring. He'd caught her a few times, and she'd blush and look away.

Then one morning before Robert went to work, her husband had run out of socks, so she'd volunteered to go down to the laundry room in the basement to fetch a pair that had just been washed. Robert had been on his way to take a shower in the bathroom as she'd gone downstairs. But then there was a distraction in the kitchen, where Ashley had been attempting to feed Petey his morning's solid food, so she'd been diverted by that.

When she went back upstairs with Robert's socks, she naturally knocked on the bathroom door and opened it to hand her husband his socks.

Only when she went into the bathroom, it hadn't been Robert taking a shower.

She'd frozen from pure surprise — but then Jean-Luc turned around and saw her gazing at him. And she was rooted to the spot as she took in the phenomenal sight of his naked body under a stream of under-pressured water.

'I'm *so* sorry...' she eventually managed to utter before staggering out of there.

But Jean-Luc had merely stood there, not even covering up his exposed manhood, as she'd gawped at him like some kind of astonished teenager.

Oh, Jesus, he looked like a model without his clothes on. A seriously well-hung model. And he'd calmly allowed her to look at him as long as she'd wanted.

She wandered into the bedroom to hand Robert his socks, looking like someone had plugged her into the mains electricity.

‘What’s up?’ her husband said as he gratefully took the socks from her.

‘I thought you were in the shower,’ she said.

‘You went in there?’

‘He just let me stare at him. Didn’t even grab a towel or anything. Just stood there and showed me everything.’

Robert smiled. ‘You have been flirting with him ever since he got here. So maybe he is one of those performers Gillian was talking about.’

‘He... but he... but.... He...’ Claire was totally flustered, realizing that Robert was practically dressed and would be leaving her alone with the gorgeous Frenchman all day.

‘Maybe when the kids are having a nap, you should get him to give you a nice back rub,’ Robert suggested, still in tease mode.

Claire caught her breath at that. ‘No...’

Robert grinned the grin of someone who wouldn’t have to be around here all day to deal with the consequences. When he strode out of the bedroom to head downstairs and out the door, as he went by he knocked on the bathroom door and called out to Jean-Luc.

Now wrapped in a towel, the sultry Frenchman opened the bathroom door only for Robert to say, ‘Uh... Jean-Luc. If you get a chance... Claire’s feeling a little *tense* this morning... perhaps you could help her out with a back rub?’

Jean-Luc looked over to Claire, who stood horrified just outside the main bedroom — looking every bit as tense as Robert had suggested to the au pair — and he smiled.

‘Of course, Mr. Sayers,’ the Frenchman said. ‘I’d be very happy to help in any way Mrs. Sayer needs.’

Reaching the bottom of the stairs, Robert glanced up to give Claire a wicked, teasing look, and then he was gone for the day.

So, it was *mostly* Robert’s fault.

Claire felt awkward around Jean-Luc all morning. Still horny AF, but awkward as well. The young Frenchman didn’t seem awkward at all. He was just as self-confident and efficient and charming as ever.

Damn her husband for putting her in that position.

Every time she laid eyes on him, she pictured him standing in the shower — his sculpted physique, washboard abs, and that magnificent beast hanging between his powerful thighs.

Was he bigger than Robert? She couldn't tell. But he was different; he was younger, he was ripped, he sounded different, he smelled different. He was not her husband. He made butterflies flutter in her chest in a way that her husband did not — not to say she didn't love Robert with all her heart, and she did desire him. But this was just new and shiny.

Still, she felt embarrassed to feel this way around him. He was their au pair, after all.

She was quietly hoping he'd forget about what Robert had asked of him when the time came for the kids to actually go down for their afternoon nap. Perhaps he'd think Robert was joking because of what had happened when she'd accidentally walked in on Jean-Luc taking a shower.

But then the time came, and suddenly the house was too quiet.

And Jean-Luc was waiting for her at the bottom of the stairs, asking her, 'Would you like me to give you that back rub, Mrs. Sayers?'

The trouble was, Claire hadn't come up with a suitable excuse not to. Presented with his offer now, she felt like it would be more awkward and embarrassing to turn down the back rub. It would almost be like admitting she was too attracted to him to risk a simple back rub, wouldn't it? It would draw attention to the inappropriate way in which she now thought of their au pair.

After all, her husband had suggested the back rub. So why wouldn't Jean-Luc suppose it meant a purely innocent massage of the shoulders and back?

'Okay then — if you really don't mind,' she said, indicating that it would be a bit of a chore for him, thereby underlining the sense that this whole back rub thing was meant as nothing more than some kind of therapeutic remedy for stiff muscles.

'It would be no problem at all,' the Frenchman smiled. 'Should we find somewhere you can lie down comfortably?' he suggested, gesturing toward the stairs down to the basement.

'Oh... uh...' The thought of using Jean-Luc's bedroom suddenly seemed too risky to Claire. She didn't want it turning into anything *inappropriate* just because they were lying on a bed together. She glanced at the couch in the living room and said, 'Or we could do it sitting down?'

‘I think it would be more effective if you’re stretched out properly on a bed,’ he said.

‘I guess...’ She nodded. The way he’d used the word ‘effective’ seemed to reassure her that he intended nothing more than an innocent massage.

But then, as he shepherded her toward the descending steps, he said something that made her feel less reassured: ‘If we use my room, the children won’t hear.’

Yet it was too late to object now.

Claire clutched the baby monitor and followed the young Frenchman downstairs. She was feeling a little nervous. But what was she worried about — that he’d try something on her, or that she’d be tempted to try something on him?

But as they went into Jean-Luc’s room, her anxiety was turning into a kind of low-grade excitement at the thought of this handsome guy putting his hands all over her.

She tried to force herself not to feel sexual arousal.

‘How do you want me?’ she asked him.

Jean-Luc’s room was immaculately clean and tidy. They’d never had much in the way of storage in their basement guest room — just a tiny closet in the corner — but somehow he had managed to stash all his belongings away. There was zero clutter in there — it felt very zen.

‘On the bed?’ he said gently, without any hint of forcefulness.

‘Okay...’ she said.

‘Oh — do you happen to have any oil in the house?’ he asked her. ‘It would be better...’

She took a moment to think, and was about to apologetically concede that about all they had was canola oil and extra virgin olive oil in the kitchen — when she remembered a bath salts set Robert had got her for the previous Christmas.

Jean-Luc smiled. ‘Why don’t I go get it, and give you a little time to get ready on the bed?’

‘Uh... *sure*...’

He left her feeling nervous again. What did he mean ‘give her time to get ready on the bed’? He was just going to give her a back rub, wasn’t he? Surely he didn’t expect her to take off her clothes, or anything like that?

Hmm. But he was planning on using massage oil. That would make it feel better. She wouldn’t like to get oil all over her clothes, though...

With a flutter of anxiety in her chest, she peeled off her long-sleeve t-shirt. Well... if he saw her in her bra, that wouldn't be too embarrassing, would it?

She climbed onto the bed and lay on her front. The bedsheets smelled mildly of *him* — well, of course they did. It was a very alluring scent, though it did nothing to help her keep a lid on her libido. There was something thrilling about how different it was from her husband's scent.

Was it so wrong to feel a thrill from the idea of being with a man who was not her husband?

She knew Robert wouldn't have a problem with it. When they'd been in Rome, she'd slept with another man. A lot. And afterward, it seemed like Robert only loved her *more* — and that her adulterous adventure during the Marriage 2.0 had made him *more* attracted to her.

But this was about her own sense of dignity and self-confidence.

And, somehow, she was paranoid about the story getting out to friends and family. Do you know that she slept with the au pair? Seriously. A male au pair. She couldn't keep her hands off him while her husband was at work.

Then he was back, declaring cheerfully, 'I found it — it was just where you said it would be.'

'Great,' she said, feeling apprehensive, now, that he would think her a prude because she'd only removed her top.

He was French. The French were more free and open about nudity, weren't they?

But he didn't say anything about her state of attire. He helped her brush her hair up and out of the way of her back as she lay there, and then she heard him oiling up his hands.

And then, he was *touching* her.

He started on the middle of her back, then her shoulders, spreading the oil over her skin, pressing his hands against her flesh, kneading her muscles. It felt so good. Better than good.

It would have felt good if Robert had been the one doing it. But this was another man, a younger man, a handsome French man — a man on whom she had a foolish, schoolgirl-style crush.

And so, even beyond the sensation of the massage, the fact that he was touching her, looking at her, focusing all his attention on her gave her a kind of strange exhilaration.

It was a little sexual in nature, sure, but not totally.

She'd heard of people calling a feeling like this 'ASMR.' She wasn't sure what the acronym stood for, though. When he touched her, it gave

her a strange but delightful tingling sensation that started on her head and spread down the back of her neck and her spine.

It all added to her state of relaxation and mild sexual arousal to develop into a real sense of euphoria.

It meant that as Jean-Luc continued to massage her back, Claire couldn't help but emit little sighs and moans — which risked sounding sexual in nature.

'You've done this before,' she said after a while.

Jean-Luc chuckled. 'Many times,' he said. 'When I was in university... it was seen as a good way to become... how d'you say... popular with the girls.'

'I bet it was,' Claire laughed. 'You must have been pretty popular.'

'I could not complain,' he said.

He had a very calming, comforting presence, which did not seem like something you could learn. It was purely part of who he was. He worked diligently around Claire's back and her shoulders, and it felt absolutely incredible.

But it got to a point where he'd done her back and her shoulders and the back of her neck and her spine and her lower back. It was starting to feel as though he couldn't go on massaging those same areas.

She felt almost upset that this massage was going to come to an end.

So when he quietly said, 'Do you want me to do your legs, Mrs. Sayers?'

She instantly said, 'Sure... that would be lovely...' without really thinking about it.

She'd been wearing a pair of black leggings — she often did around the house when it was just her and the kiddos, leggings were so easy and comfortable, and she had a ton of them if baby Pete happened to vomit on them, or have an accident, or throw pudding down her lap.

But now Jean-Luc was massaging her calves and thighs through the leggings, and it suddenly seemed they were made of incredibly thin material.

Oh, but it felt good, though.

'You want me to try with the oil on your legs?' he said.

At first, she didn't understand what he meant. Then she did.

'Oh. *Uh*... I guess so...'

He hesitated, and she quickly realized he was waiting for her to remove her leggings. Christ. She suddenly felt very self-conscious. She tried to remind herself that he was French, so not only was any kind of

nudity no big deal for him, but probably he'd seen everything anyway. He'd been popular with the *laydeez*.

It was embarrassing to strip down to your bra and panties when your crush was just standing there watching you, though.

She glanced up at him, and he smiled as she lifted her hips to haul down her leggings. Oh, Jesus, there were her panties. Should she have put on nicer panties since she knew there was a chance Jean-Luc would follow through on Robert's request to give her a massage this afternoon? But this morning, Robert had only called it a back rub.

But perhaps if she'd worn sluttier underwear, Jean-Luc would have thought she's had intentions toward him all along.

Anyway.

Claire lay back down, turned her head away from Jean-Luc again, and tried to relax. Now he was oiling up her legs, from her ankles up to the tops of her thighs.

Jesus, he got *close*.

He started coaxing her muscles again, steadily from the calves on up. Giving her that dreamy ASMR sensation again. Making her moan quietly.

Oh, God. Then he was doing her thighs.

Oh, but it felt so wonderful, his hands gliding over her greased skin, pushing against the muscles in her thighs, kneading out the tension. But the edges of his hands were getting super close to her *business*.

Then he was massaging her *ass*, for Christ's sake. Kneading her *butt cheeks*.

True, it really felt like professional treatment. This wasn't just a glorified college boy who'd found a guaranteed way into the panties of various French girls at university.

'You've had training,' she said, 'haven't you? Like, professionally.'

'Some,' he admitted, and actually, it made her feel a little better that he'd just been touching her ass.

Now he went back to rubbing her back — well, some new tension had crept in since she'd removed her leggings in his presence.

'Was that training in France, or when you came to America?' she asked him.

'America,' he said.

She said, 'And this wouldn't be...a normal part of the Au Pair Program, would it? I mean... and the way you've been letting me do most of the childcare while you've been taking care of everything else.'

'No,' he agreed. 'It's not part of the Au Pair Program.'

She turned toward him, twisting so that she could look up into his face. ‘So you are part of the Marriage 2.0 program?’ she asked him, straight out.

‘Yes,’ he said, and Claire heard herself gasp. Jean-Luc added, ‘I thought we made that clear, Mrs. Sayers.’

‘We thought... well, there was a chance you were just an au pair.’

‘I’m not just an au pair,’ he said, and as though to emphasize the point, he swept his oiled hand right over her buttocks again — under the waistband of her panties — down to her upper thighs.

‘Oh, that feels nice...’ she moaned, feeling suddenly emboldened in her temptation to be inappropriate with the au pair.

Well, he wasn’t just an au pair, was he.

‘Jean-Luc...’ she said, ‘When they told you what you were supposed to do for Robert and me... how far did they tell you that you could go?’

The Frenchman said, ‘I’m here for whatever you and Mr. Sayers might need...’

His hands now swept up her thighs — and actually brushed up against her pussy, albeit so briefly she could almost have believed she imagined it.

The touch may have been brief, but suddenly it was like the final straw that broke the camel’s back. Or, in this case, brushed the camel toe. Claire felt the heat inside her body flare up, and the familiar fizzing, buzzing, blooming ecstasy erupt between her thighs, and then wash over her shuddering, quivering body.

She couldn’t help but cry out, and while painfully aware that Jean-Luc was right there, she could not quell the minor seizure, the jerking, twisting, and writhing of her body as it was taken by the wave of energy.

He’d made her come.

It had snuck up on her after a slow, prolonged massage — but then, as subtle as it had been in arriving, it was so insanely intense when it hit her. She felt like she’d been lying quietly on a beach, and then a silent tsunami had crashed all over her.

‘Oh God... oh God... oh *God*...’ she was moaning.

Then, so super aware that Jean-Luc was right there, so humiliatingly close as she had a freaking orgasm right in front of him, she went into full apologetic mode. She felt like she’d dived into a swimming pool on school sports day, only to realize she hadn’t put on her swimsuit.

‘Oh God, I’m *so* sorry. I don’t know what came over me...’

Jean-Luc merely smiled, ‘Hey, don’t worry about a thing, Mrs. Sayers. I just hope that I could make you feel good...’

She felt so embarrassed.

She grabbed her clothes and apologized again, and then she just had to get out of there.

What must he have thought of her?

One little massage and she was moaning and groaning and *coming* like she'd never even touched a boy before. Or had a boy touch her, she meant.

She put her clothes back on in the living room, blushing like she'd rolled around in poison ivy or something. Upstairs, she tried to calm down. Told herself this was Marriage 2.0. Jean-Luc had confirmed he was part of the program.

They were supposed to arrange erotic adventures, weren't they?

She texted her husband. Told him Jean-Luc had given her a nice back rub. Didn't go into details about the back rub, but she did tell Robert that their French au pair had confirmed that he was fully part of Marriage 2.0. He wasn't just an 'innocent' au pair.

Robert texted back: *Hmm. Very interesting.*

EPISODE 4

‘**Y**ou would like your massage now, Mrs. Sayers?’

She was just breathless with excitement when he said that.

‘Uh... *yes*. Right... of *course*...’

As soon as Ashley and Pete were down for their nap the following day, Claire’s heart rate started picking up. She could feel every beat of her cardiac muscle inside her chest — it felt like someone had just injected her with pure adrenaline.

She ambled down the stairs wondering whether Jean-Luc was really going to do as Robert had asked that morning.

‘You want to go make yourself comfortable? I’ll just get the oil.’

‘Yes, right.’

‘There’s a towel on the bed.’

A towel. He hadn’t offered her a towel last time. But last time, it was supposed to be only a back rub. A pure, innocent back rub. She hadn’t taken off her clothes. Even when things had started heating up, she’d left her underwear on. Well, her panties, at least.

This time, he was offering her a towel. He was expecting her to strip off completely, wasn’t he?

She was going to get naked for a man who was not her husband.

She watched him creep silently up the stairs, moving so carefully to avoid waking the kiddos. Then she took a deep, deep breath and went down into the basement.

Her pussy was throbbing already. Jesus. And he hadn’t even touched her yet.

After what had happened yesterday, Robert had come home after work just besotted with her. Obsessed, you might say. Every opportunity he had to touch her, he took. His kiss when he first greeted her, he sucked on her lips and breathed her in, like he couldn’t get enough of her.

During dinner, he'd get up to get more water, or the ketchup, or the salt, or more pasta — and each time, he'd brush a hand gently along her shoulders. Reminding her, each time, what Jean-Luc had done to her.

She was just high on his intense desire for her.

Jean-Luc had disappeared for the evening back to his basement den. Robert had eventually managed to get Petey to sleep while Claire read Ashley her bedtime story.

Then, after the long wait to ensure sleep was sound, there was no settling in front of the TV for the evening.

Robert had dragged Claire into the main bedroom for another round of the World Silent Sex Championships. And after an ebullient half hour of stifled sighs, swallowed moans, and intensely muted movements, both were duly crowned WSS Champions.

They were getting good at that. They were practically tantric masters by now.

Robert had been all over her, of course. It was so much fun how crazy he was for her — merely because another man had given her a back rub. And brushed his hand briefly against her pussy.

In the morning, she'd been feeding Petey in the kitchen and had overheard Robert talking with Jean-Luc in the living room — and she distinctly heard her husband ask their au pair to give her another massage if there was time.

It made her gasp.

It made her accidentally try to stick a spoon of Bolognese into Petey's eye.

Her husband was shameless, she thought.

Then she reminded herself that Jean-Luc had confirmed he was working directly for Marriage 2.0. This was kind of what he was here for.

Then Ashley had walked in, trailing Bunny along the floor behind her, and the two-year-old had asked her, entirely innocently, 'What's a *'happy ending,'* mommy?'

So here she was, mid-afternoon, the kids were napping peacefully, and she was drifting downstairs to Jean-Luc's bedroom for another massage.

And her husband had asked him to give her a happy ending.

Jesus wept.

She was so embarrassed. And so excited. She was a mass of confusing emotions. She felt like the snake pit from *Raiders of the Lost Ark*.

And here was the au pair's bed with a clean, white towel folded perfectly, ready for her to drape over herself. It was proof that he expected her to be fully naked this time.

God.

Oh, she was wet already. Would he think her a shameless hussy if he found her soaking wet when he accidentally let a hand brush against her pussy this time?

From upstairs, she heard Jean-Luc starting down the stairs again from the bathroom. Another deep breath, and she decided there was nothing for it but to go for it. Like diving into an icy swimming pool.

She peeled off her clothes as quickly as possible so she could be on the bed, safely under the towel, by the time he arrived. Thankfully, he had to take his time down the stairs to avoid too many creaks.

'Ugh...' she sighed as she slipped down her panties, seeing how damp they were already.

Naked as a jaybird, she lay on the bed and pulled the towel over herself. Shivering, though it wasn't too cold in that basement room. Breathing in and out, slowly, calmly, every breath laced with the smell of Jean-Luc, and with the memory of how he'd made her come the last time she lay here.

'There,' he said, sounding pleased that she was in position, apparently ready.

Naked.

Jeez. Was she a loser because she'd Googled 'happy ending' while Ashley watched *Daniel Tiger* that morning? She could hardly believe Robert had asked Jean-Luc such a thing.

Had her husband merely been making a joke with Jean-Luc?

Now as she heard the young Frenchman rubbing his oiled-up hands together in preparation for the massage, Claire suddenly felt seriously self-conscious about getting naked. Maybe Robert had been fooling around with Jean-Luc and had joked about a 'happy ending'?

You could hardly leave it to a two-year-old to determine the nuance of adult conversation.

And now she'd taken off all her clothes.

What must he think of her?

And yet Jean-Luc hardly seemed shocked. He was French, of course, so there was that.

Claire felt her heart beating insanely quickly inside her chest. Could Jean-Luc hear it? It sounded like someone drumming their fingers on a tabletop, for goodness' sake. Google had said a 'happy ending,' officially, meant some kind of orgasm given to a client at the end of a massage. 'Usually a hand job or blow job.' Thanks, Google. Apparently, women didn't usually get happy endings in proper massage places.

'Okay. Are you comfortable?'

God, his voice could get her horny.

'Uh... yeah. Yeah, thanks.'

Then he peeled away her towel. She was mortified. What was the point in even having it there? Deep breath. She didn't feel in any position to complain. In fact, she wondered if this was how it usually was — she'd never really had proper massages before. If she did demand the towel back, she might look even more ridiculous.

She didn't have anything to be embarrassed about, she told herself. She was in relatively good shape.

Jean-Luc brushed her hair out of the way of her shoulders and then gently but firmly took her arms and placed them by her sides. Oh, even brief touches from him felt electric.

Now he put his hands on her back and began working the oil into her skin along her spine and lower back before spreading it up to her shoulders and upper arms.

Oh, it felt just divine.

'Oh... that feels nice...' she moaned, not meaning her thoughts to spill out into words, but they just seemed to escape.

'That's good,' Jean-Luc said. 'You are feeling a little tense. You'd do better to try to relax...'

'Okay...'

The trouble was that if she relaxed fully while he stroked and kneaded her back, then she would start drifting off to sleep. She was getting that giddy, tingling sensation again as he tended to her — ASMR. She'd looked it up since the previous day. Autonomous sensory meridian response. The feelings of euphoria, relaxation, or well-being from someone giving you personal attention.

She was pretty sure he'd made her come so easily — without really even touching her private parts — because of the whole ASMR thing.

Today felt even more intense. She was naked, as he focused his attention on her. She felt exposed, vulnerable — and yet, at the same time, somehow beautiful, proud, worshipped.

Jean-Luc started spreading oil over her legs, parting her thighs a little more so that he could access her thighs — and she knew he must be getting the full view of her sex. She felt terrified and intensely aroused at the same time.

Could he see how wet she was?

He seemed to use a lot of oil on her legs. More so than on her shoulders or her back. Noticeably more on her thighs, too, than lower down.

His hands swept over her butt cheeks and down again to her inner thighs — right at the top, perilously close to her pussy.

‘Are you okay, Mrs. Sayers?’ he asked her quietly.

‘Oh, yes,’ she said. ‘Yes, I’m fine...’

‘You can tell me to stop at any time,’ he said. ‘If you feel uncomfortable, or...’

‘Oh, I’m very comfortable,’ she said, so relaxed her words seemed to slur. She thought she must sound drunk or something.

She seemed to pass a point where she felt she’d been exposed under his gaze for so long that it no longer mattered what he saw — or, importantly, what he touched. He was from Marriage 2.0, wasn’t he? The program was supposed to arrange erotic adventures for clients.

And her husband had told him to give her a happy ending.

Jean-Luc put more oil on his hands and concentrated on her thighs and her buttocks for a few minutes — and his hands did get close to her sex again, sweeping in so that the edges of his hands practically did graze against her outer labia.

Then he said, ‘Turn over, please.’

She caught her breath at this instruction. He hadn’t asked this of her the previous day. Despite her newfound boldness, she hadn’t figured on lying face up.

But again, she hardly felt in a position to refuse him.

She turned over and lay on her back. Arms straight by her side, resting on the pillow. Looking like a massage client, not a woman trying to appear seductive.

But still — she was completely on display.

He put more oil on his hands — they were going to run out soon, at this rate — and then he started sweeping his hands over her stomach. She moaned a little; it felt so good. It felt the way it had when he’d been doing her back — except that now, his hands moved up and over her bare breasts.

Oh, God.

For a while, he worked his hands all over her torso just as though he was doing somebody's back and shoulders. It almost felt like he'd overlooked the fact that she had breasts, that her nipples were sticking straight up, sensitive as anything.

And yet, when he focused on her breasts themselves, his hands centered over them, his fingers swirling around them — it was clear he knew what he was doing.

Oh, Wow.

It felt just incredible. She felt electricity rippling all through her body, heat, and energy blooming out from her manhandled tits all down her spine to her sex, and all the way down to her toes.

A few more minutes of that, and he'd have her coming again.

But then he moved down to spread some fresh oil on her legs and thighs.

She moaned quietly as his hands veered close to her pussy again. Then, they swept over her abdomen and over her mound. She held her breath, desperately hoping he wouldn't leave her hanging. His hands dived down between her thighs, pressing against her outer labia on either side.

And then, glory alleluia, first one hand and then the other glided over her sex. Full, unbridled, magnificent contact.

She had to resist letting out a long moan. She still felt a strange societal pressure to not be seen to be enjoying this too much. To admit that she was lying on a stranger's bed being fingered by a man who was not her husband.

She sucked breath in through her teeth as he slid his fingers through her slippery folds, touching her like a real expert.

She was trying to use every trick in the book she'd learned with Robert in how to experience sexual delights without moving too much, without making too much noise. Getting in tune with her identity as a World Silent Sex Champion.

But now he had one hand pretending to be a g-string she was wearing, wedged between her inner thighs — and one finger slipped deep inside her to continue to manipulate her from within.

'Oh...' a moan escaped her tight control. She couldn't help it.

Now he put one hand over her mound, pressing against her clit in the most wonderful way — while the other worked his digits inside her. Thrusting, but with only tiny movements — vibrating inside her, rather than really fucking her. It reminded her of sitting on Robert's cock at night while trying not to move.

But this was not Robert. His touch was different, his smell was different, his smile was different.

‘Feels good?’ he smiled down at her.

‘Oh yes,’ she beamed, suddenly feeling the most brutal need to fuck him.

Then the moment was disturbed by a God-awful bleating sound.

Her phone.

Both of them dived for the pile of her clothes, desperate to stop the dreadful noise before it woke the little ones upstairs, and this whole magnificent intermission would be over.

Jean-Luc passed the phone quickly to her.

Robert.

She accepted the call. ‘What’re you doing calling right now?’

‘Sorry, couldn’t resist.’

‘You could’ve woken the kids...’

‘But you’re in the basement, right?’

‘Well yeah...’

‘Show me.’

‘You’re somewhere safe at work?’

‘In the restroom. Safe enough.’

They had to switch to a FaceTime call. The anxiety that suddenly gripped her at the notion of her husband seeing her all naked like this, covered in oil, another man’s hands all over her — well, they were tempered by the sense that this was his fault. He had requested Jean-Luc do this ‘happy ending’ for her.

She liked the idea of shocking her husband.

‘Wow,’ Robert said.

‘This is what you wanted?’

‘Oh yes...’

Jean-Luc didn’t seem to have any inhibitions at all. As Claire held out the phone to try to give her husband the full view of her nudity, the young Frenchman resumed his focused attention on her pussy.

‘Oh yes...’ she heard Robert moaning quietly as she directed the phone’s camera toward her sex as the Frenchman’s fingers began thrusting into her soaking entrance.

Then he said, ‘Does it feel good, honey?’

‘Oh yes...’

‘You know he has professional experience.’

‘Oh, I guessed he did...’

‘Is he hard for you, my darling?’ Robert said, and Claire gasped. She gazed up at Jean-Luc, horrified at her husband saying something so personal about him, super apologetic in case he was offended.

But Jean-Luc was smiling warmly.

As he continued to stroke her pussy with one hand, the other he withdrew from her breast and picked up her nearest hand, bringing it to the bulge in his pants.

Claire gasped again.

‘He is, isn’t he?’ Robert said from the phone. Then, ‘Why don’t you ask him if he’d like to get it out for you. To let you play with it.’

‘Honey!’

‘Jean-Luc, would you like to show my sweet wife what you’re hiding there?’ Robert called out.

‘Of course, Mr. Sayers.’

Then he was removing his pants. His underwear. He was standing there in just a shirt, his legs lean and powerful looking, his cock exposed, and standing up straight.

Claire’s eyes widened, her mouth opened wide.

She looked up at his face again, and couldn’t help but reflect his mischievous smile back at him. Then she put her hand on his cock, curling her fingers around the shaft. And as he reached forward to continue stroking her pussy, she began pumping that delicious-looking cock.

‘Move a little closer to him, honey,’ Robert ordered her. ‘Why don’t you offer him a little real fun?’

She wasn’t sure what her husband was telling her to do — but she felt that urge to try to shock him, or impress him.

She swiveled a little on the bed so that her head was close to Jean-Luc’s crotch. Then she brought it to her mouth, stretching her lips around it. She had to turn her body, pick herself up from the mattress and twist herself a little so she could sink her mouth down on his beautiful cock.

But then there she was, sucking him.

It was so wrong. It seemed he was so much younger than she was — barely out of college. But he was so handsome. Now as she sucked on him, he peeled off his shirt to reveal the kind of torso that teenage girls would want on posters pinned to their bedroom walls.

‘Do you have much time before the kids wake up?’ Robert said.

Claire withdrew the young Frenchman’s cock from her mouth, and glanced at the time on her phone. ‘Half an hour, twenty minutes if we’re lucky?’

Robert said, 'Climb onto the bed, Jean-Luc. I want to see you fuck her.'

Claire caught her breath again. Her husband seemed so much better at shocking her than she was at him.

But Jean-Luc did precisely as he was asked, climbing onto the bed, kneeling between Claire's splayed thighs. And she went along with all of it, without question. It brought back memories of Rome, of taking the bold leap to fuck Mason. And of how much Robert had wanted her when they'd finally gotten back together at the end of the week.

Robert put an arm around her waist and pulled her closer to him. Then he laid his thick, hard cock between her legs, and Claire nearly came then and there.

He smiled at her, and she smiled brightly back at him. A silent expression of consent between them.

She widened her thighs as further encouragement for him.

Then he touched the tip of his cock to her entrance. She felt him lean into her, his weight behind his manhood so that it sank right into her, squeezing into her well-oiled sex, making the most of the massage oil and Claire's copious wetness.

God.

He was inside her.

'Can you see, my darling?' she whispered into the phone, and directed it so that her husband could see for himself; another man's dick sank balls deep in her dripping wet pussy.

'Oh, you're so beautiful, my sweet. He's so hard for you...'

The Frenchman started squeezing his hips, thrusting into her. She smiled up at him, moaned a little at how good it felt as he rocked her entire body with each thrust.

'Quickly,' she whispered. 'Fuck me... we don't have much time...'

She was flushed and glistening with oil, but with two men gazing on as Jean-Luc fucked her, she felt like some divine entity, adored and worshipped.

He wasn't wearing a condom, but it was too late to worry about that. They had to trust the program. Everything was supposed to be designed by science, right? And now, Claire wanted to feel the young Frenchman erupt deep inside her.

He stood on the floor, and she angled herself toward him, her butt on the edge of the mattress. From there, he could pound into her and bring both of them to the most massive orgasm in almost no time at all.

She was just about able to clutch the phone so that her husband could see, moaning, 'I'm coming, my darling... he's making me come...'

Then she heard Robert saying, 'Come inside her, Jean-Luc. I want to see you come inside her...'

And she felt the gorgeous adonis let loose, his cream shooting out deep within her, a wonderful thing in and of itself. But the fact that she'd just heard her loving husband telling this stallion to come inside her tipped her over the edge into full orgasm.

She was shuddering and jerking and crying out as the overwhelming power burst into flames inside her.

A God in human form sank his glorious manhood deep inside her again and again, shooting his thick cream deep within her, making her feel like the most beautiful woman alive — and so vibrant and joyous and fertile.

She was gasping for breath when he was finally done, rolling off her and onto his back.

God, she felt so alive.

She told her husband to hurry home. And a little later, she wasn't surprised when he texted her, letting her know he'd faked illness. That one of his colleagues would handle the afternoon's soccer practice. That he was on his way home to claim back his gorgeous, sexy, deliciously unfaithful wife.

EPISODE 5

‘Daddy’s home!’

The kids were excited he was home early, of course.

But for once, their au pair was actively shepherding them away to take care of them, telling them they’d see their Daddy very soon; he just had a few important things to sort out with Mommy first.

‘Everything okay?’ Robert smiled at the handsome young Frenchman, feeling funny to think that this guy, right here, had just fucked Claire.

My beautiful wife has been unfaithful. And this guy is the one she had.

‘Everything’s perfect,’ their au pair replied, half an eye on the kids as they returned to the TV and the afternoon’s episode of Sesame Street. ‘Mrs. Sayers is waiting for you downstairs.’

‘Thanks, buddy.’

He felt just the way he had at Leonardo da Vinci International Airport as he had reunited with Claire after their week in Rome. Except that this time, they wouldn’t have to wait for a ten-hour flight back home to pass before they could express their physical need for each other fully.

Robert headed downstairs into the basement, where his beloved wife was lying on Jean-Luc’s bed.

Smiley as he’d ever seen her.

‘Hey, you.’

‘Hey, you. I was just having a lovely nap,’ Claire said, sitting up, stretching with a full yawn.

‘Are you too tired...?’ he asked, sitting down on the bed beside her.

‘Oh no,’ she said. ‘Well-rested now.’

She always looked so pretty just after she’d had sex with another man. Or maybe it was just that Robert took the most notice during those

times. Of course, he'd only really had one other time to compare this to.

He leaned into her for a kiss. Her messy hair, her glowing, gleaming skin suggested she hadn't showered yet after her rumble in the hay with Jean-Luc.

And as he kissed her, he breathed her in — the funky, spicy scent of exercise, of another man's sweat, of sex that Robert had not been involved in.

It made his heartbeat quicken and his manhood thicken, more so than even the sweet, tender kiss with his beautiful wife.

'You enjoyed your happy ending, then?' he asked her between kisses.

'Uh-huh,' she smiled, grabbing his shirt as she kissed him, while he slung his hand around the back of her neck.

She was wearing a pair of panties and a T-shirt he didn't recognize. It took Robert a moment to figure out it was probably one of Jean-Luc's shirts. His hand moved to her bare legs as they kissed, enjoying her smooth, silky soft skin, detecting the slight clamminess, the faint traces that she wasn't as clean as she could have been.

Freshly fucked, no less.

She was constantly smiling as they kissed. Just beaming. He loved the little dimples in her cheeks when she was this happy. And she just couldn't tone it down right now, her hand moving to his crotch, feeling the bulge in his pants, knowing how hard he was for her right now.

'We shouldn't be long,' she said. 'The kids'll be wondering where mommy is.'

'The kids are fine,' he said. 'Jean-Luc has it all covered.'

He knelt up and removed his shirt. She knelt up and began kissing his bare torso.

'Have you started working out?' she asked him, flashing her eyes at her husband's chest.

He laughed. 'New Year's resolution — remember?'

'God,' she said, marveling at the sight of him as though she'd only just started to see in color. 'I feel like I've been taking you for granted, honey.'

'I guess when you sleep with someone else, we both get that kind of sense,' he said, taking hold of her head in both hands, sucking on her pretty lips with a real hunger as she unfastened his belt.

Kissing her, one of his hands dived down between her thighs, sweeping over the front panel of her panties to find the heat of her sex. Her underwear was a smoldering mess — soaking wet, sticky as a

patisserie disaster. Claire moaned as he stroked her well-fucked pussy through her underwear, panted as he continued sucking on her mouth.

She lay back on the bed, across the pillows, and he lay beside her, wedged against the headboard. The two of them making out like teenagers.

Absence might make the heart fonder, but adultery made it fonder still.

He ran his hand over the pleasing shape of her chest. Her nipples were pushing up so stiff against the thin material of the Frenchman's shirt. She arched her back as his hand moved over her breasts.

But then he was kissing her soft neck and stroking her pussy through her panties again. Claire's hand slid down his chest and then took hold of his hand to guide it under the waistband of her panties, urging him to touch her directly.

He loved how much she wanted it — even after gaining satisfaction from another man.

He allowed her to push his hand down, his fingers brushing through her sodden fur, until his digits dipped in her hot, oil-slick sex.

She held his wrist firmly in place as he slid his fingers inside her and began a rhythm within her tight sex.

Panting, 'Oh, *yeah...*'

Robert smiled. 'Not too worn out?'

She grinned and shook her head. As he found her clit, and circled his fingers around it, he managed to shove her shirt upward with his face — and take her stiff little pink nipples in his mouth one by one.

She stroked his head as he sucked on her nipples, sighing and panting and groaning a little louder than they would have been comfortable with at night up in their own room.

Robert just wanted to worship her. It really did take the intervention of another man to open his eyes to just how gorgeous his wife was. Sure — she was a relatively new mom, so she didn't always dress up to show off her beauty to its fullest degree. But this wasn't just a visual thing now. As he kissed his way down from her small but perfectly formed breasts to her nicely trim tummy, a powerful chemistry made him crave her so completely.

It was a slight funkiness in her scent and in her flavor, that came from the fact that she'd been violated by another man. It was the slight clamminess of her skin and — in certain places in particular — the stickiness that screamed out her wickedness. It was how she moved

under him, how she responded to him, the blissful sounds she made as he explored her adulterous form.

There were pheromones at play here — from her, from her young French lover — that ramped up her husband's desire as though he'd taken speed, or cocaine, or a mixture of the two.

And, as he kissed his way to the waistband of her panties and tugged them down so that he could stroke his nose and lips through the little dark patch of fur over her mound, it seemed that those pheromones were only getting stronger the closer he came to her sex.

Claire propped herself up on their elbows to watch him slide down her sodden panties and expose her creamy pussy. Then she lifted her hips briefly to help him remove her underwear, and moaned as he settled between her splayed thighs and dived in to eat her well-fucked pussy.

It seemed all kinds of wrong, going down on her after she'd been with another man.

Any ordinary husband would have been horrified. But then, any ordinary husband would have been seething with jealous rage long ago, so he would never have to contend with something like this.

Robert enjoyed the wickedness of worshipping his wife's adulterous pussy with his mouth. He enjoyed the forbidden nature of it, the sense of the taboo that surrounded the thought that another man had penetrated her here, that he had thrust his big dick in this exquisite pussy. He had shot his load inside her.

She lay back as he ate her, moaning and gasping for breath, and he loved how her body writhed and undulated in response.

'Oh, my God.... *Oh...*'

How she smiled and giggled and wiggled her hips to fuck his mouth while he sucked on her juicy folds.

'Oh my *God...*'

He loved how she pressed her bare feet against his back, and shuddered and jerked — and came — as he feasted on her.

They didn't need to fly to Rome for an erotic adventure. It could come to them.

'I love you, you know that?' she said after she'd pulled off his pants and underwear, then straddled him, taking his hard cock deep inside her white-hot pussy.

Again, she looked as though she'd had her blindfold removed or the lights suddenly switched on, in how she declared her love for him. She held his head with both her hands as she pushed herself down on his manhood and gazed at his face with wonder.

‘I know,’ he said, feeling like the luckiest man on Earth at that moment.

People mentioned terrible things in the world and suggested it meant there could be no God. But moments like this made Robert believe in God. Here he was, a lowly high school teacher, making love to the most gorgeous woman.

Here he was, a lowly high school teacher with two wonderful kids. What had he done to deserve it all?

‘You didn’t forget your birth control, did you?’ he smiled.

She grinned and shook her head.

He kissed her, then took her tight in his arms and rolled her over so that he lay over her, stretched out between her legs.

‘You’re so beautiful,’ he said, and now it was his turn to gaze into her eyes as though he’d just had his blindfold removed.

‘Even after some other guy just fucked me?’ she giggled.

‘Especially because some other guy just fucked you.’

She groaned as he thrust his big, hard cock into her soaking pussy.

He held the back of her neck and sucked on her lips as he slowly fucked her, remembering how it felt to watch the young Frenchman fucking her.

‘Did it feel so good when he slid his big dick inside you?’ he said, breathless.

She grinned. ‘It felt amazing. But you know what I loved most of all?’

‘What?’

‘You were telling him what to do.’

‘Mmm, yeah, that was fun.’

‘You were fucking me with his cock.’

When she said that, he pulled out from her and kissed his way down her body again. He had to have another taste of her deliciously unfaithful sex.

‘When he touched me, when he kissed me, when he fucked me — it was more than just how good it felt *physically*,’ she said, propping herself up on her elbows again to watch him work her pussy with his mouth. ‘It was like... making you feel good as well as me, all at the same time...’

He moved up beside her again, but turned her over. She went willingly, and he lay over her back, swamping her with his physicality, as though shielding her from a fire.

‘How long do you think he’ll stay?’ she asked him as he slid his cock back inside her searingly hot sex, tightened because her legs were closed.

He nuzzled into her neck, kissing her there, breathing in the pleasing scent of her hair. ‘In Rome, we had a week.’

‘It’s already been longer than a week with Jean-Luc.’

He began thrusting into her, making her body jolt under him. ‘We don’t need Marriage 2.0, you know that?’ he said. ‘Not really.’

‘We don’t?’

He kissed her under the ear. ‘We don’t need them to find you a boyfriend.’

She gasped at his words, then moaned, ‘Oh my *God*...’

‘*Two* boyfriends, if you like.’

She looked into his eyes, and her jaw dropped. ‘What will people think?’

‘People won’t have any idea.’

Later, Claire was giving Petey his evening bottle when Robert came to ask Ashley to go upstairs for her bath.

But while their two-year-old pouted about missing out on yet more Bluey time while stomping her way up the stairs, Robert ducked into the kitchen, where Jean-Luc was cheerfully cleaning up after dinner.

‘Jean-Luc, if you get the chance tomorrow...’

Claire leaned back a little on the couch to overhear her husband.

‘Yes, Mr. Sayers?’

‘Uh... do you think you could put together a dating profile for Claire?’

Claire caught her breath, and felt a sudden powerful throb between her thighs.

‘Of course, Mr. Sayers. I’d be happy to. Would you like me to put it on some of the dating websites?’

‘Uh... yeah, I think so.’

‘I’ll need some pictures.’

‘Perhaps we could take some tonight when the kids are asleep?’

‘Sounds good.’

Tonight, when the kids were asleep. Robert smiled at her as he wandered back through the living room before disappearing upstairs to give Ashley her bath. She sat looking surprised as he went past.

Well, what had she expected? He'd said they'd find her a boyfriend. God.

This wasn't normal, was it? Having a husband who turned you on this much?

When the kids were asleep, Robert took her into the bedroom and asked her to pick out some nice clothes to wear for her profile. She was buzzing as she went through her closet, choosing what looked nicest on her.

This was really happening, huh? Robert and Jean-Luc were going to put a profile for her on a dating website.

Robert also found her bikini and told her to decide on some sexy underwear.

'For the pictures?' she was confused.

'Along with the pictures we'll use for your profile, we should have some ready in case interested guys want to see more of you, right?'

'Okay...'

It was fun, though. A lot more fun than she expected. She'd never had ambitions to be a fashion model, even as a kid. Still, she enjoyed having two handsome guys paying her such intense attention.

And, as she changed clothes and stood for them in various locations in the basement, there was the continual underlying sense that this was all being done so that she could find a date. That she was going to be looking for a boyfriend.

They took pictures of her in three different outfits. Robert took some of the pictures, while Jean-Luc took others as Robert helped to position her. All the images were taken on Robert's phone.

After the profile pictures, they had Claire change into her bikini for a swimwear shoot.

Then she changed into a few different sets of lingerie.

'We don't have to send these pictures to anybody,' Robert said. 'These could be just for us if you want.'

That made her relax a little more and get into it. It was sexy, the way they directed her, the way they looked at her. The various poses — some of them seemed so raunchy, she couldn't believe it.

Then Robert asked if they could have some pictures with Jean-Luc.

The Frenchman was okay with it. Robert said if she started dating other people, they might not want her husband present when it came time to have sex. So it would be nice for him to have something to look at while he waited for her.

So she started posing with Jean-Luc.

Robert had them dress like they'd been on a date, and now they were home. Snapping away with the camera as he directed the Frenchman to begin stripping off Claire's clothes — and Claire to help Jean-Luc remove his.

She loved how her husband was looking at her. The desire on his face.

She liked thinking that he could be at home enjoying these pictures while she was out on a date.

There were some more formal-style poses, as though they were taking pictures for a magazine. Robert had them kissing, touching each other. Lying in positions on the floor. The two of them in various stages of undress around each other, embracing each other, making out.

Claire toying with Jean-Luc's big, hard cock.

Jean-Luc rubbing his cock over Claire's body. Claire taking his hard cock inside her.

After that, they took some less formal poses. They lay together on the bed, Robert directing them. Jean-Luc going down on her, fingering her. Claire kneeling in front of him, sucking on his cock. Jean-Luc lying on top of her, entering her, fucking her. Claire straddling him, taking his cock inside her, riding him.

It was so sexy, being directed by him.

He took still pictures of them, not video. Jean-Luc fucking her from behind. Standing up. Missionary style. Somehow he preferred the idea of looking at her like that. Artwork, not cinema.

It turned her on so much to have her husband watching them, directing them, focussing on them so intensely.

And then came time for Robert to lay down the phone.

While she was still riding Jean-Luc's big cock, her husband pulled down his pants and approached the head of the bed, so that she could lean over and take it in her hands, in her mouth.

God, it felt so unbelievably sexy, so incredibly filthy, to have two different men at once like this. Two cocks so big and hard for her. One pounding her pussy, the other thrusting into her throat.

She came almost immediately when she had two men fucking her at once. Then Jean-Luc made way, and Claire went on all fours for her

husband to fuck her doggy-style while the young au pair knelt up by her head, feeding her his dick.

Oh God, there was so much *man* around her. The heat, the sweat, the *testosterone* as they fucked her. She was so wet. One cock and then the other, squeezing into her, touching parts she didn't even know she had.

They all ended up one big mess of sweaty flesh, flushed, moaning, gasping for breath. Two men spraying their hot cream all over her body.

EPISODE 6

He was nervous on his way home; of course he was.
Stoked, but nervous.

Tonight was a big night.

He was shivering as he parked the car on the street outside the house. His hand trembling when he stood on the threshold and tried to unlock the front door.

‘Daddy’s home!’ came the familiar yell from Ashley as he stepped inside. He knelt down and was nearly bowled over by an over-exuberant toddler hurling herself at him, arms outstretched.

Then there was Claire, with a beautiful smile as she came through the kitchen door and saw him.

And behind her, someone else. A very familiar face.

‘Gillian?’

She looked practically the same as the last time he’d seen her. Defying time.

‘She happened to be in town again,’ Claire grinned as she kissed her husband in greeting. ‘So she dropped by.’

‘Auntie Gillian’s going to help Mom get ready for her night out with her friend,’ Ashley informed her father as Gillian stepped forward to greet him with a little kiss on the cheek and a broad smile.

‘How are you?’

‘Very good, thank you,’ Gillian beamed. ‘I’ve been having more meetings at Corporate HQ, but then I couldn’t let Claire go out on her first proper date in years without a good send-off!’

‘How’s the new job working out?’

‘Very well. I think there’s a lot of potential in this industry.’

‘We’d say there is,’ Robert nodded. ‘We had another great experience on the program. As you can see — Claire’s found herself a date.’

'And a very attractive one, judging by his pictures,' Gillian gave Claire a little squeeze. Claire blushed and smiled.

It was so nice to see Gillian again, reminding Robert of the time Claire had spent an entire week away from him, in the company of another man.

It proved a distraction from some of the nervous tension of this evening.

But then Robert had to sit with Petey and Ashley downstairs while Gillian went up to help Claire get ready for her date.

He thought he might have preferred to be with Claire, helping her pick out her outfit, her underwear for her big date. But actually, it was kind of exciting to have Gillian around — the lively, stylish blonde helping Claire to look her very best for a potential new lover.

And when Claire came downstairs, she just took Robert's breath away.

'How do I look?'

'Unbelievable.'

She was wearing a chic-looking white jacket that looked designer over a fairly simple plain white top that offered a faint suggestion of a white bra beneath. But it was the skirt that really caught the eyes — it was so short that she would probably have difficulty retrieving something if she'd dropped it. Robert sighed at how much of Claire's shapely thighs it left exposed.

And it was leopard skin print. Not the kind of thing Claire would have picked out — definitely a Gillian choice. Yet it looked somehow stylish with the jacket and top — and with the designer clutch purse they'd picked out.

'Good for a first date?'

'As long as you were hoping to get lucky on your first date.'

She grinned at that, as though he was making light of things, as though he was simply complimenting her looks. And yet, both of them flashed their eyes at each other, indicating that — actually — they were hoping she might get lucky on this first date.

'Doesn't she look amazing?' Gillian asked as she came down behind her.

'Oh yes.'

Gillian giggled. 'I'd do her myself.'

Claire laughed. 'You'll have to wait your turn.'

She did a little twirl at the bottom of the stairs for Robert, enjoying the chance to bask in his besotted gaze.

But though he just wanted to eat her up, all he got was a peck on her cheek. Even her makeup was done to perfection — and she didn't want to mess it up.

'You'll keep me updated on where you are?' he asked her.

'Of course.'

Then Robert stepped out of the way to let Gillian head out, too — assuming that the blonde would probably accompany Claire into the city.

But Gillian stayed where she was beside Robert.

Claire smiled at her husband, knowing what he was thinking. She said, 'Gillian's going to keep you company until I get back — isn't that nice of her?'

Robert glanced at the beautiful blonde, his eyebrows rising up. 'Uh... yeah...'

Gillian smiled sweetly at him.

He nodded, smiled back. Well, it would be nice to have someone to distract from constantly thinking about Claire being out with another guy.

But then Claire was actually heading out. Taking a deep breath, saying, 'Well, wish my luck, you guys!'

Gillian telling her just to relax and have fun, and if the guy turned out a disappointment, they'd get her an Uber straight home.

Claire nodded.

Then one more squeeze for Robert, her husband whispering into her ear, 'I love you. I hope you have so much fun.'

She gave him a slightly dazed smile — not quite believing they were doing this.

But knowing she could do it.

Knowing how turned on her husband had been when she'd been with Jean-Luc.

'Love you,' she said, and then it was time to go.

'How you feeling?' she asked him.

Robert heaved a huge sigh, saturated with anxiety. 'Nervous,' he said, offering Gillian a smile, which somehow didn't seem genuine even to himself.

'But you've done this before,' she grinned.

'A while ago,' he nodded. 'But this seems different.'

‘How so? Last time, she went off with Mason — and that was for a whole week.’

‘Yeah. I realize that. But you guys were... you know... on the program, like us.’

Gillian chuckled. ‘We were customers, sure, but we weren’t exactly performers.’

They were sitting in the living room — mainly because Robert had needed to sit down almost immediately after Claire left for her date. They could talk quietly in there without waking the kids.

Robert said, ‘Even so — her date tonight is just some guy from Tinder. No connections to the program at all.’

‘How do you know that?’

Robert stared at Gillian a moment, his eyes wide.

Gillian smirked. ‘I’m not saying he is from Marriage 2.0, I’m not saying he isn’t...’

Robert caught his breath. ‘Are you saying he’s one of your performers?’

‘I’m saying he could be. Does that make you feel differently about tonight?’

Robert thought about it. It would feel safer, perhaps, knowing that the guy Claire was dating was just another performer from Marriage 2.0, like Jean-Luc had been. But at the same time... something deep inside him rather wished that he wasn’t.

He liked the thought that Claire was actually out there, in the real world, dating somebody real.

‘I thought our adventure was over when Jean-Luc left us,’ he said.

Gillian shrugged, ‘It probably was. But you asked Jean-Luc to set up Claire’s dating profile, right?’

‘Uh-huh... so that means this is still part of our adventure?’

‘You sound disappointed. So you prefer that she’s out there dating somebody real, from Tinder?’

He stared at Gillian. She was beautiful — *really* beautiful. She really didn’t look like she’d aged at all since their week together in Rome. Claire had left her here to keep Robert company, knowing they’d had sex together before. Wasn’t she even slightly concerned he might be tempted to try something with her again? Or was she hoping he would?

And yet Robert was more interested in thinking about his wife being out there, dating somebody else. That was the thrilling part.

‘I guess I do,’ he said. ‘I prefer the idea that we wouldn’t always have to rely on Marriage 2.0.’

‘You’re not. Not really. Jean-Luc posted Claire’s profile, but then she fielded all the messages, right? And she chatted with the guys, she chose tonight’s date. She arranged everything with him.’

‘I suppose.’

‘You guys can do this whenever you like. You don’t need to ask someone else to set things up for you. Not now.’

He smiled. ‘I thought you were supposed to be working for Marriage 2.0 these days. Aren’t you supposed to encourage us to sign up for more adventures?’

Gillian grinned. ‘I’m not really a salesperson,’ she said. ‘I recruit talent.’

‘Performers.’

‘Uh-huh.’

‘So do you know whether her date tonight is... one of your guys?’

Gillian smiled, and seemed to hesitate a moment before she shook her head. ‘I’m not really involved in Casting,’ she said. ‘In Human Resources, we deal with taking on new people, managing any problems existing staff members have, and that kind of thing. We’re not involved in customer programs.’

Robert sighed. His hands seemed to move on their own to his lap, where his manhood was at least semi-hard within his pants. It was difficult not to just tell Gillian he needed to go to the restroom and disappear for some self-release.

He was so aroused. But he had to pace himself.

‘Look,’ Gillian said. ‘I’m only here because I’m your friend. I’m one of the few people you’ve ever told about your time with Marriage 2.0 —

‘The only one, I think,’ Robert noted.

‘Exactly. So because you and Claire seem to need a little company right now, I’m here. I’m here as your friend — not because I work for Marriage 2.0.’

Robert nodded, but needed a moment to analyze what she’d said.

‘So I can assume you’re not part of our program.’

‘Definitely not — I think ethically, because I’m an employee and I know you, I’d have to recuse myself.’

‘But you did entice Claire into the program with your staff discounts,’ Robert said.

Gillian shook her head. ‘Claire was the one who came to me and said she was thinking about going back to Marriage 2.0. That was before I even told her I was working for them now.’

‘Seriously?’

‘Uh-huh. She said she thought you guys needed a little boost.’

‘Oh.’

Strangely, Robert liked the thought that Claire had independently come up with the idea to try Marriage 2.0 again.

Gillian said, ‘I actually said you guys know what kinds of things turn you on, and suggested she didn’t even need to go to Marriage 2.0. But she said she wanted to be sure you did something both of you wanted to do.’

Robert felt his manhood thickening more at hearing about Claire’s desire for more extra-marital adventure.

‘I guess if we’d just tried to do what we did before,’ he said, ‘then maybe we would have tried some kind of swinging thing. Instead, it was all about Claire and Jean-Luc.’

Robert noticed Gillian adjust her seated position slightly, as though her thighs were getting a little overheated. Was she thinking about how it had been on their week in Rome? Was she hoping he was going to make a move on her tonight?

But he wanted to save himself for Claire.

‘If you think about it,’ Gillian said, ‘When you were with me that week in Rome, most of the time you were wondering about how Claire was getting on with Mason.’

‘I was.’

‘And then they let you watch her with him. That was the peak of your adventure, right?’

‘So they knew, even back then, that I mainly just wanted Claire to sleep with someone else? So why did they engineer it so that I slept with you all week?’

Gillian laughed. ‘You didn’t enjoy it?’

‘I’m not saying that...’

‘The artificial intelligence would have calculated that the best experience for everybody was to have you sleep with me, and Claire sleep with Mason.’ Gillian shrugged, ‘Maybe Claire likes — or liked — the thought of you being with someone else.’

‘And now she doesn’t?’

‘I don’t know. Tastes change over the years.’

They went downstairs to watch TV in the den in the basement, so they could make a little more noise than up in the living room. They were watching some kind of reality TV show where lots of young and very bland people with orange tans and overly bright white teeth were flirting with each other.

Robert poured them both large glasses of white wine as Gillian asked him how he was doing for the umpteenth time.

‘They must be coming to the end of dinner right about now, don’t you think?’ he asked her.

‘I would say.’

‘So I guess... what’s next? Too early to go straight back to his place...’

‘You think a guy would say ‘no’ if Claire suggested it?’

Robert laughed. ‘No, but I think Claire would feel weird suggesting it this early. And if he suggested it this early... hmm. Well, I don’t know everything they’ve been texting between themselves since they were first matched on Tinder...’

Gillian said, ‘She doesn’t let you read her text messages from him?’

‘I never really asked. I don’t know... I guess I don’t want to cramp her style. Don’t want to seem overbearing.’

‘A helicopter husband.’

‘Exactly. It’s enough for me that she’s shown me his pictures, and she’s told me all about him, and I know when she’s going out with him... and she’s going to tell me all about it if she sleeps with him...’

Gillian flashed her eyes. ‘Will you feel disappointed if it doesn’t happen tonight?’

He shrugged. ‘I guess it would be hard not to be. But if it doesn’t, hopefully it will soon.’

‘Claire’s so much more self-confident now than when we were in Rome.’

‘Yeah. Partly because of what happened, I think.’

‘And because she’s a little older, probably. And a mom. And married to you.’

‘And because we had a handsome French au pair stay with us for three weeks, and for most of the time, he and Claire were at it like bunny rabbits.’

‘And because when they were at it like bunny rabbits, most of the time you were with them, telling them what to do.’

Robert grinned. ‘Now you’re really making me seem like a helicopter husband.’

‘She seemed to enjoy it. A lot.’

Robert took a swig of his wine, feeling a touch embarrassed, but also strangely proud that this beautiful blonde should know so much about his and Claire’s recent sex life.

While he was mid-swig, his phone buzzed with a text message.

Gillian’s phone buzzed too.

Robert glanced at the message Claire had sent to them both.

‘They’re in an ‘intimate’ cocktail bar,’ Gillian read from her screen, her eyes flashing again as she added, ‘And she’s already kissed him.’

Robert felt his heart throb with a flash of intense heat. Now it was his turn to shift in his seat — to conceal his now-full erection.

‘What’s an ‘intimate’ cocktail bar?’

‘Probably somewhere fairly dark. Cozy. They can probably sit in a booth and cuddle up, and not many people can see them.’

A few moments later, their phones buzzed again, and Robert was startled to find that his wife had sent them a selfie of her and her date making out.

Looking at it, he felt the wind knocked out of him. And yet his marble column of an erection told him that he was as excited as he could be.

‘You’ve done this before,’ Gillian said, sensing his need for reassurance.

‘Yes,’ he nodded. ‘But that doesn’t make it any easier.’

Gillian gave him an encouraging smile, which said she was impressed by him, he was doing superbly. She said, ‘You know you can call her back any time you want.’

Then her phone beeped, and Robert’s did not.

‘Look, she’s asking me if you’re really okay,’ she said, showing him her screen. ‘You’re okay, right?’

He nodded.

Gillian tapped away at a reply. Then giggled as Claire sent another message.

‘She says maybe I could distract you,’ she said, then flashed her pretty blue eyes his way. ‘I wonder what she means.’

‘She said that?’

Gillian showed him her screen again. ‘You see? Maybe she still has fantasies about you sleeping with other people.’

Robert laughed. ‘Or else she just feels guilty for getting to date other people, even though she knows that’s what I want.’

‘She was okay about what you and I did in Rome?’

He shrugged. 'Yeah, I guess so.'

'When you got home, did you talk about it much?'

'Yeah, you could say that.'

'Mostly about Claire and Mason, or did you talk about us, too?'

'Mostly her and Mason.'

More wine.

'What happened with you and Mason after our week?' Robert asked her.

'We talked a lot,' she said. 'Fucked a lot.'

'He was okay with what happened?'

'Oh, yes,' Gillian nodded.

'And you were okay with what he did?'

'I was fine with it. I mean... it wasn't as *cute* as you guys...'

'*Cute*'?' Robert laughed.

Gillian smiled. 'You guys are all about each other,' she explained. 'It's *so* cute. You get off on her sleeping with other guys... and here she's trying to make you feel better about being left at home by asking me to distract you...'

'You and Mason...'

She shook her head. 'I mean, I *love* him. I always will. He's given me so much. And I don't see the need to leave him. But we got back, he decided he had permission to sleep with whoever he wanted... and he didn't really care if I did the same.'

'Oh.'

She shrugged. 'I mean, it's fine. He doesn't get jealous if I feel like sleeping with some guy I met at a bar. And I really don't care who he sleeps with.'

'But do you guys still... together...?'

'Sure,' she said. 'We still have fun together. I mean, that's all you can ask for a marriage, right?'

'I guess.'

'Sometimes, we even share somebody,' Gillian said.

Robert nodded, and his thoughts turned to how it had been between Claire, himself, and their French au pair, Jean-Luc.

'But you consider your Marriage 2.0 adventure was a success, right?' he asked her.

'Sure. I mean, I wouldn't work for the company if I didn't believe in it.'

'You just don't seem like you got your Disney happy ending.'

She smiled. 'I think we're far happier than we would have been,' she said. 'I think, honestly, if we hadn't done the program, he would have ended up cheating on me, and I would have taken it personally. And that would have been it for us.'

'Oh, right.'

'You just have to accept: different couples have different kinds of happy ending.'

Claire sent two more selfies. One was of her smooching her date by the Bethesda Fountain in Central Park.

'A nice, romantic walk in the park, huh?' Gillian said, seeing how her words jabbed into Robert.

The second selfie was at another 'intimate' cocktail bar an hour later. Claire had taken off her jacket, and as she kissed her date for the picture, it was clear to Robert that her nipples were stiff, pushing against her top.

Half an hour after that, she sent a message to them both saying that her date, Brad, lived at such-and-such an address in Brooklyn, and that they were now en route.

'Successful date, wouldn't you say?' Gillian asked him.

'I would,' Robert nodded. He'd stopped drinking wine by this point, feeling like he needed a clear head both to fully appreciate the experience of Claire being out with a new lover, and because he wanted to be sexually capable when she got back.

Gillian was up on her feet, having fetched another glass of vino for herself. But her drinking had slowed considerably, too.

'You told Mason you were seeing us while you were in town?' he asked her.

'Uh-huh,' she nodded.

'What did he say?'

'He said to pass on his regards. He said he wished he could be here too, to see Claire again.'

Robert grinned. He liked having a wife that other men wanted. Was that ego? Of course it was.

'Did he think you'd end up sleeping with me again?' Robert asked her.

Gillian shrugged. 'I'm guessing he assumed it would happen.'

Robert said, 'Am I a huge disappointment?'

She giggled. 'Just because we're not fucking right now? Of course not. I know you enough to know you're saving yourself for your honey. Although... I think I was going to be Claire's little present for you for tonight...'

'I just don't think I could handle two women in one night,' he said earnestly. 'I mean... maybe when I was in my twenties...'

'I bet you could if you paced yourself.'

'I'd have two unfulfilled women on my hands, instead of one semi-fulfilled.'

Gillian laughed. 'You are too modest, Mister. And anyway, you know right about now, Brad's getting started on ensuring she's already fulfilled by the time she gets back to you?'

'Oh, right.'

'And when she sees how horny you are for her, because she just banged Brad, she's going to be pretty easy to fulfill for a second time tonight, too.'

Robert nodded. 'Even so, I'd be better off waiting for my beloved...'

The pretty blonde sipped her wine. Then, after a moment, she said, 'We could tell people we did it... Claire... Mason, at least.'

Robert laughed. 'We could, couldn't we? But probably no one else.'

He watched as she reached behind herself, under her top. Then, with an odd little dance, she pulled out a bra made of black satin.

'We'd need to make it look believable if we're going to make up a story for Claire,' she said, flinging her bra across the room as though it had come off in the heat of passion.

'Uh... I guess so,' Robert said.

Gillian strode slowly around the den, gazing around. Robert could see her nipples pushing stiff against her t-shirt, now she no longer had a bra.

'I suppose realistically,' she said, 'would we have ended up on the bed in the guest room?'

'We might have.'

'I think it looks a little pristine right now...'

She went into the guest bedroom. A few moments later, a curious Robert leaned in the guest room doorway himself, to find her lying on the bed, making it look suitably rumpled.

'Does it look authentic?'

He said, 'I suppose.'

She pulled herself up off the bed, stepping toward him. 'Maybe we should pull the covers off. Or... she could come home, find us naked.'

Well, she said it. And now he had the image of her naked in his head. It was difficult not to be tempted — she was a very attractive woman. Had Claire really meant for her to be a little ‘present’ for him for the evening, to distract him from her date?

In front of him, she stooped to remove her jeans. ‘Maybe just underwear...’ she said.

He gazed at the bed, which looked like somebody had just laid down on it for a moment or two — hardly a bed that a couple of people had fucked on. Would Claire feel offended if he’d rejected her ‘present’?

Their phones buzzed again. Robert felt his heart nearly leap out of his chest.

A selfie of Claire and Brad outside Brad’s apartment.

Then, a selfie of Claire standing in front of a bathroom mirror, looking gorgeous. Somehow, she had lost her top and was standing there in a sexy white lacy bra and her breathtakingly short, leopard-print skirt.

Her message read: *Date couldn’t be going better. Brad is terrific. I guess this is the last chance for any objections... it’s all happening now. Hope you two have been enjoying some nice distractions xx*

Reading her words made Robert catch his breath. Well, she had arranged for Gillian to be here with him as a ‘distraction.’ Knowing that they’d previously slept together. A jealous wife wouldn’t do that.

‘She’s going to fuck him,’ Gillian said. ‘Any minute now.’

‘She is,’ he nodded, feeling the butterflies fluttering in his stomach. ‘God... maybe I really do need some kind of distraction.’

He laid eyes on the beautiful blonde, standing there in her t-shirt and panties. She smiled, stepped up, and draped her arms over his shoulders.

She kissed his lips, and it was far too enjoyable. ‘You know to make this really authentic, you’ll have to smell of me.’

He drew in a deep chestful of her sweet perfume. ‘We could both take showers. We’d smell of shampoo.’

‘We’d wake the kiddos if we took showers.’

‘Hmm...’ he said, pulling her toward him. ‘In that case, I think I really am going to have to find a way to smell of you...’

He put his arms around her slim waist and kissed her, and she went up on tiptoes to kiss him back, her hands clutching his shoulders. It felt way better than it should have, given his insistence that he only had eyes for his wife. It made him feel guilty.

But this was simply human chemistry, wasn’t it? Man being attracted to woman. It was merely lust, not love.

She was pressing herself against him — leaning into him, and he knew she had to be feeling his hard cock pressing at her body through their clothes. He swept a hand up inside her t-shirt, for a moment forgetting she'd removed her bra until his fingers glided over her small but delectable breasts, the feeling of bare skin surprising but delighting him.

She moaned as he gently pinched one of her nipples.

But then he felt one of her hands grab his wrist, and she was directing his digits down her body, under the waistband of her remaining underwear, over a heart-stoppingly hairless mound, and down into the hot, soaking vale between her thighs.

'You need evidence, right?' she said quietly, breathless, between kisses.

He slipped a finger inside her slick pussy. 'What are you going to tell Mason we did?'

'Everything,' she grinned as he started to work his finger inside her. 'The works.'

'And Claire?'

'I think she'll want to imagine you made full use of her gift, so you weren't all angsty about her being with Brad.'

'Hmm,' Robert said. 'We will need evidence.'

He sank to the floor before her and tugged down her panties. She dutifully stepped out of them after they'd fallen to the floor, and then he was kissing his way around her perfectly shaven pussy. She put an encouraging hand on his cranium as his mouth arrived at her slick folds.

Then she lifted a foot over his shoulder, resting it on the bed so he had easier access to her sex.

And it really was good distraction from the torment of his cuckolding. He gazed up at the beautiful blonde's body as he lapped at her pussy, and it was like a close-up view of a supermodel — but one who had shed most of her clothes.

She peeled off her top.

Correction: one who had shed *all* her clothes.

This was what Claire wanted, right? A nice distraction for him.

She tasted so good. She smelled so good. She felt so good, she looked so good.

She stroked his hair as he feasted on her pussy, sucking on her soaking lips, smothering her clit with his hot mouth. He had no problem if she wanted to come. After a while, though, her legs were shaking.

He lay on the bed and had her straddle his face, and it didn't matter that her slender legs went all wobbly when he made her come with his mouth. She just rode the wave, worked her hips over him, ground her dripping-wet pussy against his lips and tongue.

By the end, she was riding his head like it was one of those mechanical bull-riding contraptions at a rodeo.

Spreading her wetness all over his face.

But then she was declaring her right of reciprocation. Stripping off his clothes as he insisted he wanted to save his main event for his returning wife.

'I'll just play a little,' she said, adding, 'she'll know you didn't really do anything if it's only your face that smells of me.'

She had to have his hard cock inside her, she said. Or else Claire would know.

Robert let her straddle his hips and sit firmly on his solid cock. It felt good, sure. She seemed to enjoy it, too. He even rolled her over onto all fours so he could fuck her doggy style — her butt was just a peachy dream. He just had to make very sure he didn't come.

He almost didn't make it. He made her come again, and nearly shot her full of his cream. He just managed to control himself at the last moment.

Then they were lying on their backs, gasping for breath, listening out for the baby monitor in case their last round had woken the kiddos.

And Robert realized he hadn't checked his phone in ages.

Claire was on her way home.

EPISODE 7

He lay there on his back as she came in, so hard the bedsheet half-covering him looked like a tent for the Cirque du Soleil.

‘So you had fun?’ he asked her.

Her full lips curled upward in a joyful smile as she removed her coat.

‘Oh yes, definitely. And you?’

He grinned. ‘You told Gillian to seduce me?’

Claire giggled. ‘I thought you might like to remember old times.’

She peeled off her top, and he caught his breath at the sight of her bare breasts.

‘You know the best thing about the old times was watching you with Mason?’ he said, his stiff manhood twitching with desire under the bedsheet.

She giggled again. He loved it when she was giggly like this. ‘Don’t tell me you don’t have a good time with Gillian. She’s gorgeous.’

‘She is attractive,’ he conceded.

Then she removed her skirt, and he saw her little white cotton panties — fairly plain but for a little feminine bow over her mound. His eyes lit up. She looked as though she’d wet herself.

‘Brad’s attractive, then?’ he smiled, his eyes traveling up her slender but curvaceous frame, finally reaching her amused brown eyes.

‘Very,’ she said, stepping to the bed. ‘Turns out he’s five years older than me — but you’d never know it.’

‘He gave you enough bang from his buck, though?’

She grinned, ‘Oh yes, can’t you tell?’ She gazed down and, with her thumbs and forefingers, tugged the waistband of her little panties upward, so the thin material tightened over the alluring shape of her pussy — emphasizing the large wet spot that sprawled over her well-used sex.

‘You still have energy left for this?’ he said, his eyes directing hers toward the festival going on under the marquee covering him from the waist down.

‘Absolutely,’ she said, crawling onto the bed, brushing her face gently up one of his legs as she went.

She let out a low moan as she came to his crotch, and stroked his stiff shaft with her nose through the bedsheet.

‘I can smell her on you,’ she said, almost in awe.

He was glad he’d let Gillian talk him into fooling around.

‘I wasn’t sure you were particularly interested in... that kind of thing,’ he said. ‘You know... the way our second Marriage 2.0 adventure went.’

She grinned. ‘You’re my honey. I like to do nice things for my honey sometimes,’ she said, as though Gillian had simply been a nice box of chocolates, or a new motorcycle. But Claire dwelled over his lap a while, stroking him with her cheeks and her jaw, indulging in the gently musky, spicy scent emanating from beneath the sheet.

‘Did it feel so good being inside her again?’ she asked him.

‘It felt good,’ he said. ‘But I couldn’t stop thinking about you.’

She giggled. ‘You’re just saying that.’

‘No, I’m not.’

She kissed her way up his bare stomach, his chest, breathing deep, long chestfuls of air laced with the scent of Gillian.

But now he could also detect the strange new scent of another man on Claire. She lay over him, and he resisted the temptation to just grab hold of her in a bear hug, turn her over and screw the living daylights out of her.

He wanted to take his time and appreciate the full experience of his wife’s latest little adventure in adultery.

He put his hands on her slim waist and craned his neck to kiss her lips. She was gazing into his eyes with complete adoration, and perhaps a touch of amusement at how he tried so valiantly to remain calm, relaxed, almost casual. Men didn’t like to reveal their emotions too much, huh?

Then she ducked her head down a little, allowing him to kiss her more deeply.

He sucked on her warm, sweet lips, tasting the strange funk of another man on her, inhaling that musty, curious piquant scent from the sex she’d enjoyed with somebody else. Enjoying the warmth of her body on his, the dancing of her hot breath on his face, the silkiness of her long, dark hair as he ran his fingers through it.

‘I can taste her on you,’ she whispered, breathless, her high cheekbones emphasized by her beaming smile.

‘I can taste him on you,’ he chuckled.

She giggled. ‘It’s so *naughty*.’

‘Mmm-hmm.’

She sucked on his lips some more, savoring them as though at a wine tasting. ‘You went down on her,’ she said. ‘She must’ve enjoyed that.’

‘I think I may have gotten another five-star review on Amazon,’ he joked.

‘God,’ she laughed. ‘If women could buy oral sex from you on Amazon... we wouldn’t have to worry about our mortgage.’

‘I’d probably lose my teaching job, though. School Boards tend to frown on teachers selling sex online.’

She sat up, and he ran his fingers all over her bare chest, marveling at the slight stickiness, the clamminess of her skin. It was only faintly detectable, as though she’d just had a workout at the gym and hadn’t yet showered — but it was further evidence of her tryst with another man, so it turned Robert on like crazy.

‘The kids were okay?’ she asked him.

‘Sound asleep,’ he said, glancing over at the bedside table where the baby monitor had been.

‘Gillian has the monitor upstairs,’ Claire said, peeling back the sheet to expose his hard cock.

Robert raised his eyebrows. ‘She’s staying overnight?’

‘Of course.’ She began kissing her way down his bare chest, the corners of her mouth once again curling upwards as she reached the large tumescence waiting for her.

‘We’re keeping her up late.’

‘She doesn’t mind. She’s been having a good time tonight.’

She brushed her nose lightly down his shaft, breathing him in, then caressed him gently with her lower lip. She wasn’t jealous about him being with another woman, then. She gave him an exploratory lick, and that didn’t seem to put her off either.

Then she gently took his hardness in her hand, brushed her hair back behind her ear with the other, and slipped the tip of his manhood into her mouth.

Robert groaned at the intense heat that enveloped his sensitive glans.

Claire moaned quietly as she sank down on his hardness. He could feel her moan through her mouth as she stretched her lips around him, and engulfed him between her cheeks.

She lifted off him, then kissed him slowly around the root of his cock, inhaling the smell of his sex with Gillian.

Was she like him, then? In more ways than he'd thought? She was taking pleasure in the fact he'd been with someone else.

She picked up his cock again, pumping it slowly in her tight fist, gazing up at him with a contented smile as she slipped the end into her mouth some more.

God, she'd never been this good at oral sex when they'd started dating. And if she'd picked up a few tips from her week with Mason in Rome, it seemed like she'd absorbed a full training course when Jean-Luc was with them.

Had she done this with Brad tonight? She must have done.

Claire giggled. 'What were you thinking about just then?'

'Huh?'

'Your cock was, like, *throbbing*.'

He smiled. 'I was thinking you probably did this with Brad tonight — and I was thinking how much he must've enjoyed it.'

She lifted up from him. 'I did do this with Brad,' she grinned. 'And he sure seemed to enjoy it.'

He urged her up so he could kiss her mouth. Such a thrill to know she'd used it on her date.

'And you fucked him, too?' he said.

She beamed and nodded. Kneeling up to tug down her soaking panties. 'You want proof?'

'Uh-huh.'

She knew what he liked. They'd done this enough times after she'd fucked Jean-Luc. She pulled down her panties, and that dark, spicy scent of her adulterous sex thickened considerably. In the low light from the bedside lamp, he could see how messy her date had left her pussy.

'He came inside you?'

'I told you — he's been tested.'

'He dates a lot, then?'

'He's very good-looking.'

She dropped her panties on his face. He picked them up. They were sticky with another man's emissions. Robert shivered at seeing such clear-cut evidence of his wife's adultery.

But then she turned around, straddling his chest but facing away from him, backing up so his vision was filled by her gorgeous heart-shaped rear.

He sat up a little so he could plant little kisses on her peachy cheeks. Then he lay back and pulled her by the hips over him, until her sticky, glistening sex touched down on his eager mouth.

He'd gotten used to the flavor of a man on her pussy. It didn't freak him out.

You couldn't really be squeamish about what a man did with your wife if you genuinely wanted to share. Robert wasn't even slightly tempted by the thought of being with another guy — he was just incredibly turned on by the way another guy left her once he was done.

He was just incredibly turned on by Claire being promiscuous.

He moaned as he ate her unfaithful pussy, cleaning her up while getting her wetter and wetter at the same time. And for a while, she just sat over him, gently rocking her hips, grinding her soaking-wet sex against his mouth, brushing her clit against his chin.

Then she lay forward over him, taking his hardness in her hands, delighting in the proof of his excitement for her and her evening's date, along with the fact that she'd given him the gift of Gillian while she'd been away.

She came like that — nothing dramatic, but slow and sensual, the best kind of orgasm when you've had an intense evening already.

She came, and then she pulled her sweet pussy away from him, leaving his face cold with the wetness plastered over his cheeks.

They were so quiet.

Almost silent as she turned to face him before impaling herself on his pole. Sighs, quiet moans, but no cries or yells as she took his gloriously hard cock deep inside her pussy, and started to ride him like a bull.

They'd trained themselves to be quiet.

They had the perfect skills for the parents of young kids who were constantly horny for each other. They could fuck quietly enough, now, to do it without waking the children.

Marriage 2.0 had done that for them as part of their program. It was an understated part of their program, sure, but perhaps one of the most important of all, considering they lived in a small house.

Just because it was silent, it was still sexy as hell to watch his wife riding his hard cock, to see her open her mouth wide as though moaning loudly. Screw her eyes tight shut from the intensity of the sensations running through her flushed, sweaty body.

They were quiet enough that when Gillian came downstairs and placed the baby monitor on the bedside table, they could hear it.

They'd react if one of the kiddos needed them.

‘You guys are amazing,’ the pretty blonde whispered, watching as Claire shuddered from another mild but delightful orgasm, and her riding of her husband slowed.

‘It’s better when we’re quiet,’ Claire grinned and lifted herself off her husband.

Robert was confused about what was going on, but assumed that Gillian had reached the limit of her night’s energy, and was about to suggest she sleep up in their bedroom, while he continued to indulge in his wife’s exquisite promiscuity down here.

But Claire was calmly making way. Getting up off the bed. And Gillian was casually peeling off her top, and taking off her jeans and underwear.

His naked, dark-haired wife sat in the little armchair in the corner.

Their naked, blonde-haired friend climbed onto the bed, lying between Robert’s thighs.

Then Claire was sitting there, gently stroking her pussy while watching Gillian take her husband’s cock in her hands, and direct it to her beautiful ruby-red lips.

‘Sweetheart?’ he said, glancing over at her.

‘What?’ Claire grinned. ‘I wanna see.’

Gillian smiled sweetly up at him, even though her mouth was full. Robert just tilted his head back and groaned. Well, he supposed he’d gotten to watch his wife with Jean-Luc enough times. Fair’s fair.

Gillian was good, he had to admit. And sexy as you wouldn’t believe. That cute little butt of hers pushed upward as she sucked on him.

And when the blonde climbed onto him to take his cock inside her, she rode him facing Claire. She let Claire see everything as she filled her tight, shaven pussy with his big hard-on.

‘Does that feel good, honey?’ his wife asked him as the pretty blonde worked her hips to fuck his huge cock.

‘Oh yes, sweetie. So good. You like watching her fucking me?’

‘I do... it’s so sexy...’

Gillian moaned and wailed as she used his enormous cock. She wasn’t so well-trained in being silent as the others. They were safe enough in the basement if it was only her.

Robert had her on all fours, thrusting into her deliciously tight pussy from behind, and she could at least bury her face in the pillows to stifle her gasps and whimpers.

Then as the blonde began rising toward another orgasm, and Robert fought to keep well away from one, Claire got up from the armchair and

approached the bed. Robert assumed she wanted to take over from the gorgeous blonde for a while. Switch over like tag-team wrestlers.

But to his astonishment, Claire calmly knelt at the foot of the bed, right in front of Gillian's face, as the pretty blonde was rocked by Robert's thrusts.

Then Claire quietly took Gillian's head in her hands and kissed her lips tenderly, passionately.

Wow.

It was so beautiful. Two attractive women sucking on each other's lips. It certainly seemed to draw Gillian over the edge into a powerful climax — but seeing his wife tangling tongues with their gorgeous friend was too much for Robert, too. He felt like someone had pushed him off a high cliff — there was no way he could stop himself from going.

Then while Claire ran her fingers through Gillian's soft, golden hair and moaned while they savored each other's lips, Robert began jerking and bucking — and firing off his hot oil deep inside the blonde's exquisite pussy.

The surprises kept on coming. Recovering his breath, Robert found himself presented with the baby monitor by his wife.

Claire giggled. 'It's your turn to sit with the baby monitor, honey.'

He furrowed his brow. Gillian lay back on the bed, looking just ravishing. Claire lay beside her, looking just as divine. Putting her arm over the beautiful blonde's chest, leaning in for another sweet kiss.

'Oh, uh... okay...' he said, taking a seat in the armchair.

Claire smiled. 'Thanks, honey.'

Gillian gave him a mischievous little wave and blew him a kiss.

He made himself comfortable and watched his wife kiss her way down Gillian's toned stomach.

'Honey, you've made a real mess of her,' Claire said before ducking down between the blonde's shapely thighs.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Max Sebastian is the Amazon-bestselling author of *The Madeleine Trilogy*, *What's Mine is Yours* and *A Lockdown Affair*.

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A promotional poster for the TV show 'Marriage 2.0 Season Three'. The background features a woman in a white lace bra and underwear, and a man's torso in jeans. The text is overlaid in white.

BEGINS JAN 6, 2024

CHANGE THE RULES

MARRIAGE 2.0

SEASON THREE

WRITTEN BY

MAX SEBASTIAN

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